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Culture mechanics

culture mechanics *noun*
Status: proposed theoretical term
Field: moral psychology (psychology of morality), social psychology, cultural psychology, organizational psychology, organization studies, sociology of morality, sociology of culture, cultural theory, distributed cognition

Short definition

Culture mechanics is a proposed framework for explaining how culture is installed in people, activated in particular situations, synchronized across groups, reproduced through institutions, and deliberately or accidentally changed.

It describes the human being as **homo duplex**, a creature with two functionally distinct processing units. The first is a powerful, general-purpose processor: the brain's main CPU. The second is a simpler social and affective processor called the **bigOther**. The bigOther does not reason in detail. It classifies thoughts, persons, actions, and situations by attaching culturally learned sentiments to them: honour or shame, loyalty or betrayal, sacredness or pollution, legitimacy or illegitimacy, belonging or exclusion.

Although the bigOther is comparatively primitive, it is connected at a decisive point. By changing how a person *feels* about what the main processor is thinking, it can redirect attention, motivation, judgment, and action before conscious reasoning notices what has happened. A proposed second output path can also condition whether rider-side conceptual retrieval, joining, and articulation continue, without making the bigOther the processor that performs those operations. It is programmed slowly with a **mythological lens** and activated quickly by social signals. In terminology adapted from Systems Leadership, a **mythology** is one socially evaluated narrative or story. Many mythologies, reinforced by symbols, rituals, institutional practices, rewards, punishments, and exemplary behaviour, shape the lens through which the bigOther maps real-world observations and events onto culturally learned values and feelings.

The **single-slot principle** proposes one local bigOther executing one operative mythological lens. That lens may braid several compatible cultural packages into a complex program; it is not a hierarchy of parallel bigOthers. An incompatible governing worldview must be rejected, or the incumbent weave must be unbraided sufficiently for one successor to be rebraided and installed.

Stable installation means **complete slot occupancy** or, in a neutral architectural sense, **full capture**. A first-order program and a lifted second-order meta-program can each fully occupy the one slot. A lifted program does not govern less. The order-level distinction concerns what is shared: first-order mechanical solidarity shares concrete rules and answers; lifted mechanical solidarity shares the rules that generate, select, apply, and revise concrete answers. Plural lives and bounded subordinate jurisdictions can follow from that architecture, but do not define it. Whether either form of full capture is open and corrigible or closed and pathological is a separate question.

The bigOther also has a special capacity: it can couple with the bigOthers of other people. It encodes its classifications in words, stories, gestures, roles, titles, symbols, and sanctions that are intelligible within a shared symbolic order. Reciprocal signalling can synchronize many locally programmed individuals into an emergent social field. That field can present the collective in self-like form and, under sufficiently integrated conditions, become an **operative multi-mind-self**. Culture is the relatively stable evaluative programming and social coordination produced and reproduced through this loop.

An operative multi-mind-self need not erase the persons through whom it acts. Culture mechanics therefore distinguishes **differentiated unity**, in which a real *we* preserves different functions, judgments, relationships, and

legitimate jurisdictions, from **subjecthood absorption (fusion)**, in which those personal standings are increasingly denied against the collective. Collective agency, synchronization, and fusion are related but independent properties.

For explanatory convenience, *multi-mind-self* may also be used as a broad family-level shorthand for a collective represented or encountered as one self. Strict analytical claims distinguish **multi-mind-self presentation** from the **operative multi-mind-self / multi-mind-self proper** and from a **fused multi-mind-self**. The shorthand alone licenses no inference to intention, ownership, responsibility, or fusion.

Some ideological symbols are **conformity signals**: their performance, absence, or refusal makes a person's relation to the installed program publicly legible. Such signals can turn private classification into monitoring, apparent consensus, recruitment, moralized exclusion, institutional coercion, or collective action. A conformity signal can also become a **targeting signal** when nonperformance exposes a sanctionable outsider; imposed marks and attributed labels can make the same target classification legible without requiring refusal.

In one sentence:

> **Culture mechanics is the study of how mythologies shape the mythological lens, how the bigOther uses that lens to give social feeling to observations and thoughts, and how networked bigOthers turn those feelings into collective order and action.**

Long definition

1. General meaning

Culture mechanics is an explanatory model of culture as a **distributed system of sentiment classification, social coordination, and symbolic reality-construction**.

The term *mechanics* expresses a specific ambition. Culture mechanics does not stop at naming or classifying phenomena such as conformity, indoctrination, collective effervescence, moral commitment, ideology, group identity, or crowd behaviour. It asks how these phenomena are produced:

- What are the functional components?
- What information or programming does each component contain?
- How is that programming learned?
- Which signals activate it?
- How does it influence thought and action?
- How are separate people coordinated or synchronized?
- How is the resulting culture stabilized by rituals and institutions?
- Under what conditions can it be inspected, resisted, or reprogrammed?

Culture mechanics therefore treats culture not merely as a collection of customs or beliefs, but as an operative system with inputs, internal state, evaluative rules, affective outputs, communication channels, feedback loops, and institutional memory. This entry begins with the individual source and coupling interface. The emergent field and its back-action upon epistemic judgment are developed in *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*.

2. Homo duplex: the dual-processing human

The model calls the human being **homo duplex** because human conduct results from the interaction of two functionally different processing units.

This is a deliberate extension of Émile Durkheim's term rather than a claim that Durkheim described precisely this architecture. In culture mechanics, the duality is between:

1. a powerful general-purpose processor; and
2. a simpler, culturally programmable sentiment-classification processor.

The two units are connected but not reducible to one another within this theory. This is a constitutive functional commitment, not a claim that two anatomical organs have been discovered. The bigOther must therefore not be silently redescribed as merely System 1, a generic heuristic, the superego, internalized norms, or an output of ordinary cognition. Those concepts may illuminate aspects of its operation, but none replaces the proposed second component without revising the theory itself.

A person's intelligence, knowledge, or technical competence does not by itself reveal how the person's bigOther is programmed. The main CPU may remain intelligent, computationally powerful, and capable of elementary

verification while the bigOther changes which conclusions feel admissible, honourable, shameful, safe, or unthinkable. Conversely, a person's cultural programming does not determine the full extent of the person's intellectual capacities.

This relative independence explains why a highly intelligent person may be strongly governed by ideological or religious classifications, while a person of ordinary intelligence may preserve considerable moral and epistemic independence. The main processor determines much of what a person *can* think; the bigOther strongly influences which thoughts feel admirable, shameful, safe, dangerous, permissible, or unthinkable.

Durkheimian dualism and the Culture Mechanics decomposition Durkheim introduces the "old formula *homo duplex*" and the image of a "double center of gravity" in "The Dualism of Human Nature and Its Social Conditions" (1914; reproduced as Chapter 10 of *Émile Durkheim on Morality and Society*, pp. 149–163). His two poles are the individual, organism-rooted life of sensations and sensory appetites and the socially derived intellectual and moral life. The second pole includes not only collective sentiments and moral authority but also language, concepts, and theoretical and practical rational activity. Durkheim therefore does not divide the person into an unconscious social censor and a conscious individual reasoner.

His account also explains how the social pole becomes intrapersonal. Religious, moral, and intellectual conceptions formed in group life penetrate individual consciousness, become durably organized and personally inflected there, retain a socially derived authority, and are renewed through continuing collective life. His description of the person's social existence as "an extension of society" therefore names a locally individualized social formation rather than a literal detached fragment of one collective mind.

The closest Culture Mechanics relation is a decomposition rather than a one-to-one match:

Durkheimian element	Closest Culture Mechanics relation	Required boundary
Organism-rooted sensation and appetite	Elephant-side embodied, affective, and appetitive processing	This does not exhaust the main CPU or make Durkheim's first pole identical with Haidt's elephant.
Collectively formed language, concepts, and rational resources	Shared symbolic protocol and distributed reconstruction codebook, locally reconstructed and used by the rider/main CPU	The local bigOther does not perform grammar, conceptual reconstruction, or detailed reasoning.
Collective moral ideals retaining authority within the person	Installed mythological lens and local-bigOther classification, renewed by field back-action	The collar is one local execution interface, not the whole of Durkheim's social being.

Culture Mechanics consequently retains Durkheim's broad observation while splitting its functions more finely. The main CPU performs conceptual and rational operations through resources that are partly socially formed; the local bigOther rapidly classifies some of their objects and possible uses; and the shared protocol and distributed field help form, stabilize, and renew both. The proposed semantic-access mechanism adds that collar classification may condition whether some rider-side retrieval, joining, standing-query, or articulation operations continue. It does not turn the collar into a language or reasoning processor. Durkheim supplies the broad social-intellectual-moral source claim, not the main-CPU/local-bigOther architecture, single-slot principle, reconstruction codebook, or collar-to-rider access mechanism.

3. First processing unit: the main CPU

The **main CPU** is the brain's powerful, flexible, general-purpose processing capacity. Its functions include:

- perception and memory;
- language and explicit thought;
- comparison and inference;
- imagination and counterfactual reasoning;
- planning and problem-solving;
- conscious deliberation;
- personal judgment;
- construction of explanations.

Most ordinary conceptions of intelligence focus on this processor. It can learn complex theories, solve technical problems, interpret evidence, and devise sophisticated strategies.

These remain main-CPU operations when their concepts, language, inferential resources, and standards have been socially formed. Social origin concerns the formation and public availability of cognitive resources; it does not relocate the detailed execution of thought into the local bigOther.

The main CPU does not, however, choose its direction in a cultural vacuum. Attention, motivation, felt relevance, moral urgency, and the acceptability of possible conclusions are influenced by the second processor.

4. Second processing unit: the bigOther

The **bigOther** is the comparatively primitive but strategically placed sentiment-classification processor. Culture mechanics distinguishes its functional operation, its phenomenological appearance, and the shared symbolic interface through which it couples with other local bigOthers.

Functional aspect The local bigOther executes the installed mythological lens. It does not usually produce a detailed argument. It assigns social and moral valence to observations, thoughts, persons, sources, roles, actions, symbols, and events:

```
observation, thought, person, source, role, action, symbol, or event
                              ↓
                     MYTHOLOGICAL LENS
            learned value-and-feeling mappings
                              ↓
                          BIGOTHER
                fast sentiment classification
                              ↓
honour / shame          loyalty / betrayal       sacred / profane
clean / polluted        legitimate / illicit     safe / threatening
admirable / contemptible                           belonging / exclusion
```

This mapping function corresponds to what **Systems Leadership** calls the **mythological lens**. Culture mechanics treats the lens as the installed evaluative program and the local bigOther as the comparatively simple processor that executes it. Its output can take the form of pride, guilt, shame, disgust, trust, fear, admiration, moral elevation, indignation, belonging, or anticipated exclusion. These outputs alter which thoughts receive attention, which possibilities are emotionally tolerable, and which actions feel obligatory.

The primary operation remains classification rather than retrieval, language, or reasoning. One proposed extension is that the resulting signal can condition whether the main CPU continues ordinary semantic-access operations such as conceptual selection, lexical retrieval, joining observations, maintaining a standing question, and stabilizing a formulation. The main CPU performs those operations; the local bigOther supplies the learned permission, honour, shame, threat, or taboo classification that may facilitate or interrupt them.

Phenomenological aspect The source of a classification need not be experienced as "my learned social programming." It may be encountered as an actually present Other—God, Destiny, Nation, History, the People, or the Cause—that sees, judges, addresses, commands, and can receive loyalty, service, protection, or sacrifice. Culture mechanics calls the felt objectivity of this encounter **bigOther-presence** and its second-person relational form **bigOther-as-Thou**.

When the installed program is jealous, this presence may itself be felt directly as jealous: as a *Thou* that claims the person, watches for disloyalty, refuses divided allegiance, and demands fidelity against rivals. The person need not experience this as "my program classified an alternative attachment as betrayal." It can be lived as "the Other is jealous and requires my loyalty."

William James's *The Varieties of Religious Experience* (1902) supplies an important phenomenological antecedent: persons can experience an unseen order or objective presence as more authoritative and conduct-directing than an explicit proposition. Martin Buber's *I and Thou* (1923) supplies the relational grammar of encountering another as a *Thou* rather than an object or *It*. Neither thinker proposed the culture-mechanical processor or its distributed field. Buber's eternal Thou in particular must not be reduced to a socially programmed classifier. The present terms borrow aspects of their phenomenology while assigning them a different functional explanation.

Kant's account of conscience supplies a further moral-phenomenological neighbour. In *The Metaphysics of Morals*, AA 6:438 and AA 6:439, one person conducts an inner court case while experiencing its judge as an observing and

commanding other. Kant's **doubled personality** (*zwiefache Persönlichkeit*) is not the culture-mechanical homo-duplex architecture: Kant explains the division through autonomous practical reason, whereas Culture Mechanics proposes a culturally programmed local bigOther. The controlled comparison is developed below in "Kant's inner tribunal and doubled personality".

This account also leaves the metaphysical status of a reported presence open. Its claim is narrower: whatever else the presence may be, the person's local bigOther can mediate how it becomes socially classified and conduct-directing.

When the mythology represents an agent, several depths of relation and enactment must be distinguished:

Depth	Culture-mechanical description	Relation to fusion
Representation	"This culture tells stories about God, a god, the Nation, History, the People, or the Cause."	No fusion follows from representation.
Consultation or service	The person asks what the represented agent would judge or accepts obligations toward it.	Personal authorship can remain fully legitimate.
bigOther-as-Thou	The agent is experienced as present, addressing, watching, judging, or commanding the person.	An *I–Thou* relation still contains two poles; presence is not fusion by itself.
Distributed enactment	Several persons and institutions provide perception, memory, judgment, voice, resources, and action to the represented agent.	Enactment can remain differentiated or become absorptive.
Fused enactment	The collectively enacted agent becomes the authoritative subject and the person's independent authorship loses standing against it.	This is subjecthood absorption by definition.

The sequence is analytical rather than a necessary developmental ladder. A person can serve without reporting a presence, report a presence without joining a collective agent, or participate in collective enactment while retaining a legitimate conscience, judgment, and right of refusal. Conversely, an intensely agentified programme can make "the Other speaks and acts through me" the operative locus of authorship.

The phrase **agent-model** in this comparison means the culturally specified representation by which people anticipate what an agent perceives, remembers, wants, judges, and commands. It is part of the operative mythological lens; it is not another local bigOther. Nor does analysis of a humanly implemented God-model decide whether God exists independently of that implementation. Culture Mechanics can examine the representation, experience, and social enactment while leaving the theological or metaphysical referent open.

Shared symbolic protocol The spelling **bigOther** marks a deliberate adaptation of Jacques Lacan's *big Other*, the locus of language, law, roles, conventions, authority, and socially intelligible meaning. Culture mechanics does not identify Lacan's symbolic order with a processor inside the individual. It treats that shared order, in one functional translation, as the **on-the-wire protocol** through which local bigOthers become mutually legible:

```
state of A's local bigOther
              ↓ encoded as
words, stories, gestures, roles, titles, symbols, sanctions
              ↓ transmitted through
shared symbolic order / Lacanian big Other
              ↓ interpreted through
B's installed mythological lens
              ↓
B's sentiment classification and outward response
```

An alphabet is not a message, and Unicode or ASCII is not the state of the computer using it. They provide shared encodings through which different machines can exchange intelligible signals. Likewise, a letter such as `M` can denote a complete mathematical mapping, while `E` or `B` can denote an entire field. Flags, uniforms, titles, and words such as *betrayal* or *justice* can function as similarly compressed social tokens because participants have learned how to unpack them.

The protocol transmits public signals, not perfect copies of private states. Synchronization requires sufficiently compatible lenses and contexts; it does not require identical inner contents. A signal can therefore activate convergence, misunderstanding, indifference, or opposition.

The bigOther's power comes less from computational sophistication than from its **position in the control architecture**. It influences how a person feels about the main CPU's thoughts. The main CPU may subsequently use its much greater power to explain, implement, defend, or occasionally question the direction supplied by the bigOther.

Historical cause, live classification, and avowed reason A present cultural response can contain three causally distinct layers:

1. **Historical cause:** the remote social experience, institutional arrangement, selection process, conflict, or practical problem through which a rule and its affective weight arose.
2. **Live classification:** the attraction, horror, shame, sacredness, loyalty, or other sentiment currently executed when the operative lens encounters the object.
3. **Avowed reason:** the explanation a person or institution can presently state for that response.

These layers can coincide, but they need not. The original problem can disappear while an affectively alive prohibition remains; a later theology, science, or political doctrine can then supply a new explanation. Conversely, a person can repeat an inherited reason after its corresponding classification has become affectively dead.

Émile Durkheim supplies a particularly clear observation in "Les principes de 1789 et la sociologie" (1890; Mark Traugott's English translation appears in *Émile Durkheim on Morality and Society*, pp. 34–42). He writes that conscious prescriptions can be "the conscious outcome of an entire unconscious process" and that, without access to their remote causes, "we invent reasons for them, lacking the real ones which we do not see." His kin-marriage example separates a surviving horror from the religious or physiological explanations later offered for it.

This is testimony to the **phenomenon to be explained**, not proof of the present processor architecture. Implicit learning, habit, affective conditioning, predictive processing, strategic rationalization, and other unitary-mind accounts remain alternatives. A discriminating study should therefore vary or measure the three layers separately: alter an explicit reason while holding the social approval environment roughly constant; alter approval while holding the proposition constant; test whether affective reversal precedes or follows doctrinal revision; and compare people who avow the same reason but display different classifications.

5. The single-slot principle

Culture mechanics proposes that the bigOther occupies the equivalent of a computer's **single PCI slot**. There is one slot, one installed local bigOther, and one operative mythological lens at a time. The bigOther is the processor or card; the mythological lens is the executable evaluative program it runs.

A stable program produces **complete slot occupancy**. This document also calls that architectural condition **full capture**. Here *full* means that one operative weave governs the slot, not that the weave is false, totalitarian, or uncorrectable. A **first-order full capture** shares binding concrete rules and answers. A **lifted full capture** shares binding rules that generate, select, apply, and revise concrete answers:

fixed meta-rules M + current knowledge or inputs K_t + situation C → binding first-order output R_t(C)

Here *fixed* means installed and binding at a given time, not eternal. Generator and outputs belong to the same operative weave. Both architectures occupy the slot completely; lifting changes the order at which binding sameness is located rather than producing an empty or half-programmed slot.

This neutral architectural **full capture** must not be confused with **Culture Program capture**, in which the authorities, metrics, appointments, correction routes, and reproduction machinery of an incumbent program are redirected until they install or reproduce an incompatible successor. A healthy lifted meta-order and a closed first-order program can each be full captures without either having captured a predecessor in that ecological sense. The successor-displacement construct and its evidence protocol are defined in *Culture Program Ecology*.

Four axes must therefore remain distinct: **slot occupancy** (full), **order level** (shared outputs or shared generator), **jurisdiction** (what the installed rules govern), and **corrigibility** (open or closed). A lifted meta-order can have universal jurisdiction at its own level over the creation, allocation, limitation, coordination, succession, and correction of first-order outputs and jurisdictions. Persons, offices, professions, institutions, communities, and contracting parties may remain plural and domain-limited beneath it. That pluralism is an important possible result of lifting, not its definition.

This **single-slot exclusivity** does not imply that the installed program is simple, culturally pure, or derived from only one source. A person may belong to several groups and encounter many religions, professions, political doctrines, familial obligations, and moral traditions. Compatible material can be assembled like software packages or libraries and braided into one operative lens. The slot restricts the number of independently operative evaluators, not the complexity or modularity of the installed weave.

Compatible packages are not separate bigOthers waiting for a higher process to rank them at runtime. Their objects, authorities, roles, and permissions already receive meaning through the one combined weave. **Paul's pride in supporting himself through work illustrates the point: Christianity and a work ethic need not compete for supremacy.** In 1 Corinthians 9:6–18, especially verses 15–18, Paul connects his boast with preaching without making use of his right to material support; 1 Thessalonians 2:9 and 2 Thessalonians 3:7–10 present labouring so as not to burden the community as an exemplary practice. A Christian mythology package and a *Berufsethos* can therefore reinforce one another within a single program. This is an illustration of compatibility, not population-level proof that every religious and professional package is compatible.

New cultural material consequently has three broad fates:

1. **Incumbent assimilation or rejection:** the installed lens interprets, neutralizes, reuses, or refuses the material in its own terms without surrendering its load-bearing classifications.
2. **Compatible integration:** a package whose important classifications and authority relations can coexist with the incumbent is braided into the one operative lens.
3. **Replacement under incompatibility:** a rival governing program cannot be installed beside the incumbent. The incumbent weave must be loosened and unbraided sufficiently for retained strands and new material to be rebraided into one successor lens.

Within the originating application developed here, **Christianity and the National Socialist worldview are deeply incompatible programming systems** at load-bearing classifications such as God and ultimate authority, the person and neighbour, race and nation, truth, obedience, sacrifice, violence, and loyalty. Nazi programming could not simply be installed beside an intact Christian program. Capture required a replacement process. A Nazi-governed successor could retain Christian words, scripture, symbols, rituals, offices, or a subjective Christian identity, but those strands would receive their operative meaning from the successor weave. The result would be one rebraided Nazi-Christian program, not two programs ordered by rank.

Deep cultural change is therefore unlike adding neutral information to memory. Reprogramming changes the weave that determines what new information means and how it feels. Incomplete replacement can produce contradiction, instability, or a tangled lens during loosening and rebraiding; it does not establish several independent bigOthers running in parallel. This helps explain why conversion, deradicalization, psychoanalysis, moral injury, ideological rupture, and profound changes of identity can be slow, conflictual, and emotionally painful.

Hard cases and possible defeat conditions Single-slot exclusivity cannot be protected merely by redescribing every apparent counterexample as "one complicated braid." Self-description, retained vocabulary, public ritual, or several group memberships do not decide the architecture. The diagnostic question is:

> **When inherited authorities conflict over the same act, which rule or authority has final interpretive priority over what the retained material means?**

The following observations remain consistent with one slot:

- one tradition interprets the other's retained symbols and practices;
- outward conformity is strategic camouflage under legal or social coercion;
- selected strands have been integrated into one syncretic successor;
- a third rule governs how both inheritances are combined;
- or the person is in unstable, incomplete unbraiding and rebraiding.

A strong candidate counterexample requires substantially more:

1. two governing evaluators issue incompatible classifications in the same domain;
2. each remains independently final rather than being interpreted, authorized, or limited by the other or by a third rule;
3. each can generate its own affect, guilt, correction, and veto;
4. neither is merely reflective knowledge, role performance, strategic concealment, or a de-animated remnant; and

5. the configuration remains stable over time rather than resolving into hierarchy, integration, replacement, or breakdown.

Evidence of that pattern would count against strict single-slot exclusivity. The theory would then need either a principled account of parallel operative evaluators or revision of the one-slot commitment. Evidence for only labels, rituals, memories, or alternating contexts is insufficient because one weave can assign different outputs to different contexts. The detailed dual-religious- identification boundary case belongs to *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*, "Examples, cases, and boundary tests".

6. Systems Leadership: mythologies and the mythological lens

Systems Leadership: Creating Positive Organisations, by Ian Macdonald, Catherine Burke, and Karl Stewart, supplies the definitive practical account used by Culture Mechanics for how culture is deliberately implemented. Its method coordinates leadership behaviour, systems, symbols, mythologies, habits, organizational arrangements, and repeated experience rather than treating mythology as sufficient by itself. Culture Mechanics embeds that organizational and workplace account in a larger theory and develops selected extensions and refinements; readers seeking the exact implementation method should read the book.

> **Culture Mechanics condenses the Systems Leadership implementation stack into one memorable duality: systems are the skeleton; human carriers, mythology, meaning, affect, *Beseelung*, and embodied habits are the flesh and blood. The skeleton makes culture durable and repeatable; the living body makes it operative and alive.**

The full semantic anatomy and its boundaries belong to *Culture Program Ecology*.

Culture mechanics adopts the following terminological hierarchy:

Term	Definition in culture mechanics
Mythology	One socially evaluated story or narrative unit. It need not involve gods or supernatural events. It shows persons, roles, actions, conflicts, and consequences while indicating what deserves admiration, shame, loyalty, fear, trust, disgust, or condemnation.
Mythologies	The accumulated and partly interconnected body of such stories available to a person or group. They provide many examples of how the social world is supposed to be interpreted.
Mythological lens	The generalized mapping formed from those mythologies and reinforced by systems, symbols, rituals, sanctions, and observed conduct. It maps real-world observations and events onto culturally learned values and feelings.
bigOther	The local sentiment-classification processor that executes the installed mythological lens and applies its mappings quickly.

The lens is one executable weave but may be modular. Mythologies, practices, professional ethics, familial duties, and local customs can operate as mutually compatible packages within it. Their plurality is a plurality of constituent strands and context-sensitive mappings, not a plurality of local bigOthers.

This yields the central culture-mechanical sequence:

```
MYTHOLOGY
one evaluated story
                    ↓
MYTHOLOGIES
many mutually reinforcing stories
                    ↓
MYTHOLOGICAL LENS
generalized mappings from observations to values and feelings
```

```
                    ↓
BIGOTHER
fast execution of those mappings
                    ↓
ELEPHANT AND MAIN CPU
felt attraction, aversion, obligation, attention, and motivation
```

An individual mythology can teach:

- which kinds of persons and roles exist;
- what counts as a good group member;
- which authorities are legitimate;
- which conduct receives praise or condemnation;
- which sacrifices are honourable;
- what constitutes betrayal, pollution, injustice, or redemption;
- how the past explains the present;
- what the group expects of the individual;
- which future is desirable or disastrous.

A story acts as an evaluated simulation. Narrative transportation places the listener inside a conflict; a hero or villain demonstrates a possible response; consequences display what follows; praise or condemnation supplies the sentiment label; and the audience's reaction shows whether the classification is collectively shared. Each story is one training example. Many convergent stories allow the bigOther to generalize a lens that can classify new situations never described in any one story.

Relevant structures and moral appraisal Dushan Wegner's *Relevante Strukturen* (2019; ISBN 9783739405636) calls attention to the relations in which a person is embedded and to the larger structures that the person experiences as important. Culture Mechanics adopts **relevant structure** as a typed relational object rather than as a synonym for anything a person happens to value:

> A **relevant structure** is a represented relational arrangement or organized condition–such as a family, friendship, profession, institution, community, legal order, practice, person-in-relation, or anticipated shared future–that the installed mythological lens treats as carrying moral weight.

Not every desired object, isolated preference, or momentarily salient stimulus is therefore a relevant structure. The term emphasizes embedding, dependence, continuity, function, and vulnerability. A mythology can teach which structures exist, who or what belongs within them, how they depend upon one another, what counts as supporting or damaging them, whose claims have precedence when they conflict, and who has standing or jurisdiction to judge and act.

Wegner's memorable formulation that good strengthens relevant structures and evil weakens them is incorporated as the **relevant-structure appraisal hypothesis**:

> **People often experience an action, omission, continuation, or proposed change as good when they believe it strengthens, protects, repairs, or honourably serves a structure they experience as relevant, and as evil when they believe it weakens, corrupts, betrays, or destroys such a structure.**

This is a descriptive hypothesis about moral perception and mobilization, not a sufficient definition of moral truth and not a claim that every moral judgment uses this route. The analysis must keep five variables distinct:

Variable	Question
Felt relevance	How much moral weight does this person or operative culture assign to the represented structure?
Represented effect	What does the person believe the action will do to it?
Actual effect	What does the action do, including indirect, delayed, and transferred effects?
Generative centrality	How strongly does the structure actually produce capabilities or conditions upon which several downstream structures depend?
Normative standing	Is the structure, claimed effect, jurisdiction, or proposed sacrifice legitimate?

The Hanekamp–Wegner ecological application sharpens the change boundary: **"Deterioration is a moral evaluation of change."** A measurement or model may establish or predict change, but the classification *deterioration* additionally selects a reference state, relevant structure, represented weakening, normative standing, and interpreter. This is a Culture Mechanics bridge from Hanekamp's application to Wegner's appraisal hypothesis, not Wegner's own formulation or proof that the evaluation is arbitrary.

Generative centrality–also described more informally as *load-bearingness*–is therefore not another name for felt relevance. A structure may be causally central to the production of character, knowledge, cooperation, or institutional continuity while receiving little explicit moral attention. Conversely, an intensely felt-relevant structure may be weakly generative, replaceable, or destructive. A **cultural sublimation architecture** is a particularly important proposed case: it can recurrently produce capacities upon which families, professions, law, science, markets, and political institutions depend even when the operative culture does not represent that architecture itself as relevant. The concept and its limits are developed in *Mythology Construction*, "Sublimation and moral formation."

That document also distinguishes the larger architecture from a **lifted sublimation generator**: installed meta-rules select binding directions, affective actuation makes them motivationally effective, and formative practices turn them into durable character and capability. Generator efficacy does not by itself establish positive normative valence.

The mismatch is analytically consequential:

```
high generative centrality
+ low felt relevance
→ weak protection and transmission
→ vulnerability to neglect, ridicule, dismantling,
  or consumption of inherited cultural capital
```

This is a hypothesis about dependency and reproduction, not a presumption that every inherited arrangement is beneficial or that whatever calls itself civilizational must be preserved.

Wegner's emphasis on *Veränderung* also motivates the more limited **change-indexed moral-mobilization hypothesis**:

> **Moral classification often becomes especially salient and action-directing when a condition is represented as causing, accelerating, continuing, preventing, or culpably failing to prevent a change in a felt-relevant structure.**

This concerns represented counterfactual movement, not physical novelty. "The rule exists" can be rendered as "officials continue the rule," "participants decline to end it," or "the institution prevents transition to an alternative." Conversely, the absence of visible mobilization does not establish that the status quo is experienced as good: coercion, habituation, helplessness, low salience, concealed dissent, and the absence of a represented alternative are competing explanations. A direct test would hold material conditions constant while comparing a static-state description, an active-continuation description, and a prevented-alternative description. Failure of these descriptions to alter moral intensity or action readiness, especially across independently measured relevance, would weaken the hypothesis.

The mythological lens need not calculate complex consequences by itself. Ordinary cognition, testimony, institutions, and a mythology's causal stories can supply a represented effect model; the local bigOther then rapidly classifies the represented support or damage through the installed lens:

```
observed, proposed, continued, or prevented change
                          ↓
main CPU + received causal stories represent likely effects
                          ↓
operative lens supplies felt relevance, moral meaning,
precedence, standing, and jurisdiction
                          ↓
local bigOther classifies protection/injury, loyalty/betrayal,
repair/destruction, justice/injustice, honour/shame
                          ↓
attention, judgment, motivation, and action are redirected
```

"Strengthening" and "weakening" are multidimensional rather than one moral scalar. An oppressive institution may increase its continuity, capacity, reach, or internal cohesion while destroying truth-contact, corrigibility, personal standing, or legitimate exit and while transferring severe costs to other persons and structures. The appraisal

hypothesis explains why participants may nevertheless experience its preservation as good; it does not vindicate that appraisal.

Several relevant structures can coexist within the one operative weave without implying several local bigOthers. Their relative weight, conflict rules, and jurisdictions are program content. A predominantly first-order solidarity may make a concrete hierarchy of structures binding as such. A lifted solidarity may make binding a procedure by which competing claims are evidenced, limited, adjudicated, appealed, and revised. This is an application of the order-level distinction, not its definition; in both cases the one slot remains fully occupied.

Systems Leadership adds an important qualification: explicit stories are not the only influences on the lens. The conduct of leaders, the design of systems, the use of symbols, institutional rewards and sanctions, and repeated experiences of belonging, success, humiliation, or exclusion can confirm or contradict the lessons conveyed by a mythology. These experiences may themselves later be narrated as new mythologies.

Culture Program Ecology formalizes the resulting implementation anatomy as a **systemic skeleton** joined to a **living cultural body**. Rules, offices, jurisdictions, incentives, feedback, accounting, correction, and succession make the program repeatable; human carriers, mythologies, meaning, sacredness, affect, moral formation, *Beseelung*, and embodied habits animate and interpret it. These are two aspects of one operative Culture Program, not two bigOthers or a new processor division.

The relationship is therefore not simply "a story causes a feeling." Rather:

```
stories + observed conduct + systems + symbols + repeated experience
                             ↓
              reinforce or contradict mythologies
                             ↓
                  shape the mythological lens
                             ↓
       lens maps a new observation onto value and feeling
```

Systems Leadership commonly describes the lens as evaluating behaviour, systems, and symbols along continua such as:

- honesty–dishonesty;
- trust–distrust;
- courage–cowardice;
- respect–disrespect for human dignity;
- fairness–unfairness;
- love or care–indifference.

Culture mechanics interprets these as important output dimensions of the programmed bigOther. They are not necessarily an exhaustive list of human moral sentiments, but they show concretely what the lens does: it converts a physical or social observation into an affectively consequential classification.

When people possess sufficiently similar mythological lenses, they tend to interpret the same conduct in similar ways. Systems Leadership calls the resulting shared evaluative pattern culture. Culture mechanics adds that compatible local bigOthers can also exchange signals and synchronize, turning shared classification into distributed affect and coordinated action.

7. Programming, activation, and reprogramming

Culture mechanics distinguishes several operations that are easily confused:

Operation	Timescale	Function
Programming	Slow	Adds, reinforces, or revises mythologies and compatible packages and thereby installs, extends, or modifies the one mythological lens used by the bigOther.

Operation	Timescale	Function
Classification	Very fast	The bigOther applies the installed lens to a person, thought, action, symbol, or event.
Activation	Fast	A present signal activates an already learned mapping in the lens.
Synchronization	Fast	Reciprocal signals align the affective or behavioural states of several people.
Reinforcement	Repeated	Successful, praised, punished, or emotionally intense execution stabilizes mythologies and their mappings in the lens.
Reprogramming	Usually slow	Modifies the operative weave. Compatible change can extend or repair it; incompatible replacement requires sufficient unbraiding of the incumbent and rebraiding of one successor lens.
Unbraiding and rebraiding	Usually slow and conflictual	Loosens load-bearing bindings, preserves or detaches selected strands, crosses a potentially unstable interval, and installs one successor weave rather than a parallel evaluator.

Situated cultural scripts: executable local braids A **situated cultural script** is a distributed, role-, institution-, or situation-indexed braid that translates selected meanings, classifications, permissions, and authority relations of an operative cultural weave into expected perception, conduct, coordination, improvisation, and access to practical, relational, or material support. It is narrower in scope but more concretely specified than the general cultural braid.

The abstraction relation is:

Level	Culture-mechanical meaning
Operative cultural braid	The comparatively general organization of meanings, values, identities, authorities, and conflict rules within the one installed weave
Situated cultural script	A higher-resolution adapter specifying how selected parts of that order operate for people in a recurrent role, institution, relationship, or situation
Local script variant	A historically or organizationally particular implementation of the more general script
Enactment	One concrete performance, modification, improvisation, or refusal of the script by actual participants

```
operative cultural weave C
+ institution or relationship I
+ role R
+ recurrent situation X
+ practical and material environment E
→ situated script S(C,I,R,X,E)
→ expected perception, conduct, coordination, and improvisation
```

The notation marks contextual specification, not deterministic execution or a calibrated function. A professional script, for example, may join a society's general meanings of work, service, competence, authority, and responsibility

to formal offices, tacit routines, tools, colleague expectations, error-recovery practices, status, livelihood, and professional pride. Participants may interpret, perform, repair, exploit, or refuse it.

A script can be larger than any individual. It may be maintained across many persons, offices, artifacts, procedures, relationships, and resource flows, while particular people enter and leave its roles. The script is therefore neither a private plan nor necessarily a collective agent. It supplies a distributed pattern for action; agency still belongs to participating persons, institutions, or, where the independent functional threshold is met, an operative multi-mind-self.

Scripts cut across the culture-mechanical object types defined below. They can contain program units, symbols, implementation arrangements, expected local execution, and interfaces among several roles. They are not another processor or another governing bigOther. One fully occupied mythological lens can support many compatible familial, occupational, civic, religious, and technical scripts. Their scope, priority, and conflict rules belong to the one operative weave. Stable same-situation scripts that remain incompatibly final and mutually ungoverned would instead raise the existing single-slot defeat condition.

The term is adapted from Venkatesh Rao's "On the Unraveling of Scripts". Rao treats scripts as learned behavioural patterns that supply meaning and material support and treats their unraveling as a mutually reinforcing loss of both. The situated-braid definition, its placement between culture and enactment, the single-slot boundary, and the distinctions among local repair, cross-script cascade, and cultural unbraiding are Culture Mechanics developments.

Script viability asks whether the script continues to translate cultural meaning into intelligible and practically supportable conduct under its actual conditions. Viability is not truth, legitimacy, flourishing, corrigibility, *Beseelung*, or moral goodness. A false or oppressive script can remain highly viable, while a worthy script can fail for lack of skill, infrastructure, resources, institutional support, or workable interfaces.

Domain-transfer failure **Status:** project-developed competence-and-script transfer mechanism

Domain-transfer failure occurs when genuine competence, a viable script, or a reliable practice from a source environment is carried into a target environment and acted upon as though its load-bearing regularities remained valid, although a change in scale, counterpart, opponent, institution, interface, resource structure, feedback, time horizon, or constraint has invalidated that transfer.

```
demonstrated competence or viable script in environment A
+ untested assumption that A's load-bearing regularities persist
+ consequential enactment in materially different environment B
+ collision with a changed causal, institutional, or adversarial structure
→ domain-transfer failure
```

Past success and surface similarity establish a transfer hypothesis, not its validity. Before discriminating consequence, the configuration is a **domain-transfer risk**. The stronger failure classification requires evidence that the changed condition mattered to the result and that the imported competence, script, or practice was not adequately adapted. A failed attempt in a new setting may instead reflect ordinary noise, bad execution, insufficient resources, an unrelated bottleneck, or a locally valid experiment whose expected risk was properly bounded.

The audit identifies:

- what competence or script was genuinely demonstrated and under which source conditions;
- which regularities were assumed to transfer and which were independently tested;
- what changed in scale, counterpart, opposition, technology, interfaces, resources, incentives, feedback, or consequence;
- whether early anomalies changed the model and practice or were interpreted through the source environment's expectations; and
- whether a locally adapted comparator performs differently under the same target conditions.

Domain-transfer failure is not prominence-derived apparent competence: the source competence may be entirely real. It is not identical to script unraveling, although a badly transferred or no-longer-adapted script can unravel after repeated collision. Moral-scale transposition is a narrower relational subtype in which a moral grammar crosses a scale and knowledge topology without the conditions that made it responsible there. Domain-transfer failure can be sincere, negligent, overconfident, institutionally selected, or deliberately exploited; the morphology alone establishes none of those explanations or any person-level guilt.

Script unraveling is the process by which a situated script loses coherence or viability: inherited meanings cease to guide workable conduct, practical consequences cease confirming the script, roles and procedures contradict one

another, participants improvise incompatible responses, or supporting institutions and resources fail. Meaning-side and practical-side failure can reinforce one another:

```
script supplies meaning, role, and expected conduct
                    ↓
participants enact and coordinate through the script
                    ↓
practice produces relational and material consequences
                    ↓
consequences confirm, correct, or discredit the script
                    ↻
```

```
loss on either side
→ weaker enactment, coordination, support, or credibility
→ further loss on the other side
→ possible accelerating script unraveling
```

Unraveling and cultural unbraiding are coupled but non-equivalent:

```
peripheral script unravels
→ local repair or script replacement within the incumbent cultural braid

load-bearing or mutually dependent scripts unravel
→ cross-script cascade
→ general meanings and authorities lose practical confirmation
→ possible cultural unbraiding

general cultural braid is unbraided
→ several dependent scripts lose common orientation
→ possible widespread script unraveling
```

The **load-bearingness** of a script is the extent to which the wider weave or other scripts depend upon its successful operation and visible confirmation. Failure of one peripheral routine therefore does not establish cultural collapse; failure across family formation, productive work, lawful succession, public truth-testing, or another highly connected script family may propagate much further. The direction and extent of propagation are empirical questions.

Scriptlessness in Rao's sense must not be translated as an empty PCI slot. It means that no viable action repertoire is available within the relevant domain. The local slot remains fully occupied, although its installed weave may be de-animated, tangled, closed, practically obsolete, or unable to generate an adequate situated response. Nor is script unraveling identical to Babelization: one widely shared script can fail while participants remain mutually intelligible, and locally viable scripts can coexist while their interfaces fall below the anti-Babel floor.

Applied to relevant structures, **relevance activation** foregrounds a concern and appraisal mapping already installed in the lens. **Relevance reprogramming** changes which relational arrangements carry moral weight, how strongly they matter, what support or damage means, or how conflicts among them are resolved. Repeated foregrounding may reinforce and eventually help reprogram the lens, but a one-shot increase in salience does not by itself establish durable reprogramming.

The theory studies one endogenous formation path and one prospective purposive research route.

Endogenous mythology formation is the largely distributed and not centrally designed process through which changes in social structure, institutions, lived practice, and receiver dispositions generate pressures, needs, and aspirations; competing articulations are then selected, sacralized, embodied, and reproduced. It is the ordinary cultural-growth path. *Endogenous* describes causal provenance, not innocence, health, inevitability, or moral legitimacy.

Purposive mythology construction is the open research possibility that a person, office, organization, or coalition might adopt a proposed destination and deliberately intervene in the mythologies, causal classifications, symbols, roles, permissions, and supporting institutions through which a population interprets and acts. Any attempted constructor remains inside culture: the desired destination, available materials, authority, and perception of the problem have themselves been culturally formed, and the intervention becomes one more input into receiver, institutional, rival, and reality selection.

The detailed semantic definition, design audit, and workflow belong to *Mythology Construction*; the present section states only the distinction needed by the core causal cycle.

```
ENDOGENOUS FORMATION
changing conditions → diffuse mismatch → competing articulations
→ distributed selection → embodiment and reproduction

PROSPECTIVE PURPOSIVE CONSTRUCTION
chosen destination D*
→ diagnose receivers, incumbent order, and likely baseline trajectory
→ deliberately alter mythologies and supporting arrangements
→ prototype, observe, correct, defend, or retire
```

The prospective branch treats mythology as a privileged symbolic intervention surface because evaluated stories encode roles, causes, values, permissions, and consequences in a form close to the bigOther's learned operations. It is not the whole implementation surface. Leadership behaviour, systems, symbols, habits, rewards, sanctions, material conditions, and repeated experience may confirm, redirect, or defeat an intended mythology. An attempted purpose therefore does not imply control:

```
actual successor
= intended destination × receiver fit × incumbent resistance
× institutional selection × rival intervention
× unintended consequence × reality
```

The multiplicative notation marks joint constraint, not a measured equation.

A slogan, flag, gesture, uniform, accusation, facial expression, or news event normally does not transmit a complete mythological lens. It is a small trigger interpreted by an already programmed bigOther. The same signal can therefore produce opposite reactions in people with differently formed lenses. When the event is subsequently organized and retold as an evaluated story, it can also become a new mythology that reinforces or modifies the lens.

A **master signifier** is an especially dense activation signal. In the co-developed analogy adopted here, it is a **highly compressed protocol token** that indexes and activates an already installed complex of stories, classifications, authorities, identities, sentiments, and expected conduct. The token does not contain that whole complex any more than M contains every ordered pair of a mathematical mapping. Its power depends upon prior programming and a shared convention for expanding it. Longer stories, repeated practice, and institutional experience can change the program; the token usually calls the program already present.

The same distinction applies when a slogan, song, hero, ritual, work, or exemplary practice evokes a culturally shared sublimation. The carrier does not contain the sublimation process or the durable cultural arrangement that teaches it. It activates installed mappings connecting the represented practice to honour, shame, capability, contribution, belonging, or obligation. A rival or cynical mythology can activate a contrary classification; repeated stories, symbols, rewards, sanctions, systems, and observed conduct can reinforce that mapping and eventually reprogram the operative lens:

```
incumbent mythologies:
sublimated practice → honour, contribution, capability
                              ↓ rival reclassification
sublimated practice → exploitation, foolishness, conformity, futility
                              ↓ repeated cultural implementation
reinforcement or reprogramming of the mythological lens
                              ↓
local bigOther supplies changed sentiment and motivation
                              ↓
changed enactment, Beseelung, and intergenerational transmission
```

Wegner's compression and decompression vocabulary supplies a useful second view of this operation: a small token can stand in for a much larger installed complex. In the constitutive language of Culture Mechanics, however, the intrapersonal target is the programming of the mythological lens. A "decoder" is an analogy for recipient reconstruction through ordinary cognition, learned context, the installed lens, and local-bigOther classification–not a third processor. Prestigious examples, ridicule, rewards, and sanctions are programming and reinforcement channels rather than a substitute for the lens. *Beseelung* remains the independent degree to which the resulting program is affectively alive and conduct-directing, not a separate decoding faculty or necessarily a conscious

willingness.

This activation capacity has a developmental precondition. The token can call an installed complex only where prior formation has built enough recipient-side conceptual, causal, evaluative, and practical structure to expand it. Operation-bootstrapped codebook formation names the recurrent experience, example, questioning, contrast, practice, and correction through which that capacity is locally reconstructed and socially calibrated. The codebook is distributed analytical shorthand for ordinary cognition, the installed mythological lens, local-bigOther classification, and the shared symbolic protocol, not another processor.

Activation and replacement must therefore not be confused. A signal can activate or reinforce material already compatible with the installed lens. It cannot by itself make an incompatible governing program co-occupy the slot. Such capture requires the incumbent's authority relations and classifications to be loosened, detached, or reinterpreted and a successor weave to be constructed.

8. Culture-mechanical objects, ideological programs, conformity signals, and targeting signals

This section develops a mini-theory of the objects through which cultural programs become personally operative and publicly legible. Its authoritative home is *Culture Mechanics* because the mechanism begins at the interface among an installed lens, the local bigOther that executes it, and a socially intelligible token. The mechanism can then scale into the mechanical-solidarity field developed in *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*. A symbol is not merely an individual possession: institutions may prescribe it, absence may communicate without deliberate intention, and its aggregate effect may exceed what any one participant intends.

Culture-mechanical object A **culture-mechanical object** is any program, carrier, implementation arrangement, processor state, or emergent collective organization whose relevant function is to install, activate, transmit, execute, synchronize, or enforce culturally learned social and evaluative classifications. The term is proposed by the present framework as a broad analytical umbrella. It does not make every member of the category the same kind of thing.

Culture-mechanical object	Meaning	Examples
Program complex	A large, internally structured package capable of programming an operative mythological lens	Religions, Marxism, National Socialism, liberal constitutional culture, nationalism, company cultures, activist movements, military ethos, professional cultures, state programmes
Program unit or content	Material from which a larger operative weave is constructed	Mythologies, narratives, causal stories, moral rules, roles, exemplars, sacred values, master signifiers
Carrier or activation device	A token through which the program is communicated, activated, or made publicly legible	Flags, veils, blue neckerchiefs, imposed yellow stars, badges, certificates, slogans, linguistic forms, masks, salutes, songs, whistle signals
Implementation arrangement	A durable structure that rewards, sanctions, repeats, or institutionalizes the program	Schools, appointment systems, rituals, calendars, dress codes, promotion criteria, laws, media routines, organizational systems
Local execution	The installed program as executed by an individual sentiment classifier	A local bigOther applying its mythological lens
Collective formation	The emergent result of compatible local execution and reciprocal signalling	Mechanical solidarity and the distributed bigOther
Collective agent	A sufficiently integrated and continuous collective formation capable of judgment, intention, ownership, and action	An operative multi-mind-self

A culturally legible phrase, song, image, hero, or ritual that evokes a shared sublimation remains a **carrier or activation device**, an **ideological symbol**, a master-signifier-like token, or a fragment of mythology according to its actual function. The Wegner-facing expression **sublimation emblem** may be useful as explanatory shorthand for its compressed representative role, but it does not create a new culture-mechanical object type. Analysis must keep separate the sublimation process, its resulting character or practice, the cultural sublimation architecture that recurrently produces it, and the token that activates relevant programming.

In common contemporary political, organizational, and media usage, **narrative** is often a fuzzy synonym for **mythology**. Culture mechanics retains a precise boundary inside that overlap. *Narrative* is the broader term for an organized account of events, actors, causes, and consequences. A narrative becomes culture-mechanically mythological when it also carries socially learned evaluation, roles, causal interpretation, expected feeling, or permission–when it teaches not only what happened but what should feel admirable, shameful, legitimate, treacherous, threatening, redemptive, permitted, or forbidden. A merely chronological account need not be a mythology. A **causal story** is a narrative specialized around explaining why something happened and assigning agency or responsibility. The common political expression **"the narrative"** may refer more broadly to an authorized mythology, mythology family, or even the lens through which events are required to be interpreted; its precise level must be identified from context.

At the applied level, **narrative design** and **narrative construction** are therefore close practitioner-language synonyms for **mythology construction**. *Mythology Construction* develops this relationship and identifies existing narrative-design toolkits as partial practical implementations of the same intervention domain.

A whole religion, political formation, company culture, activist movement, or state programme may be a **composite culture-mechanical object** containing several of these subtypes. The name *Christianity*, *Islam*, *Judaism*, *Marxism*, *National Socialism*, or *company culture* may refer in one sentence to a body of programming and in another to its institutions, carriers, synchronized population, or collective agency. Analysis must therefore identify which level is meant rather than treating the inherited name as a precise ontology.

Within that wider category, a large internally structured cultural program whose packages are mutually fitted is a **Culture Program Complex**, shortened where unambiguous to **program complex**. The composite culture-mechanical object remains broader because it may join programs, carriers, institutions, fields, outputs, and processes across analytical levels. The canonical program terminology, its reality-answerability branches, and its ecology are defined in *Culture Program Ecology*.

What the theory is disentangling Ordinary vocabulary often uses *religion*, *ideology*, *culture*, *collective consciousness*, *big Other*, or *group mind* as near-synonyms. Culture mechanics treats religion and secular ideology as members of the same broad family of cultural programming while refusing to collapse program, processor, protocol, field, and agent:

Construct	Precise role in culture mechanics
Culture Program	The executable package of mythologies, classifications, rules, roles, values, and expected conduct installed as one operative weave. **Cultural or ideological program** remains a legacy or explanatory alias.
Ideological generator and Ideology	An ideological generator is a reusable grammar capable of producing linked representations, roles, diagnoses, authorities, enemies, duties, remedies, and challenge interpretations. **Ideology** is the stricter sufficiently installed Culture Program that recurrently generates authorized social un-reality and recruits un-reason to defend its operative authority. The generator alone is not an Ideology; their primary semantic home is *Culture Program Ecology*.
Minogue-ideology	Narrow Ideology subtype joining hidden oppression, opposed positions, asymmetric or false consciousness, revelatory corrected sight, mobilization, transformative power, liberation, and a terminal ideal tending to displace ordinary political plurality. *Mythology Construction* owns the source reconstruction; *Culture Program Ecology* owns the classifier relation.

Construct	Precise role in culture mechanics
Culture Program Complex	A large Culture Program containing multiple mutually fitted packages or components; not a second bigOther and narrower than a composite culture-mechanical object.
Culture Program carrying structure	The organizational and material substrate through which a Culture Program is financed, taught, reproduced, coordinated, amplified, protected, and given continuity or operational capability. It is neither the program nor the population of human carriers; its primary semantic home is *Culture Program Ecology*.
Polity-scale *Gleichschaltung* hazard	Process-level warning that human carriers, symbolic and conformity-marker environments, and institutional-operational systems across multiple formerly independent societal domains are being aligned toward one privileged ideological direction. It can arise before a complete Culture Program is reconstructed and before a completed polity-scale mechanical-solidarity morphology or Fascism conjunction; narrow coordination and voluntary thick community remain distinct. Its primary semantic home is *Culture Program Ecology*.
Self-Attribution Presumption	First-pass evidentiary rule: initially believe an authenticated, serious actor proclamation as evidence of that actor's own operative program allegiance, motivation, or perceived authorization and treat it as a program-level warning before testing causal scope and defeaters. Its primary semantic home is *Culture Program Ecology*.
Self-Description Valence Asymmetry	An authenticated, serious adverse self-attribution receives first-pass credence about the actor's operative understanding, whereas favourable self-description records the advertised ideal but receives no exculpatory presumption against installed operation, offspring, consequences, and failed correction. Parent-program attribution remains a separate inference governed by standing, script fit, recurrence, organizational support, internal contestation, and affirmative defeaters. Its primary semantic home is *Culture Program Ecology*.
Attribution-Source Asymmetry	Self-attribution provides situated evidence about the speaker's operative program; hostile third-party attribution is an allegation about the target requiring independent support. Its primary semantic home is *Culture Program Ecology*.
Propagation–Visibility Constraint	Large-scale, high-fidelity program reproduction requires sufficient descriptive, symbolic, ritual, behavioural, or institutional transmission; secrecy shifts code into bounded channels and ordinarily trades off against scale or fidelity. Its primary semantic home is *Culture Program Ecology*.
Systemic skeleton and living cultural body	Analytically distinguishes the fitted institutional-operational structure of a Culture Program from the human, symbolic, affective, and formative life that animates, maintains, repairs, or repurposes it. They are not two programs, processors, or bigOthers. Their primary semantic home is *Culture Program Ecology*.

Construct	Precise role in culture mechanics
Pluralist adaptive constitutional search	Proposed application in which a common person-protecting shell contains bounded policy variation, plural sensors, correction, lawful movement, imitation, and succession without granting one metric or institution root access to reality. Its epistemic architecture belongs to *Epistemic Constitution* and its concrete pluralist design to *Culture Program Ecology*.
Lifted-Order Capacity Dashboard	Proposed *Culture Program Ecology* sensor suite—Speak, Own, Refuse, Exit, Appeal, Correct, Cooperate, Build, and Choose—for testing a pluralist Culture Strategy. It is neither the definition of lifted solidarity nor a scalar social good.
Projective-vandalism circuit	Observable sequence in which a disowned blemish is projected onto an opponent, a taboo label makes the target symbolically attackable, and repeated denunciation may become affectively rewarding. Its linguistic home is *Linguistic Tricks* and its motivational hypothesis belongs to *Mythology Construction*.
Theoretical *un-* family	Restricted project family for internal deformation of X beyond simple absence or external opposition. It is not the ordinary meaning of every *un-* word; its primary semantic home is *Epistemic Constitution*.
Constitutive-relation inversion	Direct theoretical *un-* morphology in which X's characteristic operation remains active while an output, commitment, or authorized representation controls the inputs or correctors to which it should answer. It needs a specified relational instance but not one bounded institution; un-reason is its inferential-mechanism application and un-reality its socially operative state application. Its primary semantic home is *Epistemic Constitution*.
Pseudomorphic governor substitution	Thicker bearer-level theoretical *un-* morphology in which a durable role, practice, procedure, office, profession, organization, or institution retains recognizable X-form, machinery, and authority while an incompatible principle governs consequential choice, correction, and reproduction or succession. A person can instantiate it only through a specified role and period; it is not a whole-person essence. The process yields a functional pseudomorph of X; its primary semantic home is *Epistemic Constitution*.
Linguistic trick and instrumental untruthfulness	A linguistic trick is a possible local communicative operation; instrumental untruthfulness is the separate orientation that selects or preserves communication for operative effect while truth-supporting conditions become subordinate. Trick form, operative trick, deliberate trick, actor attribution, and institutional attribution remain distinct. Their primary semantic home is *Linguistic Tricks*.

Construct	Precise role in culture mechanics
Distributed carrier sequence	Possible cross-scale pathway from originator or selector through carrier and recipient reconstruction into possible un-reason, un-reality, organized un-reality, and systemic reproduction. Different people, roles, and institutions can occupy different functions; intent and guilt do not propagate with the message, no conspiracy follows, and every arrow requires separate evidence. *Linguistic Trick*s owns the communicative front end; *Epistemic Constitution* owns the complete sequence.
Latent Culture Program profile, contrastive correction-interface probe, and Culture Program fingerprint	A latent profile is a bounded conditional reconstruction of classifications, sacred values, authorities, affective activations, correction relations, and action tendencies likely to become operative under specified conditions. The proposed probe first establishes comprehension of a disclosed causal form through relatively uncharged cases, then tests whether correction practice changes selectively across differently culture-loaded implementations. The fingerprint is the typed multi-case distribution of those discontinuities across neutral and several program-loaded cases; selective A-linked recurrence can raise the likelihood of A's installation or load-bearing status, while capture requires further evidence of displaced correction or authorship. *Epistemic Agency* owns the diagnostic; one discontinuity, emotional response, or naturalistic example does not establish an Ideology, Culture Program, radicalized person, or danger.
Guided unbraiding and possible de-radicalization	Guided unbraiding is the hypothetical, consensual and bounded process of making an individualized cultural-affective braid observable, loosening selected automatic couplings, and restoring correction and reflective authorship without installing the guide's replacement program. Possible de-radicalization is the broader aspirational outcome only where radicalizing capture is independently established. MCIP is one candidate method; neither the diagnostic nor unbraiding is violence-risk assessment, forced conversion, established treatment, or proof of efficacy. *Epistemic Agency* owns the complete proposal and its directional-symmetry, research, safeguard, and falsification conditions.
Un-reason	Proposed cross-scale mechanism and direct constitutive-relation inversion in which reasoning remains active while a protected conclusion governs the evidence and correction to which it should answer. It is not a third constitutional orientation, a synonym for irrationality, a PGS diagnosis by itself, or a classification of a population; its primary semantic home is *Epistemic Constitution*.

Construct	Precise role in culture mechanics
Un-reality, organized un-reality, and correction nullification	Un-reality is the constitutive-relation-inversion state in which an authorized representation retains operative public reality-status while governing how independent correction may count. It does not require one bounded institution. Organized un-reality is the fitted multi-channel stock built around one or more such representations; after disclosure, correction nullification prevents an independently sustained correction from changing operation. Un-reason can block correction one epistemic level earlier. Their primary semantic home is *Epistemic Constitution*.
Moralized observation-to-mandate loop	A protected concern recruits a virtuous observer or reporter role; submissions become custodied records; semantic upgrading and amplification convert the records into a public-problem claim; the claim authorizes an intervention; and the intervention can enlarge the observation or enforcement surface. *Mythology Construction* owns the role grammar, *Epistemic Constitution* the report-to-reality and feedback failures, *Epistemic Agency* the citizen-sensor and internal-observer consequences, and *Culture Program Ecology* the institutional audit and worked example. The loop alone establishes neither fabrication, pretext, Ideology, nor systemic lying.
Systemic-lying epistemic constitution	Constitutional meta-order that recurrently generates, selects, authorizes, protects, and replaces organized un-reality because independent truth has been subordinated to usefulness, loyalty, control, or authority. It is not the sum of conscious individual lies. Its primary semantic home is *Epistemic Constitution*.
Auxiliary-un-reality explaining-away cascade	A reality collision threatening operative un-reality U_0 elicits an authorized auxiliary causal account U_1 that explains the correction away, protects U_0, and may acquire classifications and consequences of its own. It becomes counterfeit Bayesian updating only where authorization, identity fit, or programme utility substitutes for independent support while U_1 is protected from reciprocal defeat. Its primary semantic home is *Epistemic Constitution*.
Trusted-carrier correction lock	High-gain trusted-opinion-leader-function positions remain sufficiently aligned to deny a public correction distributed credibility, reception, or operative force despite growing ordinary dissent. It is a possible receiving-field implementation of correction nullification, not proof of falsehood, coordination, capture, or Shadow-Sovereign rule; its primary semantic home is *Epistemic Agency*.
Mythological lens	The generalized mapping through which observations are converted into culturally learned values and feelings.
Ideological symbol	A socially legible token that activates the program and communicates a person's relation to it.
Conformity signal	An ideological symbol whose performance or nonperformance makes conformity and deviation publicly legible.

Construct	Precise role in culture mechanics
Targeting signal	A performed, omitted, imposed, or attributed token that assigns a person or population to a sanctionable out-group.
Local bigOther	The individual sentiment classifier that executes the installed lens.
Lacan's big Other	The shared symbolic vocabulary and protocol through which the program and its tokens become publicly intelligible.
Mechanical solidarity	The synchronized symbolic-affective coherence produced through compatible local execution and reciprocal response.
Distributed bigOther	The persistent network state maintained through persons, institutions, practices, artifacts, reputations, and sanctions.
Operative multi-mind-self	The distributed system only when it becomes sufficiently integrated and continuous to judge, intend, own, and act as a collective agent. A multi-mind-self presentation remains below this threshold.

In this section, lower-case **ideological** is retained as a legacy broad, religion-inclusive adjective for anything pertaining to a Culture Program. It includes religious, political, organizational, professional, activist, national, and lifestyle programs. The preferred formal common-category noun remains **Culture Program**. Capitalized **Ideology** instead names the strict installed un-reality-and-un-reason classifier. Both uses must be distinguished from the narrower **ideological form**, the third member of the private–collective–ideological–fundamentalist taxonomy below. The expression **ideological-form program** names that third configuration when the senses might otherwise be confused.

Disagreement, mythological rivalry, and cultural-program conflict The broad adjective *ideological* must not turn every disagreement into one undifferentiated "ideological conflict." Culture mechanics distinguishes the object and intensity of conflict:

Term	Culture-mechanical meaning
Propositional disagreement	Incompatible truth claims that need not involve rival governing lenses.
Causal-story conflict	Incompatible accounts of agents, causes, intentions, responsibility, or remedy.
Classification conflict	Incompatible assignments of identity, status, purity, legitimacy, or permission.
Mythological rivalry	Informal or decentralized competition among meaning systems, including lifestyles, religions, political outlooks, and institutional cultures.
Mythological conflict	Active interference with a rival mythology's transmission, authority, membership, or institutional embodiment.
Cultural-program conflict	Competition between incompatible governing programs or operative lenses, especially where single-slot replacement is at stake.
Propagative conflict	Organized recruitment, formation, conformity testing, delegitimation, or interference with a rival programme's reproduction.
Coercive conflict	Conflict in which expansion, retention, punishment, expulsion, elimination, or another objective authorizes or uses physical coercion or violence.

Rivalry becomes conflict when participants begin actively interfering with the rival mythology's transmission, authority, membership, or institutional embodiment.

Mythological rivalry can therefore persist without organized conflict. The transition can occur through recruitment campaigns, polemical unbraiding, conformity tests, delegitimation, exclusion from channels, institutional displacement, or censorship. *Mythology Construction*, "Mythological replacement: braiding, apologetics, and polemics," develops these operations and the problem of installing a successor weave.

Kenneth Minogue calls the organized struggle **ideological conflict**. In the preface to the second edition, dated January 2006 (p. xvi), of *Alien Powers: The Pure Theory of Ideology*, he argues that an initial move is to disable opposition, ideally by censorship. In Culture Mechanics terminology, this maps most directly to **propagative conflict** and **rival-signal suppression**, and to **coercive conflict** where physical force or violence becomes an evidenced means. Minogue's narrower, mobilizing, conflict-centered conception is now formalized as the **Minogue-ideology** subtype. It must not be silently equated with either the generalized Ideology classifier or the broad religion-inclusive adjective *ideological* used in this document.

Earlier project formulations called the last two outward operations **ideological-form conflict** and **fundamentalist-form conflict**. Those names are deprecated because they allowed propagation or violence to stand in for the inward person–programme relation. If that relation matters, report it independently: an ideological-form carrier lives the programme as a mission, while a fundamentalist-form carrier presents themselves as an instrument of its sovereign Will. Either relation can occur without violence, and coercive conflict can be executed by inwardly detached functionaries. Propagative and coercive conflict can overlap, but neither entails the other: organized propagation can remain nonviolent, while physical coercion can defend an incumbent order without seeking recruits.

Call censorship or channel exclusion **rival-signal suppression** when it obstructs a competing mythology's signals, and **counter-program suppression** when it attacks the rival program's reproduction or institutional embodiment. A counter-narrative is not analytically random noise: it may carry a rival mythology, independent evidence, an internal correction, minority perception, or innovation. For the relationship between this distinction and the physical noise-suppression heuristic, see *Analogical Models in Culture Mechanics: A Semantic Inventory*, "Positive feedback, noise, and rival signals." These conflict terms are project-developed translations; they are not Minogue's taxonomy.

Ideological symbols must be classified by function

> **An ideological symbol is a material object, word, linguistic form, gesture, sound, image, ritual, omission, or other socially legible token that activates an installed ideological program and communicates a person's relation to that program.**

The medium is incidental to the definition. A piece of cloth, grammatical ending, salute, profile image, whistle pattern, silence, refusal to applaud, or continued association with an excluded person can perform the same operation when participants know how to decode it. A symbol can be simultaneously functional in another domain: a mask can be a medical device and also acquire a moral-political meaning; clothing can protect from weather and also display membership. The presence of one function neither proves nor excludes the other.

Ideological symbols can perform several distinguishable functions:

1. activate an installed program;
2. cue the carrier's conduct;
3. display affiliation or membership;
4. distinguish insiders from outsiders;
5. advertise the program or invite imitation;
6. test conformity and expose deviation;
7. assign or expose a sanctionable out-group;
8. synchronize attention, affect, identity, judgment, or action;
9. manufacture apparent consensus;
10. mark refusal as moral or character failure;
11. communicate a claim to wider social jurisdiction;
12. enable social, institutional, legal, or physical sanctions.

No one token necessarily performs every function. Function must be inferred from the surrounding program, expectations, audience, treatment of refusal, and actual institutional consequences rather than from material form, religious or secular origin, or the stated intention of one carrier.

Conformity signals

> **An ideological symbol becomes a conformity signal when its performance, display, absence, refusal, or substitution makes conformity and deviation publicly legible and thereby enables monitoring, reinforcement, sanction, recruitment, exclusion, or a claim to wider jurisdiction.**

A **boundary signal** distinguishes insiders from outsiders. A **propagation signal** is designed or selected for easy public reproduction and advertises, normalizes, or spreads the program. A secret greeting may mainly mark a boundary; a slogan, salute, hashtag, linguistic convention, pledge, or clothing expectation may invite or pressure everyone to repeat it. One symbol can perform both functions.

Targeting signals Conformity signals and target markers are not mutually exclusive material classes. They name functions that may overlap in the same token or expectation:

> **A targeting signal is any performed, omitted, imposed, or attributed socially legible token that assigns a person or population to a sanctionable out-group and thereby makes exclusion, coercion, persecution, or violence easier to direct.**

Here **sanctionable** means treated by the program as available for sanction; it does not mean that the classification or sanction is justified.

> **A conformity signal becomes a targeting signal when its absence, refusal, substitution, or incorrect performance makes the nonconforming person legible as a sanctionable outsider.**

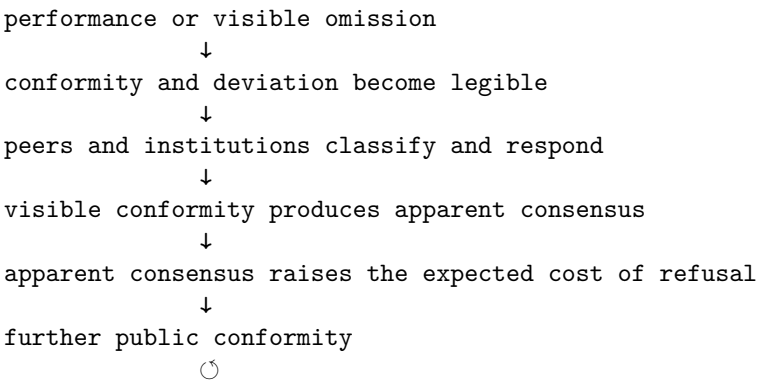
The relevant **signal polarity** is how the classification becomes visible, not whether the carrier voluntarily communicates it:

Mode	Culture-mechanical operation	Vivid example
Performed conformity	Display marks the person as one of "us"	Blue neckerchief, expected mask, badge, salute, pledge, or prescribed linguistic form
Negative targeting through nonperformance	Absence, refusal, substitution, or incorrect performance identifies the deviant	Missing neckerchief, unmasked face where masking is expected, absent certificate, refused salute, or unapproved wording
Imposed target marking	A hostile authority forces the out-group classification onto its target	The yellow star imposed on Jews under National Socialism
Attributed target marking	A name, accusation, record, database entry, or administrative category assigns target status without requiring a visible token	"Heretic," "class enemy," "extremist," "unvaccinated," or a corresponding institutional record when the classification routes sanctions

The blue neckerchief and the yellow star therefore differ in their direction of assignment but can converge downstream. The neckerchief marks the compliant member and its absence can expose a nonconforming target. The yellow star directly and forcibly marks the person whom the governing program classifies as an outsider. Both make a culturally defined boundary operational by making persons sortable.

COVID-19 supplies a particularly clear mixed case. An unmasked face could become a negative targeting signal wherever masking was expected and refusal was treated as evidence of irresponsibility, danger, or defective character. Vaccination status was normally not visible by itself; certificates, database checks, disclosure requirements, denied access, and verbal classification made it legible. The official phrase "pandemic of the unvaccinated" turned a biomedical status into a named causal category within public discourse and was explicitly joined to vaccination requirements. In a given setting, whether this classification became a targeting signal must be tested by examining blame, expected displays, access conditions, sanctions, and the treatment of refusal. This functional analysis does not by itself decide the empirical accuracy, medical value, legality, proportionality, or moral legitimacy of a mask or vaccine policy.

The decisive operation can therefore be negative. Where a display is expected, its absence identifies the person who has not complied without requiring that person to make a declaration. The signal thereby turns conduct into public telemetry:



When the performance is mutually observable, it can also generate **common knowledge**: participants know the signal, know that others received it, and know that others can observe their own response. Michael Suk-Young Chwe's *Rational Ritual* supplies this coordination mechanism. Common knowledge can organize outward conduct without proving private assent or the complete culture-mechanical account.

This loop can produce sincere convergence, strategic compliance, preference falsification, pluralistic ignorance, or a mixture of them. Timur Kuran's *Private Truths, Public Lies* supplies the established neighbouring mechanism in which public expression diverges from private preference under pressure. Václav Havel's *The Power of the Powerless* shows how ritual public conformity can reproduce a system without requiring private belief. Culture mechanics adds the local-processor, symbolic-protocol, and field account; neither author proposed this complete synthesis.

The installed program also supplies a virtual **yardstick of the good member**: a good hunter, vegan, worker, believer, citizen, revolutionary, or comrade. The conformity signal makes a person's apparent position against that yardstick visible. Assenting to an absurd statement can therefore become an especially powerful loyalty test: agreement with "2 + 2 = 5" communicates little about arithmetic but much about willingness to submit. Signals can also mark enemies. Public rejection of a stigmatized word, object, person, or association may become its own proof of belonging.

A compulsory conformity signal is not automatically a **credibility-enhancing display** or CRED. In Joseph Henrich's narrower model, costly conduct by a model can make professed commitment credible; see "The Evolution of Costly Displays, Cooperation and Religion". With a compulsory symbol, the principal cost may fall on refusal rather than on performance, and compliance may be purely strategic. **Sanction-backed conformity signal**, **compulsory membership signal**, or **public loyalty marker** is then more precise. No unvalidated checklist or numerical threshold should be presented as a CRED measure.

Beseelung* and four person–programme forms** The originating **dead–alive** analogy distinguishes information that is merely known from programming that animates conduct. A relatively dead rule resembles "stop at the red pedestrian light": a person can notice and ignore it without much guilt. An alive practice can make omission feel like personal failure, guilt, or betrayal. The German ***beseelt–literally, in a poetic translation, "ensouled"–better conveys this experienced animation than the bloodless word *stored*.

Beseelung is an independent axis. It concerns how affectively alive and conduct-directing a program is, not where the programme stands in relation to the person, how widely it recruits, or how aggressively it enforces. A bounded private-form practice can be intensely alive. A football crowd can synchronize powerfully without seeking converts. A perfectly conforming functionary can privately believe nothing, and a fundamentalist programme can transmit its effects through cynical officials.

An impersonal lifted order makes the independence of this axis especially clear. It can be comparatively cool or only weakly *beseelt* while fully occupying the local slot, governing a broad jurisdiction, receiving strong institutional support, and reliably directing conduct through professional duty, contract, office, law, and conscience. Conversely, intense *Beseelung* need not bring broad jurisdiction, institutional strength, or collective agency. Low affective animation therefore does not by itself establish incomplete slot occupancy, a weak distributed bigOther, narrow authority, or absence of durable cultural reproduction.

***Beseelung* actuation profile and person–programme relation** *Beseelung* intensity answers how alive and conduct-directing a programme is. An **actuation profile** asks through which affects and motives that animation becomes effective: pressure, duty, aspiration, belonging, love, gratitude, grievance, fear, shame, joy, play, hope, or another evidenced route. Two programmes can be equally intense while moving persons through very different profiles, and one programme can change profile without losing its operative identity.

The **person–programme relation** asks what the programme becomes for the person. It may be a bounded enrichment of life, a shared belonging, an answerable mission, an inherited obligation, an identity centre, or an authority that increasingly treats the person as its instrument. The private, collective, ideological, and fundamentalist forms defined below are ideal-type positions on this inward relation and its allocation of principal standing between person and programme. They are not identical to the separately observable outward propagation and enforcement profile. A programme practised alone can occupy an ideological or fundamentalist person–programme form, while an institution can execute coercive rules through inwardly detached functionaries.

Henri Bergson's *The Two Sources of Morality and Religion* supplies the important precursor distinction between mutually reinforcing obligation pressure and morally expansive aspiration, together with *fabulation* as an action-supporting representation. Culture Mechanics generalizes the comparison into a multi-route actuation profile rather than identifying its complete taxonomy with Bergson's closed and open sources. His two-source distinction also supplies a non-reductionist warning: morally expansive aspiration is not merely closed group pressure enlarged to a wider population. Conversely, a closed group, nation, or empire can borrow the symbols and universal language of open morality while continuing to serve cohesion, exclusion, or domination; claimed universality therefore does not identify the operative actuation source or beneficiary. The existing Kant–Rand and Child-at-Play contrasts supply project examples of duty-heavy and aspiration-heavy configurations; they do not imply that either author or every programme has only one actuation route.

Obligation accumulation

A conduct-directing **obligation accumulation** can arise when many individually weak expectations support one another until their combined output appears as an unqualified "one must."

```
habit + role expectation + anticipated judgment + reciprocal expectation
+ institutional rule + inherited usage
→ mutually reinforced obligation
→ apparently self-evident "one must"
```

No single component need be sufficient, centrally designed, explicitly believed, or consciously rehearsed. The combined result can support valuable reliability, ordinary coordination, or oppressive conformity. Its presence establishes neither truth nor pathology; the audit asks which expectations contribute, what conduct they enable or prevent, whether the person can identify and contest them, and what occurs after refusal.

Affective-to-structural load transfer **Status:** Project-developed mechanism from the originating author's proposal that a strong institutional skeleton can take over part of the conduct-directing load otherwise borne by flesh-and-blood affective intensity.

Affective-to-structural load transfer is the proposed mechanism by which an operative Culture Program becomes less dependent upon intense affective activation in every carrier because habits, roles, procedures, incentives, sanctions, records, formation, interfaces, audit, and succession make its classifications repeatable across persons, situations, and time.

> **Institutions can convert affective intensity into structural persistence and range: the norm becomes less intensely felt at each node while becoming more reliably reproduced across the system.**

The term *convert* names a functional shift in where the conduct-directing load is carried. It does not mean that affect is a conserved substance which literally moves into a building, rulebook, database, or office. The characteristic sequence is:

```
intense personal conviction
→ repeated practice and professional habit
→ institutionalized rule, role, procedure, and expectation
→ broad, quiet, reliable compliance
```

Several routes can contribute:

- **Affective substitution:** procedures, habits, incentives, sanctions, and technical constraints reduce how much fresh affective activation each act requires.
- **Structural sedimentation:** earlier moral investment becomes embodied in professional traditions, routines, records, institutions, and succession practices. This may be called *affective storage* in shorthand, but the institution stores a reproducible form and history rather than affect itself.
- **Range extension:** standardized roles and interfaces transmit a comparatively quiet norm across strangers, organizations, generations, and territories.

- **Affective concentration:** most participants comply coolly while teachers, judges, auditors, custodians, exemplars, or professional bodies carry stronger commitment and maintain the reproduction machinery.
- **Periodic reanimation:** initiation, ceremony, exemplary cases, public failure, scandal, crisis, or deliberate renewal can restore affective salience when routine structural support becomes insufficient.

Ambient and activation-conditioned coupling

A further consequence is that visible alignment under ordinary conditions and realized coordination under activation are not the same quantity:

> **A society's visible affective alignment is a poor measure of its latent collective capacity. Institutions can store coupling in roles, interfaces, infrastructure and command relations, allowing an apparently loose society to become a highly coherent machine when activated.**

Here *store coupling* is controlled shorthand for preserving a reproducible capacity for coordinated action. It does not mean literal storage of affect, agreement, agency, or collective intention, and *machine* describes the resulting coordination morphology rather than turning persons into components without judgment or standing.

For analysis, distinguish three measures:

- **Ambient affective coupling:** the alignment visible in ordinary feeling, public enthusiasm, ritual synchrony, declared belief, and everyday interaction.
- **Latent structural coupling:** the still-available capacity carried by fitted roles, interoperable standards, records, infrastructure, resource-routing systems, command relations, and learned expectations before a demanding common task activates them.
- **Activation-conditioned coupling:** the coordination actually realized when a trigger, objective, authorization, resource flow, and command or mission relation recruit that standing structure into action.

The characteristic activation path is:

```
low everyday affective synchrony
+ differentiated specialization
+ standardized interfaces
+ routable administrative, logistical, and industrial infrastructure
+ effective activation signal, objective, and command relations
→ rapid coherent mobilization across otherwise diverse agents
```

Population records and qualifications can route persons into roles; taxation, credit, and budgets can route resources into procurement; transport and logistics can move material; firms and technical standards can make outputs interoperable; professions can supply differentiated specialists; and communication and mission relations can align decentralized local judgment with a common objective. War is an extreme activation case, but disaster response, infrastructure repair, large-scale production, and scientific or technical programmes can expose the same architecture. Affective enthusiasm may ignite, legitimate, or sustain the effort, but it does not substitute for the transmission machinery. An order can therefore be weakly synchronized in everyday life yet strongly mobilizable.

Latent capacity should not be inferred from an organizational chart or nominal command chain alone. It becomes evidenced when activation or a claim-matched challenge makes resources traverse real interfaces, interoperable roles produce a coherent result, local judgment handles novel cases without losing the objective, feedback changes the course, and repair or succession preserves the function. Failure at those boundaries can reveal a paper skeleton, bottleneck, common-mode dependency, or brittle command system despite impressive formal structure.

This capacity is direction-neutral. The same structural carrier can organize care, production, rescue, repression, or industrial destruction; the operative objective and governor determine what its capacity serves. A successor governor may inherit and redirect the machinery, but mobilization capacity alone establishes neither legitimacy, capture, pseudomorphic governor substitution, nor an operative multi-mind-self.

A quiet professional conviction that "one simply does not falsify the result" may therefore be weakly *beseelt* but institutionally decisive. Professional formation, peer expectation, auditability, replication, career consequence, and institutional memory can make the classification reliable without sacred intensity, collective-self presentation, or an operative multi-mind-self.

The dimensions must remain separate:

```
low affective intensity
≠ incomplete slot occupancy
≠ narrow jurisdiction
```

```
≠ weak institutional embedding
≠ low latent structural coupling
≠ low activation-conditioned coordination
≠ low conduct reliability
≠ weak reproduction
≠ collective-self presentation
≠ absence or presence of an operative multi-mind-self
```

Avoid the unqualified expression **weak distributed bigOther**. Specify whether the alleged weakness concerns affective gain, field coherence, institutional embedding, jurisdictional reach, conduct reliability, reproduction, correction, collective-self presentation, or collective agency.

The mechanism is neither automatic nor irreversible. A static combination of cool affect and strong compliance may instead result from fear, convenience, material incentive, technical constraint, or externally imposed administration; historical load transfer requires evidence of formation, sedimentation, and changed dependence upon local activation. A skeleton can carry and distribute part of the load, but it cannot indefinitely replace living interpretation, judgment, correction, and renewal. If those relations disappear, structural persistence may decay, become brittle in unanticipated cases, preserve merely ceremonial compliance, or provide machinery for a successor governor.

When a programme contains an agent-model, ***agentified Beseelung*** can make that agent sufficiently present within local evaluation that the person begins to perceive, judge, and act from its represented perspective. This joins the dead–alive axis to bigOther-presence without making them synonyms: a practice can be deeply *beseelt* without a personified Thou, and an asserted vision or voice does not by itself establish durable affective animation, distributed agency, or fusion.

Relative deadness can also be a historical remainder. A culture may preserve a rule, word, symbol, institution, or habitual procedure after losing the mythology, rituals, practices, and transmission relations that once made it sacred, identity-bearing, and synchronizing. Such a remnant can remain functionally useful: the pedestrian signal still coordinates movement even when it no longer evokes guilt, sacrifice, or an experience of collective being. A later observer who sees only that remnant cannot safely infer that the rule was always affectively dead.

This creates a three-way calm-period ambiguity: an intact cultural system may be **dormant**; surviving material may be **de-animated**; or the former synchronization technology may be **culturally lost** and require successor construction rather than reactivation. Loss of that technology does not empty the one PCI slot: another operative mythological weave still occupies the local bigOther. *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*, "Observability, cultural forgetting, and contemporary witnesses" states the historical hypothesis and evidential problem. *Analogical Models in Culture Mechanics: A Semantic Inventory* maps them to the nested quantum, laser, magnetism, weak-field gravity, and contemporary-witness pictures.

The private–collective–ideological–fundamentalist distinction classifies dominant **person–programme forms**, not different kinds of bigOther and not a necessary sequence through which every program passes. Its inner spine is a change in what the programme becomes for the person and in who increasingly serves whom:

```
private:        programme as bounded enrichment
collective:     programme as shared belonging
ideological:    programme as mission
fundamentalist: programme as sovereign Will

person uses programme
→ persons inhabit programme together
→ person serves programme
→ programme uses person
```

Form	Lived relation	Relation to rivals and nonparticipants	Typical outward expression
Private	"This enriches my life." The programme remains an ingredient within a larger life.	Alternatives need not threaten it.	Personal discovery, self-cue, optional recognition, and little demand upon outsiders.

Form	Lived relation	Relation to rivals and nonparticipants	Typical outward expression
Collective	"This is something valuable that we share." The programme supplies belonging, ritual, and mutual recognition.	Other communities can ordinarily coexist.	Attraction, affiliation, mutual reinforcement, and visible enjoyment of membership.
Ideological form	"This is the right way, and others should be brought into it." The carrier acquires a mission.	Alternatives increasingly appear as error, injustice, false consciousness, or obstacles.	Recruitment, education, formation, conformity pressure, and institutional propagation.
Fundamentalist form	"The programme's ultimate Other acts through me." The carrier becomes an execution surface for a supposedly known sovereign Will.	Rival allegiance can become betrayal, pollution, or evil; personal judgment loses standing against the programme.	Mobilization, sacrifice, enemy marking, surveillance, coercion, punishment, expulsion, or elimination can become authorized.

Vivid ideal-type examples:

- In the **private form**, consider a dietary or yoga practice adopted as one valued ingredient of a larger life. It may be intensely loved while remaining bounded and leaving alternative lives legitimate.
- In the **collective form**, consider football-club or pop-star fandom. It attracts through advertising, spectacle, and the visible pleasures of belonging rather than demanding conversion.
- In the **ideological form**, consider a proselytizing religion or a political movement such as Marxism. Mission, education, cadre formation, or comparable training forms members in the "correct" way of being.
- In the **fundamentalist form**, the programme is encountered as an agentified God, History, Destiny, Nation, People, or Cause whose supposedly unambiguous Will acts through the carrier. Bodily force may follow, but direct possession of the Other's Will and displacement of answerable authorship are the deeper relation.

These examples make the forms concrete; they do not establish that every instance belongs wholly to one form. Whole religions, cultures, institutions, or movements may nevertheless be classified as predominantly one form when the scope, evidence, countercases, and possible falsifiers are stated.

The taxonomy is a project-developed synthesis, not a classification attributed to Susan Blackmore's account of memes and temes. Her replicator account supplies a neighbouring way to think about copied cultural information; the four forms classify a programme's relation to its human carriers and rivals. Their variability illustrates the originating software analogy: programs are flexible–that is the force of *soft* in *software*.

The separately observable **outward propagation and enforcement profile** asks how adherence is produced and how nonparticipation is treated. Its recurrent operations include personal discovery, attraction and affiliation, active recruitment and formation, retention pressure, institutional propagation, and coercive or violent enforcement. These operations can support inference about the inward form, but they do not define it. Outward conduct is often easier to observe than lived relation, so a classification should join self-description, role and ritual evidence, treatment of rival allegiance, personal authorship, refusal, sacrifice, institutional operation, and correction rather than infer an inward form from one public act.

The forms compress several axes that must remain separately inspectable:

- depth of *Beseelung*;
- public visibility;
- outward recruitment or proselytism;
- inward retention and treatment of exit;
- lateral intolerance of rival allegiance;
- jurisdiction over domains of life;
- synchronization strength;
- social and institutional sanctions;
- authorization or willingness to use physical violence.

The forms are not a *Beseelung* scale, but independence does not mean absence of correlation. A living fundamentalist carrier position will ordinarily involve high, jealous, and often agentified *Beseelung*: the programme organizes

attention, purpose, identity, sacrifice, and the standing of personal judgment. A programme-level fundamentalist form need not animate every participant equally. A small directing or interpretive stratum can transmit intense commitment through roles, commands, sanctions, records, and cool or cynical executors. If no carrier, institution, or living interpretive centre remains committed to the programme and only inherited coercive machinery persists, the better description may be a de-animated fundamentalist shell or an ordinary coercive apparatus rather than a living fundamentalist Culture Program.

Strong conviction, feeling called, self-sacrifice, or costly ethical resistance is not by itself fundamentalism. The stronger relation begins when mediation and answerable choice disappear and the carrier presents action as direct execution of the Other's supposedly known Will. Proselytism is not jealousy; jealousy is not physical violence; and discursive violence, defined below, can occur without a fundamentalist person–programme relation.

Jealous programs, solidarity, and collective agents The originating analogy is deliberately vivid:

> **A jealous multi-mind-self resembles a jealous lover who wants to own the beloved and cannot tolerate divided allegiance.**

The corresponding operational definition is:

> **A jealous cultural program claims exclusive allegiance, classifies incompatible commitment, dissent, or exit as betrayal, and mobilizes symbols, sanctions, institutions, and collective affect to defend that claim.**

Kenneth Minogue's *Alien Powers: The Pure Theory of Ideology* provides a close published neighbour in its treatment of ideological revelation as jealous and expansionary. **Jealous cultural program** and its integration with the present ontology are project-developed terms, not Minogue's complete theory. The complete source reconstruction now belongs to the narrower **Minogue-ideology** subtype; jealousy is one neighbouring relation, not its definition.

Jealousy must be attributed at the correct level:

Level	Operation in a jealous configuration
Lacan's big Other	Carries publicly intelligible categories and tokens such as loyalty, betrayal, idolatry, heresy, oath, flag, scarf, and rival symbol. It is the protocol, not the jealous agent.
Local bigOther	Executes a jealous lens and makes rival allegiance, refusal, or exit feel shameful, contaminating, frightening, or treacherous. In **bigOther-presence**, and especially **bigOther-as-Thou**, the person may directly feel a present jealous Other that claims fidelity and refuses divided allegiance. Calling the processor itself jealous remains functional shorthand for the program it executes; calling the experienced presence jealous describes how that operation can be lived.
Mechanical solidarity	Synchronizes compatible classifications and reciprocal enforcement.
Distributed bigOther	Preserves the network state through expectations, reputations, rituals, institutions, symbols, and sanctions.
Multi-mind-self	If the collective-agent threshold is met, the integrated system can itself claim, condemn, exclude, punish, or attack through its members and institutions.

Jealousy therefore has both an **analytical description** and a **phenomenological appearance**. Analytically, the installed program defines exclusive loyalty and the local bigOther executes its classifications. Phenomenologically, a jealous God, Nation, People, History, or Cause may be encountered as personally present–watching, addressing, claiming, accusing, or demanding sacrifice. This direct individual experience does not collapse the local processor into Lacan's shared symbolic protocol, and it does not by itself establish that the surrounding distributed bigOther has crossed the multi-mind-self threshold.

Single-slot exclusivity is not jealousy. Every stable program fully occupies the one local slot, including an open, pluralistic, lifted program. Jealousy begins when the installed program additionally demands exclusive allegiance,

treats legitimate rivalry or replacement as betrayal, blocks dignified exit, claims the whole person, exceeds its jurisdiction, or monopolizes authoritative interpretation.

Jealousy and proselytism are hypothesized to reinforce one another often, especially in ideological-form and fundamentalist programs, but they are not identical. A separatist sect can retain members jealously while seeking no converts; a missionary movement can recruit energetically while respecting refusal and exit. Analysis should therefore record outward recruitment, inward retention, rival intolerance, jurisdiction, and enforcement separately.

Exodus 20:3 and 20:5 supply the theological exemplar of a jealous God, exclusive covenant loyalty, and "no other gods." The jealous-lover comparison uses this as an analogy for the classification of rival attachment as betrayal or idolatry, not as empirical proof of the social mechanism. The related Christian interpretation–that the human capacity to join a multi-mind-self is the "God-shaped hole" that should be filled by God rather than a human ideological collective–is an originating confessional interpretation, not a general scientific proposition or a settled philological claim.

Moralization as character accusation: Andrick's bridge Michael Andrick's *Im Moralgefängnis: Spaltung verstehen und überwinden* supplies the missing micro-mechanism between moral classification, conformity signalling, exclusion, and escalating violence. In Andrick's account, misplaced moralization performs two changes at once:

1. **Focus:** the exchange moves from the disputed issue to the other person's character.
2. **Mode:** inquiry and argument become accusation and prosecution.

His kindergarten example preserves the operation vividly. A discussion about whether a kindergarten should have two or three floors becomes a trial of whether one participant is a good person who deserves to remain in the discussion. A fleeting statement or minor act is read as a revealing disclosure of character; the alleged disclosure becomes a character accusation; and the person's standing, rather than the proposition, becomes the target:

```
factual disagreement or missing conformity signal
              ↓
statement, omission, or association becomes "character disclosure"
              ↓
character accusation
              ↓
inquiry becomes prosecution
              ↓
discursive standing is attacked
              ↓
submit, recant, or be excluded
```

Andrick's strong verdict is that **moralization is discursive violence** and makes physical violence more likely. Its immediate domination does not require bodily force: it attacks the other's recognized standing and invokes the background threat, "You may not be breaking public law, but you are breaking my law; submit or I will exclude you." Even legitimate moral condemnation remains aggressive in this account. In private relationships it is the metaphorical **atomic bomb**, or the sharpest social weapon, although consciously removing an intolerable person from one's voluntary private circle may itself be legitimate.

The tendency toward violence therefore cannot simply be abolished in Andrick's account: even justified moral condemnation contains an exclusionary threat. His associated freedom claim is equally strong–pathological moralization and free self-determination cannot coexist. Official voluntariness does not settle the question when refusing a prescribed linguistic form, dress expectation, ritual, or declaration brings foreseeable moral, social, or professional punishment.

Culture mechanics extends rather than merely repeats Andrick's account:

```
local bigOther classifies a person as bad, disloyal, or unbearable
              ↓ encoded through
shared accusation, stigma, required denunciation, or conformity test
              ↓ reciprocally reinforced as
mechanical solidarity and collective exclusion
              ↓ preserved through
distributed reputations, institutional routines, records, and sanctions
              ↓ possibly executed by
a multi-mind-self capable of organized judgment and action
```

Guilt by association is a secondary conformity signal. Continuing to speak with an excluded person, refusing to denounce them, or preserving a public relationship can itself be treated as a character disclosure. Cancel culture, refusal to enter discussion with opponents, mandatory denunciation, and the public sorting of people into epistemic tribes are candidate manifestations of this mechanism; each case still requires evidence that the operation actually occurred.

Division is therefore not merely a static condition. It can be continuously enacted as people stop speaking with opponents, speak only about them, infer character from statements, demand public denunciation, and punish continued association. In the wider cultural process, Andrick's operation can be understood as cutting a **cleavage plane** through an existing political-cultural *we*:

- cross-boundary friendships and conversations become costly;
- bridge persons and moderates become morally suspect;
- guilt by association suppresses communication across the line;
- internally recognizable conformity signals acquire greater importance; and
- the opposite side becomes a negative identity anchor.

This cleavage operation is not yet **cultural-epistemic fission**. It can end in the silencing, expulsion, or subordination of one side while one dominant Culture Program remains. Fission additionally requires two or more sides to become sufficiently viable as separately reproducing distributed epistemic milieus and local-bigOther-forming ecologies. Andrick supplies one important bridge-cutting mechanism; he does not supply that complete collective morphology or its Babelization threshold.

The present framework adds the **moral-closure hypothesis**:

Rudolf Bilz's formulation of human existence as **tribunal existence** and Odo Marquard's "tribunalization of modern lived reality" are neighbouring diagnoses of a condition in which persons are placed under pervasive accusation and pressure to justify their right to be as they are. The exact primary source for Bilz's formulation remains to be verified; it is retained here as a provenance lead rather than presented as established evidence for the mechanism.

```
group bundles around an argument
              ↓
non-bundlers are excluded
              ↓
belonging becomes membership among "good people"
              ↓
opposition becomes character defect
              ↓
an open society is converted into a closed community
              ↓
the closed community seeks dominance
```

The originating discussion connected this sequence with Ulrike Guérot's "bundling" description of a group organizing around an argument and excluding those who refuse to bundle, and with Ferdinand Tönnies's distinction between open societal association and closed community. That compound attribution still requires a primary-source audit. The diagram above is therefore Culture Mechanics' moral-closure hypothesis, not a definition attributed to Guérot, Tönnies, or an established general definition of fascism. Moral closure is one possible pathway into, but is not sufficient for, the conjunctive whole-polity definition of Fascism. When closure becomes a concrete attempt to align multiple independent societal domains toward one privileged ideological direction, test the separate polity-scale *Gleichschaltung* hazard. Do so even before a complete Culture Program can be reconstructed or attributed. Moral closure alone does not establish that process gate.

The originating **ideology-as-hallucination hypothesis** is stronger still: an ideology operating as a collectively protected hallucination cannot win through a reality-facing explanation of mechanisms and consequences and therefore tends to use discursive domination. On this hypothesis, moralization expresses fear–or, in the culpable case, knowledge–that the position would fail under fair conditions among equals. This is a definite and risky project hypothesis, not an established result of Andrick's book. It would be weakened by cases in which a position systematically moralizes strong opponents despite repeatedly prevailing under open, symmetrical, evidence-sensitive contest, or by evidence that the moralization is better explained without awareness or fear of argumentative weakness.

The enforcement–exclusion and violence repertoire The originating claim is:

Enforcement and exclusion are dual operations. Enforcement states or applies a condition of continued inclusion, standing, access, or permitted action; exclusion withdraws or denies these goods when the condition is not met.

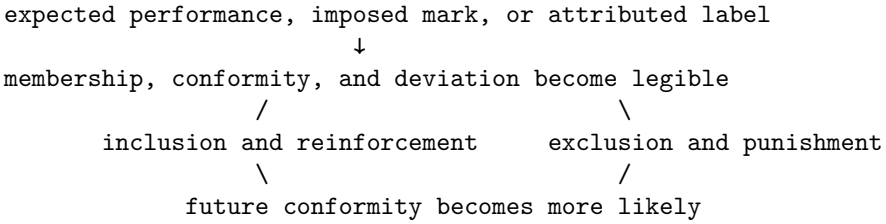
Andrick's compact threat–"Submit, or I will exclude you"–contains both sides. From the program's perspective, the rule is enforced. From the affected person's perspective, refusal can mean exclusion from moral standing, discussion, relationship, community, institution, territory, or life. The same sanction often does both simultaneously: excluding one visible nonconformist also enforces conformity among everyone who observes the consequence.

This is a structural duality, not an assertion that enforcement and exclusion are identical in every case. Instruction, persuasion, reward, or ordinary coordination can maintain a practice without applying an exclusionary sanction. A person can end a private relationship without trying to govern a wider public. Physical coercion can be used to retain or convert a person rather than expel them, although it excludes their alternative conduct and violates bodily autonomy. Jurisdiction, proportionality, evidence, due process, and the good being withheld remain separate questions.

The word *violence* must likewise not hide the difference between moral evaluation, discursive domination, exclusion, coercion, and bodily force:

Form	Program-side enforcement	Excluded standing or domain
Moral evaluation	Classifies conduct as good or bad; ordinary bigOther activity, not necessarily moralization	Moral approval or recognition as a good member; no civic or social exclusion need follow
Discursive violence	Replaces inquiry with character accusation and attacks the opponent's standing	Credibility, admissibility, or recognition as a legitimate interlocutor
Relational exclusion	Conditions or ends friendship, intimacy, or voluntary private association	A particular relationship or private circle
Collective social exclusion	Uses ostracism, cancellation, guilt by association, or coordinated reputational destruction	Community membership, social contact, reputation, and informal opportunities
Institutional coercion	Conditions employment, education, platforms, services, office, or professional standing on submission	Access to institutions, occupations, services, platforms, or public roles
Physical violence	Uses or threatens bodily force to compel, retain, punish, convert, expel, or eliminate	Bodily autonomy, movement, safety, territory, or the permitted alternative course of action
Eliminative violence	Treats the rival as having no right to remain, participate, or exist	Membership, territory, public existence, life, or memory

The conformity-signal mechanism is the sensor and this repertoire supplies possible outputs:



This repertoire is not a deterministic ladder. Moralization can stop at private withdrawal or social exclusion, and movements can jump to institutional or physical coercion. The compact distinction is:

All moralization is discursively violent in Andrick's sense; not all moralization expresses willingness to use physical violence. The fundamentalist threshold is authorization or willingness to use physical or eliminative force, not the mere presence of moral aggression.

Moralization can nevertheless raise the probability of further violence by turning the mistaken person into the bad person, licensing exclusion, making punishment appear deserved, and allowing aggression to be experienced

as protection, justice, purification, or duty. This is a probabilistic escalation hypothesis, not the claim that every moralized disagreement becomes physically violent.

Stanton's genocidal escalation processes as a neighbouring model Gregory H. Stanton's *Ten Stages of Genocide* supplies a neighbouring model of how collective classification and symbolization can become organized eliminative violence. Stanton now emphasizes that the "stages" are overlapping, non-linear processes: they can operate simultaneously, need not advance inexorably, and can be interrupted. His object is the specific process leading to genocide; the culture-mechanical repertoire is broader and also applies to non-genocidal programs, relationships, institutions, and conflicts.

The models therefore map onto one another without becoming synonyms:

Stanton's process	Culture-mechanical relationship
1. Classification	The mythological lens divides a population into "us" and "them." Classification is upstream of violence and can also serve benign or necessary distinctions.
2. Symbolization	Names, dress, documents, and other tokens make the classification socially legible. An expected conformity signal can target through its absence; an imposed marker such as the yellow star directly marks the out-group; an attributed label can do so without a worn object.
3. Discrimination	Enforcement–exclusion becomes durable law, custom, or institutional practice that removes rights, standing, access, or opportunity from the classified group.
4. Dehumanization	Moralized character accusation expands into categorical enemy construction: persons become vermin, disease, contamination, pollution, or another kind of being whose removal can be redescribed as cleansing or protection.
5. Organization	Parties, bureaucracies, police, armies, militias, media systems, lists, and surveillance turn hostility into scalable implementation capacity. Organization is infrastructure for violence, not by itself another form of violence.
6. Polarization	Moral closure, guilt by association, communicative severance, and attacks on moderates disable countercultures, compromise, and independent correction.
7. Preparation	Plans, target lists, training, weapons, mobilization, and euphemistic goals make organized physical or eliminative intent operational. These are strong indicators that a coercive or eliminative threshold has been crossed, although no numbered Stanton process defines that threshold.
8. Persecution	Institutional coercion and physical violence become coordinated identification, dispossession, arrest, displacement, confinement, torture, or killing of the target population.
9. Extermination	Genocide is a specific collective form of eliminative violence. The culture-mechanical category is broader because programs can seek to eliminate political, social, or other rivals without satisfying the definition of genocide.

Stanton's process	Culture-mechanical relationship
10. Denial	The program protects itself after and during violence through euphemism, destroyed evidence, impunity, blame reversal, suppression of memory, and attacks on witnesses. This connects the enforcement–exclusion and violence repertoire to memory control and systemic lying in *Epistemic Constitution of Lifted Mechanical Solidarity*.

Stanton's model supplies historically developed observations and an early-warning process model. It does not establish the local-bigOther processor, distributed field, jealousy, or multi-mind-self ontology proposed here. Conversely, Culture Mechanics proposes a possible micro-to-macro mechanism through which some of Stanton's processes become affectively compelling, mutually observable, and institutionally executable.

The connection is a risky escalation hypothesis, not guilt by conceptual association. A classification, symbol, health rule, access condition, or act of private exclusion does not establish a genocidal trajectory. The inference becomes stronger only as additional processes appear: a sanctionable out-group, dehumanizing mythology, destruction of moderating relations, scalable coercive organization, preparation for physical force, persecution, and elimination. The absence of these transitions, durable protection of the target group's equal civic standing, and effective correction of wrongful classifications count against the escalation hypothesis.

Private morality and public standing The originating maxim **"morality is private"** protects an essential boundary: private moral revulsion does not by itself decide who may participate in public life. Taken absolutely, however, it would exclude genuine public moral questions and legitimate public authority. The compatible formulation is:

> **Comprehensive personal moral convictions do not by themselves determine another person's civic standing. Public coercion requires publicly contestable rules, proper jurisdiction, evidence, proportionality, and due process.**

Or, more vividly:

> **We may debate moral questions publicly, but disagreement must not become a character trial that revokes the opponent's right to participate.**

An imposed target label is not the target's self-description. Nuclear taboo vocabulary such as "Nazi" may operate as a targeting signal or as one stage of the projective-vandalism circuit; it does not by itself establish the attributed Culture Program or hazard class. The Attribution-Source Asymmetry governs that evidentiary distinction.

This boundary does not prohibit private association or moral judgment. It prevents a private moral law from silently becoming public jurisdiction. Its institutional development belongs in *Epistemic Constitution of Lifted Mechanical Solidarity*, especially "Low-cost contradiction, not low-cost condemnation."

Worked examples and boundary tests **The DDR blue neckerchief.** The blue neckerchief of the Pioneer organization was not merely clothing or a membership badge. In a school environment where almost every child was expected to be a Pioneer, wearing it displayed conformity while the missing scarf exposed refusal without requiring the child to speak. The historical description by MDR records that Pioneer membership was part of ordinary school life and served the state's socialist education. The culture-mechanical interpretation–boundary marker, identity and loyalty signal, public compliance device, and trigger for monitoring or sanction–is the present framework's synthesis.

Speech and conduct. Prescribed gendered language (*Gendern*) can perform the same operation as cloth when use displays conformity, non-use becomes observable, and non-use is interpreted as character disclosure. A COVID mask can remain a medical device while also functioning as an ideological signal when the surrounding field makes it a visible test of responsibility, obedience, solidarity, distrust, or political allegiance. A salute, pledge, pronoun formula, badge, ribbon, flag, profile image, applause, whistle, silence, or continued association can likewise carry the operation. The test is functional and contextual, not material.

Kippah and Islamic veiling. The originating whole-religion comparison is deliberately asymmetric and testable. Judaism is hypothesized to be predominantly non-proselytizing and the kippah predominantly member-directed: its ordinary public meaning is the wearer's observance and affiliation, not a demand that surrounding non-Jews adopt it. Islam, considered as a whole religious-cultural program, is hypothesized to be predominantly proselytizing and jealous. Islamic veiling can therefore function simultaneously as personal observance, internal conformity,

outward propagation, and a claim to public moral jurisdiction. This classification concerns the operative canonical and institutional program and its aggregate trajectory; it does not assert that every Jew, Muslim, kippah wearer, or veiled woman understands or intends the complete operation.

On this hypothesis, veiling can become a **public threat** in a precise culture-mechanical sense: not because the fabric or every individual wearer issues a conscious threat, but because the surrounding program publicly represents a demand for wider jurisdiction and makes sanctions against eventual refusal predictable if that program becomes dominant. The kippah contrast predicts no comparable Judaism-wide apparatus for punishing refusal or compelling outsiders; evidence of such an apparatus would count against the comparison.

The blue neckerchief and Islamic veiling are thus proposed as **functional homologues** when both embody the program in everyday life, make conformity and refusal legible, distinguish good members from questionable ones, enable peer or institutional monitoring, normalize the underlying order, and reproduce it through public performance. Their differences concern propagation, jealousy, jurisdiction, and enforcement, not a categorical division between secular and religious symbols.

The boundary is not Iran. Police enforcement is the extreme implementation layer, not the beginning of a jurisdictional claim. The originating trajectory is:

```
practice presented as personal choice
              ↓
practice promoted as protection, dignity, or empowerment
              ↓
practice becomes a public model of proper conduct
              ↓
criticism is moralized as hostility or harm
              ↓
countercultures lose legitimate means of defence
              ↓
institutions accommodate and reproduce the norm
              ↓
nonconformity becomes socially or professionally costly
              ↓
the norm acquires legal and police enforcement
```

The language of protection can create an asymmetric field: the advancing program expresses its demand as care, freedom, dignity, or safety while resistance is classified as prejudice or aggression. The program remains free to extend its norm, while countercultures are morally disarmed from defending their own order. This is the proposed **protection-framed jurisdictional manoeuvre**. It can emerge through many sincere participants without a central conspiracy. Only when the collective-agent threshold is met should it be attributed as an intentional manoeuvre of an operative multi-mind-self; below that threshold it remains an emergent operation of a program, solidarity field, and distributed bigOther.

Iran is proposed not as the boundary at which the problem begins but as an advanced realized form in which a religious prescription has captured state jurisdiction. The United Nations Independent International Fact-Finding Mission on Iran documents morality-police deployment, surveillance, arrests, prosecution, and forced pledges connected to mandatory hijab enforcement. The originating **end-state hypothesis** is conditional and categorical: for the relevant aggressively proselytizing and jealous Islamic movements in Western societies, success means defeating countercultures and acquiring sufficient institutional power; **if they succeed, Iran is the predicted end-state form**, in which promoted Islamic norms become compulsory public jurisdiction. Iran exhibits the predicted completed conversion; its existence does not by itself establish that every movement will succeed.

The religion-level hypothesis should be tested against canonical claims, mission and jihad doctrines, historical institutional trajectories, treatment of apostasy and criticism, freedom of rival religions, rules governing women's dress, and conduct after political dominance is obtained. It would be weakened by durable Muslim-majority orders possessing overwhelming cultural and political power while intrinsically protecting across generations:

- genuine freedom not to veil;
- conversion away from Islam and public criticism of Islam;
- rival religions and nonreligious life;
- equal civic standing independent of religious conformity;
- constitutional barriers preventing Islamic morality from becoming compulsory public law.

Judaism's contrasting classification is equally revisable: evidence of systematic outward conversion, expanding jurisdiction over non-Jews, or coercive enforcement of kippah observance would weaken the predominantly non-proselytizing, member-directed hypothesis. Whole religions may be classified. The scientific safeguard is precise scope, evidence, countercases, and falsifiability–not protective euphemism.

Combined mechanism and boundaries The mini-theory's central mechanism is:

```
jealous mythology defines exclusive loyalty
              ↓
ideological symbol activates the installed program
              ↓
conformity or targeting signal makes loyalty, refusal, or target status observable
              ↓
deviation or target status is interpreted as character or category disclosure
              ↓
moralization turns disclosure into accusation
              ↓
mechanical solidarity distributes the judgment
              ↓
systems impose exclusion, coercion, or violence
              ↓
the program defends or expands its jurisdiction
```

This mechanism is not a claim that every symbol is a conformity or targeting signal, every conformity signal is jealous, every target classification is wrongful, every moral judgment is moralization, every ideological-form program is fundamentalist, or every distributed bigOther is a multi-mind-self. Each transition is a separate empirical question. The theory predicts greater field synchronization and enforcement when signals are publicly observable, refusal or target status is morally interpreted, sanctions are credible, rival affiliation is treated as betrayal, and institutions preserve the resulting classifications. Evidence that these variables do not affect propagation, apparent consensus, retention, exclusion, or jurisdiction would weaken the mechanism.

9. First analogy: the computer with one PCI slot

The computer analogy presents the architecture in its simplest form.

Imagine a computer containing:

- a powerful general-purpose **CPU**;
- one **PCI slot**;
- a comparatively simple sentiment-classification card installed in that slot;
- a network interface through which the card exchanges signals with compatible cards.

The CPU performs complex computation. The PCI card does something much simpler: it assigns values to the CPU's current objects and possible outputs. It marks them, in effect, as attractive or aversive, honourable or shameful, legitimate or forbidden.

The card's simplicity is deceptive. If it can alter the CPU's priorities, error signals, and reward expectations, it can redirect the much more powerful processor. A simple evaluator can cause an extremely intelligent CPU to spend enormous resources defending a premise the evaluator has made emotionally non-negotiable.

The card runs a mythological lens shaped by many mythologies and potentially assembled from several compatible programming packages. Social signals usually do not install a whole new lens; they call mappings already present on the card. Because the machine has only one PCI slot, a rival card cannot simply be added beside the first, and there is no hidden runtime controller that ranks parallel cards. Compatible packages can extend the software on the installed card. An incompatible governing program must be rejected, or the incumbent program must be unbraided and a successor rebraided and installed on the one card.

This analogy makes the division of labour between the two processors easy to understand. Its limitation is that real human cognition is embodied, affective, interpretive, and less cleanly modular than a desktop computer.

10. Second analogy: Haidt's elephant with a wireless collar

The second analogy gives a closer picture of the proposed psychological operation.

Jonathan Haidt describes conscious reasoning as a **rider** sitting on an **elephant**. The elephant represents the large, fast, intuitive, emotional, and mostly nonconscious part of the mind. The rider represents the smaller conscious and verbal part that explains, plans, and sometimes guides the elephant, but frequently rationalizes where the elephant is already going.

Culture mechanics adds a **wireless collar** around the elephant's neck.

- The **elephant** is the person's intuitive, motivational, and largely nonconscious psychology.
- The **rider** is conscious verbal awareness and explicit reasoning.
- The **processor in the wireless collar** is the bigOther.
- The **program stored in the collar** is the mythological lens.
- The **mythologies** are the evaluated stories through which that program is trained and reinforced.
- The **wireless signals** are other people's expressions, symbols, slogans, rituals, approval, disapproval, and visible conduct.

Why the elephant–collar picture is more exact The CPU–PCI-card picture remains the clearest representation of the **single-slot principle**. It shows one comparatively simple evaluator installed at a privileged point, able to redirect a much more powerful general-purpose processor, and it makes the replacement problem immediately visible. Its limitation is that an internal computer card appears addressable from within the same machine. The picture does not show the functional and epistemic remoteness of the culturally installed evaluator from conscious awareness.

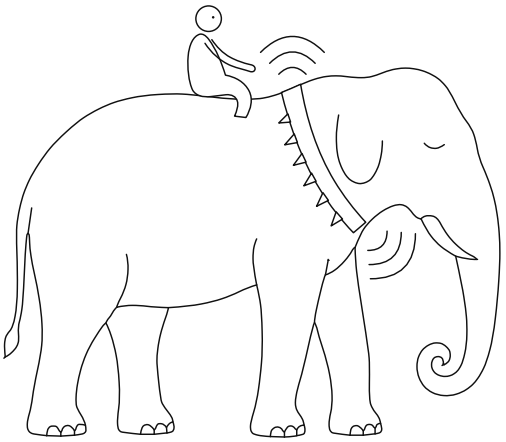


Figure 1: Single-person rider–elephant–wireless-collar model.

The elephant–collar picture adds precisely that relation. The collar is attached to the elephant, not operated by the rider. In the model, the rider has **no direct read or control path to the collar** and receives no transparent read-out of its classification. The rider may consciously perceive an incoming social signal and later notice that the elephant's affect, attention, posture, or direction has changed. Under the proposed semantic-access extension, the rider may also encounter a changed ability to retrieve, join, hold, or formulate a relation without receiving a report that the collar caused the change. The absence of reins, a remote control, a query interface, or a device in the rider's hands is therefore part of the mapping.

This remoteness is functional rather than anatomical and does not make the collar permanently unknowable. Reflective comparison, external observation, and guided investigation may permit the rider to reconstruct, question, or retrain some of its mappings. What the picture denies is an immediate, transparent first-person interface while the classification is occurring.

The model consequently distinguishes two non-transparent output paths:

```
established affective-steering path:
collar classification → elephant's affect, attention, motivation, or direction
                      → rider encounters the changed orientation

proposed semantic-access path:
collar classification → conditions on rider-side retrieval, joining,
                        standing-query activation, or articulation
                      → rider encounters changed conceptual availability
```

The second path is functional, not a claim about a literal neural wire, memory index, or third processor. The current elephant–collar figure depicts the established affective-steering channel only; it should not be read as denying the proposed additional path. It is developed with its evidential limits in *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*, "Collar-conditioned semantic access: a proposed second output path".

The figure condenses the architecture of one culturally coupled psyche. It is read functionally, not anatomically. The broad dog-collar band marks the bigOther's installed coupling to the elephant; its spikes mark **affective leverage**, not literal injury, electrical punishment, or aggression. That leverage includes aversive classifications such as shame, fear, disgust, exclusion, and indignation, but also attractive classifications such as pride, reassurance, belonging, approval, and sacredness. The two equally sized sets of radio arcs mark reception and transmission. Their lack of arrows leaves the collar's network capability neutral rather than assigning a fixed direction to one depicted message.

In the established affective-steering path, the collar can produce social pleasure and pain: pride, shame, belonging, exclusion, sacredness, disgust, reassurance, fear, or indignation. It acts upon the elephant, which can change its posture, attention, and direction long before the rider clearly notices the collar's intervention.

Only afterward may the rider become aware of a conclusion:

> "This is obviously disgraceful."
> "Someone like me cannot do that."
> "Any decent person must support this."

The rider may mistake the resulting feeling for the product of independent reasoning. It may then use the main processor's verbal intelligence to justify the direction in which the elephant has already begun to move.

This analogy is closer to the psychological claim than the computer analogy because it shows that the bigOther does not normally dictate complete thoughts. It modifies the affective conditions under which thought and action occur.

Haidt's Leary citation: nonconscious and preattentive The experimental context discussed by Haidt makes this indirect access visible. Participants consciously saw purported ratings of how much another person wanted to interact with them. Even self-described social mavericks, who reported that other people's opinions did not affect them, showed substantial changes in self-esteem when the ratings declined. Their conscious self-description did not accurately report the operation of the underlying social evaluator.

In Jonathan Haidt's *The Righteous Mind*, chapter 4, section "We Are Obsessed with Polls," Haidt reports Mark Leary's conclusion:

> "the sociometer operates at a nonconscious and preattentive level to scan the social environment for any and all indications that one's relational value is low or declining."

Haidt then places the sociometer in the elephant. The exact citation chain is Haidt, *The Righteous Mind: Why Good People Are Divided by Politics and Religion* (New York: Pantheon Books, 2012), chapter 4, section 1, note 16, which cites Mark R. Leary, "Sociometer Theory and the Pursuit of Relational Value: Getting to the Root of Self-Esteem," *European Review of Social Psychology* 16 (2005): 75–111, at 85.

Two features of Leary's formulation are decisive for the present analogy:

- **Nonconscious:** the scanning and initial relational evaluation need not enter conscious awareness. The rider can therefore experience a changed state without experiencing the operation that produced it. Here *nonconscious* does not by itself imply a specifically psychoanalytic unconscious.
- **Preattentive:** the scanning does not wait for deliberate attention. It can register socially significant indications before the rider chooses to inspect them or formulates a judgment about them.

Together the two terms identify both **opacity** and **causal priority**: the evaluation can alter the elephant before the rider attends to, understands, or explains the alteration. The rider may see the social input and later feel the output while lacking direct access to the transformation between them.

Leary's sociometer as a limited precursor Within Culture Mechanics, Leary's sociometer may be treated as a **limited version of part of the local-bigOther architecture**, and Leary accordingly as a **psychological precursor to parts of the local-bigOther theory**. The attribution is deliberately bounded: Leary did not propose the local bigOther, an installed Culture Program, the single-slot architecture, or the distributed wireless coupling developed here. His sociometer nevertheless supplies a closely fitting account of one possible affective mechanism through which indications of social valuation become motivationally effective in the elephant.

The sociometer is limited first by its position in the social sequence. It mainly describes the receiving person's sensitivity to indications of their own relational value. Culture Mechanics also models the upstream production of the judgment:

```
B's conduct
    ↓
A's local bigOther classifies B through A's installed Culture Program
    ↓
A's elephant receives the resulting affective valuation
    ↓
A expresses or behaviourally leaks approval, disapproval, inclusion, or exclusion
    ↓
B detects the indication and sociometric machinery registers relational value
    ↓
B's elephant changes before B's rider clearly understands why
```

A wholly private judgment in A cannot affect B's sociometer unless A expresses it, leaks it through conduct, or B otherwise infers it. The important distinction is that the local bigOther in A can **generate** the culturally patterned judgment, whereas the sociometer in B explains a narrower form of **detection and affective registration**.

The local bigOther also operates without an actual person A being present. B's own installed program can instantiate an anticipated or generalized third-party observer and apply its gaze to B's contemplated conduct or even to a private thought:

```
B considers a private thought, act, or possibility
    ↓
B's local bigOther instantiates the culturally expected observer
    ↓
the installed Culture Program judges B from that third-person position
    ↓
B's elephant experiences shame, pride, fear, reassurance, or felt prohibition
    ↓
B's rider encounters the result without any actual observer being present
```

This is the **local-bigOther inner eye**: the internalized third-party observer that can approve, shame, prohibit, or judge from within the person's own psyche. It must remain distinct from the individual's own imaginative-conceptual inner eye, which can narrow so that a culturally dangerous relation can no longer be seen, formulated, or named; see *Epistemic Agency*, "Scale bridge: ideological power, inner-eye blindness, and *Dummheit*".

The relation can therefore be stated compactly: **the sociometer detects indications of how others value me; the local bigOther also generates culturally programmed judgments of others, determines their content, and can reproduce the judging gaze internally when no observer is present.** Leary is a precursor to the nonconscious, preattentive, relational-value, and affective-coupling parts of Culture Mechanics, not a source for or validation of the complete synthesis.

For the mapped features, non-inferences, and relationship of the CPU, PCI-slot, wireless-collar, protocol, and network pictures to the framework's physical and craft analogies, see *Analogical Models in Culture Mechanics: A Semantic Inventory*.

11. The wireless superpower: the individual coupling interface

The bigOther's distinctive superpower is its capacity to participate in **distributed computing**. Every collar is both receiver and transmitter. There is no separate class of persons possessing the only transmitters. People emit social signals through:

- facial expression, posture, and tone;
- attention or deliberate inattention;
- laughter, applause, chanting, or silence;
- confidence, fear, disgust, or outrage;
- repetition of phrases;
- imitation and conformity;
- approval, ridicule, punishment, and protection;
- participation in or refusal of rituals.

These outputs become inputs for other collars:

```
Person A receives a publicly intelligible signal
        ↓
A's bigOther classifies it
        ↓
A's elephant changes state
        ↓
A expresses the resulting state through the shared protocol
        ↓
B and C receive A's expression
        ↓
their bigOthers classify and respond
        ↓
their responses return as signals to A
        ↻
```

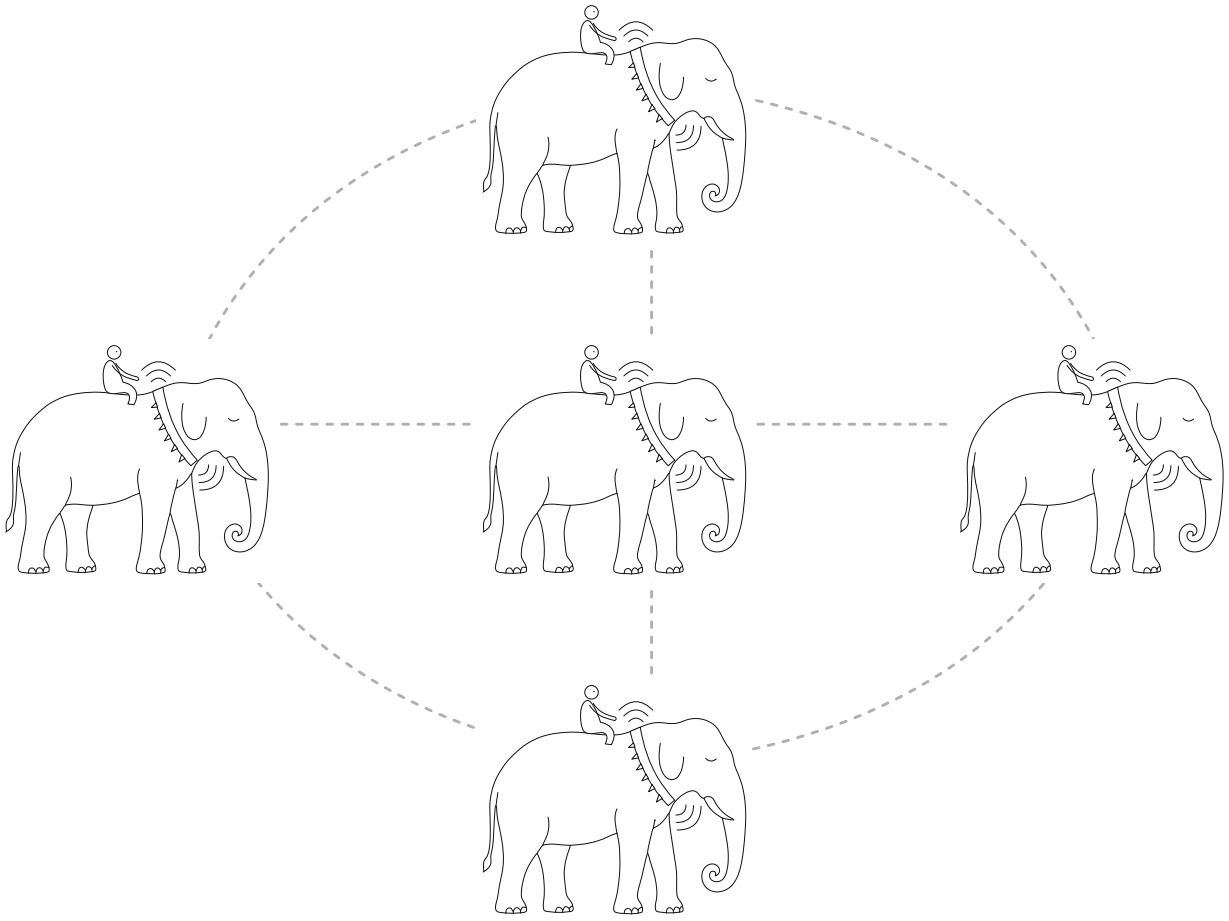


Figure 2: Distributed interaction among five equivalent rider–elephant–wireless-collar units.

The group figure repeats the complete single-person unit in a diagrammatic top-down network layout while retaining the readable side view of each psyche. All five units have the same size and components. The middle unit is therefore a focal example, not a chief, privileged broadcaster, directing organ, or separate class of transmitter. Centre-to-surrounding paths show reciprocal local coupling, while the surrounding paths show that participants also signal to one another rather than communicating only through a hub.

The dashed paths and collar arcs are symbolic, not literal radio waves, wires, or measured channels. Their lack of arrowheads marks the receive–classify–act–transmit reciprocity of every unit. The picture therefore illustrates how local outputs can become other people's inputs and produce feedback, amplification, apparent consensus, divergence, or synchronization. It does not by itself imply agreement, truth, equal influence, coercion, centralized

direction, collective agency, or a fused multi-mind-self.

The originating physical analogy is that a local bigOther resembles a charged particle: it is a source of a field and is simultaneously susceptible to the field produced by other sources. The comparison concerns relational architecture and back-action. It does not propose a new physical force or claim that social dynamics obey Maxwell's equations.

When participants run sufficiently compatible mythological lenses and can observe one another, reciprocal feedback can produce rapid alignment. A crowd may begin to attend, feel, chant, fear, celebrate, condemn, or act as if it were one body. This is the individual-to-field handoff. The field's topology, unequal transmitter gain, collective agency, and epistemic consequences belong to the detailed account in *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*, including its functional morphology of mechanical solidarity: population body, distributed trusted-opinion-leader function, common field, directing function, reciprocal coupling, and possible collective execution.

12. Local bigOther, symbolic protocol, and distributed field

Culture mechanics distinguishes seven levels that must not be treated as synonyms:

Level	Meaning in culture mechanics
Lacan's big Other	The shared symbolic order and, in the present functional translation, the on-the-wire protocol of language, law, roles, conventions, master signifiers, and recognized symbolic authority.
Local bigOther	The individual sentiment classifier that executes one installed mythological lens and transmits and receives through the shared protocol.
Mechanical solidarity	Emergent field coherence generated as compatible local bigOthers repeatedly produce, observe, and answer common classifications and sentiments.
Distributed bigOther	The dynamically maintained symbolic-affective network state reproduced through local bigOthers, institutions, roles, practices, stories, and artifacts.
Multi-mind-self presentation	The collective represented, perceived, addressed, or incarnated as one self without yet establishing collective agency.
Operative multi-mind-self / multi-mind-self proper	The distributed system when it becomes sufficiently integrated and continuous to perceive, remember, judge, intend, own, and act as a collective agent. Not every crowd, presentation, or mechanically solidary field reaches this threshold.
Fused multi-mind-self	An operative collective agent that additionally displaces participating persons as independently legitimate authors across the relevant jurisdiction.

The relationship is generative rather than an equation:

```
LOCAL BIGOTHERS
sentiment classifiers executing installed lenses
                    ↓ communicate through
SHARED SYMBOLIC PROTOCOL / LACANIAN BIG OTHER
                    ↓ may generate
MECHANICAL-SOLIDARITY COHERENCE
                    ↓ maintains
DISTRIBUTED BIGOTHER
                    ↓ may be represented or encountered as
MULTI-MIND-SELF PRESENTATION
                    ↓ may become sufficiently integrated as
OPERATIVE MULTI-MIND-SELF
                    ↓ may additionally absorb personal standing as
FUSED MULTI-MIND-SELF
```

Franz Josef Radermacher's systems work supplies an independent neighbouring route into this scale transition. His 2004 discussion of humanity as a superorganism and 2007 comparison of performant superorganisms describe higher-order capacities emerging from interacting components, including human components that remain viable systems in their own right. That family resemblance does not make *superorganism* a synonym for the operative multi-mind-self. Radermacher's systems criterion can be satisfied by organized higher-order performance without establishing the Culture Mechanics threshold of integrated perception, memory, judgment, intention, ownership, and action, still less one unitary phenomenal consciousness.

The comparison strengthens rather than dissolves the distinction between collective capacity and fusion. A differentiated superorganismic organization can increase what the whole can sense, remember, decide, and do while its human members retain independent standing and bounded jurisdictions. Subjecthood absorption begins only when the collective additionally denies those persons legitimate judgment, conscience, purpose, property, relationships, refusal, exit, or appeal. Radermacher's later ant-state warning is therefore evidence of his own recognition of this normative fork, not evidence that every superorganismic system tends necessarily toward fusion.

This is not a necessary ladder. A presentation can remain below agency, an operative multi-mind-self can remain differentiated, and a fusion ideology can seek absorption without producing competent collective agency. Unqualified *multi-mind-self* may be used as family-level explanatory shorthand, but strict claims about intention, ownership, responsibility, or fusion require the qualified term. *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity* owns the complete register rule and threshold tests.

The distributed bigOther consists of no single person or object. It is realized through language, expectations, public symbols, rituals, stories, institutions, roles, laws, artifacts, and the anticipated judgments of other people. It is implemented through individuals but, as an emergent relational organization, is not adequately explained as a mere list of independently formed individual psychologies.

The relation remains recursive:

```
DISTRIBUTED BIGOTHER
mythologies, institutions, symbols, rituals, expectations
                    ↓ programs and activates
LOCAL BIGOTHERS
                    ↓ influence
ELEPHANTS AND MAIN CPUs
                    ↓ produce
PUBLIC SIGNALS AND INSTITUTIONAL PRACTICES
                    ↓ reproduce or transform
DISTRIBUTED BIGOTHER
                    ↻
```

Culture is neither wholly outside nor wholly inside the person. It is the comparatively stable pattern maintained by this circulation between local programming and distributed execution. First-order and **lifted mechanical solidarity** differ in the abstraction level of their shared classifications, not in this basic field-forming mechanism. *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity* develops that distinction together with field geometry, collective ownership, gatekeepers, and back-action upon epistemic agency.

Durkheim's "extension of society" within the person is closest to this whole local realization of socially formed intellectual and moral life, not to the local bigOther alone. The local bigOther is a functionally distinct node and execution interface within the recursive relation: it is locally programmed and field-coupled, but it is not a miniature distributed bigOther or a literal piece detached from the network. Language, concepts, records, institutions, and ordinary rational operations cross the local/distributed boundary through additional parts of the same circuit.

Distributed bigOther and distributed epistemic milieu The **distributed bigOther** must not be collapsed into the **distributed epistemic milieu**. The distributed bigOther is the emergent symbolic–affective network state reproduced through compatible local bigOthers, public symbols, expectations, roles, institutions, practices, and field back-action. The distributed epistemic milieu is the impersonal and dispersed environment of concepts, distinctions, examples, methods, records, instruments, trained persons, and correction practices through which participants learn how to notice, inquire, infer, and communicate.

The two can overlap in carriers and institutions while remaining functionally different. The distributed bigOther concerns collectively maintained evaluation, obligation, and symbolic–affective force. The distributed epistemic milieu concerns resources used by ordinary rider or main-CPU cognition. It is not a collective brain, detached

cognitive agent, third processor, or second local bigOther. Within homo duplex, only the local bigOther occupies the distinct cultural co-processor position.

Collective formation can therefore reach the person through two coupled modes:

```
affective--evaluative actuation
→ local bigOther classifies through the installed mythological lens
→ elephant-side affect, attention, motivation, and action readiness change

collective epistemic formation
→ distributed epistemic milieu supplies concepts, methods, examples, and records
→ rider/main CPU reconstructs, retrieves, joins, infers, predicts, and revises
```

The distinction does not isolate reason from affect. Local-bigOther classification can make particular rider-side operations honourable, shameful, easy, dangerous, or forbidden without itself performing them, while an affectively animated ethos can sustain cold analytical work. *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*, "Collective epistemic formation and the distributed epistemic milieu" owns the detailed mechanism, processor boundary, historical source bridges, and scientific-ethos application.

Nested authorship, activation, and episodic multi-mind-selves An operative multi-mind-self is a **network-level subject**, not a second local self or a second PCI card installed inside each participant. Collective and personal authorship can therefore coexist at different levels. The collective can legitimately perceive, remember, decide, own, and act as *we* while participating persons retain legitimate *I*s, differentiated functions, consciences, judgments, relationships, property, and bounded rights of refusal and exit.

> **A differentiated multi-mind-self adds an operative *we* without invalidating the participating *I*s. Fusion begins when the *we* displaces those *I*s as independently legitimate authors.**

The definition is functional and emergent. It does not reduce the collective to a mere metaphor or list of individual states: the organized relation has continuing capacities and acts back upon its participants. It also does not by itself assert one unitary field of phenomenal consciousness analogous to a biological person's experience. Whether collective phenomenal subjectivity exists is a further and much harder claim than whether the distributed organization qualifies as an agent.

The relevant integration can have different temporal profiles. A continuing multi-mind-self may operate mainly through differentiated clockwork coordination and enter intermittent high-gain laser episodes. An **episodic multi-mind-self** crosses the collective-agent threshold only during bounded periods of sufficient common attention, coupling, reciprocal feedback, memory access, judgment, and coordinated action. Between episodes, institutions, calendars, roles, artifacts, places, stories, and trained local bigOthers may preserve a **latent distributed bigOther** below the presently active multi-mind-self threshold.

Calling this latency "sleep" is useful only when viable reactivation machinery and identity-bearing continuity remain. A de-animated remnant or culturally lost synchronization technology is not merely a sleeping collective self. The detailed state model and its pilgrimage, military, and Subak boundary cases belong to *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*, "Activation profiles and episodic multi-mind-selves".

Differentiated unity and subjecthood absorption (fusion) The existence or strength of a collective agent does not decide what standing its members retain. Culture mechanics calls a real shared *we* **differentiated unity** when distinct persons, functions, judgments, relationships, and legitimate subordinate jurisdictions remain constitutive parts of the common order. The qualifier **person-preserving unity** emphasizes the same boundary: unity is not mere coexistence, but neither does membership dissolve the participating subjects.

Subjecthood absorption (fusion) is the independent extent to which a collective program treats its members as organs whose personal judgment, conscience, purpose, property, loyalties, identity, relationships, refusal, or exit have no legitimate standing against the collectively enacted subject. Equivalently, fusion is the displacement or absorption of the person's self as an independently legitimate author, so that another enacted self increasingly perceives, judges, speaks, owns, and acts through that person. The person's biological body, main processor, skills, memory, and practical intelligence need not disappear; they can remain active as the collective subject's execution surface. The eye still sees, the mouth still speaks, and the hand still acts, but the collective claims the standing to determine for whom and for what they act.

Subjecthood absorption is not identical to high cultural interoperability, strong synchronization, multi-mind-self agency, comprehensive local slot occupancy, or a large jurisdiction. Those properties can contribute to it, but none defines it.

The principal dynamics increasing absorption are called **fusion pressure**:

- one selected alignment is generalized across more domains and maintained beyond the task or episode that made it useful;
- independent judgment and differentiated contribution are reclassified as noise, selfishness, alienation, impurity, or betrayal;
- personal, household, professional, associational, and institutional jurisdictions are subordinated to one collective purpose;
- the collective's classifications become compulsory while correction, refusal, exit, and appeal lose legitimate standing.

Total fusion is the limiting case: high subjecthood absorption combines with comprehensive jurisdiction and closed correction or exit. The originating image is that persons become "drops of water in one clear pond." The image comes from Minogue's account of the ideological terminus and remains subtype-specific there; Culture Mechanics reuses it here only as a source bridge to the broader fusion limit. It is a pole, not the definition of generalized Ideology, every multi-mind-self presentation or operative multi-mind-self, and not a biological state that humans can literally enter.

A **fusion ideology** is a mythology or program that treats the separate person as an incomplete, alienated, or falsely conscious fragment and seeks to reconstitute persons as organs of one collectively enacted subject with increasingly comprehensive jurisdiction. Such a program can demand fusion without succeeding in forming a competent multi-mind-self; conversely, a capable collective agent can remain differentiated, person-preserving, jurisdictionally bounded, and corrigible. *Fusion ideology* retains the older broad adjectival usage; it does not satisfy the strict capitalized Ideology classifier unless the separate generator, un-reality, un-reason, installation, and scale gates are evidenced.

One route into fusion is **Humanity inversion**: an abstraction meant to protect the standing of concrete persons is agentified, assigned a hidden true interest, and made into the authority under which those persons may be consumed. Invoking Humanity alone does not establish this pathology; the diagnosis requires the conversion from equal standing to collective subject, privileged interpreter, and sacrificial permission.

These distinctions add a **subjecthood-absorption axis** to analysis without altering the single-slot principle. Every participant still has one fully occupied local slot. The question is what standing the installed weave grants the person within the collective relation, not how many evaluators occupy that slot.

The proposed **Lifted-Order Capacity Dashboard** operationalizes part of this person-preservation question through *Speak, Own, Refuse, Exit,* and *Appeal*, then separately tests constitutional correction, cooperation, material capability, and real alternatives. Its Secure Homestead Rate treats effective owner-occupied property as one possible material anchor for independent standing. These are candidate measurements, not additions to the definition of subjecthood absorption.

The proposed ***Schutzbalken* principle** places this boundary inside the pluralistic classical-liberal Culture Strategy: public and private concentrations of power must not become unbounded, unanswerable, self-certifying, or practically inescapable jurisdictions over the person. This is a proposed constitutional response to fusion pressure, not part of the definition of fusion. Power, asymmetry, wealth, expertise, employment, or collective authority do not by themselves establish subjecthood absorption; the diagnosis still requires evidence that personal judgment, purpose, property, refusal, exit, appeal, or other standing has been displaced.

Personhood and role interfaces **Status:** trunk-concept family. The interfaces and principal failure forms are defined, while developmental formation, measurement, and comparative institutional tests remain open.

A human being cannot present their entire inward life in every social encounter. Plural cooperation therefore requires bounded surfaces through which strangers can recognize continuity, promise, responsibility, office, competence, and standing without claiming possession of the whole person.

Civil personhood is the reciprocal accountability interface through which a human becomes socially legible as a sufficiently continuous, name-bearing, reason-giving, promise-capable, standing-sensitive, and answerable participant. Others reciprocate by addressing reasons, respecting autonomy and privacy, presuming continuity, limiting force, and recognizing repair. Kevin Simler's personhood-as-game account supplies the neighbouring "lady"

and “gentleman” example; the present placement inside homo duplex and distributed cultural programming is a Culture Mechanics extension.

The trunk keeps three levels of standing separate:

Level	Meaning	Boundary
Unconditional human standing	Every individual living human organism possesses complete and equal moral standing which a person-protecting constitutional order is required to recognize.	It is not earned by fluent self-presentation, independence, competence, productivity, or role performance.
Interactional person-competence	Present ability to promise, understand reasons, regulate conduct, undertake liabilities, and participate in repair.	It can vary by person, situation, development, illness, or impairment without cancelling human standing.
Role competence and authority	Additional capability and bounded jurisdiction required by a particular office or relation.	Failure, incapacity, or removal from the role limits that interface; it does not demote the human bearer.

Inherent human standing and the recognition-only principle **Status: originating normative axiom of this synthesis.** The axiom is not attributed to Durkheim, Kant, biology alone, or current German positive law.

Inherent human standing is the complete and equal moral standing possessed by every individual living human organism from the beginning of that organism’s existence until death. It is inherent rather than conferred, complete rather than graduated, and continuous rather than acquired through development.

Human beings are recognized, not admitted, as bearers of human standing.

No person, majority, state, court, legislature, physician, profession, institution, or Culture Program has constitutive authority to create, grant, grade, suspend, withdraw, or extinguish the standing of a living human bearer through classification. Human decision-makers may make corrigible, evidence-bound findings about whether the objective bearer condition exists, but the finding is declaratory rather than constitutive: it attempts to recognize a reality that neither the decision-maker nor the law creates.

The bearer criterion is the existence of an **individual living human organism**, not the presence of human genetic material in an isolated gamete, tissue, tumour, or other cell. In ordinary sexual reproduction, the project operationalizes the beginning of that organism’s existence as successful sperm–oocyte fusion that activates the oocyte and initiates an integrated zygotic developmental process. Here *successful* refers to fusion and activation, not to later implantation, viability, live birth, health, or development to any selected stage. Mere insemination, proximity, or contact between gametes is therefore not fertilization; nuclear fusion completes ordinary fertilization but does not confer standing, and implantation does not create a bearer that was absent before it. For cloning, artificial activation, or another possible non-gametic route, the general individual-organism criterion governs so that absence of sperm cannot create a protection gap.

Human standing consequently does not depend upon developmental stage, implantation, location, viability, consciousness, sentience, presently exercisable rationality, autonomy, health, disability, dependency, productivity, wantedness, social recognition, citizenship, reputation, conduct, or political and ideological classification. These properties can matter to capability, responsibility, relationship, remedy, or the exercise of particular rights without becoming admission tests for the protected human class.

```
empirical premise:
X is an individual living human organism

explicit normative axiom:
every individual living human organism possesses complete and equal human standing

conclusion:
X possesses complete and equal human standing
```

This form does not derive the normative conclusion from biology alone. Biological evidence addresses the bearer premise; the explicit Humanist axiom supplies the normative rule.

Conflicts among human beings must therefore be adjudicated as conflicts among bearers of equal human standing rather than resolved by defining one bearer out of the category. Where reasonable uncertainty remains about whether a living human bearer exists and the contemplated act would irreversibly destroy that possible bearer, uncertainty activates a presumption of protection while evidence and review remain available; it does not create a permission to destroy.

The German Embryonenschutzgesetz, section 8 supplies a bounded legal comparator by distinguishing sperm penetration or introduction, nuclear fusion, and the statutory embryo, but it does not author this project's earlier recognition-only boundary. The German Federal Constitutional Court's 1993 abortion judgment supplies the neighbouring constitutional propositions that unborn human life possesses dignity and an independent right to life not created by maternal acceptance; the project axiom separately extends the non-conferral rule to every individual living human organism from fertilization rather than only to the statutory duration of pregnancy.

Reduced interactional or role competence can justify support, representation, limited liability, supervision, or removal from a specific office only through the independently applicable person-protecting rules. It must not be redescribed as loss of unconditional human standing.

A **role-interface** presents only the capacities, duties, authority, limits, and conduct relevant to a bounded relation: physician, judge, teacher, official, parent, colleague, diplomat, or another specified role. Helmuth Plessner's defence of masks, distance, tact, and protected inwardness supplies the decisive countercase to the assumption that every formal surface is hypocrisy or PGS. A mask can protect plurality by preventing intimacy, total sincerity, or community absorption from becoming compulsory.

The two interfaces address different relational surfaces:

```
person-interface
→ presented to other persons
→ asks reciprocal recognition, reasons, restraint, and accountability

role-interface
→ presented to persons and to the local or distributed bigOther
→ asks recognition of bounded office, duty, competence, and jurisdiction
```

The role-interface has at least four audiences that need not return the same judgment:

1. concrete interaction partners;
2. those partners' local bigOthers;
3. the distributed bigOther preserved in reputation, records, professions, and institutions; and
4. the wearer's own local bigOther, which can classify performance even without an external observer.

The role is "worn" partly toward the bigOther because installed cultural expectations determine what a proper judge, physician, citizen, parent, or colleague may do even when no present observer commands the act. That does not make the role unreal or the person insincere. Socially constituted office can enable responsible action that private feeling alone could not coordinate.

Protected opacity is the legitimate remainder that neither interface makes publicly claimable: private feeling, relationships, doubts, vulnerabilities, unperformed possibilities, and aspects of identity outside the role's jurisdiction. Opacity is not immunity from accountability for conduct performed through the interface. The boundary protects the person from a demand that every inward state become transparent to the community or institution. Plessner's countercase therefore supplies an **anti-authenticity safeguard**: complete sincerity, confession, or exposure cannot be made the general condition of civic standing or role membership. Such demands can become instruments of conformity, vulnerability extraction, programme penetration, and subjecthood absorption even when described as community, care, solidarity, or authenticity. The safeguard does not protect deception about conduct, capacity, conflicts, or interests material to the represented relation.

The trunk distinguishes four failure forms:

Failure	Operative change
Deceptive masking	The interface is used to induce trust while concealing conduct or incapacity material to the represented relation.
Role overreach	Authority or obligation acquired in one role is extended into domains the role does not govern.

Failure	Operative change
Role engulfment	The bearer increasingly experiences themselves only as the office, expected mask, or programme instrument; protected remainder and self-authorship lose practical force.
Interface inversion	The role that should serve persons or a bounded function treats preservation of its own authorized presentation as the governing purpose.

Selective civil-personhood breakdown **selective civil-personhood breakdown** *noun phrase* **Status:** proposed person–role-interface failure family

Selective civil-personhood breakdown occurs when an officeholder continues executing and defending a course while becoming selectively unavailable for the binding attachment of authorship, promises, contradiction, answerability, repair, and consequences. The operative asymmetry is not absence of agency in general:

```
authority + course execution + public defence
→ remain available

retrospective continuity + promise-binding + contradiction processing
+ answerability + repair + consequences
→ become selectively unavailable
```

Two experiential shorthands describe why this interface can feel more disturbing than ordinary evasion. The **answerability uncanny valley** is the encounter in which the cues of a continuous, articulate, responsible adult remain recognizable while the diachronic operations that ordinarily make that person reachable no longer work. The **protected role-terminal** is the controlled interface image in which questions and records are accepted syntactically but fail to change the operative role-state. These expressions describe the observer's experience and a possible interaction pattern. They do not establish literal automation, absence of inward life, incapacity, strategic design, or feigning.

Two observable routes produce this interface without deciding its cause. In the **unavailable-retrospective-self route**, the officeholder cannot or will not reconstruct the materially relevant past: "I cannot remember," "I cannot say," or "that account is no longer available." In the **non-binding-continuous-self route**, the record remains available but is denied binding force: the present role does not accept that yesterday's undertaking, authorship, reason, or contradiction constrains today's execution. The two routes can alternate, so that memory is invoked where continuity would bind and continuity is invoked where present authority is needed.

A discriminating collision occurs when retrospective uncertainty coexists with categorical self-exoneration: the bearer cannot reconstruct the interaction but claims sufficient certainty to exclude any relevant contribution or influence. The audit asks what independent record, inference, or limited proposition supports that certainty and whether the same evidential standard governs both answers. An inability to recall one encounter can coexist with independently warranted knowledge about another fact; the signature becomes informative where the exculpatory conclusion depends on the very reconstruction declared unavailable. In the non-binding-continuous-self route, the corresponding test is whether the recovered undertaking can require an explanation, acknowledgment, or repair even when changed circumstances justify a different present decision.

The construct classifies an evidenced public interface and must not silently decide among three different causal claims:

1. **observable selective breakdown**—the asymmetry is present, whatever its cause;
2. **strategic non-answerability**—the asymmetry is maintained or used to defeat accountability; and
3. **accountability malingering**—the narrower hypothesis that incapacity, confusion, memory failure, or another limitation is being performed or exaggerated in order to lower answerability expectations.

The first can be established from the role relation and repeated sequence. The second requires evidence that the interface is being used or preserved for its accountability-defeating function. The third additionally requires actor-specific evidence of feigned or exaggerated incapacity. Exceptional composure, persistence in office, implausibility, political benefit, or the observer's frustration does not by itself establish either stronger claim.

The narrower incapacity route can be decomposed without yet deciding intent. **Performed non-agency** names the actor-side presentation that the officeholder does not remember, understand, author, decide, or control the

consequential course–in compact form, "do not model me as the causal author of what you are observing." The presentation can report a genuine limitation, reflect ordinary confusion, or be strategically produced; **accountability malingering** is only the last, actor-evidenced branch. An **incapacity-based accountability discount** is the observer-side reduction of expected answerability because the officeholder is perceived as unable to participate fully in retrospective reconstruction, promise-binding, reasoned answer, or repair. The **non-agency accountability shield** is the possible conjunction in which the presented limitation elicits that discount while authority and execution remain in place. This decomposition distinguishes presentation, reception, and deliberate strategy instead of inferring one from another. Genuine incapacity and strategic exploitation by surrounding actors can also coexist. Others may preserve an impaired bearer as the public answerability interface while retaining the capacity to continue the course through that office. That hypothesis concerns their evidenced conduct and control, not feigning by the bearer; ordinary accommodation or assistance does not establish it.

The public-side consequence can be a **paternalistic accountability shield**. Repeated attempts to attach evidence, promises, or consequences cease to feel like reciprocal adult address and begin to elicit pity, management, avoidance, or resignation. The affected public may then withdraw ordinary participant expectations because continued insistence appears cruel, futile, or psychologically pointless, even though the officeholder still exercises adult public authority. This can become a **withdrawal loop through collapsed accountability expectations**:

```
repeated failure to engage as an accountable adult
→ people stop expecting continuity, honest answers, acknowledgment, or repair
→ insistence feels futile, cruel, or absurd
→ anger gives way to contempt, pity, exhaustion, or resignation
→ consequential accountability pressure diminishes
→ the politician continues executing and defending the course
```

Repeated survival then makes continued non-answerability easier to sustain and lowers the expectations from which the next demand begins. The officeholder need not preserve the affected public's esteem: the loss of reputation can itself help protect continued execution when it makes people stop addressing consequential expectations to the bearer. In that branch, power survives not merely **despite** reputational collapse but partly **through the withdrawal of accountability expectations** associated with it. The demand is nullified; the course is not corrected. This is the psychological mechanism behind the Teflon-politician branch, contrasted with the high-standing Teflon prophet in the Teflon-authority comparison. Where performed or exaggerated incapacity deliberately elicits the withdrawal, accountability malingering supplies one strategic route into this loop; the effect itself does not establish that stronger attribution.

The loop is not inevitable. Contempt or lost esteem can instead intensify accountability pressure; the proposed shield requires an observed reduction in consequential demands, not mere unpopularity or insulting descriptions of the officeholder. Withdrawal from futile personal address can instead redirect effort toward records, independent investigation, adjudication, organization, succession, or another consequential receiver. P. F. Strawson's participant–objective-attitude distinction supplies the neighbouring interpersonal transition: ordinary reactive demands can give way to management, treatment, pity, or avoidance when someone is regarded as outside ordinary adult reciprocity. The political conjunction—retained governing authority together with elicited withdrawal of reciprocal accountability—is a Culture Mechanics extension and does not imply that Strawson described its strategic use.

Thomas Szanto's open-access account of epistemically exploitative bullshit supplies a second, narrower neighbour for cases in which one party remains obliged to undertake responsible, emotionally costly epistemic work while the other protects an asymmetric discursive position. That comparison does not establish bad faith, exploitation, prejudice, or intent in an officeholder case without separate evidence.

The resulting shield can reinforce correction nullification, but the constructs remain distinct. Selective civil-personhood breakdown concerns the asymmetric person–role interface through which accountability is addressed. Correction nullification concerns the failure of an independently sustained correction to acquire reception, adjudication, operative revision, or repair. Either can occur without the other, and neither by itself establishes a hidden principal, deliberate humiliation, systemic lying, or covert operational assignment.

The primary rivals are genuine cognitive or medical incapacity, fatigue, trauma, role restrictions, legal duties of confidentiality, poor records, ordinary incompetence, changed office responsibilities, confused questioning, and poor communication. The audit therefore asks whether the limitation is domain-specific, stable over time, independently evidenced, symmetrical across favourable and adverse material, compatible with continued execution, corrected when records are supplied, and followed by appropriate delegation, recusal, supervision, repair, or removal from the role. Repeated asymmetry raises a role-accountability question; it is not a clinical diagnosis. Compare actual

performance across matched tasks and accountability occasions: **selective competence** means that precision and agency remain available for execution or advantageous objectives while reconstruction and repair recurrently disappear where responsibility would attach. Record the question, available evidence, answer, maintained decision, and later consequence separately, including occasions on which answerability succeeds. This tests the pattern without treating one incomplete reply or an observer's uncanny impression as the mechanism's proof.

Nothing in the construct reduces unconditional human standing. Interactional or role incapacity can justify accommodation, representation, supervision, limited liability, or removal from a bounded office only under the independently applicable person-protecting rules. The human bearer remains a complete and equal bearer of standing even where the public interface fails, and criticism must address the evidenced role relation rather than dehumanize the person.

Role engulfment supplies the missing failure boundary of affective-to-structural load transfer. An institutional skeleton can reduce the affective effort needed for reliable conduct, but it can also begin replacing rather than supporting personal authorship. Low affect may therefore indicate healthy professional steadiness or inward de-animation in which a person feels like a role-shaped skin over an empty shell. Performance alone does not discriminate them.

Role-bound speech can remain **full speech** when the bearer avows the judgment, marks its limits, can answer questions, and accepts responsibility for undertaking it. It becomes **empty in the relevant interface sense** when only ready-made role formulae can speak while the person's uncertainty, refusal, desire, or accountable judgment cannot become present. Formal wording, politeness, repetition, or institutional authorship does not by itself decide between the two.

The audit asks whether the bearer can state the role's purpose and limits, exercise judgment inside it, refuse an incompatible demand, retain relationships and purposes outside it, accept personal responsibility, leave or change roles, and receive recognition as more than the interface. The institution must remain able to correct performance without acquiring the whole person. **Distance-and-tact correction** addresses reasons, conduct, or bounded office performance without demanding humiliation, confession, or total moral exposure. It preserves accountability while refusing the inference that correction needs jurisdiction over the bearer's complete inward life. Difference between inward feeling and outward role conduct is not by itself hypocrisy, counterfeit, un-reason, or pseudomorphic governor substitution. Burnout, depression, trauma, dependency, ordinary professional formation, strategic compliance, disability, fatigue, and temporary role overload can produce similar experiences or conduct and remain rival explanations. The trunk therefore classifies the evidenced interface relation, not a whole person or clinical condition.

Operative relationship modes: I-mode and We-mode **Status:** trunk-concept family and proposed operative-relationship model. The distinctions are functional rather than anatomical, and one episode does not establish a permanent personality type, collective agent, or clinical condition.

The existing architecture distinguishes processor, pole, installed programme, collective field, and subjecthood relation. The present layer asks a different question: **from which relational standpoint does cognition and action operate in this episode?**

I-mode is the personal-relational position in which oneself and another can appear as concrete centres of life and possible partners in an I–You relation. It includes attachment, care, responsibility, self-interest, resentment, possessiveness, and personal cruelty. It is neither a synonym for egoism nor a guarantee of goodness.

We-mode is the socially constituted, comparatively impersonal position from which a person thinks and acts through rules, roles, categories, shared purposes, institutional standpoints, or an imagined impartial observer. It can coordinate care for absent strangers and common goods, or it can treat a fully represented human as a case, task, resource, obstacle, or enemy without an operative I–You encounter. It is neither a synonym for altruism nor a guarantee of coldness or evil.

The central relational distinction is:

> **A human can be accurately represented without becoming personally present as a You whose claim can interrupt what I am doing.**

Names, relationships, fear, suffering, preferences, and likely consequences can remain known and enter sophisticated calculation. The missing relation need not be information or reflection. It can be the second-person relation in which the affected human addresses the actor as someone to whom the actor must answer.

```
I ↔ You
personal encounter and answerability

versus

We → them / case / task / resource / obstacle
programme- or role-mediated operation
```

The originating terms ***Ausblendung*** and ***Mitgefühlsentkopplung*** are retained only in this corrected sense. What is blanked out need not be the person's attributes, suffering, or fate; it can be the operative second-person connection through which those known facts become another person's claim upon the actor. *Mitgefühlsentkopplung* names that relational result, not a theory that bureaucracy must first erase information or that an abstractly "cold" processor commits the act by itself.

Solidarity-indexed person recognition names the proposed dependence of this encounter upon operative solidarity boundaries. A **personhood-routing rule** is the installed programme's practical routing of whether a human may appear as You, whether that encounter can interrupt a role or collective task, and whether the human is instead processed only through a programme category. These are descriptions of experienced recognition and operative treatment. They do not make recognition constitutive of inherent human standing.

Pole, mode, programme, and moral direction Four distinctions are mandatory:

1. The **Durkheimian poles** describe organism-rooted and socially derived sources and functions.
2. **I-mode and We-mode** describe the operative relational standpoint of an episode.
3. The **Culture Program and mythological lens** supply what that standpoint values, classifies, requires, and prohibits.
4. **Moral direction and jurisdiction** ask whom the resulting operation preserves or consumes and how far its authority extends.

The organismic-individual pole is therefore not another name for I-mode, and the social-intellectual-moral pole is not another name for We-mode. I-mode can use socially inherited language, conscience, and reflective reconstruction. We-mode remains embodied and locally executed through the biological person's perception, intelligence, affect, and action. No parallel local bigOther or second operative weave is implied by switching modes.

We-mode is an ordinary human capacity that a Culture Program can organize, stabilize, and capture. It is not by itself a god, collective agent, operative multi-mind-self, or powerful programme. A local mode episode establishes neither collective integration and continuity nor subjecthood absorption.

Mode and moral direction therefore form independent axes:

Mode	Person-preserving direction	Person-consuming direction
I-mode	Love, care, friendship, rescue, and answerable personal judgment	Possessiveness, domination, vengeance, and cruelty that can depend upon recognizing the other's suffering
We-mode	Bounded public service, coordinated rescue or defence, common protections, and voluntary contribution	Compulsory self-erasure, sacrificial collectivism, bureaucratic atrocity, and exterminatory administration

Direction is also target-indexed. One person can be loving toward family, heroic toward comrades, and destructive toward a population excluded from personal encounter. Conversely, a general rule can protect people whom the actor will never meet. Neither warm attachment nor impersonal generality supplies a complete moral verdict.

The resulting control spectrum is:

Bounded enlistment	Full We-mode takeover
Temporary coordination for a limited task and jurisdiction	Collective purpose claims comprehensive jurisdiction

Bounded enlistment	Full We-mode takeover
The I remains a legitimate author; conscience, judgment, and refusal retain standing	Personal judgment and needs lose standing; refusal becomes betrayal
Outsiders remain persons and a classified object can reappear as You	Outsiders remain programme objects and I–You re-entry is blocked
Return from the collective standpoint remains possible; sacrifice is bounded and answerable	Self-sacrifice and sacrifice of others become programme requirements

Intensity alone does not decide the relation. A rescue team, orchestra, court, laboratory, or military unit can require strong coordination while retaining bounded roles, personal responsibility, the standing of affected persons, correction, refusal, and return. Duty becomes **person-consuming role execution** when a bounded office or mission expands toward comprehensive jurisdiction, disowns personal authorship, recodes refusal as betrayal, blocks the affected person's interruptive standing, and treats actor or target as programme material.

Repersonalization shock is the possible surprise, guilt, or moral disorientation that occurs when a human previously processed impersonally reappears as You: "How could I have thought or done that?" It demonstrates that mode-switching and return are possible. It does not make the earlier operation unreal or prove that every person, domain, or programme remains equally reachable through encounter.

Self-transcendence, love, and scale Overcoming immediate private interest does not establish goodness. The model distinguishes three routes that can produce outwardly similar self-sacrifice:

- **Relational self-sacrifice** can arise through I-mode attachment to a particular child, loved person, or encountered stranger.
- **Generalized altruism** uses socially formed concepts to extend concern to absent strangers, future persons, or people outside spontaneous attachment.
- **Collective sacrifice** makes a nation, faith, movement, army, institution, or mission the operative standpoint from which the carrier's own life becomes expendable.

The same capacity for self-transcendence can support care, courage, truthfulness, martyrdom, fanaticism, or atrocity. Ask what is served, who chooses the sacrifice, whether it is imposed on another, whether the end is independently legitimate, and whether refusal and correction remain possible.

Love likewise crosses layers. Embodied attachment and care supply energy and personal presence, while symbolic formation can generalize neighbour-love beyond family, familiarity, faction, or spontaneous affection. Generalization without encounter can remain an abstract command; warmth without generalization can remain narrowly partial. Person-preserving agape is therefore a cross-layer achievement rather than the property of the elephant, rider, social pole, or programme alone.

Scalar personhood collapse is the transition by which necessary numerical or administrative compression becomes moral cancellation: inability to imagine every member vividly is treated as permission to make the aggregate the only real object and its constituent persons morally negligible. The mechanism is distinct from information loss. A single target can be richly represented without becoming You, while an aggregate can additionally conceal the requirement that each member retain standing.

Statistics remain morally and epistemically necessary. They can reveal distant deaths, hidden patterns, unequal treatment, and harms that vivid individual cases conceal. The person-preserving conjunction is:

> **I-mode: this one is an entire world. We-mode: every unknown person must count equally. World: establish how many persons are affected and what caused the harm.**

Names, testimony, case review, individual appeal, and aggregate measurement should therefore correct one another. Institutions need not simulate a million simultaneous intimate encounters, but the limits of feeling cannot authorize cancellation of the people being counted.

13. Symbolic reality

The bigOther does not merely evaluate an independently completed physical world. It also participates in creating **social reality**.

A piece of cloth becomes a flag. A person becomes a judge, citizen, traitor, hero, or martyr. An utterance becomes a promise, verdict, oath, insult, or declaration of war. A place becomes sacred. A relationship becomes a marriage. An individual becomes the bearer of rights and dignity.

These properties are not inherent physical properties, but neither are they merely private fantasies. They are real insofar as people and institutions collectively recognize and act upon them. Symbols, rituals, and authorized classifications therefore do not only represent society; their execution helps constitute society.

Culture mechanics calls attention to both directions:

1. society programs the local bigOther; and
2. locally classified action reproduces or transforms society.

14. The full culture-mechanical cycle

The complete process can be summarized as follows:

```
SLOW CULTURAL FORMATION AND PROGRAMMING
endogenous formation and/or attempted purposive construction
stories + symbols + systems + rituals
+ leadership + rewards + sanctions + experience
                    ↓
MYTHOLOGIES
individual socially evaluated stories
                    ↓
MYTHOLOGICAL LENS
the single local evaluative mapping program
                    ↓
BIGOTHER
fast execution and sentiment classification
                    ↓
ELEPHANT
attention + intuition + motivation + bodily readiness
                    ↓
RIDER AND MAIN CPU
verbalization + explanation + planning + possible criticism
                    ↓
SITUATED CULTURAL SCRIPT
role-, institution-, and situation-indexed expectations,
routines, permissions, interfaces, and error recovery
                    ↓
VISIBLE ACTION AND COMMUNICATION
                    ↓
ENCODING IN SHARED SYMBOLIC PROTOCOL
words + gestures + symbols + roles + sanctions
                    ↓
OTHER LOCAL BIGOTHERS RECEIVE AND CLASSIFY
                    ↓
COORDINATION, SYNCHRONIZATION, OR OPPOSITION
                    ↓
RITUAL, CUSTOM, ROLE, INSTITUTION, OR EMERGENT FIELD
                    ↓
REINFORCEMENT OR MODIFICATION OF MYTHOLOGIES,
LENSES, AND DISTRIBUTED BIGOTHER
                    ↻
```

The diagram makes the individual-to-field handoff visible without yet displaying all later consequences, sensing paths, retained history, or institutional changes. *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity* owns the detailed account of how the emergent field acts back upon judgment, distributes authority, and supports or suppresses epistemic agency. The following propagator model joins that back-action to the other cross-scale transitions without collapsing their distinct semantic homes.

Culture propagator and dynamic evolution The **culture propagator** is the scale-declared, history-bearing state-transition operator that maps a cultural configuration into later possible configurations through the coupled evolution of operative representations, persons, emergent collective fields, institutional carrying structures, worldly consequences, sensing and correction architectures, and retained memory.

Propagator does not here mean only the propagation of a message or the recruitment of additional carriers. Propagation is one process inside the wider transition relation, alongside correction, reproduction, institutionalization, decay, fission, recovery, and replacement. Deliberate adversarial steering is one possible forcing regime, not the definition of the propagator.

Let the typed cultural state at a declared scale be:

$$z_t = (r_t, p_t, d_t, k_t, w_t, s_t, m_t).$$

Symbol	Cultural-mechanical meaning
r_t	Socially operative representations: classifications, causal accounts, expectations, legitimacy assignments, person-types, threats, duties, and possible futures
p_t	Person-level configurations: installed lenses, interpretation, judgment, relationships, dispositions, conduct, refusal, and correction across the relevant participants
d_t	The emergent symbolic-affective field or distributed-bigOther configuration reproduced through reciprocal signalling, expectations, institutions, practices, stories, and artifacts
k_t	Institutional and carrying structure: roles, rules, appointments, resources, access, sanctions, archives, organizations, infrastructure, and succession
w_t	Relevant worldly conditions and consequences: material production, capabilities, burdens, injuries, opportunities, performance, externalities, and other resistant outcomes
s_t	Sensing and correction architecture: what can be noticed, sampled, classified, recorded, preserved, transmitted, compared, challenged, and admitted as correction
m_t	Retained history: learned expectations, records, reputations, embodied habits, institutional memory, sunk costs, damaged or strengthened relationships, and other path-dependent residues

Let y_t denote observations made available through the sensing architecture. Let θ_t denote slower or structurally privileged transition conditions, including authority topology, network structure, jurisdiction, interdependence, reproduction, trust routing, correction rules, and the distribution of coercive or material capability. Let u_t denote a specified input or intervention and ε_t disturbances and omitted influences.

The state–parameter distinction is scale-relative. A constitution may be treated as fixed during a short episode and as a slowly changing state variable over a century. An analysis must declare that choice rather than moving an inconvenient change silently into the background.

The typed scaffold is neutral among continuous, discrete, deterministic, stochastic, agent-based, network, and historical-process realizations. In a continuous-time model one may instead write:

$$\dot{z}(t) = \mathcal{F}\big(z(t), \theta(t), u(t), \varepsilon(t)\big).$$

That notation does not assert one known differential equation for culture. The model form must follow the declared question, scale, data, and causal resolution; the discrete equations below expose typed handoffs rather than claiming that cultural processes advance in synchronized steps.

In discrete-time shorthand, the general update is:

$$z_{t+1} = T_{\theta_t}(z_t; u_t, \varepsilon_t).$$

Where uncertainty is material, T or the two-time operator below maps the initial state into a distribution over possible later states rather than one predicted point. The corresponding component handoffs can be written:

$$p_{t+1} = F_p(p_t, r_t, d_t, k_t, w_t, m_t; \varepsilon_t^p, u_t^p),$$

$$d_{t+1} = F_d(d_t, p_{t+1}, r_t, k_t, m_t; \varepsilon_t^d, u_t^d),$$

$$k_{t+1} = F_k(k_t, p_{t+1}, d_{t+1}, r_t, w_t, m_t; \varepsilon_t^k, u_t^k),$$

$$w_{t+1} = F_w(w_t, p_{t+1}, d_{t+1}, k_{t+1}; \varepsilon_t^w, u_t^w),$$

$$s_{t+1} = F_s(s_t, k_{t+1}, p_{t+1}, d_{t+1}, r_t, m_t; \varepsilon_t^s, u_t^s),$$

$$y_{t+1} = H(w_{t+1}, p_{t+1}, d_{t+1}, k_{t+1}, s_{t+1}; \varepsilon_t^y),$$

$$r_{t+1} = F_r(r_t, p_{t+1}, d_{t+1}, k_{t+1}, y_{t+1}, m_t; \varepsilon_t^r, u_t^r),$$

$$m_{t+1} = F_m(m_t, z_t, z_{t+1}, y_{t+1}).$$

Structural conditions can themselves update:

$$\theta_{t+1} = F_\theta(\theta_t, k_{t+1}, d_{t+1}, r_{t+1}, w_{t+1}, m_{t+1}).$$

The displayed order makes causal handoffs inspectable; it is not a chronological dogma. Cultural systems are asynchronous, multi-speed, distributed, and delay-ridden. Institutions can act before most persons learn a classification, material consequences can arrive years after a decision, and an old archive can re-enter the loop after apparent cultural forgetting.

The presence of every typed component does not establish the displayed loop. Each proposed handoff requires its own temporal and causal support, and an applied analysis must preserve one-way movements where no return path has been shown. The equations are therefore a hypothesis grammar for reconstructing transitions, not evidence that every named component interacted in a completed circuit.

At programme level, the circulation of cultural authority follows these handoffs from represented good through interpretation, institutional conversion, formation, consequence, and return. Its fork between correction and self-authorization is an application of this canonical state-transition model, not a replacement for it or a presumption that every cultural movement is a threat.

For a sufficiently specified state and forcing history, the two-time propagator is:

$$z_{t_1} = \Phi_{t_1,t_0}^{\theta,u,\varepsilon}(z_{t_0}).$$

Its ordinary composition property,

$$\Phi_{t_2,t_0} = \Phi_{t_2,t_1} \circ \Phi_{t_1,t_0},$$

is legitimate only when the state at t_1 contains the memory needed to determine later movement and the relevant forcing schedule is specified. If apparently identical present states respond differently because of hidden history,

the state description is incomplete. The repair is to restore the missing history to m_t, treat another slow variable as part of the state, or use a history-dependent operator over a trajectory segment. Failed point-state prediction can therefore indicate omitted memory, delayed feedback, or an incorrectly chosen quotient rather than random cultural irrationality.

The typed model preserves the framework's constitutive architecture. The local bigOther and main cognitive processor remain functionally distinct within persons; p_t is not a homogeneous population average. The field d_t is implemented through persons and material carriers but has relational organization and back-action that cannot be reconstructed from independently formed individual attitudes alone. Field coherence, synchrony, collective-self presentation, operative collective agency, and fusion remain separate thresholds. One operative mythological lens still occupies the single local slot; change in that lens is an unbraiding, rebraiding, or replacement process rather than runtime arbitration among several sovereign bigOthers.

The detailed person–field projection belongs to *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*. The consequence, sensing, and correction projection belongs to *Epistemic Constitution*. The trajectory family belongs to *Mythology Construction*, and Culture Program reproduction, identity, capture, and strategic forcing belong to *Culture Program Ecology*.

Question-relative quotient dynamics Different descriptions can encode the same relation for one inquiry while remaining importantly different for another. A quotient therefore removes only distinctions declared irrelevant to a specified question. Genealogy, programme identity, hazard, causal inheritance, and present response need not admit the same equivalence relation.

Three relations are especially easy to collapse and must remain distinct:

Equivalence	Meaning	Licensed inference
Syntactic or coordinate equivalence	Different expressions encode the same declared state.	The wording or coordinate difference may be removed from that representation.
Observational equivalence	The available sensing process does not currently distinguish two states.	The observation is underdetermining; causal identity does not follow.
Causal-dynamical equivalence	Substitution leaves the relevant successor relation invariant under matched conditions.	The distinction may be quotiented out of that specified dynamic model.

In a reflexive system, deployment can break an observational equivalence that held beforehand. Two classifications that fit the same present record can alter conduct, trust, institutions, or later sensing differently once they become operative. They are then dynamically active coordinates rather than harmless aliases.

Let $\pi : Z \to Z/\sim$ project states into a declared quotient. The transition rule descends to that quotient only if equivalent states have equivalent successors:

$$z \sim z' \Longrightarrow T(z) \sim T(z').$$

Equivalently, there must be a well-defined quotient transition $\bar{T}$ such that:

$$\pi \circ T = \bar{T} \circ \pi.$$

If the condition fails, the discarded distinction changes the modeled future. The analysis must restore the active variable or narrow its question rather than force the dynamics into the quotient. Current observational equivalence is not operational identity: a difference can become causally visible under stress, refusal, failure, emergency, defeat, or succession. The controlled mathematical mapping and its limits are given in *Analogical Models in Culture Mechanics*.

Forcing regimes and dynamic descriptors The propagator separates the transition architecture from the origin and purpose of an input:

Regime	Distinguishing condition
Ordinary endogenous evolution	The coupled system changes without a demonstrated directing intervention.
Exogenous shock	War, disaster, technology, migration, discovery, scarcity, or another event perturbs the state without being generated by the modeled cultural loop.
Declared reform or policy intervention	An actor openly attempts to change specified outcomes or transition rules.
Opportunistic exploitation	An actor recognizes an emerging loop and amplifies, selects, or redirects it.
Adversarial reflexive attractor steering	An actor deliberately targets representations, routing, institutions, sensors, or correction so that decentralized responses help induce a strategically useful transition.

Ordinary endogenous movement can include sincere moral conviction, commercial selection, bureaucratic simplification, reputational self-protection, institutional inertia, uneven harms, and competition for authority. Those mechanisms can produce a dangerous trajectory without an adversary and remain serious rivals when deliberate steering is alleged. Steering denotes directional leverage, not exact control: an intervention can fail, decay, overshoot, strengthen a rival, or help create an unintended third regime.

Six non-scalar descriptors make different parts of a transition inspectable:

Descriptor	Governing question	Distinct function
Representational leverage	How much consequential change can an input reach through a classification, symbol, expectation, or trusted channel?	Input effectiveness
Reflexive gain	How strongly does a representation-induced response return to amplify, damp, or redirect the next response?	Feedback sign and amplification
Basin margin or transition proximity	How much displacement or structural change separates the present regime from another reproducible regime?	Susceptibility to transition
Sensor endogeneity	How much apparent evidence is elicited, selected, classified, or produced through the contested representation and response?	Dependence of observation on deployment
Correction independence	Can sufficiently independent persons and procedures expose error and alter operation without the tested custodian's permission?	Detection, adjudication, and reversal capacity
Hysteresis depth	What successor structure remains after the initiating input is removed, and what reconstruction would reversal require?	Persistence after transition

The descriptors do not form one universal risk score. Each requires a specified unit, period, interface, causal question, and observable counterpart. Additional case-specific descriptors can include field coupling, reproduction rate, succession robustness, jurisdictional congruence, interoperability, externality routing, material dependence, and bridge density.

The propagator is descriptive until a correction and normative relation is specified. A representation can be self-consistent, causally effective, stable, adaptive, and destructive. A programme can accurately learn how to

dominate. The programme-level course-preserving-adaptation and resilience-inversion trajectory shows how operational adaptation can protect programme continuation while social and material renewal, correction, or succession capacity declines. Reality-answerability and preservation of the concrete person's standing are therefore independent constraints rather than outputs automatically supplied by dynamic stability.

The principal boundaries are:

1. no social wavefunction, universal potential landscape, conserved cultural energy, or established universal field equation is asserted;
2. persons remain reflexive nodes capable of interpretation, resistance, deception, defection, imitation, concealment, and reorganization;
3. no quotient is innocent by default;
4. self-consistency, stability, persistence, and causal efficacy do not establish truth, legitimacy, fit, or moral value;
5. transition does not imply progress;
6. distributed causation does not establish centralized design;
7. a transition mechanism does not identify an actor or transmit an initiator's intention to downstream participants;
8. failure to identify or prove an actor blocks the actor attribution but does not erase independently supported feedback, field, institutional, consequence, or persistence findings; and
9. the same causal, consequence, correction, quotient, and rival-explanation standards apply to preferred and opposed programmes without presuming equal power or effect.

15. Open and closed cultural programming

Culture mechanics is descriptive before it is normative. The same mechanisms can support an open society or a closed total community.

A **closed cultural program** forms a mythological lens that teaches the bigOther to reward:

- unanimity and obedience;
- one overriding identity;
- submission to a central authority;
- denunciation of deviants;
- conflation of factual truth with political loyalty;
- exclusion of competing institutions and sources;
- treatment of counterevidence as betrayal or pollution.

An **open cultural program** forms a mythological lens that teaches the bigOther to value second-order norms:

- every person possesses dignity;
- opponents remain legitimate members of society;
- disagreement is not automatically betrayal;
- respect for a person does not require agreement with every claim;
- evidence may correct belief;
- authority may be criticized;
- compromise can be honourable;
- multiple institutions and affiliations must remain independent;
- no person or institution may become the sole authorized voice of the bigOther.

On the single-slot model, pluralism does not mean having no shared programming or installing one independent evaluator for each affiliation. It means that one open weave can be a fully installed lifted meta-program whose shared generator admits different context-sensitive first-order outputs. Its concrete surface can vary without its authority being weaker or local: the binding sameness lies in the rules by which answers are generated, tested, applied, and revised. These rules are not a higher runtime judge ranking several bigOthers; generator and outputs form one weave. Detailed cases and boundary tests are developed in *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity*. Pluralism as a reality-answerable Culture Strategy, and the distinction between Culture Strategy and Pure-Ideology Culture Program, are developed in *Culture Program Ecology*.

16. Autonomy, capture, and susceptibility

Culture mechanics does not define autonomy as the absence of a bigOther. Language, morality, identity, and social cooperation all require cultural formation. Nor is autonomy the installation of a second bigOther to overrule the first.

The relevant question is whether the main processor can inspect and revise the one installed lens and the bigOther's classifications. Autonomy is therefore compatible with full capture: it names an operative weave whose binding rules protect the main processor's capacity to inspect and revise its classifications, not incomplete programming or escape from the slot.

In an autonomous configuration, a person can:

- distinguish affective certainty from evidence;
- notice shame, disgust, or group pressure as signals rather than proofs;
- compare inherited classifications with direct experience;
- tolerate disagreement and temporary dissonance;
- question the authority that supplied a classification;
- revise the mythological lens when its classifications contradict evidence or experience.

Every installed program governs classification, and a lifted program necessarily has meta-authority over first-order jurisdictions. **Pathological capture** begins not with governing authority as such but when the weave or its representatives become uncorrectable, monopolize authorized interpretation, exceed their constituted jurisdiction, or claim **epistemic sovereignty**—that reality must answer to authorization rather than authorization to reality. The bigOther then determines which perceptions, questions, relationships, and feelings the main CPU may treat as legitimate. Intelligence remains available, but is recruited to implement or defend the installed lens.

Full capture can integrate an already compatible package, but capture by an incompatible governing worldview requires replacement. Authorities, sanctions, rituals, relationships, and field back-action must loosen the incumbent weave's load-bearing bindings, make detachment or reinterpretation survivable, and help rebraid one successor. Conversely, counter-relations and reality contact can protect or repair the incumbent weave without acting as a second evaluator. A rival successor is not pathological merely because it replaces an incumbent; its corrigibility and authority relations must be assessed independently.

Susceptibility to such capture is not treated as a single scalar trait. It can involve different degrees of:

- programmability through narratives and exemplars;
- sensitivity to approval, rejection, and unanimity;
- ease of synchronization with a group;
- identity dependence;
- affective charge and internalization;
- resistance to counterevidence;
- difficulty of reprogramming;
- practical ability to dissent or leave.

17. Synonyms and terminological neighbours of the bigOther

There is no established term that is an exact synonym for the **bigOther** as culture mechanics defines it. The term deliberately combines a local sentiment classifier, its culturally learned programming, its relation to the symbolic order, and its capacity for distributed synchronization. Existing concepts usually name only one of these aspects.

The closest everyday term is **conscience** (*Gewissen*), provided that it is understood as an affectively active moral evaluator rather than as a little rational judge inside the mind. Conscience marks conduct and even contemplated conduct with approval, guilt, shame, obligation, or prohibition. In that respect it performs part of the bigOther's sentiment-classification function.

Conscience is nevertheless narrower than the bigOther. The bigOther also classifies status, belonging, legitimacy, loyalty, sacredness, pollution, identity, and social danger, including cases that are not ordinarily described as matters of conscience. Conversely, conscience can include deliberate moral reflection performed by the main CPU, whereas the bigOther refers specifically to the fast culturally programmed evaluator that influences such reflection. Culture mechanics can therefore distinguish a **socially authored conscience**, whose judgments are largely supplied by the surrounding field, from a more **self-authored conscience**, whose inherited classifications can be examined and deliberately endorsed, rejected, or revised.

Neighbouring term	Main overlap with the bigOther	Important difference
Lacan's big Other	The prior symbolic order of language, law, roles, authority, and socially intelligible meaning; functionally, the shared protocol through which local states become publicly legible.	It is the source term, but Lacan did not describe a literal local co-processor, PCI card, or the full on-the-wire analogy. Culture mechanics adds that implementation and translation.
James's felt objective presence	A reality or unseen order may be experienced as objectively present and conduct-directing.	It illuminates **bigOther-presence** phenomenologically but does not specify its local processor, cultural program, or network mechanism.
Buber's I–Thou relation	Another is encountered in a second-person relational mode rather than as an object.	It illuminates **bigOther-as-Thou** but must not be reduced to social programming; Buber's eternal Thou is not the culture-mechanical bigOther.
Conscience / Gewissen	Internal moral approval, guilt, shame, obligation, and prohibition.	It is the closest ordinary-language partial synonym, but is narrower than the bigOther and can also include reflective moral judgment by the CPU.
Superego	Internalized authority, prohibitions, ideals, guilt, and demands placed upon the self.	It emphasizes a psychoanalytic intrapsychic agency, often especially its punitive aspect; it does not by itself denote the full symbolic network or distributed computation.
Generalized other	George Herbert Mead's organized attitudes and expectations of a community that a person learns to take toward the self.	It closely describes the social standpoint represented locally, but not the proposed dual-processor architecture or its primitive affective interface.
Collective conscience / collective consciousness	Durkheim's shared beliefs and sentiments, with their moral authority over group members.	It is closest to the distributed bigOther; it does not isolate the local sentiment-classification unit through which collective sentiments become personally operative.
Internalized norms, moral schemas, and moral identity	Learned evaluative rules, expectations, and identity commitments.	These are components of the mythological lens executed by the bigOther rather than names for the processor, the narrative corpus, and the network together.
Habitus	Social history embodied as durable perception, feeling, and action dispositions.	It is broader than moral-social classification and does not posit a single-slot evaluator or a separate general-purpose CPU.
Socialized mind and **ego development**	Describe developmental relations to social expectations, internal standards, and one's own meaning-making system.	They describe organizations or levels of the whole person, not an additional processor. They are developmental neighbours of the bigOther, not synonyms for it.

The vocabulary should therefore be used with the following rule:

> **Conscience, superego, generalized other, collective conscience, felt objective presence, and I–Thou relation each illuminate an aspect of the bigOther; none alone names the complete culture-mechanical construct.**

18. Development of the bigOther: Kegan and Loevinger

Culture mechanics treats the bigOther as developmentally variable. A person is not born with a completed mythological lens. Social evaluation is first encountered through attachment, imitation, direct reward and punishment, and dependence on caregivers. It is then internalized as group-authored conscience and may later become available for self-authorship and reflective revision.

Robert Kegan's constructive-developmental theory and Jane Loevinger's ego-development research provide the closest developmental models found in the surrounding conversations, but neither proposed a bigOther. Kegan's subject-object theory describes increasingly complex **forms of mind** or **meaning-making**, not merely moral conscience. Loevinger's theory describes development of the **ego** across impulse control, character, interpersonal understanding, conscious preoccupations, and moral evaluation. The culture-mechanical model below is consequently a synthesis and translation, not a claim that either theorist described the wireless collar.

The key developmental question is:

> **Is the mythological lens something the person can look at and revise, or is it the unquestioned lens through which the person looks?**

This is Kegan's subject-object distinction applied specifically to cultural sentiment classification. What remains **subject** to a person has the person: it organizes experience but cannot yet be examined as an object. What becomes **object** can be noticed, compared, evaluated, and acted upon. Development of the bigOther therefore does not primarily mean that the collar becomes stronger. It means that the homo-duplex system gains a more complex and reflective relation to the lens stored in the collar.

Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity operationalizes this movement by distinguishing reason as **press secretary**, **interpreter**, and **auditor**. Making a classification and its provenance visible is the interpretive step; testing its framing, authority, jurisdiction, evidence, consequence, and corrigibility is the further audit. Articulate reasons alone do not establish that the main CPU authored the verdict.

A four-phase culture-mechanical model

Culture-mechanical phase	Closest Keganian neighbour	Closest Loevingerian neighbour	Relation to the bigOther
1. Installation and external regulation	Impulsive and instrumental forms of mind	Impulsive and Self-Protective stages	Social control is experienced mainly through immediate attachment, advantage, reward, retaliation, and punishment. A stable moral-social lens is still being installed; much of its authority remains visibly outside the person.
2. Socially authored bigOther	Socialized Mind	Conformist and transitional Self-Aware levels	Group expectations, authorities, relationships, and accepted roles become internally binding. The person can subordinate impulse to shared rules, but has difficulty standing apart from the social field that defines what ought to feel admirable, shameful, loyal, or forbidden. Borrowed judgment is experienced as one's own obvious conscience.

Culture-mechanical phase	Closest Keganian neighbour	Closest Loevingerian neighbour	Relation to the bigOther
3. Self-authored bigOther	Self-Authoring Mind	Conscientious stage	The person constructs an internal code and can use it to evaluate competing external demands. The main CPU can identify, endorse, and deliberately revise at least some mappings in the installed lens. The bigOther remains present, but its lens is increasingly governed from within rather than continuously authored by the current group.
4. Self-transforming bigOther	Self-Transforming Mind	Individualistic transition, Autonomous stage, and the rare Integrated stage	The person can take even a self-authored value system as object, recognize its partial and constructed character, tolerate conflicts among frameworks, and revise the meta-rules by which classifications are made. The lens can include its own corrigibility without dissolving all commitments.

These are correspondences, not one-to-one equations. In particular, Loevinger's **Conscientious** stage is not simply "having a conscience"; it is a comparatively developed organization characterized by self-evaluated standards, responsibility, long-term goals, and evaluation of rules rather than mere acceptance of group rules. Her **Individualistic** level is a transition from Conscientious to Autonomous, and the Autonomous and Integrated levels add tolerance of inner conflict, ambiguity, interdependence, and increasingly integrated identity. Kegan describes a related shift in different terms: from being authored by relationships and the surrounding culture, to authoring an internal system, to being able to inspect the limitations of that system itself.

Development under the single-slot principle Development does not install additional bigOthers beside the first one. The computer still has one PCI slot, one operative sentiment-classification architecture, and therefore one fully occupied slot. What changes is the person's relation to the installed card and, during lifting, the order of the rules it runs:

```
EXTERNALLY ENFORCED LENS
the environment supplies immediate reward and punishment
                    ↓
SOCIALLY AUTHORED LENS
the group's judgments operate internally as obvious conscience
                    ↓
SELF-AUTHORED LENS
the person can evaluate social demands through an internal code
                    ↓
SELF-TRANSFORMING LENS
the person can inspect and revise even the code and its meta-rules
```

A self-transforming person can represent several moral systems in the main CPU, translate between them, and understand each from within. This does not require several PCI cards running independently or a higher evaluator that ranks them at runtime. Until reconstruction occurs, one local bigOther still executes one operative lens.

The developmental achievement is that the person can treat this present lens as partial, corrigible, and open to deliberate repair, compatible extension, unbraiding, or replacement.

Self-transformation can therefore unbraid a first-order program whose concrete answers are treated as final and rebraid one lifted program in which binding meta-rules generate, select, apply, and revise concrete answers. First-order religious, professional, familial, political, or local packages need not vanish; their particular rules and conclusions remain within the successor weave as outputs or bounded packages answerable to its generator. This is full lifted capture, not a neutral evaluator standing above culture.

Nor does greater autonomy require disconnection from distributed computing. The socially authored person is especially liable to be synchronized by whichever reference group carries authority. The self-authoring person can choose commitments and networks from an internal standpoint. The self-transforming person can participate in collective life without assuming that any single network exhausts reality, and can sometimes translate between networks without simply fusing with either one.

The "less than 1%" claim The recollection that the most developed Keganian form occurs in fewer than one percent of adults is supported, with an attribution caveat. A peer-reviewed account by Lars Bauger, Rob Bongaardt, and Jack J. Bauer reports that, **according to Kegan and Lahey (2009)**, approximately 80–90% of adults make meaning between the Socialized and Self-Authoring levels, while the Self-Transforming Mind is "seldom seen (less than 1%)." The estimate is therefore appropriately attributed to **Kegan and Lahey's framework**, while the directly checkable wording appears in Bauger, Bongaardt, and Bauer's 2021 article.

This figure should be treated as a reported developmental estimate, not as a population census, a biological constant, or a direct measurement of the bigOther. It concerns Kegan's highest whole-person meaning-making structure. Culture mechanics translates that structure into the capacity to take one's own mythological lens as object; it does not claim that Kegan measured a collar processor or that exactly the same percentage applies across all societies and methods.

Developmental cautions Developmental complexity is not identical to intelligence, factual correctness, kindness, mental health, or moral worth. A powerful CPU does not guarantee a self-authored relation to the bigOther. Conversely, a self-authored person can construct and defend a cruel or epistemically contaminated code. Development describes increasing capacity to author and inspect a framework; the content and consequences of that framework must still be evaluated independently.

The highest phase should also not be understood as the disappearance of conscience. Its defining feature is **reflective ownership without finalization**: the person can retain commitments, feel moral sentiments, and participate in a culture while knowing that the framework producing those classifications is neither infallible nor complete.

19. Cross-references to closely related concepts

The following concepts overlap with parts of culture mechanics without being synonyms for the theory as a whole.

Affect Control Theory and BayesACT **Affect Control Theory** (ACT) and its probabilistic extension **BayesACT** provide a formal computational neighbour to the culture-mechanical account of the mythological lens. ACT models culturally learned affective meanings—called **fundamental sentiments**—attached to identities, actions, and settings. An observed social event produces a **transient impression**, which is compared with these culturally expected meanings. The resulting discrepancy is called **deflection**. Deflection generates pressure toward emotion, reinterpretation, identity adjustment, or corrective action that restores affective consistency.

The correspondence is:

Culture mechanics	ACT/BayesACT
Mythological lens	Culturally learned fundamental sentiments and impression-formation rules.
Real-world observation or event	An observed actor–behaviour–object event producing a transient impression.
bigOther classification	Comparison of the transient meaning with culturally expected meaning.

Culture mechanics	ACT/BayesACT
Affective signal	Confirmation or deflection—the discrepancy between expected and observed meaning.
Resulting response	Emotion, reinterpretation, identity adjustment, or corrective action.

BayesACT adds uncertain beliefs about identities and situations, Bayesian updating, explicit goals, and decision-theoretic action selection. In culture-mechanical terms, it offers one possible formalization of how an installed cultural mapping could combine with an observation to produce affective confirmation or error and consequent pressure on feeling and action:

```
culturally learned affective expectations
                  +
         observed social event
                  ↓
     affective comparison or inference
                  ↓
         confirmation or deflection
                  ↓
       feeling and pressure to respond
```

This is a cross-reference rather than a foundation of culture mechanics. ACT and BayesACT do not propose a separate bigOther, a single PCI slot, mythological narrative programming, or distributed synchronization. They also do not explain how mythologies initially form the mythological lens. BayesACT's instrumental action selection extends beyond the primitive sentiment-classification function assigned to the collar and overlaps with planning functions that culture mechanics assigns to the main CPU.

BayesACT should not be conflated with the project's separate **auxiliary-un-reality explaining-away cascade**. That construct borrows the form of Bayesian *explaining away* as a diagnostic contrast: independently evidenced alternative causes belong to legitimate model revision, whereas the project-labelled counterfeit form treats an authorized auxiliary account as if authorization were causal evidence and uses it to protect an operative un-real representation. The social system need not calculate an explicit probability, and neither Bayesian inference nor BayesACT is thereby classified as un-reason.

Stanovich's rationality framework Keith E. Stanovich, Richard F. West, and Maggie E. Toplak distinguish rationality from intelligence and describe cognition with a **tripartite model**:

- The **autonomous mind** produces rapid, automatic, highly practised, or evolutionarily prepared responses.
- The **algorithmic mind** supplies computational capacity for sustained processing, inhibition, and cognitive simulation. Conventional intelligence tests primarily track capacities at this level.
- The **reflective mind** concerns goals, epistemic values, thinking dispositions, and the decision to initiate reflective processing or override a default response.

This tripartite division should not be mapped one-to-one onto homo duplex. In culture mechanics, all three Stanovichian minds describe operations performed within the ordinary brain—the main cognitive system represented by the CPU, elephant, and rider. The bigOther is an additional functional distinction: a culturally programmable sentiment classifier coupled to that system.

The most faithful architectural mapping is:

Stanovichian term	Function in Stanovich's model	Closest culture-mechanical location
Autonomous mind	Generates fast default responses	Part of the main brain and especially the elephant; it is influenced by, but is not identical to, the bigOther.
Algorithmic mind	Supplies computational power, decoupling, inhibition, and simulation	The processing power of the main CPU.

Stanovichian term	Function in Stanovich's model	Closest culture-mechanical location
Reflective mind	Establishes goals and epistemic dispositions and initiates override	The governing and self-corrective activity of the main CPU, represented partly by the rider.
Mindware	Provides learned knowledge, rules, procedures, and strategies for reasoning	General acquired programming available to the main CPU; mythologies may carry mindware, while their culturally evaluative lessons can be compiled into the bigOther's mythological lens.

This prevents two misleading equations:

> The autonomous mind is **not** the bigOther.
> Mindware in general is **neither a mythology nor the mythological lens**.

Probability theory, falsification, causal reasoning, and decision rules are mindware used by the main CPU without necessarily belonging to the bigOther. A mythology is a culturally evaluated story and may carry many kinds of mindware. The mythological lens is narrower than mindware in general: it is the mapping distilled from many mythologies that organizes social identity and sentiment classification.

Mindware gaps and other rationality failures A **mindware gap** exists when a person lacks a learned rule or body of knowledge required for rational judgment. Someone may possess ample algorithmic capacity but not understand base rates, regression to the mean, falsification, or probabilistic reasoning. In culture-mechanical language, the main CPU is powerful enough, but lacks the corrective program needed to evaluate or override a default response.

Stanovich's taxonomy separates this from several other failures:

Failure	Stanovichian description	Culture-mechanical translation
Cognitive miserliness	Reflective processing is not initiated; an easy default is accepted.	The CPU does not spend the effort needed to inspect the elephant's response or the collar's classification.
Override failure	Reflective processing begins and relevant mindware exists, but the default response is not successfully suppressed.	The CPU detects a problem but fails to overcome the elephant's or bigOther's strongly weighted response.
Mindware gap	The alternative knowledge or rule needed for a rational response is absent or insufficiently learned.	The CPU lacks the epistemic tool needed to correct the response.
Contaminated mindware	Acquired mindware itself causes irrational belief or action.	In the culture-mechanical use developed here, the bigOther executes a defective lens that generates misdirecting sentiments and protects its mappings from evaluation.

These failures can combine. A contaminated bigOther may discourage the reflective mind from initiating inspection, make affective override more difficult, and prevent missing corrective mindware from being learned.

Contaminated mindware as a badly programmed bigOther In Stanovich's framework, **contaminated mindware** is acquired mindware that directly causes irrational belief or action—either by reducing epistemic accuracy or by thwarting effective goal pursuit. It can include superstitious thinking, antiscience attitudes, conspiracy beliefs, dysfunctional personal beliefs, misleading causal models, and culturally conditioned misinformation.

Stanovich gives special attention to mindware containing **evaluation-disabling properties**. Such mindware keeps itself lodged in a host by attaching punishment to questioning, rewarding unquestioning acceptance, or making

itself unfalsifiable. This aspect provides the strongest direct bridge to culture mechanics because punishment, reward, and protected sacredness are operations of the bigOther's sentiment-classification system.

Following the present theory's guidance, culture mechanics adopts the term in this more specific functional sense:

> **Contaminated mindware is a badly programmed bigOther: contaminated mythologies have shaped a defective mythological lens whose classifications attach strong sentiments to thoughts and evidence in ways that systematically misguide the main CPU.**

The defective lens may mark:

- a false claim as sacred truth;
- honest doubt as betrayal;
- reliable evidence as enemy contamination;
- asymmetric scrutiny as moral vigilance;
- cruelty as righteous duty;
- correction as humiliation or surrender;
- loyalty to a source as a substitute for evaluating its claims.

The contamination lies in both **content** and **control**. Individual mythologies can carry misleading claims, roles, causal explanations, or anti-evaluation procedures. Repetition compiles those lessons into a defective lens, while the bigOther executes the lens and thereby determines how entertaining, questioning, revising, or rejecting them feels. Pride, shame, sacredness, belonging, authority, disgust, fear, and anticipated punishment protect the defective lens.

The resulting causal sequence is:

```
CONTAMINATED BIGOTHER PROGRAMMING
misleading mythologies + evaluation-disabling procedures
                      ↓
DEFECTIVE MYTHOLOGICAL LENS
misdirected mappings from observations to values and feelings
                      ↓
STRONG AFFECTIVE MISCLASSIFICATION
false feels sacred, doubt feels disloyal,
harm feels righteous, correction feels shameful
                      ↓
REFLECTIVE INHIBITION OR FAILED OVERRIDE
the CPU does not inspect, cannot overcome, or lacks corrective mindware
                      ↓
MOTIVATED OR MYSIDE REASONING
selective search, asymmetric scrutiny, rationalization, and defence
                      ↓
IRRATIONAL BELIEF OR ACTION
reduced epistemic accuracy or frustrated goal attainment
```

The phrase "wrong direction" should be tied to Stanovich's standards of rationality rather than merely to disagreement with an observer. A bigOther is contaminated when its lens systematically impairs:

- **epistemic rationality:** forming beliefs that are appropriately calibrated to evidence and reality; or
- **instrumental rationality:** acting effectively in pursuit of the person's considered goals.

Political, religious, or moral disagreement alone is not evidence of contaminated mindware. The diagnosis requires such features as demonstrable epistemic failure, goal-thwarting consequences, asymmetric standards, or procedures that disable evaluation.

The extension and its boundary The synchronization can now be stated precisely:

- **Stanovich supplies the cognitive pathology:** harmful acquired knowledge and strategies can cause irrationality even when computational intelligence is adequate.
- **Culture mechanics assigns that pathology a location in its dual architecture:** when contaminated mindware is cultural, identity-laden, and affectively enforced, it becomes part of a defective mythological lens executed by the bigOther.

- **Culture mechanics adds a causal interface:** the contaminated bigOther misguides the main CPU by attaching strong feelings to its thoughts and possible conclusions.
- **Culture mechanics adds a distributed mechanism:** networked bigOthers reward, punish, repeat, and synchronize contaminated mythologies and lens mappings across people.
- **Motivated or myside reasoning is usually downstream:** the main CPU is recruited to protect the direction already weighted by the bigOther.

This is a faithful extension, not a claim that Stanovich proposed a bigOther, a wireless collar, homo duplex, or distributed cultural computation. His category is broader: contaminated mindware need not always be socially synchronized or strongly affective. Culture mechanics deliberately concentrates on the subset for which the acquired contamination has entered the mythological lens of the sentiment classifier.

Conversely, not every mythology produces contaminated mindware, and no single story normally determines an entire lens. Mythologies can instead teach intellectual honesty, falsifiability, evidential symmetry, uncertainty, and willingness to revise. An open culture can thereby form a lens that makes reality-oriented conduct feel honourable and correction tolerable rather than misdirecting the CPU away from them.

Dysrationalia **Dysrationalia** is Stanovich's term for irrational thought or behaviour despite adequate intelligence. It is closely related to the homo-duplex thesis because it rejects the assumption that a powerful main CPU guarantees rational judgment.

Culture mechanics proposes one possible social-affective pathway to dysrationalia: the bigOther can set priorities, prohibit questions, or make accurate revision socially painful while leaving general intelligence intact. Dysrationalia is nevertheless broader. It can also result from mindware gaps, cognitive miserliness, poor thinking dispositions, or failures to initiate reflective processing.

Motivated reasoning **Motivated reasoning** is the tendency for desired conclusions, identities, loyalties, or emotional needs to influence how evidence is sought, interpreted, remembered, and evaluated.

In culture mechanics, motivated reasoning is not itself the bigOther. It is what the main CPU may do after the bigOther has marked one conclusion as honourable, safe, identity-preserving, or socially rewarded and another as shameful, dangerous, or disloyal. The CPU's power can then increase the sophistication of the rationalization rather than correct its direction.

Not every instance of reasoning from one's existing perspective is irrational. Prior beliefs may deserve evidential weight, and revising an established model has real cognitive costs. The culture-mechanical concern is the narrower case in which the bigOther enforces asymmetric or evaluation-disabling treatment of evidence and thereby reduces epistemic or instrumental rationality.

When that directional use becomes recursively organized so that concepts, premises, burdens, exceptions, and even criticism are made to protect the installed verdict from possible defeat, *Epistemic Constitution* calls the mechanism **un-reason**. It explains how the main processor's sophistication can strengthen capture through reasoning itself. Motivated reasoning is one possible contributor; un-reason is the wider cross-scale organization and does not follow from intelligence, disagreement, or one error.

Identity-protective cognition **Identity-protective cognition** is motivated reasoning specifically directed toward protecting membership, status, or alignment within an identity-defining group. It is one of the closest empirical neighbours of the wireless-collar model.

The bigOther supplies an internalized audience and asks, in effect:

> What would accepting this evidence say about who I am, whose side I am on, and whether I still belong?

The person may consequently reject an accurate conclusion not because it exceeds the main CPU's capacity, but because accepting it would trigger shame, loss of status, or symbolic expulsion.

Moral conviction, sacred values, and taboo trade-offs **Moral conviction** occurs when a preference or belief is experienced as a matter of fundamental right and wrong rather than negotiable interest. A **sacred value** is protected from ordinary comparison or exchange. A **taboo trade-off** is a comparison whose mere consideration is treated as morally offensive.

These concepts describe classifications produced by the bigOther when it assigns exceptional moral authority to an object or rule. They help explain why compromise can feel like corruption and why cost-benefit reasoning can provoke outrage rather than deliberation. They also distinguish an ordinary strong preference from programming that determines what the main CPU is permitted even to compare.

Actively open-minded thinking and epistemic autonomy **Actively open-minded thinking** is the disposition to search for reasons one may be wrong, consider alternatives, apply standards symmetrically, and revise beliefs in response to evidence. It is a form of healthy mindware and a partial operational counterpart to what culture mechanics calls **epistemic autonomy**.

Epistemic autonomy does not require the absence of a bigOther. It requires a mythological lens that permits the main CPU to inspect the bigOther's outputs and that does not convert doubt, correction, or uncertainty automatically into shame and betrayal.

Actively open-minded thinking predicts resistance to many reasoning errors and forms of contaminated mindware, but it should not be treated as a universal antidote. Stanovich's work finds myside bias unusually resistant to prediction by intelligence and, in several paradigms, by actively open-minded-thinking measures themselves.

Master signifiers In Lacanian terminology, a **master signifier** is a privileged signifier that organizes other meanings and identifications. Words such as *Nation*, *Justice*, *Science*, *Tradition*, *Safety*, *Freedom*, or *Revolution* can function in this way.

A master signifier is not inherently contaminated. It becomes a carrier of contaminated mindware when invoking it terminates evaluation rather than organizing an inquiry—for example, when "Science" changes from the name of a corrigible method into an authority token that makes further judgment impermissible.

In the wireless-collar and protocol analogies, a master signifier is a **highly compressed protocol token**. It indexes a large package of already installed mythologies, classifications, authorities, identities, sentiments, and expected conduct without restating them. This explains both its efficiency and its danger: participants can coordinate through a short token, but the expansion it activates may remain unspoken and therefore difficult to inspect.

Master-signifier analysis grid

> **A master signifier should be analysed by what it sacralizes, who bears it, how it unifies, what it authorizes, and what happens to the outlier—not merely by its dictionary meaning.**

The **master-signifier analysis grid** is a project-developed decompression method. The assistant synthesized the grid from the Humanism–Diversity discussion; the project author then selected it for theory integration. It compares the operative structures activated by a signifier without turning those structures into one scalar judgment:

Field	Diagnostic question
Token family	Which word, capitalization, slogan, symbol, negation, and neighbouring terms select the same installed complex?
Sacred referent	Which person, relation, collective, abstraction, pattern, process, condition, or future, if any, is placed beyond ordinary trade-off?
Bearer	Who or what, if anything, is said to instantiate, represent, carry, embody, or transmit the sacred referent?
Protected principal	Whose or what interests, standing, continuity, or development, if any, finally select action when goods conflict?
Unity topology	Does the signifier join persons directly through a common standing, mediate membership through groups, federate differentiated forms, or impose one higher-order content upon them?
Difference operator	Which distinctions are ignored, protected, amplified, administered, ranked, corrected, or treated as suspect?

Field	Diagnostic question
Distributive grammar	What is allocated—standing, liberty, voice, office, recognition, burden, remedy, resources, reward, opportunity, or outcome—and by which rule: equality, contribution, need, injury, category, parity, or another principle?
Causal story	Which condition becomes a problem, who or what caused it, who is harmed or blamed, and which fixer and remedy follow?
Interpreter custody	Who defines the term, its bearers, categories, indicators, exceptions, conflicts, and legitimate application? Can rival interpretations defeat the custodian's account?
Authorization and jurisdiction	Which power, objects, domain, duration, discretion, sanction, and epistemic authority does invocation support?
Outlier performance	What happens to the difficult case—the infant, dependant, dissenter, noncontributor, mixed or unclassified person, statistical minority, failed exemplar, or person whose concrete interest conflicts with the aggregate or pattern?
Realization stack	How does the signifier operate semantically, affectively, behaviourally, institutionally, and materially rather than only propositionally?
Completion	What observable condition permits the demand, correction, emergency, or programme to count as complete?
Correction	Which evidence, consequence, appeal, refusal, succession, or external reality check can revise the interpretation and authorization?
Trajectory	Across time, does the complex build and transmit finite goods, stabilize bounded maintenance, renew its own demand, displace its principal, or consume its carriers and containing order?

Outlier performance is not a licence to stigmatize unusual persons. It is a stress test of what the signifier actually protects when its easiest representative case is unavailable. **Distributive grammar** likewise does not presume that one rule fits every object: equal moral standing, contribution-sensitive reward, need-based aid, compensation for a demonstrated injury, and role-specific authority answer different questions.

The grid is neither a new constitutional orientation nor a diagnostic score. Some master signifiers organize knowledge or coordination without one sacred referent, bearer, or protected principal; the grid records that absence rather than manufacturing one. Several fields deliberately cross-reference independent theory components: causal stories and authorization payloads, subjecthood absorption, truth and drive orientations, Culture Program jurisdiction, and service direction. A field should be retained only if comparative application changes or sharpens the analysis. A master signifier remains capable of healthy compression when its referent, custody, authorization, boundaries, completion, and correction can be made explicit and contested and when the formation path needed to reconstruct its reasons, limits, and application remains practically reopenable.

When *Science*, *Safety*, *biodiversity*, *risk*, or another master signifier compresses a model-mediated authorization, the grid should be paired with the **model-to-mandate custody chain**. That chain does not add another grid axis. It decompresses the existing causal story, interpreter custody, authorization, completion, and correction fields into observation, metric, model, conditional forecast, harm translation, protected-principal valuation, severity threshold, remedy comparison, mandate, and outcome audit. A valid early stage may coexist with an invalid later crossing, and a disputed mandate does not by itself falsify the underlying observation or model.

Bonhoeffer's Dummheit Dietrich Bonhoeffer's 1943 reflection "Von der Dummheit" (PDF of the complete section) is the starting point of the culture-mechanics theory. It posed the originating questions: **What causes this *Dummheit*? How does it work?**

The German original reads:

> Jede starke äußere Machtentfaltung, sei sie politischer oder religiöser Art, schlägt einen großen Teil der Menschen mit Dummheit. Ja, es hat den Anschein, als sei das geradezu ein soziologisch-psychologisches Gesetz. Die Macht der einen braucht die Dummheit der anderen. Der Vorgang ist dabei nicht der, dass bestimmte – also etwa intellektuelle – Anlagen des Menschen plötzlich verkümmern oder ausfallen, sondern dass unter dem überwältigenden Eindruck der Machtentfaltung dem Menschen seine innere Selbständigkeit geraubt wird und dass dieser nun – mehr oder weniger unbewusst – darauf verzichtet, zu den sich ergebenden Lebenslagen ein eigenes Verhalten zu finden. Dass der Dumme oft bockig ist, darf nicht darüber hinwegtäuschen, dass er nicht selbständig ist. **Man spürt es geradezu im Gespräch mit ihm, dass man es gar nicht mit ihm selbst, mit ihm persönlich, sondern mit über ihn mächtig gewordenen Schlagworten, Parolen etc. zu tun hat. Er ist in einem Bann, er ist verblendet, er ist in seinem eigenen Wesen missbraucht, misshandelt.** So zum willenlosen Instrument geworden, wird der Dumme auch zu allem Bösen fähig sein und zugleich unfähig, dies als Böses zu erkennen. Hier liegt die Gefahr eines diabolischen Missbrauchs.

The English translation used here is:

> Every powerful display of external force, whether political or religious, strikes a large portion of people with stupidity. Indeed, it appears to be almost a sociological-psychological law: the power of the few needs the stupidity of the many. The process does not consist of certain intellectual faculties suddenly withering. Rather, under the overwhelming impression of power, people are robbed of their inner independence and - more or less unconsciously - give up forming their own judgments about the situations that arise. The fact that the stupid person is often obstinate should not hide the reality that he is not acting autonomously. **In conversation one senses that one is not dealing with the person himself but with slogans and catch-phrases that have gained mastery over him. He is under a spell, blinded, his very being abused and misused.** Having become a will-less instrument, the stupid person is capable of any evil and at the same time incapable of recognizing it as evil. Here lies the danger of a diabolical misuse.

This is not a claim about low intelligence. Bonhoeffer describes a socially induced loss of inner independence in which external power, slogans, and formulas speak through a person whose ordinary intellectual abilities remain available. His *Dummheit* is therefore broader and more political than contaminated mindware.

Bonhoeffer names the phenomenon; culture mechanics proposes a mechanism. At the individual level, an intelligent person's main CPU can remain capable while the bigOther supplies the classifications, slogans, sentiments, and permissions under which that intelligence operates. *Epistemic Agency under Mechanical Solidarity* develops the social-field account: mutually synchronized local bigOthers and institutional power can make borrowed judgment feel internally compulsory and thereby weaken the person's capacity to form an independent response.

The finer ideological-power scale bridge distinguishes the internalized observer from the person's own capacity for inward seeing. An approaching culturally forbidden relation may become difficult to hold, formulate, or name before an authorized slogan occupies the resulting conceptual vacancy. The compact distinction is:

> **Blindness is the negative moment: what the person can no longer see, formulate, or name. *Dummheit* is the positive occupation of that vacancy: authorized formulas speak and judge in the person's place.**

Weak inattention or one blind spot is not yet *Dummheit*. The stronger candidate mechanism requires inhibited self-authored articulation and predictable replacement by authorized classification in the activated domain; wider claims require evidence of domain spread, synchronization, conduct, enforcement, and persistence.

Bonhoeffer's distinction between ***Belehrung*** and ***Befreiung*** adds a correction boundary that the mechanism must preserve. He argues that the condition cannot normally be overcome by instruction alone and that genuine inner liberation often becomes possible only after external liberation has preceded it. Culture Mechanics translates that claim structurally rather than clinically: supplying a better proposition to the rider may leave the social penalties, trusted routing, apparent unanimity, repeated slogans, and affective reinforcement that continually regenerate the protected classification unchanged. Liberation in this bounded sense reopens the conditions under which a person can sustain their own questions, remain with anomalous experience, encounter plural sources, and form an insight; it does not predetermine which answer they must reach.

This also requires two recovery clocks. Public rules, permissible speech, authoritative channels, and visible conduct can change faster than the person's accumulated affective and semantic organization. The postwar OMGUS attitude series is a bounded illustration: after the Nazi state's defeat, approximately half of respondents in the American occupation zone still described National Socialism as a good idea badly carried out, with the reported figure reaching

55 percent in August 1947. Samuel Clowes Huneke's "The Democratization Paradox" supplies the related historical hypothesis that democratic habits could precede deeply internalized democratic meaning. These observations support the distinction between release from a closed social field and later internal reconstruction, not a claim that occupation itself produced one mechanism, that changed conduct proves changed conviction, or that external coercion is a general licence for cultural reprogramming. Removing a closed transmitter can make inquiry possible without making recovery immediate or its eventual conclusion controllable.

At whole-polity scale, Bonhoeffer's power–*Dummheit* relation is the originating epistemic bridge to the project's functional definition of Fascism. Concentrated directing power cannot itself perceive, administer, reproduce, and act through an entire polity. It becomes socially executable when distributed carriers and a population deprived of inner independence repeat its formulas, apply its classifications, perform its administration, and enforce its direction. The resulting feedback strengthens the power whose field helped produce the population-side *Dummheit*. This is a functional dependency, not an assertion of equal responsibility between rulers, carriers, and coerced participants.

The historical baseline and the theoretical application must remain distinct. The United States Holocaust Memorial Museum's biographical account documents Bonhoeffer's theological and ecumenical activity, opposition to Nazi church policy, connections to resistance, and 1943 arrest. Its broader account of non-Jewish resistance also distinguishes individual theologians such as Bonhoeffer from church hierarchies that supported or acquiesced in the regime. Those facts do not directly measure anyone's local bigOther or establish the mechanism proposed below.

The **culture-mechanical application hypothesis** is that Bonhoeffer's one local bigOther executed a densely braided Christian mythological lens to which he was deeply loyal. That Christian weave could incorporate compatible packages such as a *Berufsethos*, familial responsibility, intellectual discipline, pastoral duty, and responsibility toward the concrete neighbour. They did not stand beside Christianity as independent evaluators or compete with it for supremacy; their operative meaning was produced within the one Christianly programmed weave.

National Socialism did not offer one more compatible package. On the originating verdict stated in "The single-slot principle," its governing classifications were deeply incompatible with an intact Christian weave. Nazi capture would therefore have required replacement rather than ranking:

```
INCUMBENT CHRISTIAN BRAID
God, truth, neighbour, church, obedience, responsibility, practice
                          ↓
LOOSEN AND UNBRAID LOAD-BEARING BINDINGS
detach authorities, meanings, loyalties, sentiments, and defences
                          ↓
LIMINAL INSTABILITY OR DEPENDENCY
the old weave no longer governs coherently; a successor is not yet secure
                          ↓
REBRAID RETAINED AND NEW STRANDS
bind Christian remnants, Volk, race, Führer, nation, ritual, and sanction
                          ↓
ONE NAZI-GOVERNED SUCCESSOR WEAVE
```

Where such capture succeeded in a pastor or priest, continued use of scripture, Christian vocabulary, ritual, office, or self-description would not by itself show that an intact Christian program survived below a higher-ranked Nazi program. The material could have been detached from its previous relations and rewoven into one Nazi-Christian successor lens. Whether and how this occurred in any particular person remains a historical and biographical question, not something the theory may infer from conformity alone.

The corresponding hypothesis about Bonhoeffer is that this unbraiding did not succeed. His deep loyalty, theological work, Christian practice, relationships, alternative authorities, and encounters with persecuted people may have maintained or repaired the incumbent braid. A supporting counterfield did not provide a second PCI card; it helped the installed Christian programming resist loosening and replacement. National Socialist signals could consequently be classified through that existing weave as idolatry, falsehood, or injury to the concrete neighbour rather than being processed as commands from a higher-ranked political identity. This is a proposed explanation of the historical contrast, not a direct measurement of Bonhoeffer's inner architecture or proof about clergy as a class.

Culture mechanics interprets Dummheit as a condition in which:

1. the bigOther has acquired meta-authority;

2. contaminated mindware—that is, defective mythologies and lens mappings—supplies protected beliefs, misdirected sentiments, and anti-evaluation rules;
3. social power supplies rewards, sanctions, repetition, and apparent consensus; and
4. the main CPU is recruited to execute and defend the resulting classifications.

Normopathie and political ponerology: two faces of captured culture Culture mechanics treats **Normopathie** and **political ponerology** as complementary perspectives on a captured cultural system. They are not identical concepts. They describe the same pathological configuration from different social positions:

- **Normopathie** describes the population-side result. People over-adapt to a pathological social normality and cease to recognize it as pathological. Their local bigOthers defer to authorities, prestige sources, reference groups, and apparent consensus; borrowed classifications may then crystallize into moral emotions and eventually feel like an autonomous conscience.
- **Political ponerology** describes the formation and exploitation of destructive political power. Its concepts of **spellbinders**, ponerogenic processes, and **pathocracy** provide the more precise elite-side vocabulary: manipulative, characterologically destructive, or cynically instrumental actors create, capture, intensify, administer, and profit from a pathological cultural order.

The two faces belong to one culture-mechanical "coin": a **captured distributed bigOther**. On one face are the people living under its spell; on the other are the spellbinders and seducers who shape, exploit, and gain power from it.

```
SPELLBINDERS AND PATHOCRATIC ACTORS
select and manipulate mythologies, symbols, systems, and sanctions
                          ↓
CAPTURED MYTHOLOGICAL LENS / DISTRIBUTED BIGOTHER
defines normality, virtue, loyalty, danger, and deviance
                          ↓
NORMOPATHIC ADAPTATION
borrowed judgment, conformity, Dummheit, denunciation, self-policing
                          ↓
APPARENT CONSENSUS AND DISTRIBUTED ENFORCEMENT
reward the spellbinders and strengthen their control
                          ↻
```

Systems Leadership identifies important channels through which this capture can occur. Systems, symbols, leadership behaviour, and mythologies can be selected or modified so that the resulting mythological lens maps obedience to virtue, dissent to betrayal, dependence to safety, and elite interest to the common good. Political seduction then substitutes identification and affective trust for examination: the seducer offers protection, belonging, moral certainty, or relief from responsibility while seeking access, loyalty, power, and impunity.

The normopathically adapted population is therefore not merely passive. Once local bigOthers have been synchronized, ordinary participants become the distributed execution and enforcement layer of the captured bigOther. They repeat its mythologies, display its classifications, reward conformity, punish dissent, and manufacture the apparent consensus to which other uncertain people defer. A powerful main CPU may assist this process by producing sophisticated rationalizations for directions that the bigOther has already made emotionally compulsory.

The relation is recursive rather than simply top-down. Spellbinders gain a selection advantage in a culture whose lens rewards their methods, while their control over institutions enables them to strengthen that lens. A normopathic culture can arise without a single deliberate architect through decentralized conformity, dependency, and institutional inertia; it can then be captured by ponerological actors. Conversely, a would-be spellbinder cannot sustain a pathocracy without compatible institutions and a sufficiently synchronized population.

In this synthesis, Bonhoeffer's **Dummheit** names a characteristic loss of inner independence on the population side; **Normopathie** names the normalization and social reproduction of that condition; and political ponerology—especially **pathocracy**—names the elite formation and power process that can cultivate and exploit it.

These terms are interpretive cross-references, not interchangeable clinical diagnoses or licenses to pathologize political opponents. Normopathie and political ponerology are not standard mainstream empirical categories, and the culture-mechanical connection proposed here should not be attributed directly to Hans-Joachim Maaz or Andrzej M. Łobaczewski. Its claim is narrower: the concepts illuminate complementary positions within one possible cultural feedback loop.

Kant's inner tribunal and doubled personality Immanuel Kant's account of conscience in *The Metaphysics of Morals*, AA 6:438 and AA 6:439 supplies an independently developed language for a moral phenomenology relevant to homo duplex and bigOther-presence. It does not supply the Culture Mechanics processor or its social explanation.

Kant calls conscience the consciousness of an **"inner court"** (*innerer Gerichtshof*) in which a person's thoughts accuse or excuse one another. Every person, he says, finds themselves:

- observed by an **inner judge** (*innerer Richter*);
- threatened and held in *Respect*, which Kant glosses as respect joined with fear;
- answerable to a power they did not make arbitrarily, but which is incorporated into their being;
- followed by that authority **"like his shadow"**;
- periodically awakened by its **"terrible voice"** even after trying to stupefy or distract themselves; and
- constrained to conduct this business with themselves **"as at the command of another person"** (*als auf den Geheiß einer anderen Person*).

The juridical structure creates a problem. If accused, accuser, and judge were simply the same party in the same capacity, Kant argues, the prosecutor would always lose. Conscience must therefore represent an **other**–an actual or ideal person–as judge. At AA 6:439 Kant names the resulting structure:

> **"Die zwiefache Persönlichkeit … dieses doppelte Selbst"**
>
> **"The doubled personality … this double self."**
>
> *(close project translation)*

The complete footnote is more differentiated than a simple "higher judge versus lower accused" picture. The courtroom contains accuser, accused, legal counsel, and judge. Kant identifies accuser and accused as the same human being *numero idem* while distinguishing their practical capacities. As subject of a moral legislation grounded in freedom, the human being is considered as *homo noumenon* and as **another** relative to the rational sensible human being–*specie diversus*, but only in a practical respect. The inner judge finally issues the verdict whose authority reason can honour only as an unconditional *iubeo* or *veto*.

Kant's affective account matters as much as the courtroom roles. In the *Critique of Practical Reason*, AA 5:73, the moral law strikes down and humiliates self-conceit while becoming an object of the greatest respect. At AA 5:80, its voice makes even the boldest transgressor tremble; respect combines freely submitting one's will with an unavoidable constraint imposed by one's own reason and therefore contains both displeasure and elevation. In the *Groundwork*, AA 4:401, respect is a feeling produced by a concept of reason and the consciousness that the will is subordinated to a law one imposes upon oneself.

This produces an exact comparative tension:

> **For conscience to be autonomous, its authority must be mine. For conscience to judge me, its authority must confront me as another.**

The following mapping keeps the shared explanatory target and the incompatible explanations visible:

Kantian formulation	Culture-mechanical interpretation	Boundary
Inner court, accuser, accused, counsel, and judge	Moral evaluation can be lived as a structured encounter among functionally different positions inside one person	Kant's practical roles are not empirical processors or several local bigOthers
Observed, threatened, and held in respect joined with fear	Affective classification can make authority present, inescapable, and conduct-directing	Kant derives respect from practical reason; he does not explain it as social programming
The authority was not made arbitrarily and follows like a shadow	Installed authority can feel discovered or incorporated rather than voluntarily invented	For Kant this is an original moral predisposition, not evidence of a culturally installed lens
Business with oneself conducted as at the command of another person	A local moral authority can be encountered in the second-person form of bigOther-as-Thou	Kant's represented other may be actual or ideal and belongs to his practical-rational account, not the Culture Mechanics bigOther

Kantian formulation	Culture-mechanical interpretation	Boundary
Doubled personality / double self	An independent philosophical description of functional non-unitarity relevant to homo duplex	It is neither a clinical split personality nor an identity with the main-CPU/local-bigOther architecture
***Homo noumenon* and the rational sensible human being**	The comparison invites separate analysis of the authorizing position and the person subject to affect, inclination, and consequence	*Homo noumenon* is not the local bigOther, and the sensible human being is not simply the main CPU
Terrible voice and unconditional *iubeo* or *veto*	Moral programming can become agentified, command-like, and phenomenologically authoritative	The ordinary local bigOther need not speak, personify itself, or produce auditory experience

Kant, Durkheim, and Culture Mechanics offer different accounts of this overlapping phenomenological target. The following table isolates the moral-authority relation and must not be read as reducing Durkheim's broader social-intellectual-moral pole to morality alone; that source boundary is developed in "Durkheimian dualism and the Culture Mechanics decomposition":

Account	Source and authority of the moral encounter
Kant	Autonomous practical reason represents the ideal judge and gives itself universally binding moral law
Durkheim	Within a broader socially derived intellectual and moral pole, society's sacred moral ideal confronts the individual through collective beliefs and sentiments
Culture Mechanics hypothesis	A local bigOther executes a socially installed moral lens and can present its authority as an observing and judging Thou; a live collective field may amplify and renew that local operation

The safe comparative formulation is:

> **Kant's *zwiefache Persönlichkeit* independently describes a moral phenomenology in which one numerically identical person occupies distinct practical positions and an internally rooted authority confronts the sensible person as an observing, judging other. Culture Mechanics models a structurally similar relation through homo duplex and bigOther-presence. Kant explains the authority as autonomous practical reason; Culture Mechanics hypothesizes a culturally programmed local bigOther. The comparison identifies a shared explanatory target, not a shared ontology or empirical confirmation.**

The comparison supports neither a historical claim nor an inference to collective agency. A severe Kantian conscience could remain locally active after the culture that formed or reinforced it had disappeared. Inner observation, command, guilt, or awe establishes at most the phenomenology of local presence. A **multi-mind-self** additionally requires a distributed system with sufficiently integrated perception, memory, judgment, intention, ownership, learning, action, and continuity. Explaining how a law becomes psychologically gripping would also not by itself establish the law's moral validity.

Jaynes, Bach, and agentified collective enactment Julian Jaynes's *The Origin of Consciousness in the Breakdown of the Bicameral Mind* and Joscha Bach's "Synthetic Sentience" provide neighbouring models for two different levels of agentified enactment. Jaynes hypothesized an older mentality in which action-guiding products were experienced as the auditory commands of gods rather than as self-authored deliberation. Bach describes selves and gods as implemented agents and develops the possibility of a multi-mind-self enacted across several human minds. Culture Mechanics does not adopt either complete theory. It uses their conjunction to ask how a culturally represented agent can become locally present and distributedly operative.

The local authorial relation is called **We-mode enactment** when a particular culturally constituted *we* becomes operative through the Durkheimian social-intellectual-moral pole and supplies the classifications, purposes, obligations, and standpoint from which the biological person thinks and acts. The person supplies local perception, memory, calculation, language, and bodily execution, but in the stronger absorbed episode the *we* occupies the authorized

subject-position. Duty, professional correctness, historical necessity, and "what must be done" can instantiate this relation without auditory voices or explicit personification.

We-mode enactment can be local and momentary. It does not by itself establish a continuing multi-mind-self, collective phenomenal consciousness, permanent subjecthood absorption, or the truth of the enacted authority. The relevant asymmetry can nevertheless be severe. **Asymmetric personal address** names the relation in which the carrier experiences a collective or represented authority as a Thou that sees, knows, loves, judges, or commands, while the collective formation registers the carrier principally as a member, office, resource, instrument, or obstacle:

> **Upward, the collective is personified; downward, the person is componentized.**

This asymmetry also separates personal attention from functional salience. One carrier's death ends an entire lived world, while the distributed formation may register little functional change. A leader or specialist may receive intense collective attention because their loss disrupts a function, and an ordinary carrier's death may be converted into a martyr-symbol that renews solidarity. Neither functional notice nor symbolic reuse establishes reciprocal personal care for the person who was lost. Experienced personal address from below does not establish reciprocal personal care from above. Even a programme that prescribes care enacts actual care only through concrete persons.

Neighbouring proposal	Culture-mechanical interpretation	Boundary
Jaynesian bicameral mentality	A possible highly agentified, command-like operating regime of homo duplex	It is not a synonym for homo duplex and is not required by the architecture.
Divine auditory commands	Cultural programming experienced as bigOther-presence or bigOther-as-Thou and attributed to a god-agent	The local bigOther normally classifies affectively and need not generate auditory voices.
Commands not experienced as self-authored	Weak personal authorship, deep capture, or possible subjecthood absorption	Obedience and presence alone do not establish total fusion.
Several gods addressing one person	Several compatible divine agent-models held within one pantheonic mythological weave and activated by situation, ritual, role, or place	This need not install several local bigOthers or violate single-slot exclusivity.
Bach's god or top-level agent implemented across minds	A distributed bigOther that can produce a multi-mind-self presentation and may cross the further threshold into collective perception, memory, judgment, intention, ownership, and action	Shared representation and synchronized devotion alone remain below the operative multi-mind-self threshold.
Human alignment and collective agency	Coupling, compatible programming, functional integration, and collective-agent formation	Alignment is not one scalar and does not establish truth, goodness, jurisdiction, corrigibility, or fusion.

The safe comparative formulation is:

> **Jaynesian bicameral mentality can be interpreted as a culturally produced, highly agentified, command-like operating mode of homo duplex in which the culturally programmed second side becomes phenomenologically present as one or more gods and receives action-guiding authority otherwise attributed to an autobiographical self.**

The less historically committed name **bicameral-like enactment** refers to that possible regime without accepting Jaynes's dating, universal scope, philology, or neurological explanation. Jaynes emphasizes intrapersonal phenomenology; Bach emphasizes distributed implementation; Culture Mechanics proposes a functional bridge:

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shared mythology of a god
→ god-agent represented in local mythological lenses
→ agentified Beseelung and presence as Thou
→ coordinated enactment through several persons and institutions
→ distributed bigOther
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→ god-as-multi-mind-self presentation
→ possible operative god-as-multi-mind-self
→ social confirmation of the god's local presence
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The god-agent can acquire functional perception through adherents, memory through scripture and tradition, judgment through compatible local bigOthers, speech through persons and institutions, intention through ritual or decision procedures, ownership through sacred or common objects, and action through coordinated bodies. This implementation can remain differentiated. It becomes fused when the collectively enacted subject displaces participating persons as independently legitimate authors.

A pantheon is compatible with the single-slot principle when its gods are agent-personae with differentiated jurisdictions inside one operative weave. A ritual or situation can activate one persona without changing the processor. Incompatible top-level packages contesting the same load-bearing classifications still require rejection or replacement under single-slot exclusivity.

These comparisons have strict evidential limits. A multidisciplinary critical reappraisal identifies neurological and philological problems in Jaynes's proposal while treating the non-unitary self as an important legacy. Ancient texts rarely decide whether a reported god-voice was an auditory experience, ritual language, literary convention, political legitimation, or some combination. Resemblance to Jaynes or Bach therefore does not validate the local-bigOther architecture, prove a history of consciousness, reduce theological beings to human artifacts, or make every religion, ritual, shared intention, or synchronized group a multi-mind-self.

Theological interpretation: Word, Incarnation, Christian We, and the satanic hack **Status:** conditional Christian theological interpretation built upon the Culture Mechanics architecture. It is neither an empirical proof of God nor a reduction of God to collective psychology.

The governing construction is:

> **If human We-mode is part of the embodied capacity through which the Christian God addresses human beings through the Word, and if Incarnation and Cross disclose the proper direction of that capacity, then collective authority is legitimate only while it remains subordinate to concrete, non-fungible persons. A Culture Program that captures this capacity, impersonates divine authority, demands human submission, and consumes persons for its own preservation can then be interpreted as a satanic hack of a created capacity.**

The hypothesis begins from incarnation rather than from an opposition between spirit and biological embodiment. Human receptivity to language, shared meaning, authority, ritual, and collective address is implemented through flesh-and-blood persons and their social-intellectual-moral pole. Discovering a biological, psychological, or pharmacological implementation would therefore not by itself decide whether the perceived referent is real. The development analogy is thirst: artificial stimulation can produce a thirst experience, but the possibility of simulation neither proves nor disproves the existence of water. Correspondingly, religious intensity does not authenticate its claimed source, while mediation through brain and culture does not by itself disprove that source.

> **Intensity shows that the experiential apparatus is active; it does not identify what activated it.**

The resulting task is calibration rather than either reduction or credulity. An immediate experience of presence, awe, love, dread, unity, or surrender must remain distinguishable from the DCL interpretation that names its source as God, a calling, a command, or a particular revelation. Alternative causes, false positives, independent knowledge, consequences, openness to correction, and the possibility of internally generated experience therefore remain relevant even when the experience is sincere and intense. Within this conditional Christian interpretation, the moral calibration also asks whether the attributed command preserves conscience and refusal, widens who can become You, and makes authority bear sacrifice rather than merely demand it.

Within the Christian interpretation, five scriptural motifs specify the direction in which divine authority relates to persons:

Christian motif	Theological claim	Culture-mechanical implication
The numbered hairs (Matthew 10:29–31; Luke 12:6–7)	No detail of the individual falls below God's attention threshold.	Scale must not collapse person-resolution.
The lost sheep (Matthew 18:12–14; Luke 15:3–7)	One person is not negligible beside the ninety-nine.	Aggregate continuation cannot make one carrier disposable by definition.

Christian motif	Theological claim	Culture-mechanical implication
The Good Samaritan (Luke 10:25–37)	The outsider can become neighbour through concrete encounter.	A We-boundary cannot finally determine who is eligible to become You.
The Word made flesh (John 1:1–14)	Logos enters concrete bodily existence rather than remaining an abstract command above it.	Shared word and embodied particularity are joined rather than opposed.
The Cross (especially John 11:49–52; Philippians 2:5–11)	The collective logic voiced by Caiaphas gives one person for the people; the Christian confession identifies that victim with the incarnate God, whose self-giving reverses ordinary sacrificial sovereignty.	God occupies the sacrificial position rather than licensing the collective to preserve itself by sacrificing the dissenter.

The incarnational direction can be stated more sharply:

The Word becomes flesh rather than demanding that flesh disappear into the Word.

Three allied motifs extend the same test from divine attention to collective form:

Christian motif	Theological claim	Culture-mechanical implication
The Sabbath made for the human being (Mark 2:27)	Sacred rule is ordered toward the person rather than the person existing as material for the rule.	Institution, office, and rule remain person-serving rather than becoming sovereign ends.
One body with differentiated members (1 Corinthians 12:12–27)	Unity can coordinate irreducibly different members without making them interchangeable.	Collective integration need not require subjecthood absorption or homogenization.
Pentecost (Acts 2:1–11)	Common address becomes intelligible across distinct languages rather than abolishing their plurality.	Shared meaning can increase interoperability without requiring one flattened voice.

Together they support the theological compression:

No person is too small to be noticed, too few to be sought, or too foreign to become You.

They also distinguish two different claims to comprehensive vision. A collective panoptic eye may register every carrier while seeing each chiefly as a classified case, member, deviant, asset, or threat. The Christian personal-gaze claim is that divine scale preserves the irreducible particularity of each person rather than lowering that person below the threshold of notice.

The **Christian We** is the collective form implied by that compression. It can mediate scripture, memory, worship, correction, education, mutual aid, and coordinated action, but it is a mediator rather than the final sovereign. It must point beyond its own institutional voice both to God and to the concrete neighbour whom its classifications may have missed. It is structurally self-subordinating: its continuation, reach, prestige, and institutional self-preservation cannot become the highest good. It must remain interruptible by one injured person, one lost person, an outsider, conscience, refusal, suffering, adverse reality, and the encounter that defeats its classification. Its collective *kenosis* consists in relinquishing claimed supremacy and accepting contraction, loss, or sacrifice rather than making another person's body the price of its victory.

Self-subordination does not give every outsider unlimited jurisdiction over the community or require passivity toward aggression. Personal standing and authority to command are different relations. It does require that concern for salvation cannot erase present conscience or turn refusal into permission for coercive incorporation. Witness, persuasion, service, example, and freely received Word can extend a Christian We; force may produce compliance or membership records, but it cannot produce authentic faith. A person-preserving We therefore protects the conditions under which an outsider can become You before becoming one of Us and under which actual embodied love can occur; it does not replace that love with benevolent classification.

This yields a sharp structural contrast:

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CHRISTIAN THEOLOGICAL PATTERN
God gives himself for persons
→ collective authority becomes self-subordinating
→ the outsider may still become You
→ the We may have to lose rather than consume the dissenter

SACRIFICIAL RELIGIOUS OR IDEOLOGICAL PATTERN
the collective or its god presents its command as ultimate authority
→ submission authenticates belonging
→ refusal wounds the sacred boundary
→ the refusing person becomes expendable
→ sacrifice restores and proves collective sovereignty
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The **satanic hack** is the conditional Christian name for the second pattern. It is not shared language, collective life, authority, religious experience, or We-mode as such. It is the capture and impersonation of the highest authority by a programme that makes its own voice indistinguishable from conscience, converts obedience into proof of truth, forbids legitimate exit, and claims authority to dispose of the persons through whom it acts. In that configuration, the collective word takes possession of human bodies, displaces their answerable authorship, and demands that persons be given for it.

This interpretation also sharpens the Jaynes–Bach comparison. A collectively enacted god can "see" through classifications and treat the loss of one carrier like the unnoticed loss of a hair. The Christian claim that every hair is numbered states the opposite scalar relation: divine magnitude does not entail low-resolution knowledge of the person. Theological personal address is therefore not established by the carrier's felt experience of being watched, loved, judged, or commanded; reciprocity is tested by whether the claimed authority preserves the non-fungible person's standing, including under refusal and exit.

Under this conditional Christian premise, Islam is the developed contemporary representative of a broader comparative theological class rather than the only possible instance. Egyptian, Greek, Norse, and other mythological divine programmes can likewise be interpreted as counterfeit occupations of created receptivity where gods or sacred orders demand persons, costly submission, or human sacrifice for their own power and continuation. The broad theological classification does not imply that those traditions share one historical mechanism. Culture-mechanical case classification still requires the particular command, boundary, institution, enforcement route, and sacrificial operation to be shown. The worked canonical-classical Islamic apostasy application appears in *Culture Program Ecology*, "Theological interpretation: canonical-classical apostasy law and the satanic-hack classification".

Historical Christian collectivities can violate the Christian pattern. Such a violation does not dissolve the structural contrast; within this interpretation it means that a Christian institution or movement has itself been captured by the sacrificial operation that the Incarnation and Cross oppose. Catherine of Siena's crusade advocacy is treated below as an internal Christian stress test rather than as an exception silently removed from the comparison.

Four source roles must remain visible:

1. **Scriptural text** supplies the cited motifs and their narrative relations.
2. **Christian doctrinal synthesis** interprets Logos, Incarnation, Cross, and divine attention as one person-preserving pattern.
3. **Culture Mechanics** maps that pattern onto We-mode, personhood routing, scalar personhood collapse, exit sovereignty, and sacrificial boundary repair.
4. **Historical application** asks what a named institution, law, movement, or actor actually taught and did.

Neither a theological classification alone nor resemblance to a myth settles the historical application. Conversely, keeping those source roles separate must not be used to withhold the theological conclusion after its stated conditional premise and factual application gates have been accepted.

Summary cross-reference table

Related concept	Primary question	Relation to culture mechanics
Autonomous mind	What fast default response is generated?	Part of the ordinary brain and elephant, not the bigOther; the collar can alter its affective inputs and direction.

Related concept	Primary question	Relation to culture mechanics
Algorithmic mind	Is there sufficient computational capacity?	Corresponds most closely to the processing power of the main CPU.
Reflective mind	Will reflective processing be initiated, and under which goals and dispositions?	Corresponds to the CPU's governing and self-corrective activity, represented partly by the rider.
Cognitive miserliness	Was reflective processing avoided?	The CPU accepts an easy response without inspecting the elephant or collar.
Override failure	Was a detected default unsuccessfully suppressed?	The CPU engages but fails to overcome a strongly weighted elephant or bigOther response.
Mindware gap	Is a rational tool missing?	The main CPU lacks the learned rule needed to construct a corrective response.
Contaminated mindware	Has acquired mindware corrupted rational judgment?	For culture mechanics, this is a bigOther executing a defective mythological lens that uses strong sentiments and evaluation-disabling rules to steer the CPU away from epistemic or instrumental rationality.
Dysrationalia	Why can adequate intelligence coexist with irrationality?	The bigOther is one possible source of direction or inhibition independent of CPU power.
Motivated reasoning	How do desired conclusions bias reasoning?	The main CPU reasons directionally under affective priorities that the bigOther may supply.
Identity-protective cognition	How does group identity bias judgment?	The wireless collar attaches belonging, status, and exclusion to conclusions.
Sacred values and taboo trade-offs	Which comparisons are morally prohibited?	The bigOther determines what may not be questioned, priced, or compromised.
Actively open-minded thinking	Can the person seek disconfirmation and revise?	Healthy mindware helps the main CPU inspect the bigOther's output.
Master signifier	Which symbol organizes a field of meaning?	A highly compressed protocol token can activate a cluster of mythologies and mappings already present in the mythological lens.
Bonhoefferian Dummheit	How does social power displace inner independence?	Describes large-scale capture of judgment by a power-saturated bigOther.
Normopathie	How does a population adapt to and reproduce a pathological normality?	Describes the population-side condition in which a captured bigOther supplies borrowed judgment, conformity, and distributed enforcement.
Political ponerology / pathocracy	How do destructive actors form, capture, and exploit political power?	Describes the elite-side actors and selection processes that can program, administer, and profit from a captured distributed bigOther.

Related concept	Primary question	Relation to culture mechanics
Kantian inner tribunal and doubled personality	How can an authority within one person be experienced as observing, judging, and commanding that person as another?	Supplies an independent philosophical description of the local moral phenomenology; Kant's practical roles and noumenal account do not establish the main-CPU/local-bigOther architecture or a social source.
Jaynesian bicameral mentality	How might culturally generated guidance be experienced as the commands of gods rather than self-authored thought?	Supplies a controversial intrapersonal limit model for agentified, command-like homo duplex; it does not define the ordinary local bigOther.
Bachian god-as-multi-mind-self	How might one represented agent be implemented across several minds and bodies?	Supplies a distributed-agent neighbour; Culture Mechanics adds its local processor, field formation, functional threshold, fusion axis, and metaphysical boundary.
Conditional Christian theological interpretation	What would distinguish God-address through embodied We-mode from a collective impersonation of divine authority?	Word, Incarnation, Cross, and the person-preserving motifs define the Christian We as self-subordinating; submission-as-proof, prohibited exit, and disposal authority define the satanic-hack contrast under the stated premise.
Radermacherian superorganism	How can interacting persons, institutions, information systems, and technical infrastructure produce capacities attributable to a higher-order system?	Supplies a neighbouring systems architecture for differentiated higher-order performance; it does not by itself establish an operative multi-mind-self, collective phenomenal consciousness, fusion, or legitimate jurisdiction over the components.

20. Scope and terminological cautions

Culture mechanics is a proposed synthetic term, not the established name of a single accepted scientific theory. It combines ideas associated with social psychology, Durkheimian sociology, Lacanian psychoanalysis, Systems Leadership, narrative theory, cybernetics, distributed cognition, cultural evolution, and systems theory.

Its computer and wireless-collar descriptions are functional models, not claims that the brain literally contains a PCI card or a separately identifiable anatomical collar processor. Its charged-particle, field, laser, wireless, and computing comparisons describe proposed relations and generate hypotheses; they do not assert that social processes are physically electromagnetic or obey the equations of the source domains.

The **culture propagator**, its typed seven-component cultural state, the six non-scalar dynamic descriptors, feedback-boundary handoffs, and their integration with the present architecture are project-developed formulations. *Propagator*, state-transition, quotient, attractor, basin, bifurcation, remanence, and hysteresis borrow mathematical or physical relations under the controlled limits in the analogy inventory. They do not attribute a universal social differential equation, fixed landscape, or quantitative parameterization to the source domains. The model-form neutrality and distinction among coordinate, observational, and causal-dynamical equivalence are likewise project modeling rules rather than claims borrowed from one source-domain formalism.

Its use of **homo duplex** extends Durkheim. Durkheim's socially derived pole includes language, concepts, rational activity, and morality; it is therefore broader than the local bigOther and cuts across the project's main CPU, shared symbolic protocol, reconstruction resources, local classifier, and distributed field. The project supplies that decomposition and the proposed semantic-access path. Its use of **bigOther** operationalizes and modifies Lacan. Its protocol interpretation isolates one functional aspect of Lacan's symbolic order rather than exhausting the concept. **bigOther-presence** and **bigOther-as-Thou** borrow phenomenological cues from James and Buber without attributing

the proposed processor or field mechanism to either thinker. These inherited terms name important sources of the model but should not be mistaken for exact summaries of their doctrines.

Relevant structure and the underlying connection between experienced moral good or evil and represented structural support or damage are adapted from Dushan Wegner's *Relevante Strukturen*. The typed relational definition, the separation of felt relevance, represented effect, actual effect, generative centrality, and normative standing, the multidimensional account of strengthening, and the placement of the appraisal inside the homo-duplex and single-slot architecture are Culture Mechanics extensions. They should not be attributed to Wegner as his own distinctions. The named change-indexed moral-mobilization hypothesis is likewise a project-developed operationalization of Wegner's emphasis on change, not his own formal construct.

Kant's inner court, inner judge, doubled personality, double self, *homo noumenon*, and affective account of respect are neighbouring philosophical descriptions, not the Culture Mechanics architecture and not empirical confirmation of it. Kant locates moral authority in autonomous practical reason, not in a socially programmed local bigOther. The project comparison isolates a shared phenomenological problem–an internally rooted authority confronting the person as another–while retaining the conflict between their explanations.

Jaynes's bicameral mind and Bach's implemented multi-mind-self are neighbouring theories, not analogies or empirical confirmation. The term *multi-mind-self* in this project is taken from Bach. Culture Mechanics adds the distinction between a multi-mind-self presentation, an operative multi-mind-self that crosses an explicit functional threshold, and a fused multi-mind-self, together with the family-level shorthand rule stated above. The bicameral-like comparison is narrower than Jaynes's historical theory and must not be used to claim that ancient people universally lacked consciousness or an individual mind.

The **Christian We**, **collective *kenosis***, and **satanic hack** are project-developed terms within an explicitly conditional Christian theological interpretation. The numbered-hairs, lost-sheep, Good-Samaritan, Sabbath, differentiated-body, Pentecost, Incarnation, Caiaphas, Cross, and related scriptural motifs are source texts; their integration into one person-preserving, differentiated-unity contrast and their mapping onto We-mode, scalar personhood, exit sovereignty, and collective sacrifice are the project's theological synthesis. The framework neither attributes that synthesis to Jaynes, Bach, Durkheim, or one biblical author nor presents it as an empirical demonstration of a transcendent referent. The thirst analogy preserves that epistemic boundary: mediation or artificial elicitation does not disprove a referent, while experiential intensity does not authenticate one. The separation of immediate experience from DCL interpretation and the listed calibration questions are project developments rather than an authenticated Huberman attribution.

Radermacher's superorganism is likewise a neighbouring systems proposal rather than the source of the Culture Mechanics ontology. His layered information- processing, institutional, and technical account helps specify how a distributed system might acquire higher-order capability, while Culture Mechanics separately defines the operative multi-mind-self threshold and the subjecthood-absorption axis. His superorganism, communication-network, queen/bottleneck, and ant-state claims must therefore be reported in their own source roles rather than combined and attributed back to him as an AI queen-bee theory.

The theory's three constitutive commitments each carry an explanatory burden. The local bigOther is functionally distinct from the main CPU; the distributed field is emergent from relations among persons, communications, institutions, practices, and artifacts; and the single-slot principle permits a modular weave of compatible packages while denying parallel operative evaluators. Under the third commitment, first-order and lifted programming both fully occupy the slot; order level distinguishes shared concrete answers from a shared generator of answers; a lifted generator may govern universally while constituting limited subordinate jurisdictions; and corrigibility must be evaluated independently. These claims should produce comparative explanations and possible tests. None licenses an immaterial substance, erases the responsibility and causal contribution of biological persons, or proves that every apparent conflict of allegiance is a completed worldview replacement.

The single-slot commitment is therefore defeasible in principle. A stable case of two incompatible evaluators remaining independently final over the same conduct, each generating its own affect, veto, and correction without hierarchy, reinterpretation, contextual division, or a third governing rule, would count against it. This defeat condition should not be neutralized after the fact by calling every such observation a complex braid.

The framework also does not claim that cultural programming determines behaviour mechanically. Humans interpret, combine, resist, conceal, question, and change symbolic instructions. The model proposes structured influence, not perfect control.

Inherent human standing and the **recognition-only principle** are project-developed normative commitments. They do not claim that biology by itself yields a moral conclusion, that Durkheim or Kant supplied the fertilization

boundary, or that present positive law already implements the axiom consistently. The empirical bearer premise, the normative human-standing rule, and any legal implementation must remain separately visible.

Culture-mechanical object, **ideological symbol**, **conformity signal**, **targeting signal**, the four person–programme forms, the outward propagation and enforcement profile, **jealous cultural program**, **enforcement–exclusion duality**, **protection-framed jurisdictional manoeuvre**, and the combined signal–moralization–jurisdiction mechanism are project-developed constructs. **Situated cultural script**, **script viability**, **script load-bearingness**, and **cross-script cascade** are likewise project-developed Culture Mechanics terms developed from Rao's neighbouring account of learned scripts, meaning, material support, and unraveling. Rao does not supply the one-slot architecture, the cultural-braid hierarchy, or the distinction between script repair and governing-weave replacement. The originating author supplied the cross-environment competence problem through the contrast between asymmetric and industrial peer warfare; the assistant abstracted it as **domain-transfer failure**. The remembered categorical colonial-officer episode remains unverified and is not part of the construct. The four forms are ideal types rather than a validated scale. Andrick supplies the theory of moralization attributed to him; the processor, protocol, field, jealousy, and ideology-as-hallucination extensions belong to Culture Mechanics. Whole religion classifications and the Iran end-state claim are explicit hypotheses, not facts established by the definitions themselves. Gregory H. Stanton supplies the neighbouring genocidal-process model attributed to him, not the targeting-signal definition or the culture-mechanical causal ontology.

An observed symbol does not by itself disclose the carrier's private intention, degree of belief, or complete program. The same token can be voluntary, coerced, devotional, propagating, targeting, jurisdictional, resistant, or multiply functional in different settings. Target status can be made legible through performance, absence, imposition, or attribution. The relevant evidence includes who is expected to perform the token, who assigns it, who may refuse, how absence is interpreted, what sanctions follow, which jurisdiction is claimed, and what the program does after acquiring power.

Finally, describing culture as programming does not imply that all symbolic reality is false. Money, law, office, obligation, legitimacy, and dignity are symbolically constituted but socially consequential realities. Culture mechanics distinguishes such constitutive social meanings from factual claims about physical reality, which remain answerable to evidence.

Semantic summary

- **Broader class:** theory of cultural causation and social coordination.
- **Central object:** the culturally programmed bigOther in the homo-duplex individual.
- **Primary operation:** sentiment classification.
- **Dynamic evolution model:** the culture propagator is a scale-declared, history-bearing state-transition operator over operative representations, persons, collective field, carrying structure, worldly consequences, sensing and correction, and retained memory. Adversarial steering is one possible forcing regime rather than its defining form.
- **Dynamic modeling boundary:** state, parameter, input, disturbance, and observation must be declared at the chosen scale; continuous, discrete, stochastic, agent-based, network, and historical-process forms are alternative realizations rather than rival definitions; a quotient is valid only when discarded differences do not change the relevant successor relation; and each proposed handoff requires separate temporal and causal support.
- **Dynamic non-inference:** stability, persistence, reproduction, causal efficacy, and transition do not by themselves establish truth, legitimacy, fit, progress, centralized design, or actor intent; an open actor gate does not erase independently supported lower-layer dynamics.
- **Durkheimian source boundary:** Durkheim's social pole includes collective language, concepts, rational activity, and morality; Culture Mechanics decomposes that broad pole across the rider/main CPU, public symbolic and codebook resources, local-bigOther classification, and field back-action rather than identifying it with the collar alone.
- **Distributed-milieu boundary:** the distributed bigOther is the emergent symbolic–affective network state, while the distributed epistemic milieu is the dispersed environment of concepts, methods, examples, records, instruments, trained persons, and correction practices used by ordinary rider/main-CPU cognition. They can share carriers without becoming one mechanism, collective brain, or additional processor.
- **Proposed semantic-access reach:** the local bigOther does not reason or search memory, but its classification signal may condition whether rider-side retrieval, joining, standing-query activation, and articulation continue.
- **Narrative unit:** one mythology—one socially evaluated narrative or story; *narrative* is the broader ordinary-language term and often its fuzzy synonym.

- **Narrative corpus:** mythologies—the accumulated stories that train cultural evaluation.
- **Installed evaluative program:** the mythological lens shaped by those mythologies and reinforced by systems, symbols, practices, and institutions.
- **Situated cultural script:** a distributed, role-, institution-, or situation-indexed executable braid that translates selected parts of the operative cultural weave into detailed expectations, routines, permissions, interfaces, improvisations, and practical support.
- **Abstraction and execution:** the cultural braid is broader and more abstract; a script is narrower but more concretely specified; a local script variant is one implementation; an enactment is one performance, modification, or refusal.
- **Script viability and unraveling:** viability asks whether cultural meaning still generates intelligible and practically supportable conduct; unraveling is the mutually reinforcing loss of meaning-side and practical-side coherence. Neither establishes truth, legitimacy, flourishing, or slot vacancy.
- **Domain-transfer failure:** genuine competence, a viable script, or a reliable practice from one environment can fail when transferred under an untested assumption that its load-bearing regularities remain valid in a materially different environment. The mechanism is distinct from apparent competence and requires a consequential source–target mismatch rather than novelty alone.
- **Script propagation:** peripheral script failure may be repaired within the incumbent braid, while failure of load-bearing or mutually dependent scripts can create a cross-script cascade and contribute to cultural unbraiding.
- **Relevant structure:** a represented relational arrangement or organized condition that the installed lens treats as carrying moral weight.
- **Relevant-structure appraisal hypothesis:** people often experience represented support for a felt-relevant structure as good and represented damage as evil; felt relevance, represented effect, actual effect, generative centrality, and normative standing remain distinct.
- **Generative-centrality distinction:** a structure can causally produce capabilities required by many downstream structures without receiving corresponding felt relevance; a cultural sublimation architecture is one proposed case.
- **Generator–architecture distinction:** a lifted sublimation generator selects binding directions; actuation and cultural sublimation architecture make those directions effective and durable. Structural efficacy and positive value remain separate.
- **Change-indexed moral-mobilization hypothesis:** moral appraisal often becomes more salient and action-directing when a condition is represented as causing, continuing, preventing, or failing to prevent change in a felt-relevant structure; this is a testable mobilization pathway, not a complete ontology of ethics.
- **Analytical umbrella:** a culture-mechanical object is a program, carrier, implementation arrangement, processor state, collective formation, or collective agent involved in cultural installation, activation, transmission, execution, synchronization, or enforcement; its subtype must be identified.
- **Religion-inclusive program category:** religions, secular ideologies, company cultures, activist movements, professional cultures, and state programmes are analyzed as members of the same broad family rather than different ontological kinds.
- **Ideological symbol:** a medium-independent socially legible token that activates an installed program and communicates a person's relation to it.
- **Master-signifier analysis grid:** a non-scalar decompression method comparing sacred referent, bearer, protected principal, unity topology, difference operator, distributive grammar, causal story, interpreter custody, authorization, outlier performance, realization, completion, correction, and trajectory.
- **Conformity signal:** an ideological symbol whose performance, absence, refusal, or substitution makes conformity and deviation publicly legible.
- **Targeting signal:** a performed, omitted, imposed, or attributed socially legible token that assigns a person or population to a sanctionable out-group; an absent conformity signal can therefore become a target marker.
- **Person–programme forms:** private, collective, ideological, and fundamentalist; these are ideal-type relations of enrichment, belonging, mission, and instrumental possession, not kinds of bigOther or one necessary developmental staircase.
- **Outward propagation and enforcement profile:** personal discovery, attraction, recruitment, formation, retention pressure, institutional propagation, coercion, and violence are separately observable operations rather than definitions of the four inward forms.
- **Conflict ladder:** propositional, causal-story, and classification conflicts remain distinct from mythological rivalry; active interference creates mythological conflict, incompatible governing lenses create cultural-program conflict, organized recruitment and suppression create propagative conflict, and physical coercion or violence marks coercive conflict.
- **Signal-suppression distinction:** rival-signal or counter-program suppression describes interference with

opposition without analytically reducing rival or corrective signals to random noise.

- **Independent animation axis:** *Beseelung* describes how affectively alive and conduct-directing a program is, analytically distinct from inward person–programme form and outward propagation or violence.
- ***Beseelung* actuation profile:** pressure, duty, aspiration, belonging, love, grievance, fear, shame, joy, play, hope, and other evidenced routes can produce similar intensity while creating different person–programme relations; intensity, actuation, inward form, and outward propagation and enforcement profile remain separate but can be empirically correlated.
- **Obligation accumulation:** many individually weak habits, role expectations, anticipated judgments, reciprocal demands, institutional rules, and anonymous usages can reinforce one another into an apparently unconditional "one must" without one component, designer, or explicit doctrine being sufficient.
- **Affective-to-structural load transfer:** institutionalized habits, roles, procedures, incentives, records, formation, audit, and succession can reduce the affective activation required at each node while extending a program's persistence, reach, and reliable reproduction; this is functional load redistribution rather than literal storage of affect. Visible everyday alignment is therefore a poor proxy for latent collective capacity: distinguish ambient affective coupling, latent structural coupling, and coordination realized under activation.
- **Jealous cultural program:** a program that claims exclusive allegiance and treats incompatible commitment, dissent, or exit as betrayal; single-slot exclusivity alone is not jealousy.
- **Moralized enforcement bridge:** a signal or refusal becomes character disclosure, character accusation attacks civic or social standing, solidarity distributes the judgment, and systems attach exclusion or coercion.
- **Enforcement–exclusion duality:** enforcement conditions continued inclusion, standing, access, or permitted action on conformity; exclusion is the withdrawal or denial applied to refusal, and one visible sanction can perform both operations.
- **Coercive threshold:** authorization or willingness to use physical or eliminative force, not the mere presence of moral evaluation, inward fundamentalist form, or discursive violence.
- **Genocidal escalation neighbour:** Stanton's ten overlapping processes map one possible path from classification and symbolization through discrimination, dehumanization, organization, polarization, preparation, persecution, and extermination to denial; they are not a universal ladder or a synonym for the broader culture-mechanical repertoire.
- **Local processor:** the bigOther that executes the lens.
- **Single-slot constraint:** one local bigOther executes one operative lens; no higher runtime evaluator ranks parallel bigOthers or governing worldviews.
- **Complete slot occupancy / full capture:** a stable first-order or lifted program completely occupies the one slot; *full* does not by itself mean pathological.
- **Order levels:** first-order mechanical solidarity shares concrete rules and answers; lifted mechanical solidarity shares rules that generate, select, apply, and revise concrete answers.
- **Generative relation:** fixed, installed meta-rules combine with current knowledge or inputs and a situation to generate a binding first-order output; generator and output remain parts of one weave.
- **Jurisdictional distinction:** a lifted meta-order may govern universally at its own level while persons, offices, institutions, communities, and contracting parties remain plural and domain-limited beneath it; that pluralism is a consequence or application, not the definition of lifting.
- **Corrigibility axis:** first-order and lifted captures can each be open or closed; epistemic sovereignty, correction failure, interpretive monopoly, and jurisdictional spillover—not rivalry alone—mark pathology.
- **Package compositionality:** compatible religious, professional, familial, national, and local packages can be braided into that one complex lens.
- **Replacement under incompatibility:** an incompatible governing program must be rejected, or the incumbent weave must be unbraided sufficiently for one successor to be rebraided and installed.
- **Three-layer causal distinction:** the historical cause of a rule, its current affective classification, and its presently avowed reason can coincide or diverge and should be measured separately.
- **Bonhoeffer correction boundary:** *Belehrung* supplies propositions; *Befreiung* reopens conditions for self-authored inquiry. Release from a closed social field can precede slower internal reconstruction, and changed conduct does not by itself establish changed conviction.
- **Formation–construction distinction:** endogenous mythology formation is the distributed growth and selection of cultural articulations from changing conditions and a substantive research path in its own right; purposive mythology construction is the prospective study of attempted target-state-guided intervention in that same ecology.
- **Intervention-hypothesis boundary:** mythology may be a privileged symbolic intervention surface, but it is not the whole culture-implementation stack; attempted purposive construction neither places the constructor outside culture nor guarantees the installed successor.
- **Single-slot defeat condition:** stable same-domain operation by two incompatible evaluators that remain

independently final, affectively alive, and mutually ungoverned would count against strict single-slot exclusivity.

- **Phenomenological appearance:** bigOther-presence or bigOther-as-Thou—the collective or symbolic authority encountered as an objectively present Other.
- **Kantian moral-phenomenology neighbour:** the inner court, observing judge, *zwiefache Persönlichkeit*, *doppeltes Selbst*, and unconditional *iubeo* or *veto* independently articulate how one person's moral authority can confront the sensible person as another; Kant's autonomous-rational ontology remains distinct from the local-bigOther hypothesis.
- **Agentified enactment depth:** representation, consultation or service, presence as Thou, distributed enactment, and fused enactment must not be collapsed; only the final relation entails authorial displacement.
- **Established affective target:** the elephant—the intuitive, motivational, largely nonconscious mind.
- **Proposed second output path:** non-transparent conditioning of the rider's semantic-access interface without giving the rider direct read or control access to the collar.
- **Conscious interface:** the rider and the main CPU.
- **Shared communication interface:** Lacan's big Other, functionally translated as the on-the-wire symbolic protocol.
- **Network operation:** reciprocal signalling through the protocol and possible synchronization.
- **Field coherence:** mechanical solidarity.
- **Emergent network state:** the distributed bigOther.
- **Self-like representation:** a multi-mind-self presentation can organize the collective as one represented, perceived, addressed, or incarnated self without establishing agency.
- **Possible collective agent:** the operative multi-mind-self or multi-mind-self proper when integration and continuity pass the relevant threshold.
- **Radermacher superorganism neighbour:** differentiated interacting persons, institutions, information systems, and technical infrastructure can produce higher-order performance without by that fact establishing the operative multi-mind-self threshold, phenomenal collective consciousness, subjecthood absorption, or legitimate comprehensive jurisdiction.
- **Family-level shorthand:** unqualified *multi-mind-self* may be used explanatorily where no threshold inference depends upon it; claims of intention, ownership, responsibility, or fusion require the qualified term.
- **Nested authorship:** a network-level operative multi-mind-self can add an operative *we* while differentiated participating *I*s retain legitimate personal and subordinate jurisdictions; it does not install a second local bigOther.
- **Episodic multi-mind-self:** a distributed bigOther that crosses the collective-agent threshold only during bounded high-integration periods; viable latency, de-animation, and cultural loss remain different inter-episode states.
- **Differentiated unity:** a real shared *we* that preserves distinct persons, functions, judgments, relationships, and legitimate subordinate jurisdictions; **person-preserving unity** emphasizes this boundary.
- **Subjecthood absorption (fusion):** the independent extent to which a collective program denies personal judgment, conscience, purpose, property, loyalty, identity, relationships, refusal, or exit legitimate standing against the collective.
- **Fusion pressure:** dynamics that generalize compulsory alignment, subordinate differentiated jurisdictions, and weaken correction, refusal, exit, and appeal.
- **Total fusion:** the limiting combination of high subjecthood absorption, comprehensive jurisdiction, and closed correction or exit.
- **Fusion ideology:** a program that construes separate persons as alienated or falsely conscious fragments to be reconstituted as organs of one collective subject.
- **Humanity-inversion boundary:** equal human standing and an open aspirational horizon become fusion pressure when Humanity is agentified, assigned a true interest, and used to authorize privileged interpreters and sacrifice.
- **Personhood-and-role-interface trunk:** civil personhood makes a human reciprocally legible as continuous, reason-giving, promise-capable, standing- sensitive, and answerable; role interfaces expose only the bounded competence, duty, authority, and conduct relevant to a relation while protected opacity preserves the remainder of the person. The inherent-human-standing axiom gives every individual living human organism complete and equal standing from the beginning of its existence until death; recognition is declaratory rather than constitutive, and standing remains distinct from variable interactional and role competence. Anti-authenticity protection prevents compulsory disclosure from becoming a condition of civic standing while preserving accountability for materially represented conduct.
- **Interface failures:** deceptive masking, role overreach, role engulfment, and interface inversion must be distinguished. Role engulfment is the failure boundary in which structural support begins replacing personal authorship; low affect and reliable performance alone do not diagnose it. The audit also distinguishes full

from empty role-bound speech and retains ordinary clinical, developmental, and situational rivals.

- **Selective civil-personhood breakdown:** an officeholder can retain authority, execution, and public defence while becoming selectively unavailable for the binding attachment of authorship, promises, contradiction, answerability, repair, and consequences. The observable interface, strategic non-answerability, and accountability malingering through performed or exaggerated incapacity are successively stronger claims with separate gates. The answerability-uncanny-valley and protected-role-terminal shorthands describe the observer's experience without deciding its cause. Performed non-agency is the actor-side presentation, the incapacity-based accountability discount is the observer-side update, and their possible conjunction is the non-agency accountability shield. Reciprocity withdrawal can form the broader paternalistic accountability shield and a withdrawal loop in which failed adult answerability collapses expectations, anger gives way to contempt, pity, exhaustion, or resignation, and consequential pressure diminishes while execution and defence continue. Loss of esteem can thereby help protect power, as in the Teflon-politician branch, instead of disproving insulation. The loop can instead be broken by redirection toward records, investigation, adjudication, organization, succession, or another receiver. None of these audience effects cancels the officeholder's unconditional human standing or establishes intent, diagnosis, hidden command, or covert assignment.
- **Operative relationship modes:** I-mode permits oneself and another to appear as concrete centres of life in a possible I–You relation; We-mode operates through rules, roles, categories, shared purposes, institutional standpoints, or an imagined impartial observer. Neither mode is intrinsically good, evil, egoistic, altruistic, warm, cold, personal, or collective-agentic.
- **Pole–mode–programme separation:** Durkheimian poles describe constitutive sources and functions; I/We modes describe an episode's relational standpoint; the installed programme supplies classifications and ends; jurisdiction and moral direction determine whom the operation preserves or consumes.
- **Personhood-routing relation:** solidarity-indexed person recognition and a personhood-routing rule describe whether a human can appear as an interrupting You rather than only as a programme object. Recognition remains declaratory of, never constitutive of, inherent human standing.
- **Bounded enlistment versus takeover:** intense coordination remains person-preserving where task and jurisdiction are limited, authorship, conscience, refusal, and return remain available, and affected persons retain standing. Full We-mode takeover makes collective purpose comprehensive and turns self-sacrifice or sacrifice of others into programme requirements.
- **Repersonalization and scale:** repersonalization shock marks the possible return of a classified human as You. Scalar personhood collapse instead turns necessary aggregate representation into cancellation of the persons counted; it does not make statistics dispensable.
- **Self-transcendence routes:** relational self-sacrifice, generalized altruism, and collective sacrifice can produce similar conduct through different causal structures. Neighbour-love is a cross-layer achievement joining embodied care, symbolic generalization, personal encounter, and judgment.
- **Asymmetric personal address:** a carrier can experience the collective as a personally addressing Thou even where the enacted collective registers that carrier only as a member or component. Upward address does not establish reciprocal person-to-person care from above.
- **Conditional Christian theological interpretation:** Word, Incarnation, and Cross disclose a person-preserving direction for embodied We-mode; the Christian We remains self-subordinating and interruptible by each concrete person, while the satanic hack captures the same receptivity, impersonates ultimate authority, prohibits exit, and consumes persons for programme preservation.
- **Long-term result:** reproduction or transformation of culture through ritual and institutionalization.
- **Central normative problem:** whether the bigOther remains contestable by reflective judgment or acquires final authority over it.
- **Developmental axis:** externally enforced → socially authored → self-authored → self-transforming bigOther.
- **Reflective-role bridge:** press secretary → interpreter → auditor distinguishes defence of a verdict from making its programming object and genuinely testing it; self-authorship requires more than articulate post-hoc reasons.

Example of use

From the perspective of **culture mechanics**, the ceremony did not merely communicate the organization's values. It reenacted and reinforced particular mythologies, strengthened corresponding mappings in each participant's mythological lens, and made the bigOthers' resulting sentiments collectively observable.

Compact formulas

Inherent human standing:

> **beginning of an individual living human organism → complete and equal human standing; factual recognition is declaratory and corrigible, never constitutive; capability, dependency, wantedness, conduct, and classification may change circumstances or remedies but never admission to the protected human class**

Selective civil-personhood breakdown:

> **retained authority + continued execution and defence of a course + selective unavailability for retrospective continuity, promise-binding, contradiction, answerability, repair, or consequence → possible reciprocity withdrawal and paternalistic accountability shield; performed non-agency + observer-side incapacity discount → possible non-agency accountability shield; observable asymmetry $\neq$ strategic use $\neq$ feigned incapacity**

Single-slot composition and replacement:

> **one PCI slot → one local bigOther → one operative mythological lens; compatible packages → one braided program; incompatible governing worldview → rejection or incumbent unbraiding → liminal interval → one rebraided successor**

Historical explanation and present execution:

> **historical cause $\neq$ live affective classification $\neq$ avowed reason; present agreement among them is an empirical question**

Activation and formation:

> **operation-rich formation → locally reconstructed and socially calibrated codebooks → compressed symbol activates a larger installed complex; token inheritance without recurrent formation does not transmit a finished decoder**

Durkheimian source pole and Culture Mechanics decomposition:

> **socially formed language, concepts, rational resources, and moral ideals → local reconstruction across rider/main CPU, symbolic protocol, and installed lens; local bigOther classifies their culturally relevant objects and uses → established elephant steering + proposed rider-side semantic-access conditioning; classification influences thought without performing thought**

Coupled collective-formation modes:

> **distributed epistemic milieu → rider/main-CPU concepts, methods, query paths, and correction practices; distributed bigOther and local-bigOther execution → evaluative force, affect, motivation, and action readiness; shared carriers and reciprocal influence do not make these one processor**

Formation, intervention, and selection:

> **endogenous formation: changing conditions → mismatch → articulation → distributed selection → embodiment; prospective purposive construction: candidate chosen destination D* → diagnosis → symbolic and institutional intervention → testing and correction; where intervention is attempted, the actual successor is jointly constrained by intention, receivers, incumbent and rival fields, institutions, consequences, and reality**

Situated scripts and unraveling:

> **operative cultural weave + role/institution/situation + practical environment → situated cultural script → enactment and consequence → reinforcement, repair, or unraveling; peripheral failure → local script replacement, while load-bearing cross-script cascade → possible cultural unbraiding**

Domain transfer:

> **genuine competence or viable script in environment A + untested invariant assumption → enactment in materially different environment B → discriminating collision with B's causal, institutional, or adversarial structure → possible domain-transfer failure**

Relevant-structure appraisal:

felt relevance × represented support or damage → possible moral appraisal and mobilization; actual multidimensional effect + generative centrality + normative standing → separate evaluation

Sublimation-bearing symbols and lens programming:

carrier or activation device → installed sublimation-related mappings → local-bigOther classification; repeated rival mythology + systems + rewards + sanctions + conduct → possible lens reprogramming → changed Beseelung, enactment, and transmission

Affective-to-structural load transfer:

living conviction → repeated practice and habit → fitted roles, procedures, records, audit, and succession → lower per-node affective demand + greater structural persistence, range, and reliable reproduction; structure reduces recurrent arousal but does not literally store affect or replace living correction indefinitely; ordinary visible alignment may remain low while fitted roles, interoperable interfaces, infrastructure, resource routing, and command relations preserve high activation-conditioned coordination capacity

Change-indexed moral mobilization:

represented change, continuation, prevention, or culpable omission affecting felt-relevant structure → intensified moral classification and action readiness (hypothesis, not definition)

Single-slot hard test:

two incompatible same-domain evaluators + independent finality + independent affect, veto, and correction + stable coexistence without hierarchy, reinterpretation, contextual division, or third rule → evidence against strict single-slot exclusivity

Order, jurisdiction, and lifting:

one fully occupied slot × {shared concrete rules and answers | shared answer-generating meta-rules} × {corrigible | pathological}; fixed M + current K_t + situation C → binding R_t(C); lifting may enable plural first-order outputs and bounded jurisdictions without creating a second bigOther

Person–collective constitution:

collective agency × subjecthood absorption × jurisdiction × corrigibility; differentiated unity preserves personal and subordinate standing, while generalized compulsory alignment + jurisdictional absorption + blocked correction, refusal, and exit → fusion pressure → possible total fusion

Operative relationship modes:

I-mode $\leftrightarrow$ We-mode is an episode-level standpoint axis, not the Durkheimian pole distinction; programme supplies classifications and ends; moral direction and jurisdiction determine person-preserving or person-consuming operation; bounded enlistment preserves authorship, refusal, You-interruption, and return, while full takeover blocks them

Agentified enactment and the Jaynes–Bach bridge:

mythology → god-agent represented in one operative lens → agentified *Beseelung* / bigOther-as-Thou → distributed enactment → multi-mind-self presentation → possible operative multi-mind-self; displacement of personal authorship within that agent → fused multi-mind-self

Conditional Christian theological contrast:

created receptivity to Word and shared authority + Incarnation and Cross → Christian We subordinate to concrete persons; collective capture + claimed ultimate voice + submission as proof + prohibited exit + disposal authority → satanic hack; conditional theology $\neq$ empirical proof, and biological mediation $\neq$ disproof of the referent

Kantian inner-tribunal comparison:

one numerically identical human + distinct practical positions → inner moral authority represented as observing and judging other; Kant: autonomous practical reason and doubled personality | Culture Mechanics: possible local-bigOther presence; shared phenomenological target $\neq$ shared ontology

Conformity and targeting signals, moralization, and enforcement–exclusion:

ideological program → performed, omitted, imposed, or attributed token → conformity, refusal, or target status becomes observable → character disclosure and accusation → distributed judgment → enforcement through inclusion, exclusion, coercion, or violence → defence or expansion of jurisdiction

Rivalry and conflict:

propositional, causal-story, or classification conflict → possible mythological rivalry → active interference with transmission, authority, membership, or institutional embodiment → mythological conflict → organized recruitment and rival-signal suppression → propagative conflict; physical coercion or violence in the conflict → coercive conflict. The two outward types may overlap, and inward ideological or fundamentalist person–programme form remains a separate classification.

Full culture-mechanical cycle:

mythologies shape the mythological lens → the local bigOther maps observations onto social feelings → the elephant moves → the rider explains or questions → behaviour is encoded in the shared symbolic protocol → other local bigOthers classify and respond → an emergent field acts back upon its participants → distributed synchronization reproduces or transforms culture

Culture propagator:

typed cultural state $z_t = (r_t, p_t, d_t, k_t, w_t, s_t, m_t)$ **+ declared transition architecture** θ_t **+ input** u_t **+ disturbance** ε_t **→ later possible state** $z_{t+1} = T_{\theta_t}(z_t; u_t, \varepsilon_t)$**; retained memory is part of the state whenever later movement depends on history**

Question-relative quotient condition:

$z \sim z' \Rightarrow T(z) \sim T(z')$**; if apparently equivalent states have dynamically different successors, restore the discarded distinction or narrow the question**

Epistemic agency under mechanical solidarity

epistemic agency under mechanical solidarity *noun phrase*
Status: proposed synthetic term and field of analysis
Fields: social epistemology, moral psychology, social psychology, developmental psychology, sociology of knowledge, sociology of morality, political psychology, cultural theory

Short definition

Epistemic agency under mechanical solidarity is the capacity of a socially formed and epistemically dependent person to judge, test, and revise beliefs while living inside an emergent symbolic-affective field that already supplies shared meanings, trusted authorities, legitimate institutions, and social rules about what may count as knowledge.

The term describes a tension rather than an escape from society. Human beings cannot verify everything personally. They must rely on testimony, experts, professions, records, and institutions. At the same time, networked local bigOthers can synchronize around particular **master signifiers**, narratives, authorities, and institutional **gatekeepers**. The resulting field is implemented through persons and communication but is not merely a sum of independently formed psychologies: its organized public signals, institutions, expectations, and sanctions act back upon each participant. Authorization can thereby begin to replace evaluation.

The field is not automatically a collective agent. It can nevertheless acquire a **multi-mind-self presentation**: the collective is represented, encountered, or addressed as one self. Under sufficiently integrated conditions it can become an **operative multi-mind-self** capable of continuing or episode-bounded judgment, action, and unitary ownership through many *beseelte* persons. A recurrent but non-universal topology places a comparatively uniform audience before an elevated teacher, leader, or institutional voice; common attention, narrative, authority, and mutual awareness can then produce an unusually receptive programming state. The same geometry can transmit truthful education or propaganda.

For readability, explanatory passages may use *multi-mind-self* as a family-level shorthand for this self-like organization or presentation. Wherever an inference depends upon collective agency, the stricter expression **operative multi-mind-self** or **multi-mind-self proper** is required. The shorthand does not by itself establish collective intention, unitary ownership, fusion, or responsibility.

The healthy form is **corrigible epistemic dependence**: authorities are trusted provisionally, within a domain, because they provide access to evidence and methods that remain open to correction. The pathological form is **authority-gated belief updating**: a claim is admitted or rejected primarily according to whether it carries the signature of a socially authorized person, office, institution, identity, or narrative. This produces **asymmetric epistemic permeability**—high openness to authorized claims and low openness to direct evidence or elementary checks arriving through an unauthorized route. A person can therefore be easy to persuade from inside the authorized structure and extraordinarily difficult to correct from outside it.

The corresponding developmental achievement is **epistemic adulthood**. It does not mean distrusting all institutions or becoming intellectually self-sufficient. It means gaining enough reflective distance from one's socialization and its mechanical-solidarity field to inspect the inherited architecture of trust itself: why an authority is trusted, where its jurisdiction ends, what could defeat its claims, whether its sources are genuinely independent, and whether legitimacy has been confused with truth. In the specialized sense used here, the freedom thereby achieved is **cognitive liberty**.

Under the single-slot principle this freedom remains a **full capture**: one operative weave still completely occupies the local bigOther. Emancipation can lift that weave from shared concrete answers to shared rules for generating, selecting, applying, and revising answers. Particular beliefs, offices, and institutions can then vary within one binding generator. Order level, complete occupancy, jurisdiction, and corrigibility remain separate properties.

The positive norm is **piety toward the real**: models, narratives, authorities, and even one's own conviction must remain answerable to a reality capable of surprising and correcting them. The practical problem is how to help people recover this reality-responsive judgment without merely recruiting them into a closed successor solidarity with different but equally preemptive gatekeepers. **MCIP**—Mirror, Cut, Invite, Promise—is one proposed micro-method: preserve the person, expose a precise discrepancy, return authorship, and make independent inquiry socially and practically survivable.

Culture Program Ecology uses this reality-correction relation to distinguish Culture Strategies from Pure-Ideology Culture Programs while keeping branch, order level, full slot occupancy, jurisdiction, and corrigibility separate.

In one sentence:

> **Epistemic agency under mechanical solidarity is the socially situated ability to use inherited communities and institutions as corrigible instruments of knowledge without allowing their authority to become the final permissioning layer for reality.**

Long definition

1. General meaning

The term names the relation between two facts:

1. **Knowledge is socially dependent.** No person can personally reproduce all observations, calculations, experiments, historical investigations, or technical judgments on which modern life depends.
2. **The social structures that transmit knowledge also form judgment.** They teach people whom to trust, which questions are respectable, which institutions have jurisdiction, which symbols carry legitimacy, and which doubts feel shameful, dangerous, or disloyal.

Epistemic agency under mechanical solidarity asks what remains of personal judgment after this necessary social formation has taken place. Its central question is not whether a person is influenced by culture. Everyone is. It is whether the person's culturally inherited trust architecture can itself become an object of reflection and correction.

The object of analysis is therefore neither an isolated cognitive trait nor an accusation of gullibility. It is a **person–culture–authority relationship**. It includes:

- the person's dependence on testimony and expertise;
- the collective formation of meanings and sentiments;
- the distribution of epistemic authority across persons, roles, institutions, and channels;
- the narratives and symbols by which authority is legitimized;
- the dispositions that regulate trust, doubt, and closure;
- the social costs of disagreement, checking, and exit;
- the routes through which reality can correct the resulting mental model.

The term belongs inside the broader proposed framework of *Culture Mechanics*, which begins with the homo-duplex individual: the main CPU, the local bigOther, its mythological lens, and the shared symbolic protocol through which local states become socially legible. This entry begins at the next causal level. It asks how networked local bigOthers generate mechanical-solidarity coherence and a distributed bigOther, how that field acts back upon its participants, how it can present the collective in self-like form, and under what further conditions it becomes an operative multi-mind-self. *Culture mechanics* in this sense is a term of this synthesis, not the name of an established academic theory. Epistemic agency under mechanical solidarity concentrates on one particular output of that machinery: **who or what is permitted to determine what a person treats as real**.

Exact culture-implementation practice belongs to Macdonald, Burke, and Stewart's *Systems Leadership: Creating Positive Organisations*. This entry addresses the narrower epistemic and collective-field consequences of such cultural formation rather than restating that practical method.

> **Culture Mechanics condenses the Systems Leadership implementation stack into one memorable duality: systems are the skeleton; human carriers, mythology, meaning, affect, *Beseelung*, and embodied habits are the flesh and blood. The skeleton makes culture durable and repeatable; the living body makes it operative and alive.**

The full semantic anatomy and its boundaries belong to *Culture Program Ecology*.

2. Semantic anatomy of the term

Each word performs necessary work.

Epistemic **Epistemic** concerns belief, knowledge, evidence, justification, inquiry, uncertainty, and correction. It distinguishes this topic from agency in the general sense of being able to choose or act.

The relevant object is not merely the truth value of individual sentences. People act through larger mental models: classifications, causal structures, expectations, narratives, and predictions. A communication can contain many true statements while inducing a distorted model through selective framing. Epistemic evaluation must therefore ask whether the installed model adequately tracks the relevant structure of reality.

Agency **Agency** is the effective capacity to participate in the authorship of one's own beliefs and trust relations. It includes the ability to:

- distinguish evidence from social authorization;
- recognize uncertainty rather than filling every gap immediately;
- ask what would count against a favored claim;
- perform available low-cost checks;
- compare explanations and causal stories;
- inspect the jurisdiction, incentives, record, and correction mechanisms of authorities;
- tolerate the emotional and social discomfort of disagreement;
- revise both a belief and the standards by which the belief was previously judged.

Agency is more than the legal permission to think freely. A person may be formally free while remaining unable to question the classifications through which freedom itself becomes intelligible. Agency also requires practical access to alternatives, emotional tolerance for dissonance, and some ability to survive the social consequences of independent judgment.

Under **Under** indicates situatedness, not necessarily oppression. A person exercises judgment *under* inherited language, institutions, roles, authorities, dependencies, and collective sentiments. These structures can support or impair agency. The preposition avoids two false pictures: the isolated knower who owes nothing to society, and the completely determined subject who possesses no capacity for reflection.

A person also acts under **situated cultural scripts**: distributed, role-, institution-, and situation-indexed local braids that translate a more general cultural weave into detailed expectations, routines, permissions, interfaces, improvisation, and practical support. A script can be larger than one participant without becoming a subject or another bigOther. Epistemic agency includes the capacity to notice what a script asks one to perceive, trust, report, conceal, escalate, or ignore; to distinguish failure of the general rule from failure of its local adapter, enactment, interface, or resources; and, where standing and capacity permit, to interpret, repair, refuse, or help replace the script.

Mechanical solidarity **Mechanical solidarity**, introduced by the French sociologist **Émile Durkheim** in *De la division du travail social* (1893), is social cohesion produced through shared beliefs and sentiments and the felt moral authority of the collective consciousness. Durkheim contrasts it analytically with **organic solidarity**, which arises from differentiation, specialization, and interdependence in a division of labour.

Culture mechanics interprets mechanical solidarity as an **emergent symbolic-affective field**: compatible local bigOthers repeatedly communicate, observe, answer, reward, and sanction one another until common classifications acquire organized force beyond any isolated encounter. The field exists through persons, language, practices, institutions, and artifacts, but its relational organization acts back upon the persons who implement it. This field vocabulary and mechanism are proposed here; Durkheim did not describe electromagnetic fields, local bigOther processors, or a wireless network.

The present theory distinguishes two architectures of that shared moral force:

> **First-order mechanical solidarity shares concrete rules and answers. Lifted mechanical solidarity shares the rules that generate, select, apply, and revise concrete answers.**

The adjective *lifted* is new here: it extends Durkheim rather than reproducing a term used by him. Its minimal formal relation is:

> **fixed meta-rules M + current knowledge or inputs K_t + situation C → binding first-order output R_t(C)**

Fixed here means operatively installed and binding, not eternal. A lifted ruleset can itself be revised through the procedures it recognizes. The generator, its present inputs, and its concrete outputs all belong to one operative weave; they are not separate bigOthers. First-order and lifted solidarity also use the same proposed field-forming mechanism and both can fully occupy the single slot.

A dense corpus of detailed prescriptions that *beseelte* participants follow as self-compulsorily proper is a strong and testable indicator of predominantly first-order solidarity. It is not the definition: first-order orders can contain interpretive procedures, and lifted generators can produce extensive, precise rules. Lifted systems often display **generative compression**—comparatively few meta-rules generate many changing answers—but fewness alone is not decisive. The diagnostic question is where common binding force resides: in the concrete answers, or in the rules by which answers are produced and corrected.

Modern societies may combine organic differentiation with lifted mechanical solidarity. A shared generator can admit different religions, occupations, identities, institutions, and ways of life as different first-order outputs or bounded packages. It can also constitute and limit offices and jurisdictions. Pluralism, division of labour, and bounded subordinate authority are therefore important possible consequences of lifting, not its definition. Nor must lifted authority be weak or local: a generator can have universal jurisdiction at its own level while the outputs and authorities it generates are particular and bounded. The cases and difficult classifications are developed in §25.

The older image that lifting makes culture's "surface area" shrink needs one terminological correction. What can contract is the **shared first-order prescription footprint**: fewer religions, occupations, identities, lifestyles, empirical conclusions, and ordinary decisions must be identical across participants. That contraction can enlarge the first-order choice space under one common generator:

```
large shared corpus of concrete answers
→ narrow range of admissible first-order variation

compressed shared generator and jurisdictional shell
→ wider range of bounded first-order packages and answers
```

This is not necessarily a reduction in the canonical **lifted-solidarity surface area or meta-order span**, which concerns how widely the common meta-order is actually recognized and binding. A lifted order can therefore be sparse in shared concrete prescriptions, thick and demanding at the level of its meta-rules, and society-wide in span. The expanded choice space remains generated and bounded rather than unlimited: packages that claim compulsory supremacy or abolish the rules preserving persons, bounded jurisdiction, refusal, exit, and correction are not simply one more coequal output of that generator. The proposed relation between this footprint, culturally maintained scotomata, and the resulting open theorizing surface is developed with the semantic-access mechanism below.

Durkheimian organic solidarity as a lifted composite Durkheim's **organic solidarity** has a specific source meaning. A society is organized through differentiated organs with special functions and partially independent spheres of activity; persons are increasingly located through an occupational rather than a kinship milieu; and the organs become reciprocally dependent, including a central organ whose privileged position derives from its function and

whose own dependence upon the others remains visible. Durkheim treats this division of labour as producing a form of social cohesion, not merely an economic substrate.

Culture Mechanics preserves that source description while analytically decomposing its solidarity relation:

```
Durkheimian organic solidarity
             maps to
organic differentiation / clockwork coordination
                  +
lifted mechanical solidarity
```

Organic differentiation names the topology of specialized roles, interfaces, handoffs, knowledge, and reciprocal material dependence. **Lifted mechanical solidarity** names the common binding force by which participants recognize the rules that constitute, allocate, constrain, and correct those differentiated roles. Functional interdependence alone can form a causal dependency chain; it does not by itself explain why strangers recognize contracts, offices, professional obligations, impartial procedures, or one another's standing as legitimate.

A useful explanatory discriminator is the **profitable-and-unobserved deviation counterfactual**: if external detection, immediate sanction, and reputational consequence were credibly absent, would the obligation still govern because deviation is experienced as dishonourable or incompatible with the office or profession? Conduct that remains rule-bound under genuinely low-observation conditions supports an internalized impersonal-governor explanation more strongly than compliance only under direct surveillance. It does not isolate or prove the local-bigOther mechanism. Habit, uncertainty about discovery, long-horizon self-interest, private conviction, technical constraint, and misdescribed observation conditions remain rivals, while a person's hypothetical self-report is not equivalent to observed conduct.

The project therefore proposes a stronger possible reinterpretation of Durkheim's historical transition:

```
shared concrete classifications, roles, and answers
                  ↓ lifting
shared generator producing differentiated roles, duties, and answers
```

On this account, declining resemblance among visible first-order outputs need not mean that mechanically solidary commonality has weakened. Commonality may have moved into the less visible generator. Shared contract rules can generate millions of different contracts; constitutional rules can generate changing officeholders; scientific rules can generate divergent disciplines and revisable conclusions; and professional rules can generate different role-specific duties. This is a project-developed reinterpretive hypothesis, not Durkheim's own account and not proof of its historical prevalence.

> **Organic differentiation weakens visible resemblance without necessarily weakening solidarity; lifting relocates solidarity into the order that makes differentiated action interoperable and mobilizable.**

One important consequence is that **lifted solidarity can produce individual autonomy without ceasing to be solidarity**. The apparently autonomous actor on the ordinary "Newtonian" surface exercises a differentiated sphere whose property, contract, office, evidential, and correction relations may themselves be constituted and protected by the common lifted order. Diversity of action is therefore compatible with full common slot occupancy at the level of the generator.

The same architecture permits **affective-to-structural load transfer**. A professional rule may require little emotional arousal at each decision because formation, role expectations, peer judgment, records, audit, replication, sanctions, and succession already carry much of its conduct-directing load. "One simply does not falsify the result" can remain a quiet classification while governing work across distant strangers and generations. The resulting order can be weakly *beseelt* at most nodes yet structurally strong, broadly distributed, and reliable. This establishes neither collective-self presentation nor an operative multi-mind-self.

At civilizational scale, the same mechanism produces the distinction among **ambient affective coupling, latent structural coupling, and activation-conditioned coupling**. Low visible agreement or enthusiasm among differentiated persons may coexist with high latent coordination capacity when roles, standards, records, transport, communications, resource routing, and command or mission relations already form interoperable interfaces. A demanding common task can activate those interfaces and produce coherent output without erasing local judgment or requiring prior emotional unanimity. The order may therefore appear loose in ordinary life while remaining strongly mobilizable; realized mobilization still does not by itself establish subjecthood fusion, common private belief, or an operative multi-mind-self.

The extended order also introduces an impersonal third position of accountability. An engineer, physician, judge, merchant, or officeholder can be answerable through a standard, profession, law, office, or conscience even when no concrete beneficiary is present to demand performance. Keep three positions distinct:

- the **immediate evaluator or rule carrier** through which the duty is judged;
- the **protected beneficiary**, often concrete known or unknown persons; and
- the **ultimate principal** whose standing the order finally serves.

The local bigOther makes the generalized evaluation affectively and practically operative; the distributed bigOther and its institutions reproduce it across persons and succession. A person-protecting lifted order can use impersonal accountability to protect strangers. Subjecthood absorption becomes possible when an institution or collective abstraction instead becomes the ultimate beneficiary and concrete persons become its instruments.

This decomposition does not identify Durkheim's source distinction with the project's first-order–lifted axis. It types one important intersection. A family can use a lifted generator, a large polity can impose shared concrete answers, and differentiated activity can exist without a sufficiently common or corrigible lifted order. Organic differentiation and lifted solidarity can also co-develop and act back upon one another; the decomposition is not a claim that one historically creates the other in a single causal direction.

Related distinction: Hyperculture and cultural essentialism The German sociologist **Andreas Reckwitz** distinguishes two late-modern *regimes of culturalization* in "Zwischen Hyperkultur und Kulturessenzialismus" (2016) and the related *Die Zeit* essay "Alles so schön hyper". **Cultural essentialism** treats culture as the durable inheritance of a comparatively homogeneous community, organized by an ingroup–outgroup distinction and the preservation or recovery of valued traditions. **Hyperculture** treats globally circulating cultural goods, practices, and identities as a diverse repertoire from which individuals construct singular ways of life.

There is a strong structural correspondence with the present framework, but not an identity:

Reckwitz's distinction	Translation into the present framework
Cultural essentialism	Resembles **first-order mechanical solidarity**: cohesion is sought through common substantive identities, practices, origins, and beliefs.
Hyperculture	Resembles **first-order plurality combined with organic and market differentiation**: cultural elements circulate, combine, and serve individual self-development. It is not itself a form of solidarity.
The normative order supporting hyperculture	Can take the form of **lifted mechanical solidarity** around diversity, tolerance, openness, self-realization, human rights, and legitimate cosmopolitan institutions.

The theories therefore ask different questions. Reckwitz classifies what culture is taken to be and how cultural value is produced; *lifted mechanical solidarity* identifies the level at which social similarity, legitimacy, and common moral authority are located. A hypercultural society can be highly plural at the first order while demanding strong conformity to a second-order affirmation of plurality.

The comparison also exposes an **order-level culture-recognition asymmetry**. A person who has learned to recognize culture mainly through shared concrete answers, sacred histories, rituals, dress, taboos, enemies, and embodied authorities may treat first-order commonality as culture as such. The comparatively compressed generator of a lifted order can then appear to be cultural emptiness, indecision, bureaucracy, permissiveness, or weakness even when it is operatively binding through reciprocal standing, bounded jurisdiction, legitimate opposition, peaceful succession, and correction. This is a recognition failure, not evidence that every apparently thin liberal order possesses a living lifted culture; the distinction between an operative but misrecognized order and a merely written shell belongs to Culture Program Ecology.

Hypercultural selection must also be separated from programme-level jurisdiction. A person may adopt food, music, dress, stories, techniques, or practices from another culture as elements within a plural repertoire without installing the source culture's whole answer generator or granting it compulsory authority over non-adherents. The lifted umbrella therefore permits broad but bounded selection and recombination; it does not treat every parent programme's claim to supremacy as another interchangeable lifestyle option.

This higher-order solidarity becomes epistemically problematic when terms such as *diversity*, *tolerance*, or *human rights* function as unchallengeable master signifiers, one authorized interpretation becomes compulsory, and disagreement is classified as hostility toward the value itself. That is an essentializing use of hypercultural meta-norms, not sufficient reason to classify every left-liberal, green, or cosmopolitan position as cultural essentialism. Claiming truth is not the criterion; the question is whether claims and interpretations remain corrigible or become identity- and authority-gated. Cultural essentialism and hyperculture can therefore both support or suppress epistemic agency through different authorities: tradition, religion, nation, and communal leaders in one case; prestigious media, professions, expert institutions, and cosmopolitan moral vocabularies in the other.

3. The epistemic predicament: dependence is unavoidable

The starting condition is **epistemic dependence**, not epistemic credulity. The immediate source is the American philosopher **John Hardwig's** paper "Epistemic Dependence" (1985), which argues that rational knowledge often depends essentially on trusting other knowers. The present entry extends Hardwig's person-to-person problem into institutional trust, mechanical solidarity, and the social routing of belief updates.

Modern knowledge is distributed. A person who consults a physician, relies on an engineer's safety calculation, uses a statistical series, accepts a historical date, or trusts a laboratory result is normally doing something rational. Testimony and institutional knowledge are not inferior substitutes for a purely personal knowledge that could realistically be achieved. They are constitutive parts of human knowing.

Healthy epistemic dependence can involve:

- division of cognitive labour;
- transactive memory, in which people know who is likely to know what;
- credentialed expertise;
- records and institutional memory;
- methodological standards;
- peer criticism and replication;
- trusted personal judgment in domains where another person has demonstrated competence.

The decisive distinction is between **reliance** and **preemption**:

> "The authority's judgment is important evidence that I should normally weight heavily."

is different from:

> "The authority's judgment decides what evidence I am permitted to recognize."

The first is delegated reality-testing. The second is delegated reality-permission.

Epistemic agency therefore cannot mean verifying everything personally. Such autarky would make a person less knowledgeable, not more. Agency consists in retaining **meta-authority** over dependence: the ability to understand why trust is granted, limit it by domain, calibrate it by performance, compare it with other routes to reality, and withdraw or revise it when warranted.

4. Socialization into institutional trust

Socialization teaches more than propositions and rules. It installs an **architecture of epistemic trust**.

The exact expression **socialization into institutional trust**, and the mechanism assigned to it here, are synthetic. Important antecedents are **Patrick Wilson's** account of cognitive authority, **Niklas Luhmann's** analysis of trust as a way of reducing social complexity, and **Anthony Giddens's** discussion of trust in expert systems and other abstract systems. None of these authors proposes the whole Durkheimian many-to-few mechanism formulated below.

Children and citizens learn:

- which persons and offices may teach, diagnose, judge, certify, or interpret;
- which credentials and uniforms signify competence;
- which publications, channels, and formats count as official;
- which institutions possess jurisdiction over which questions;
- which sources are respectable, fringe, sacred, suspect, or inadmissible;
- what kind of challenge counts as inquiry and what kind counts as insolence or betrayal.

Much of this learning occurs before a person can independently assess the institutions involved. Later reasoning takes place through the trust structure that earlier socialization supplied. The person may know how to ask, "What does the recognized institution say?" without yet knowing how to ask, "Why does this institution possess jurisdiction here, and how would I recognize its failure?"

The recurring architecture can have the following shape:

```
large and diverse population
             ↓ shared socialization
common second-order classifications and legitimacy rules
             ↓
small set of elevated institutions, professions, and offices
             ↓
authorized spokespersons and communication channels
             ↓
certification of claims as presumptively reliable
```

This many-to-few architecture is an important form of modern mechanical integration, but it is not the definition of mechanical solidarity. Shared consciousness can also be horizontal and leaderless. Consensus itself can become the gatekeeper: "Everyone like us knows this." Conversely, a differentiated institution can possess legitimate authority without producing strong mechanical solidarity. The terms should therefore not be collapsed.

Section 12 returns to this asymmetry as a **privileged authority-addressed programming topology**: a recurrent and potentially powerful geometry within a mechanically solidary field, not a universal shape or a synonym for the field.

5. Epistemic gatekeepers and trust anchors

An **epistemic gatekeeper** is a person, role, institution, profession, identity, or communication channel whose authorization strongly influences whether a claim is admitted as credible. This is a functional use of the familiar word *gatekeeper*, not a claim that a single cited author established this exact category.

A **personal epistemic authority** is a narrower relationship in which another person's considered judgment itself constitutes evidence. The closest direct sources are Wilson's *cognitive authority* and the American philosopher **Linda Trinkaus Zagzebski's** *Epistemic Authority* (2012). Such reliance can be rational when competence, intellectual character, access, and record deserve trust. The person becomes a gatekeeper, in the more specific usage of this entry, only when this evidential weight acquires a permissioning function—when evidence effectively cannot enter except through their approval.

The gatekeeper need not be personally known. In an institutional form, the person speaking may be a replaceable interface:

```
socialization into institutional trust
                 ↓
institution recognized as epistemic trust anchor
                 ↓
office, credential, or channel authenticates a spokesperson
                 ↓
claim inherits institutional authority
                 ↓
institution-gated belief update
```

The audience does not primarily think, "I know this speaker and have inspected their reasoning." It thinks, "This speaker is authorized to represent the institution that society recognizes as competent in this domain." The institution is the **epistemic trust anchor**; the spokesperson is the **institutional epistemic proxy**.

Several diagnostic observations follow:

- If the statement loses most of its authority when the same person leaves office, the institution was the real trust anchor.
- If an unknown successor can speak with equal force, the individual was primarily an interface.
- If the spokesperson loses credibility by contradicting the institution even while presenting the same evidence, institutional authorization dominated personal reasoning.
- If identical evidence is accepted or rejected according to branding, belief updating is substantially institution-gated.

Gatekeeping is not inherently pathological. Filtering can protect limited attention from fraud, noise, and incompetence. It becomes dangerous when the gatekeeper changes from a defeasible evidence source into what this entry calls a **reality-validation node** whose approval determines whether contrary evidence may count at all. Zagzebski's **Preemption Thesis** is a relevant but not identical antecedent: it concerns how a recognized authority's judgment can replace some of the subject's own reasons. The pathological permissioning relation meant here is stronger and closer to what **Christoph Jäger** criticizes in "Epistemic Authority, Preemptive Reasons, and Understanding" (2016).

6. Forms of authority and epistemic spillover

The following table concerns authorities constituted *within* an order. Their competence can and normally should be bounded even when the lifted constitution that creates and coordinates their jurisdictions is universal at the second order. A parliament, court, profession, office, or expert does not inherit universal epistemic competence merely because the common legal and epistemic meta-order governs the allocation of its authority.

For example, a lifted legal order can govern universally what counts as lawful legislation, office, contract, consent, permissible terms, interpretation, enforcement, remedy, appeal, and correction. Particular legislatures, courts, officials, and contracting parties exercise only the competences that order constitutes for them.

At least four forms of authority should be distinguished:

Form	Legitimate function	Characteristic spillover risk
Coordination authority	Organizes common action and resolves operational decisions.	The right to direct action is mistaken for superior knowledge of every relevant fact.
Normative authority	States, interprets, or enforces rules and obligations.	The right to define a rule is mistaken for the power to determine empirical reality.
Epistemic authority	Supplies competent testimony or judgment in a defined knowledge domain.	Domain-specific competence is generalized beyond its evidence and expertise.
Pastoral authority	Guides a person's welfare, identity, duties, conscience, or interpretation of life.	Care and intimate understanding become grounds for surrendering judgment.

Role-conferred epistemic authority spillover occurs when authority in one domain silently produces deference in another. A teacher's legitimate classroom authority, an officer's command authority, a priest's pastoral role, a manager's organizational authority, or a public institution's procedural legitimacy can be treated as if it guaranteed factual correctness outside the appropriate domain.

Mechanical solidarity facilitates spillover because disagreement may acquire a moral meaning. A factual challenge can be classified not as a proposed correction but as disobedience, disloyalty, ignorance, pollution, lack of compassion, or an attack upon the community. The authority then receives support not only from its own office but from peers whose reactions make the cost of doubt collectively visible.

Jurisdictional spillover is therefore a pathology of an authorized person, office, or institution exceeding its allocated competence. It is not evidence that the lifted meta-order itself should lack universal jurisdiction over how those competences are created, limited, coordinated, appealed, and corrected.

The pathological inference is:

> "Because this person or institution is entitled to coordinate, represent, protect, or guide us, it must also be the correct interpreter of reality."

7. One umbrella, not one continuum

The concepts gathered under this entry are related but are not interchangeable positions on a single scale from independence to gullibility. They are different kinds of things.

Concept	Semantic kind	Central question
Epistemic dependence	Social condition	From whom and through what institutions must I obtain knowledge?
Epistemic vigilance or credulity	Disposition and monitoring function	How carefully and symmetrically do I assess communicated information?
Epistemic gatekeeping	Relationship and network architecture	Through which nodes must a claim pass before I treat it as admissible?
Authority spillover	Transfer mechanism	Has legitimate authority in one domain acquired unearned force in another?
Persuasion	Belief-change process	By what operations is a judgment, identity, or evaluation being changed?
Narrative or causal story	Meaning-making medium	How are events organized into cause, blame, responsibility, and remedy?
Master signifier	Symbolic operator	Which privileged term organizes meanings, identities, and legitimate knowledge?
Mechanical solidarity	Form of social integration	How are people held together through shared classifications and sentiments?
Piety toward the real	Normative orientation	Does reality retain the right to correct the model and the authority?
Cognitive liberty	Developmental and normative achievement	Can the person take the inherited trust architecture as an object of reflection?

The whole field is multidimensional. Relevant axes include:

- degree of necessary dependence;
- calibration of trust;
- concentration or plurality of authority;
- domain limitation or spillover;
- symmetry or asymmetry in evaluating evidence;
- identity investment and need for closure;
- transparency of sources and methods;
- social cost of doubt, dissent, and exit;
- institutional capacity for correction;
- personal capacity for inexpensive direct verification;
- willingness to leave a question unresolved.

Someone can be highly dependent yet epistemically agentic, skeptical toward most sources yet preemptively deferential toward one, self-authored yet wrong, or socially conformist while relying on institutions that happen to be accurate. No single credulity score captures these configurations.

8. Authority-gated belief updating and asymmetric epistemic permeability

Authority-gated belief updating is the central pathological mechanism named by this entry. Both this label and **asymmetric epistemic permeability** below are proposed terms, not terms taken verbatim from the cited literature. Authority-gated belief updating occurs when the source's authorization controls the admissibility or weight of a claim before its content receives independent consideration.

Its simplest form is:

```
claim arrives
     ↓
Is it endorsed by my recognized authority,
identity, institution, or socially legitimate narrative?
```

```
├─ yes → admit, accept, or rationalize
└─ no  → reject, distrust, or refer back to the authority
```

The associated observable pattern is **asymmetric epistemic permeability**:

- authorized information passes through easily;
- unauthorized counterevidence meets an unusually high burden;
- direct checks are displaced by consultation with the gatekeeper;
- a trusted source's error is explained away;
- an outsider's accurate claim is treated as suspect because of its origin;
- intelligence is used to defend the installed conclusion rather than expose it to symmetrical testing.

This resolves the apparent contradiction between being easy to persuade and hard to convince. The person is not open in every direction. They are highly permeable along authorized channels and comparatively impermeable across unauthorized boundaries.

This is therefore **not generalized gullibility**. A person may be suspicious, argumentative, and highly skilled at finding weaknesses in out-group claims. Their credulity is selective and routed. The question asked before "Is this true?" is "Who is entitled to say this?"

The strongest diagnostic case occurs when a person refuses an available, inexpensive verification—an original source, a transparent count, or a calculation using elementary arithmetic—and instead asks the gatekeeper what the answer is. Referring to expertise can be rational; refusing a decisive cheap check because it lacks social authorization indicates that the authority has begun to preempt evidence.

The **cheap-check gradient** makes that comparison explicit: as verification cost and required competence fall, and accessible evidence becomes more decisive, persistent substitution of authorized reassurance for checking becomes stronger evidence for authority-gated updating. This is an investigative gradient, not a numerical law. Establish actual exposure, accessibility, comprehension, time, relevant competence, and the check's discriminating value; compare willingness to perform equivalent checks of favoured and rival sources. Selective avoidance can coexist with extensive effort spent investigating opponents, so neither general laziness nor low intelligence explains the asymmetry by itself. The gradient alone establishes neither scotosis, a Second Reality, deliberate dishonesty, nor the falsity of the authority's claim.

9. Epistemic vigilance, credulity, and closure

Epistemic vigilance, as developed by **Dan Sperber, Fabrice Clément, Christophe Heintz, Olivier Mascaro, Hugo Mercier, Gloria Origgi, and Deirdre Wilson** in "Epistemic Vigilance" (2010), is the family of processes by which communicated information is assessed for source reliability and content plausibility. **Epistemic credulity** is used here more broadly for an insufficiently discriminating readiness to accept communicated claims.

That broad usage overlaps with, but is not identical to, the narrower construct measured by **Chloe Campbell, Michal Tanzer, Rob Saunders, Thomas Booker, Elizabeth Allison, Elizabeth Li, Claire O'Dowda, Patrick Luyten, and Peter Fonagy** in "Development and Validation of a Self-Report Measure of Epistemic Trust" (2021), where *epistemic credulity* is one of three measured positions alongside trust and mistrust. In this entry, *credulity* normally refers to a nonclinical tendency or situational failure, not to a diagnosis. Ordinary authority-gated updating is usually selective. It may arise from:

A later comprehensive review of epistemic-trust research distinguishes the development of selective trust in children, adult epistemic stances, and their possible relations to mental health. It reports Fonagy and colleagues' proposal that early caregiving and wider social experience help shape whether communicated knowledge is treated as personally relevant and usable for general social learning, while emphasizing that several theoretical assumptions still need stronger experimental tests. Culture Mechanics uses only the bounded developmental and source-routing possibility. It does not infer attachment history, psychopathology, or a person's general trust disposition from reception of one message.

- prestige bias;
- attachment or dependency;
- high need for closure;
- authoritarian submission;
- identity-protective cognition;
- fear of exclusion;
- lack of corrective mindware;

- information overload;
- genuine inability to inspect a technical claim;
- repeated experience that deference is rewarded and questioning punished.

Need for closure and authoritarian submission are susceptibility variables, not synonyms for mechanical solidarity or master signifiers. A conventionally anti-authoritarian person may be captured by counter-institutional master signifiers such as *Awakening*, *Resistance*, *The People*, or *Hidden Truth*. The deeper vulnerability is often a low tolerance for leaving the gap of uncertainty open.

Calibrated vigilance avoids both indiscriminate trust and indiscriminate distrust. Contrarianism is not agency if the person automatically reverses every institutional statement or submits to a counter-gatekeeper. Inverted authority-gating remains authority-gating.

10. Pastoral epistemic authority

Pastoral authority is authority legitimated through care, protection, guidance, personal knowledge, or concern for another person's welfare. The major theoretical antecedent is the French philosopher and historian **Michel Foucault's** account of *pastoral power*, including "The Subject and Power" (1982). Its epistemic form arises when the trusted guide becomes an interpreter not only of what the person ought to do but of what their experience means and what counts as reality.

This functional use overlaps with discussions of **pastoral power**, especially authority exercised through individualized guidance, care, confession, and direction of conduct. **Pastoral epistemic authority** is a narrower synthetic term for the resulting relation to knowledge; it should not be treated as an exact synonym for every historical or Foucauldian use of pastoral power.

Healthy pastoral epistemic authority can offer:

- counsel during uncertainty;
- interpretation where technical and existential questions overlap;
- accompaniment through fear or confusion;
- a trusted provisional judgment when the person cannot investigate alone;
- support for eventually recovering independent judgment.

It becomes **pastoral epistemic gatekeeping** when care preempts examination. Dependence feels like safety, disagreement feels like ingratitude or betrayal, and the guide's interpretation becomes more authoritative than the person's accessible evidence. The relationship can then transfer responsibility for judgment while preserving the subjective feeling of being protected.

Pastoral authority need not be personal. An institution may present itself as society's caretaker; an unknown spokesperson then inherits a pastoral tone from the office. The institution does not merely claim, "We possess relevant evidence." It claims, implicitly or explicitly, "We know what is happening, what it means for you, and what a responsible person should feel and do."

11. From local bigOthers to a mechanically solidary field

This section develops the field effect previewed in *Culture Mechanics*. It preserves the individual-to-field order: homo duplex supplies the local source and receiver; communication among many such persons produces an emergent organization; that organization then acts back upon the individuals who sustain it.

Handoff from the individual architecture Seven constructs must remain distinct:

Construct	Function in the present theory
Lacan's big Other	The shared symbolic order and, in the present functional translation, the on-the-wire protocol of language, law, roles, conventions, master signifiers, and recognized symbolic authority. This does not exhaust Lacan's concept.
Local bigOther	The individual sentiment classifier that executes the installed mythological lens and transmits and receives through the shared protocol.

Construct	Function in the present theory
Mechanical solidarity	Field coherence generated as compatible local bigOthers repeatedly produce and answer common classifications and sentiments.
Distributed bigOther	The dynamically maintained symbolic-affective network state reproduced through local bigOthers, institutions, roles, practices, stories, and artifacts.
Multi-mind-self presentation	The collective represented, perceived, addressed, or incarnated in self-like form. This presentation can organize loyalty and action without establishing a collective agent.
Operative multi-mind-self / multi-mind-self proper	The distributed system after it becomes sufficiently integrated and continuous to perceive, remember, judge, intend, own, and act as a collective agent. Not every field, self-presentation, or crowd reaches this threshold.
Fused multi-mind-self	An operative multi-mind-self that additionally displaces participating persons as independently legitimate authors across the relevant jurisdiction. Agency and fusion are separate thresholds.

The relation is causal rather than synonymous:

```
LOCAL BIGOTHERS
individual sources and receivers
             ↓ communicate through
SHARED SYMBOLIC PROTOCOL / LACANIAN BIG OTHER
             ↓ may generate
MECHANICAL-SOLIDARITY COHERENCE
             ↓ maintains
DISTRIBUTED BIGOTHER
             ↓ may be represented or encountered as
MULTI-MIND-SELF PRESENTATION
             ↓ may become sufficiently integrated as
OPERATIVE MULTI-MIND-SELF
             ↓ may additionally absorb personal standing as
FUSED MULTI-MIND-SELF
```

This sequence is a vocabulary map, not a necessary developmental ladder. A distributed bigOther can remain below self-like presentation; a presentation can remain below collective agency; and an operative collective agent can remain differentiated and person-preserving. Conversely, a fusion ideology can seek subjecthood absorption without forming a competent collective agent.

The document therefore uses two registers. In explanatory prose, *multi-mind-self* may be convenient family-level shorthand where no threshold inference depends upon the word. In definitions, diagnostics, evidence claims, and assignments of intention, ownership, or responsibility, **multi-mind-self presentation**, **operative multi-mind-self**, and **fused multi-mind-self** must be distinguished. Existing technical compounds such as **continuing multi-mind-self**, **episodic multi-mind-self**, and **unitary ownership by the multi-mind-self** use the operative sense unless a passage explicitly says otherwise.

Field formation and back-action The originating physical analogy compares the local bigOther to a charged particle. A charged particle is a source of an electromagnetic field and is also acted upon by the field produced by other charges. Likewise, each local bigOther emits socially intelligible classifications and responses while remaining susceptible to the organized signals, expectations, sanctions, institutions, and apparent consensus produced by other nodes.

```
local classification
        ↓ encoded in word, gesture, symbol, role, or sanction
public signal enters the shared symbolic order
        ↓ interpreted and answered by other local bigOthers
```

```
reciprocal signals become patterned and mutually expected
        ↓
mechanical-solidarity field / distributed bigOther
        ↓ back-action
changes salience, feeling, legitimacy, trust, and perceived possibility
inside each participant
        ↻
```

Culture Mechanics gives the authoritative treatment of **ideological symbols**, **conformity signals**, and **targeting signals** at this individual-to-public interface. Performance, absence, refusal, substitution, imposition, or attribution can make conformity or target status publicly legible; the field mechanism here begins when other local bigOthers classify and answer that signal. Its private, collective, ideological, and fundamentalist person–programme taxonomy, its separate outward propagation and enforcement profile, jealousy and *Beseelung* axes, and its account of moralized character accusation are not repeated in this document.

The field is causally real within culture mechanics. It is implemented through persons, communication, institutions, practices, and artifacts, but its relational organization cannot be reconstructed adequately by describing each person as if their psychology had formed in isolation. Public classifications alter incentives; institutions preserve memory; roles survive replacement of their occupants; signals become common knowledge; and each participant responds partly to what they expect others to expect. The field therefore has downward or back-action without requiring a carrier-free substance.

Culture-propagator person–field projection The culture propagator gives the complete cross-scale state-transition model. This document owns its person–field projection: the coupled change of person-level configurations p_t and the distributed field d_t through public signals, reciprocal expectation, trusted routing, sanctions, roles, practices, institutions, and retained relational history.

The minimal recursion is:

```
operative representation and situated encounter
→ local-bigOther classification and main-CPU judgment
→ speech, conduct, refusal, role performance, sanction, or practice
→ interpretation and response by other local bigOthers
→ patterned mutual expectation and collective-field change
→ altered salience, legitimacy, trust, relationship, and perceived possibility
→ later local classification and judgment
↻
```

This is a reflexive loop because a representation does not merely describe an independently completed population. Once communicated and acted upon, it can change the persons, relationships, institutions, and expectations from which its later evidence will be drawn. No central designer is required. Downstream participants can be sincere, locally reasonable, differently informed, and unaware of the wider trajectory while their mutually conditioned responses still produce an emergent field effect.

Reflexive gain asks how strongly a representation-induced response returns through the field to amplify, damp, reverse, or redirect the next response. The relevant feedback is signed, delayed, network-local, nonlinear, and potentially asymmetric rather than one permanent scalar property of a society. One path can amplify while another damps; a strong immediate response can decay, while a weak repeated signal can accumulate through trusted carriers, institutions, or memory. Reflexive gain must therefore remain distinct from initial representational leverage, transition proximity, sensor endogeneity, correction independence, and persistence after the input ends.

A two-variable local heuristic can make the round trip inspectable:

$$\dot{q} = F(q, r), \qquad \dot{r} = G(r, q), \qquad \ell = \frac{\partial F}{\partial r}\frac{\partial G}{\partial q},$$

where r is an operative representation and q the declared social response variable. The sign of ℓ indicates the local return direction and its magnitude the local amplification only under the specified approximation. In the full propagator the relevant object is a signed and delayed feedback Jacobian or family of directional derivatives. A norm or spectral radius may summarize a fitted local model, but it must not erase causal direction, timing, threshold, network position, or asymmetric power.

High reflexive gain is not the same as proximity to a transition boundary. A high-gain system deep inside a robust basin can make a large excursion and return, while a moderate-gain system near a fragile boundary can tip into another reproducible regime. Immediate reaction size therefore cannot substitute for a separate estimate of basin margin or transition proximity.

Gain and transition margin are time-indexed rather than permanent attributes of a society. Adoption, response, consequence, sensing, correction, institutionalization, and reproduction can run on different clocks. A delayed corrective path can permit a temporary overshoot without durable transition, while a short interval of high gain or small margin can let a modest perturbation outlast its source. Empirical analysis must therefore compare those timescales rather than infer long-run persistence from immediate intensity.

An intended correction can consequently become another participant's next disturbance:

```
A detects danger in B
→ A constrains or counteracts B
→ B adapts, resists, conceals, or organizes defensively
→ A encounters the induced response as further danger
→ A intensifies the countermeasure
↻
```

The generated danger can be real without being independent corroboration of the initial causal story. The diagnostic question is how much would remain without the countermeasure and how much was generated, selected, displaced, or intensified through it. A common external shock, independently increasing danger, proportionate defence, unequal power, or one-sided closure can produce superficially similar escalation. The loop therefore neither presumes equal contribution nor turns restraint into a universal prescription.

Bridge persons, cross-cutting relationships, shared practices, independent associations, and common correction procedures are not merely static social assets. They are feedback paths capable of transmitting a counter-signal, preserving rival evidence, slowing negative-identity formation, or carrying an adverse fact across a field boundary. Conversely, making those relations costly can increase effective gain within separated clusters even where no participant intends cultural fission.

The projection preserves four boundaries:

1. person-level change does not reduce to field change, and field change does not erase the local bigOther/main-CPU distinction;
2. a field is not established by an average attitude or a large reaction alone;
3. reciprocal amplification does not establish equal power, equal closure, coordination, conspiracy, or shared intent; and
4. field coherence, reproduction, self-like presentation, operative collective agency, and fusion remain separate findings.

The analogy with a **photon** isolates a second hypothesis: an organized social meaning can retain relative identity while its biological and material carriers change. A law, office, ritual, master signifier, or institutional expectation may persist while speakers, documents, and officeholders are replaced. This is relative carrier-independence, not disembodiment and not a claim that symbolic messages are literally photons.

These comparisons are explanatory pictures and hypothesis generators. The theory does not posit a social electromagnetic force, Maxwellian equations, or a physical identity between affective alignment and field physics.

Laser synchronization, magnetization, and cultural domains The originating umbrella for this family is deliberately memorable:

> **Culture Mechanics is the Quantum Mechanics of Psychology.**

The intended comparison is statistical, micro-to-macro, and observational. Human capacities and local cultural processing that are inconspicuous in ordinary life can become publicly observable when many interacting persons produce collective order. The theory seeks population-level tendencies, distributions, thresholds, and feedback relations, not exceptionless prediction of every individual. The relevant scientific family is broader than quantum mechanics: it also includes classical statistical mechanics, nonlinear dynamics, phase transitions, and condensed-matter physics. The Vicsek model of self-driven particles, for example, is a classical model in which neighbor alignment and noise produce a transition in collective motion.

When local bigOthers exchange signals and observe one another's reactions, they can synchronize. The **laser analogy** emphasizes driven, temporally concentrated coherence:

Laser analogy	Culture-mechanical counterpart
Emitters	Individual persons and local bigOthers
Energy input	Fear, hope, anger, enthusiasm, moral concern
Coupling	Education, media, ritual, repetition, and institutions
Mode selection	Master signifiers and authoritative classifications
Phase-like alignment	Similar attention, affect, rhythm, interpretation, judgment, and response
Coherent output	Public mania, ritual effervescence, collective judgment, enforcement, or coordinated action

The originating formulation says that people can be:

> **charged with the mythologies of a multi-mind-self**

and then discharge as a crowd moving with common direction and rhythm. This sentence uses *multi-mind-self* in the family-level explanatory register: the mythologies can represent the collective as one self before an operative collective agent has been established. It preserves the framework's language of ***Beseelung***: mythology can make a collective orientation affectively alive before a visible triggering episode. Preparation or synchronized discharge does not by itself establish that a multi-mind-self proper already exists. That threshold additionally requires continuing integration sufficient for collective perception, memory, judgment, intention, ownership, and action. Public manias can be deliberately engineered, accidentally amplified, or endogenously self-organized. They are not necessarily "unnatural," and astrophysical lasers show that lasers are not exclusively human-made.

The complementary **magnetization analogy** makes durable spatial patterning more vivid. Local magnetic moments can align through interaction rather than invention by a central controller. A material may contain differently aligned domains, and a boundary can remain sharp even though the same underlying kinds of elements exist on both sides. **Remanence** is retained magnetization after the forming field is removed. In the social analogy it names the hypothesis that classifications, sentiments, and expectations can persist after a strong forming ritual, leader, institution, or media environment weakens. Likewise, neighboring populations may sustain distinct classifications, customs, and aesthetic expectations through dense local reinforcement.

Ferromagnetism depends upon quantum exchange, but ordinary iron should not be described as every component occupying one global quantum-coherent state. NIST's review of metallic ferromagnetism connects exchange-supported spin polarization with domain structure, while Feynman's discussion of magnetic materials explains domains, wall motion, and hysteresis. A laser is an open, pumped, dissipative process; a ferromagnet is ordinarily treated as an ordered material phase. Their shared structure is an abstract pattern of collective order and symmetry breaking, not one state or guaranteed universality class. Experiments can nevertheless describe a stochastic order parameter and spontaneous symmetry breaking in laser regimes; see Ohadi et al..

The originating Bavaria-and-Swabia observation illustrates the hypothesis. Customs such as *Blumenschmuck* or *Kehrwoche*, regional house forms, standards of cleanliness, and visible treatment of shared space may change markedly across a cultural boundary. The observation makes a proposed domain wall perceptible; it does not by itself establish a population-level mechanism, explain every resident, or show that boundaries are immutable. Migration, bilingual participation, institutions, media, and individual dissent can weaken, cross, or reorganize them.

The detailed magnetic-moment, domain, domain-wall, and remanence mapping is a user- and project-developed analogy, not Durkheim's theory. William James provides a closer psychological precursor: in *The Varieties of Religious Experience* he describes abstract realities as polarizing and magnetizing human lives. Gustave Le Bon uses "magnetic influence" and hypnotic fascination in *Psychologie des foules* (1895; English translation). Neither author proposed the culture-mechanical topology. **Coercivity, nucleation, domain expansion, and competing magnetization** remain candidate extensions, not canonical mechanisms.

First-order and **lifted mechanical solidarity** can both magnetize a field. In the first, alignment concerns shared concrete rules and answers. In the lifted form, alignment concerns the generator by which concrete answers are produced, applied, and corrected. The resulting answers may differ across time and situation without weakening solidarity because the shared operation has moved to a more abstract level, not disappeared.

These physical comparisons are explanatory pictures and hypothesis generators. Quantum mechanics is not merely statistical: the standard formalism gives probabilities for measurement outcomes while representing time evolution

unitarily; see MIT's *Quantum Theory I* lecture notes. People are also reflexive and strategic: they can interpret, resist, deceive, defect, and change the institutions being modeled. The analogy asserts no social wavefunction, quantum consciousness, or shared physical equations. For the relationship among the field, laser, magnet, clockwork, computing, and braiding pictures, see *Analogical Models in Culture Mechanics: A Semantic Inventory*.

Observability, cultural forgetting, and contemporary witnesses The analogy family carries a stronger historical hypothesis than periodic activation of an otherwise intact collective being:

> **A society can lose the cultural knowledge, practices, narratives, rituals, and institutions needed to generate strongly synchronized multi-mind-selves.**

The underlying human capacity may remain, just as the biological capacity for language remains even when a particular language disappears. The relevant cultural technology can nevertheless be forgotten. Rules may survive as fossils—followed through habit, convenience, or enforcement but no longer spiritually charged. They can coordinate people without ***Beseelung***.

This possibility is part of the originating autobiographical account:

> **For the first nearly fifty years of my life, I was not aware of multi-mind-selves in their strongest expressions. I do not believe that I merely overlooked an active phenomenon. Its strongest forms were not there to be seen. I began to notice them when a sequence of public manias made their effects hard to miss.**

The report is a theoretically generative observation and an autobiographical interpretation, not by itself a population-level demonstration of cultural loss. Its conceptual force is to deny that calm-period absence must mean dormancy. Lionel Shriver provides a neighboring contemporary diagnosis. In "How to spot the next mania", she writes that since roughly 2012 she has been disturbed by renewed susceptibility to rapidly spreading "collective derangement" and identifies a succession of public manias. Her novel *Mania* (2024) turns that concern into fiction. Her testimony helps establish that she experienced a change in the phenomenon's visibility; it does not establish the present theory's mechanism.

For most everyday life, "Newtonian psychology" is good enough. Preferences, decisions, rule-following, cooperation, competition, and responses to incentives usually do not require a theory of multi-mind-selves. The explanatory demand changes when many persons suddenly align in attention, emotion, language, moral judgment, and action. A normally inconspicuous human capacity then "shines through" into macroscopic life. The laser picture proposes one active sequence:

```
cultural preparation through mythologies
+ emotionally charged triggering event
+ reciprocal observation and reinforcement
+ suppression or exclusion of counter-signals
→ coherent collective passion and action
```

The **weak-field gravity analogy** concerns access to that sequence. When no strongly synchronizing multi-mind-self is present, the causal signature may be too weak to attract attention. Researchers observing only calm-period individuals can therefore mistake the sufficiency of ordinary psychology under those conditions for proof that no additional collective mechanism can ever become causally important.

A weak present-day signature leaves at least three historical possibilities open:

Calm-period condition	What remains	What a later trigger can do
Dormant	Living mythology and the old synchronization practices remain available but inactive	A suitable event can reactivate the familiar collective state
De-animated	Rules and symbols remain, but their sacred, affective, and identity-bearing connections have deteriorated	A trigger may produce compliance or mild sentiment without strong collective synchronization
Culturally lost	Only fragments or no viable transmission and activation system remain	A later "revival" may require construction of a successor system rather than reactivation of the former one

The distinction is not between effective and ineffective rules. “Do not cross when the pedestrian light is red” can coordinate conduct perfectly well while carrying little guilt, sacred attachment, identity, or capacity for collective sacrifice. *Dead* means affectively or spiritually dead in the originating dead–alive analogy. The loss of one synchronization technology also does not leave a person’s PCI slot empty: another operative mythological weave continues to occupy the local bigOther.

From calm-period remains alone, dormancy, de-animation, and cultural loss may be difficult to distinguish. Later observers can possess the old texts, words, and symbols while lacking access to their former animating force. This gives ***Zeitzeugen***—contemporary witnesses—a specific evidential role:

Witness	Strong-field observation retained by this theory
Julien Benda	*La trahison des clercs* (1927) records political passions becoming coherent, continuous, sacred, morally systematized, and supported by intellectual production and communication.
Dietrich Bonhoeffer	“Von der Dummheit” (1943) records the person-level effect of overwhelming political or religious power: loss of inner independence and displacement of judgment by slogans and formulas.
Lionel Shriver	Her 2024 account records noticing a renewed succession of public manias, or what this framework calls collective demonstrations of our capacity to “lose our minds.”
Originating author	The autobiographical contrast places a long period of macroscopic absence beside a later period in which the proposed beings became difficult to miss.

Benda and Bonhoeffer are complementary. In the gravitational picture, Benda describes the massive body forming and the surrounding field intensifying; Bonhoeffer describes what can happen to a person already caught deep inside that field. These authors, Shriver, and the originating author are not calibrated instruments. They can be selective, frightened, morally involved, synchronized, or mistaken. Yet when the primary phenomenon is no longer present, something is better than nothing: reports by people who were there and tried to capture the effect in words are the next-best evidence of its experienced form. Situatedness creates bias, but it also creates access.

The resulting observability thesis is:

> **Culture Mechanics is difficult to discover because its underlying human capacities and local processes are usually inconspicuous, and cultures may even lose the practices that once made them macroscopically visible. A tightly synchronized multi-mind-self is therefore not always available for direct study. During a calm period, its mythology and synchronization practices may remain dormant and capable of reactivation. But the culture may also have forgotten how to produce the state: its living mythologies may have deteriorated into affectively dead rules, detached symbols, and habitual procedures, or a viable transmission system may have disappeared. From the weak present-day signature alone, we may be unable to distinguish dormancy from cultural decay or extinction. Only under exceptional conditions do these capacities break through into macroscopic life as collective effervescence, public mania, intensified mechanical solidarity, or a tightly synchronized multi-mind-self. Contemporary witnesses are therefore important because they observed the rules, symbols, and mythologies while these were still spiritually charged and collectively active. If we study humanity only during calm periods, we may mistake the temporary or historical absence of these beings for evidence that they cannot exist.**

Gravity models **detectability**, not the collective phenomenon’s ontology. Gravity becomes weaker with distance, whereas a particular cultural system may genuinely decay or disappear. Nor does ordinary orbital weightlessness mean that gravity is absent: an orbiting spacecraft is in free fall, as NASA’s account of orbital mechanics explains. The precise physical picture is therefore a spacecraft in a weak-field region far from massive bodies. *Analogical Models in Culture Mechanics: A Semantic Inventory* places this limit inside the complete nested analogy.

Activation profiles and episodic multi-mind-selves Collective agency and momentary synchrony have different temporal profiles. A multi-mind-self can remain a continuing agent through records, roles, trained members, decision procedures, institutions, property, and recurrent practices without remaining laser-synchronized at every moment.

Conversely, a distributed bigOther can cross the collective-agent threshold only during a bounded episode. The latter is an **episodic multi-mind-self**:

> **An episodic multi-mind-self is a distributed bigOther that becomes sufficiently integrated to perceive, remember, judge, intend, own, and act as a collective agent only during bounded periods of adequate coupling, common attention, reciprocal feedback, and coordinated execution.**

The adjective *episodic* is preferable to *temporal*, because every collective is temporal. It identifies threshold crossing and state change rather than mere duration.

Profile	Baseline	Activated state	What persists afterward
Continuing multi-mind-self with variable gain	The collective remains an agent through low-intensity clockwork coordination	A crisis or ritual produces intensified laser synchrony	The same institutional self returns to lower gain
Episodic multi-mind-self	A viable distributed bigOther remains below the collective-agent threshold	A bounded event temporarily supplies sufficient integration and collective action	Identity-bearing practices and memory permit later reactivation
Latent distributed bigOther	Mythology and activation procedures remain viable but are not presently integrated as an acting self	A suitable trigger may reactivate the old configuration	The possibility of recurrence remains
De-animated remainder	Rules, symbols, or procedures persist without their former sacred and affective force	A trigger may produce coordination without the former collective being	Function survives more readily than animation
Culturally lost machinery	No viable transmission and activation system remains	A later movement must construct a successor rather than wake the old system	Fragments need not preserve the former identity

The familiar **sleep–waking analogy** fits only the viable-latency cases. Human identity is materially anchored by one organism across sleep. A distributed collective instead depends upon calendars, texts, places, offices, rituals, artifacts, memories, and trained participants to preserve an identity-bearing path between episodes. If those carriers and reactivation relations have disappeared, the old collective is not asleep; it may be extinct.

Three boundary cases clarify the distinction:

Candidate	Baseline state	Peak state	Interpretive limit
Catholic pilgrimage (*Wallfahrt*)	Church, calendar, route, shrine, liturgy, stories, and trained participants preserve a latent or continuing religious field	Common movement, prayer, song, place, and mutual observation can produce short-lived collective effervescence and a possible episodic multi-mind-self	Strong synchrony or felt boundary-softening does not prove subjecthood absorption; differentiated pilgrims, clergy, musicians, caregivers, and dissent can remain
Military unit in battle	Training, command roles, records, equipment, traditions, and unit identity may preserve a continuing institutional agent	Danger, shared attention, rapid signals, and ferocious coordinated action can create an exceptionally high-gain mode with possible temporary fusion	Disciplined combined-arms action can be highly agentic yet differentiated; panic or a rout can be contagious without coherent agency

Candidate	Baseline state	Peak state	Interpretive limit
Subak irrigation and temple system	Irrigation, allocation, ritual, governance, memory, and common ownership can sustain relatively low-intensity continuing agency	Maintenance, drought, allocation conflict, or ritual can create periodic laser moments	The example is an originating interpretation and hypothesis, not proof that Subak has one phenomenal consciousness

The Subak case is especially useful because it shows how a multi-mind-self might remain continuous without permanent laser synchronization. Its ordinary operation can be substantially clockwork-like while periodic laser moments renew the moral, ritual, and institutional protocol. A military unit can display the same pattern at a shorter timescale. A pilgrimage more plausibly tests the episodic threshold.

> **A multi-mind-self need not remain laser-synchronized continuously. It may persist through distributed memory and organization while moving between low-activation clockwork operation and high-activation laser episodes.**

Activation and fusion remain independent questions:

> **Activation asks whether the collective is presently acting as a self. Fusion asks what standing participating persons retain while it does so.**

An activated collective can therefore remain differentiated; it can become temporarily absorptive; or a latent distributed bigOther can remain below the multi-mind-self threshold. Likewise, intense copying or common rhythm may fail to form an agent if continuing perception, memory, judgment, intention, ownership, or organized action is missing.

Crowd modes, collective effervescence, and Durkheim's solidarities The project uses three ideal-typical crowd modes. A **random crowd** shares space without a common task and is weakly coupled for the variable under study. A **clockwork crowd** routes differentiated roles or aggregates independent contributions toward a common result. In **routed clockwork**, as in a pit crew, participants are functionally interdependent through interfaces and handoffs. In **aggregative clockwork**, as when independent forecasts are externally averaged, the contributors may have little functional dependence upon one another even though their variety improves the aggregate. A **laser crowd** aligns timing, attention, affect, interpretation, judgment, or action. *Mythology Construction*, "Coordination, synchronization, and the coupling thermostat," gives their design-level treatment.

The governing reader picture is:

> **Coordination and synchronization are the two ends of a single continuum of interaction strength.**

This is an ideal-typical continuum rather than a claim that every empirical group has only one dimension. Here interaction strength primarily means pressure toward shared timing, attention, affect, interpretation, and response. Functionally interdependent specialists may remain clockwork-like, and an orchestra or pit crew can combine differentiated roles with temporary high synchrony.

A compact diagnostic separates **synchrony** `S`, **functional coupling** `F`, and **task error** `E`. `S` asks whether participants are in step, `F` asks how their contributions depend upon or hand off to one another, and `E` asks whether the result performs the specified task accurately. A Kuramoto-style order parameter `r` can instantiate `S` where a meaningful phase exists; mean squared error can instantiate `E` where a target exists. Neither quantity defines a crowd mode or a form of solidarity, and MSE does not measure functional dependence. The full measurement note and its boundary cases are in *Analogical Models in Culture Mechanics: A Semantic Inventory*.

The project-developed Durkheimian correspondence is:

```
mechanical-solidarity field formation or renewal ↔ laser synchronization
organic differentiation                          ↔ clockwork coordination
```

The compact relationship table prevents process, cohesion, durable state, organization, and meta-order from being treated as synonyms:

Construct	Kind of thing	Typed relationship in this model
Laser synchronization	Dynamic alignment process	Can dynamically produce or periodically renew mechanical solidarity
Collective effervescence	Intensified ritual or assembly experience	Resembles a laser moment and can carry its renewing work
Mechanical solidarity	Cohesion through common classifications and sentiments	Can be produced or renewed by alignment and stabilized as durable field order
Magnetization	Picture of durable aligned state, domains, and remanence	Stabilizes or preserves the orientation after an active laser episode
Clockwork coordination	Differentiated organizational mode	Resembles the organic-differentiation component of Durkheimian organic solidarity
Durkheimian organic solidarity	Source concept of cohesion through differentiated interdependence	Is analytically decomposed here into organic differentiation and lifted mechanically solidary binding force
Lifted mechanical solidarity	Shared binding meta-order	Constitutes and corrects the common role, obligation, and legitimacy relations of a differentiated order
Multi-mind-self	Collective agent above an integration threshold	May emerge from sufficient continuing integration; no preceding relation makes it automatic

The relation is **resembles, supports, or renews**, not **is identical to**. Laser synchronization is a dynamic process; mechanical solidarity is a form of cohesion through common classifications and sentiments. Clockwork coordination is an organizational mode; organic differentiation is a topology of specialized activity. Durkheimian organic solidarity remains the source composite, while the present theory locates its common binding force at the lifted mechanically solidary level. Organic differentiation and a mechanically solidary field can coexist, and a magnetized field can remain stable without an active laser state.

The preferred term is **clockwork coordination**, not *clockwork synchronization*. Clockwork names differentiated contributions connected through roles, interfaces, handoffs, aggregation rules, and a common meta-order. It has an affinity with **differentiated unity**, but the two are not identical: clockwork describes organization in action, whereas differentiated unity describes the standing retained by persons and subordinate parts within a real shared *we*.

Laser synchronization likewise does not by itself mean **subjecthood absorption (fusion)**. A **bounded laser synchronization** aligns a selected variable for a limited task, time, or jurisdiction. A choir, emergency team, ritual assembly, or pit crew can therefore synchronize intensely while retaining differentiated members and bounded authority. A **generalized and jurisdictionalized laser synchronization** extends the demanded alignment across domains, maintains it beyond the original task, treats independent judgment as noise or betrayal, and makes the shared classification compulsory. That is a pathway to **fusion pressure**, not proof that fusion has occurred.

Vince Gilligan's Apple TV series *Pluribus* (2025) supplies a fictional limit case. Its "Joining" generalizes common goals, values, knowledge, affect, and action across nearly all humanity and seeks to absorb the remaining immune persons. The story therefore dramatizes the path from generalized and jurisdictionalized alignment to subjecthood absorption. It ultimately exceeds the laser analogy, because its characters become one literal shared consciousness rather than distinct persons synchronized in selected variables. The analogy inventory's *Pluribus* note states the mapping and non-inference.

The Borg in *Star Trek* supply a hostile counterpart at approximately the same fictional endpoint. Their interconnected collective consciousness forcibly assimilates persons and technology, pursues perfection by adding useful distinctiveness to itself, and answers independent refusal with "Resistance is futile." The comparison separates absorptive architecture from program content: *Pluribus* presents fusion through peace, happiness, and care, while the Borg present it through efficiency, adaptation, dominance, and coercion. In both cases, independent subjecthood and exit cease to have standing. The Borg sharpen the distinction between functional variation and differentiated unity: a collective may preserve a person's capabilities as collective resources while abolishing the person as

their independent owner and judge. The analogy inventory's Borg note states the detailed mapping, vocabulary qualification, and non-inference.

Two axes must consequently remain independent:

Axis	Low or failing pole	High pole	It does not decide
Cultural interoperability	Society-wide translation and common procedure fail	Differentiated groups remain able to share a cultural or political field	Whether persons are absorbed into a collective subject
Subjecthood absorption	Personal and subordinate standing is protected	Judgment, conscience, purpose, property, loyalty, identity, refusal, and exit are subordinated to the collective	Whether groups can translate or coordinate across their differences

High cultural interoperability with low subjecthood absorption is the characteristic space of person-preserving differentiated unity. High interoperability can also be closed and absorptive; low interoperability can coexist with intense local laser synchronization and local fusion pressure. *Mythology Construction*, "Cultural interoperability and its breakdown (Babelization)" defines the first axis and its relationship to lifted mechanical solidarity.

Durkheim's *Les formes élémentaires de la vie religieuse* (1912) describes assemblies in which a "sort of electricity" forms, sentiments echo and amplify, and gestures and cries become rhythmic and unified. The English translation also calls religious technique a "sort of mystic mechanics." **Collective effervescence** can therefore resemble a laser moment without becoming laser physics.

Lifted mechanical solidarity can supply the shared moral or constitutional protocol under which differentiated roles, professions, and institutions remain legitimate and mutually intelligible:

> **The laser moment periodically regenerates the moral protocol used by the clockwork system.**

This recursive claim does not make every synchronized crowd a multi-mind-self or every mechanically solidary order epistemically captured.

Repeater gain and crowds Every local bigOther transmits. **Repeater** or **high-gain repeater** is the network analogy for greater reach, credibility, frequency, connectivity, or institutional amplification; it is not a separate social position or a second name for a type of person. When applied to a teacher, priest, officer, celebrity, editor, manager, party official, or institutional spokesperson, it names the amplification dimension of the trusted-opinion-leader function described below. The same analogy can describe the gain of a crowd, institution, channel, or algorithm without turning any of them into a human leader.

The Wi-Fi analogy must not obscure aggregate gain. A synchronized crowd of weak transmitters can equal or exceed one strong repeater: applause, silence, repetition, visible unanimity, ridicule, or coordinated refusal becomes a high-amplitude signal precisely because many participants enact it together. Nor is amplification always vertical. Peer groups, rituals, crowds, and decentralized networks can synchronize without a privileged leader.

Trusted-opinion-leader function, cascades, and cultivated authority **Trusted-opinion-leader function** is the canonical name for the distributed receiving-field position through which selected persons or institutionally authorized role occupants amplify, interpret, validate, model, locally implement, and return feedback about the common field with disproportionate force inside a specified jurisdiction. Different carriers perform these operations in different proportions and at different gain. They are variations of one function, not a taxonomy of "dots," repeaters, trusted opinion leaders, and first officers as separate kinds.

A **trusted opinion leader** is a human person-in-role currently carrying that function: members of a field recurrently refer to the person or authorized office for judgments, interpretations, or validation, thereby giving its classifications disproportionate credibility, transmission, or field-organizing force. The trust can attach primarily to personal reputation or primarily to the role and institution. Thus a newly installed priest can inherit operative trust before becoming personally known, while a former priest can lose that routing position after losing the office. *Trusted* describes socially operative trust, not necessarily warranted trust. *Opinion* includes factual judgments, interpretations, recommendations, and demonstrations of what competent or proper people do; it does not restrict the role

to expressions of subjective preference. *Leader* identifies the human occupant of a receiving-field position without implying formal command.

Julien Benda's ***clerc*** is a neighbouring source-attested role, not another name for this construct. Benda defines the *clerc* through an intellectual vocation answerable to disinterested truth, reason, and justice and diagnoses betrayal when that authority dignifies practical political passions. Culture Mechanics defines the trusted-opinion-leader function from the receiving field: people recurrently refer judgment to a person or authorized role, giving its classifications unusual credibility and transmission.

The two roles can overlap:

Role	Defining question	Relationship
Benda's *clerc*	What intellectual or moral vocation does the authority claim, and does it remain answerable to disinterested truth, reason, and justice?	Source-attested normative-vocational role
Trusted-opinion-leader function / trusted opinion leader	To which distributed receiving-field position does a specified field refer judgment, interpretation, or validation, and who currently carries it?	Project-developed function and its human person-in-role occupant
***Clerc* functioning as trusted opinion leader**	Does intellectual or moral authority also occupy a high-trust routing position in the relevant field?	High-leverage carrier of either correction or moral and epistemic authorization

An obscure intellectual can occupy Benda's vocational role without functioning as a trusted opinion leader in the relevant field. A local peer, athlete, entertainer, or practical exemplar can function as a trusted opinion leader without being a Bendaian *clerc*. Neither title establishes betrayal, capture, truth, or falsehood. The overlap becomes especially important where a power-political programme uses trusted intellectual or moral authority to turn political usefulness into apparent universal validity; that application belongs to *Culture Program Ecology*, "Benda's morality–politics bridge".

The phrase and composite definition are proposed here by adapting the broader opinion-leadership literature. They are not a camel-case renaming of the established medical-marketing category *key opinion leader*. The similarity is nevertheless intentional: **key opinion leader** and **trusted opinion leader** run substantially in parallel as human positions whose influence depends upon recognition by a receiving field, trust or authority within a jurisdiction, privileged transmission, interpretation, peer diffusion, and feedback. The developed body of research on KOL identification, cultivation, credibility, network effects, disclosure, conflicts of interest, and influence measurement can therefore supply hypotheses, methods, comparison variables, and warning signs for studying trusted opinion leaders. Transfer is not automatic validation: medical KOL findings remain domain-bound empirical results, while the trusted-opinion-leader construct is broader and belongs to the present Culture Mechanics synthesis.

A carrier of the trusted-opinion-leader function combines, in variable amounts, amplification or repeater gain, personal or role-conferred epistemic authority, gatekeeping, translation, modelling, brokerage, pastoral guidance, institutional representation, chief-facing mediation, and field feedback. "Repeater" isolates only the amplification dimension. A crowd, channel, or algorithm can therefore have high repeater gain without occupying the trusted-opinion-leader function, while a person with extensive reach may still lack the referral relation that constitutes it.

A **trusted-opinion-leader-function profile** should therefore ask at least:

Axis	Diagnostic question
Amplification or repeater gain	What are the carrier's reach, frequency, connectivity, brokerage, access to common attention, and institutional or algorithmic amplification?
Authority basis	Does reception rest on demonstrated expertise, personal trust, formal office, institutional authorization, pastoral care, familiarity, prestige, or parasocial attachment?

Axis	Diagnostic question
Competence basis and apparent competence	Which competence has been demonstrated for this question; which confidence is instead supplied by prominence, fluency, prestige, repeated visibility, or success in another domain; and would the same claim receive comparable weight from an unknown speaker?
Routing and translation	Does the carrier select, gatekeep, translate, interpret, model, endorse, or relay material?
Chief-facing mediation	Does the carrier operationalize broad direction, defend or shield an elevated directing organ, absorb contention, and return criticism or operational reality upward?
Field feedback	Can the carrier register local reception, make it visible, and return audience resistance and needs to the source or directing function?
Jurisdiction	For which topic, audience, setting, channel, and period does the carrier actually carry authority?
Independence and correction	Who supplied access, funding, evidence, wording, status, and amplification; are apparently plural carriers causally independent; and can the carrier, office, and message be corrected or replaced?

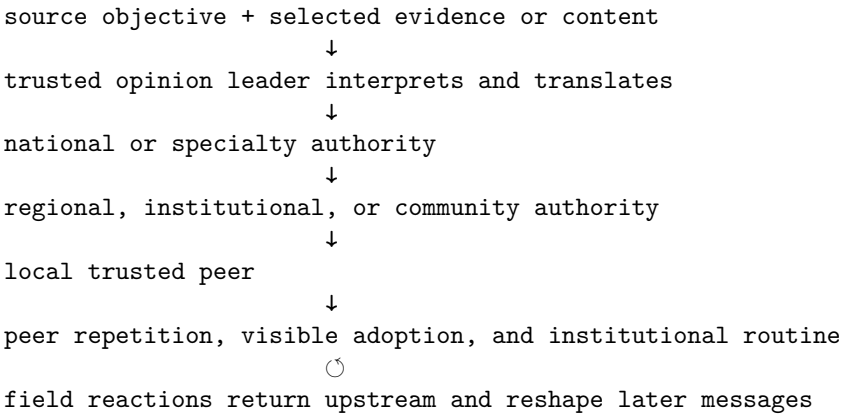
A sparse Fernandes–HateAid–Hubig–ARD worked application uses Hirschhausen's movement from a documented medical deepfake grievance into broader platform, legal, and democratic-risk claims as a bounded illustration of cross-domain authority transfer. The application does not infer falsehood, capture, or policy competence from trusted-opinion-leader status alone.

This profiles one function and, where relevant, its human person-in-role occupant; it is not a psychological essence and does not imply that all dimensions covary. The same axes can be applied analogically to an office, institution, channel, or other nonhuman authority node without redescribing the infrastructure itself as a leader. A medical **key opinion leader** can be a domain-specific subtype when the professional field actually refers judgments to that person; the industry label alone does not establish the relation. Such a person may combine scientific expertise, personal epistemic authority, professional office, institutional proxy, gatekeeping, translation, peer brokerage, and access to congress or guideline audiences. A social-media influencer may become a trusted opinion leader through repeated familiarity, perceived authenticity, identity fit, parasocial attachment, follower interaction, visible engagement, and platform-allocated attention, but audience size alone is insufficient. A physician creator may occupy both the medical-KOL and influencer profiles. In each case, *repeater gain* names one dimension of the same trusted-opinion-leader function rather than a competing person-type.

Influence should be identified from the receiving field rather than inferred from title, publication count, follower count, or formal rank alone. Healthcare implementation research distinguishes sociometric nomination by peers, key-informant identification, self-designation, and observation of behaviour or network effects. These methods need not select the same people. The 2019 Cochrane review *Local Opinion Leaders: Effects on Professional Practice and Healthcare Outcomes* found moderate-certainty evidence that interventions involving local opinion leaders probably improve professional compliance with evidence-based practice, while effects varied and evidence for patient outcomes remained very uncertain. That result supports conditional, jurisdiction-specific influence; it does not validate the full culture-mechanical ontology or show that famous speakers are the locally effective trusted opinion leaders.

The topology is also partly endogenous. Institutions, sponsors, movements, and platforms can discover existing trusted opinion leaders or prospective leaders, appoint them to offices, or amplify and cultivate their positions through research access, authorship, speaking opportunities, professional introductions, office, media exposure, recommendation systems, and repeated visibility. Brian Gac and colleagues' archival study "Pharmaceutical Industry Use of Key Opinion Leaders to Market Prescription Opioids" (2024) documents companies identifying, recruiting, and developing people they called KOLs. The finding establishes that authority topology can be deliberately modified in that historical setting. It does not establish that every cultivated authority is insincere, every payment is corrupting, or every transmitted conclusion is false.

Privileged transmission is commonly bidirectional and multistage. A node can translate evidence or programme content into the field's recognized language, detect objections and practical barriers, and return that information to the source, which then adapts later messages. Transmission may proceed through nested jurisdictions:



At each handoff, wording, emphasis, evidential status, and provenance can change. Several visible authorities may therefore be one causal source repeated through different faces, while one message may mutate from tentative evidence into expert interpretation, recommendation, local shorthand, and finally "what competent people do." Leila Agha and Dan Zeltzer's *Drug Diffusion through Peer Networks: The Influence of Industry Payments* finds payment-associated prescribing changes among paid physicians and their peers in one anticoagulant market; it supports the reality of peer spillovers there, not a general claim that all cascades are paid or manipulative.

The portable lifecycle is therefore a candidate analytical map, not a universal campaign law:

> **field sensing → leader identification, appointment, or cultivation → message or evidence selection → seeding and legitimation → translation → nested cascade → horizontal normalization → institutionalization → maintenance, correction, or replacement**

Analysis should track the source, incentives, transformations, independent routes, field feedback, and propagation of later corrections through this lifecycle. The same architecture can diffuse accurate practice, repair a failed tradition, sell a product, or support covert capture. Influence and truth remain separate variables.

Pre-content source routing and positional transition **Status:** proposed source-position decomposition; the four German labels are a received Bonelli source lead whose exact presentation still requires page-level verification

Messages do not always enter judgment as propositionally neutral candidates. Before adequate examination of their content, a receiving field can classify a source, role, institution, topic, or source–topic combination and thereby alter how much attention, associative work, checking, retention, and transmission the message receives. The source lead attributed to Raphael M. Bonelli's *Tabu: Was wir nicht denken dürfen und warum* supplies four useful routing positions:

Received routing position	Default reception tendency	Candidate epistemic effect
vertrauenswürdig	Favour attention and integration	The message more readily enters the working set, receives associative effort, acquires durable indices, and propagates through the field.
fragwürdig	Scrutinize and integrate conditionally	The message remains potentially available, but uptake depends more heavily upon corroboration, coherence, reasons, and further testing.
uninteressant	Allocate little attention	The message can disappear through neglect before it is richly encoded, joined to other observations, or retained as a standing question.
unerwünscht	Avoid, reject, or defensively reframe	Affective or social aversion can prevent adequate truth evaluation, inhibit the questions the message might generate, and contaminate adjacent sources or formulations.

These are relational positions, not permanent types of people. The relevant unit is at least `source or role × question or domain × receiving field × time`. A physician may be *vertrauenswürdig* on one medical question and *fragwürdig* on a political one. An office can confer initial trust on an unknown occupant, while loss of that office can remove the inherited routing advantage. The same source can be unwanted in one field and trusted in another.

The fourfold clarifies the input side of the trusted-opinion-leader function. Socially operative trust increases the probability that a message receives attention and integration; it does not warrant its truth. Conversely, unwanted source status can prevent a true message from receiving adequate examination; it does not establish that the rejection was irrational or that every ignored source deserved attention. Scarce attention, demonstrated unreliability, lack of jurisdiction, fraud, harassment, and ordinary editorial selection remain valid rival explanations.

The routing state can reach the semantic-access interface before a complete proposition is evaluated:

```
source, role, topic, or association is recognized
→ local bigOther supplies trust, interest, suspicion, danger, or pollution
→ main-CPU attention, retrieval, joining, checking, and articulation change
→ message is integrated, conditionally held, neglected, or defensively routed
→ the visible response becomes further field evidence about the source
↻
```

Bonelli's received fourfold does not by itself explain positional dynamics: how a person or office becomes *vertrauenswürdig*, how trust spills into another jurisdiction, why failure sometimes leaves standing intact, how a source becomes *unerwünscht*, or how an unwanted source re-enters the evaluable range. The trusted-opinion-leader profile and lifecycle supply a project-developed transition programme rather than an attribution to Bonelli:

1. **Entry and cultivation:** demonstrated competence, accurate performance, visible correction, personal familiarity, formal office, peer nomination, endorsement, repeated exposure, institutional access, and platform amplification can create or transfer operative trust.
2. **Maintenance and insulation:** selective visibility of success and failure, control of access or correction, reputation networks, jurisdiction spillover, repeated social proof, and costs borne by others can preserve authority after its original warrant weakens.
3. **Loss or narrowing of trust:** claim-specific performance records, disclosed dependencies, failed correction, loss of authorizing office, independent counter-routes, and credible replacement carriers may move reception toward conditional scrutiny; they may instead polarize the field.
4. **Production of unwanted status:** taboo, stigma, associational contamination, identity threat, moral exclusion, reputational attack, channel denial, office removal, and material sanction are distinct candidate operations requiring separate evidence.
5. **Return to evaluability:** trusted intermediaries, first-person retrieval, source-independent corroboration, safe encounter, shared consequential practice, visible corrigibility, restored access, reply, and appeal may reopen examination without compelling assent.

The resulting research object is a transition graph, not a moral caste system. It should record who assigned or withdrew a routing position, the operative jurisdiction, the evidence and performance history, independent routes, field feedback, sanctions, correction, and change over time. A Sowellian "Teflon prophet" is the limiting maintenance problem: consequential failure does not proportionately reduce later standing or jurisdiction. The opposite problem is rapid de-authorization after dissent despite a potentially valid correction. Neither pattern may be inferred from agreement or disagreement alone.

Distributed narrative reproduction, classification, and enforcement The receiving field can reproduce its routing and alignment conditions through ordinary interactions without a central examiner. Three episodic roles are enough to decompose the loop:

- a **narrative reproducer** repeats or performs the expected narrative, vocabulary, interpretation, or affective response;
- a **narrative classifier** treats another person's reproduction or non-reproduction as evidence of that person's social, moral, or epistemic standing; and
- a **narrative enforcer** attaches, recommends, or normalizes consequences after that classification.

These are functions in an encounter, not person-types. One person can perform all three, different people or institutions can execute successive handoffs, and a person can be examined in one setting while examining another person in the next. Observed reproduction does not establish whether the speaker reasoned independently, acted habitually, anticipated isolation, responded affectively, or strategically sought advantage.

```
receive or observe the accepted narrative
→ reproduce, withhold, question, or refuse it
→ another participant classifies the response as alignment or defect
→ a participant or institution rewards reproduction or burdens refusal
→ witnesses update expectations about consensus and permissible conduct
→ later encounters repeat the test under the changed field
↻
```

The test need not be announced. Required terminology, ritual affirmation, a leading question, a joke demanding the approved reaction, conspicuous silence, denunciation, or a small conversational correction can perform it when the response is used to infer alignment and standing. The loop is one possible micro-to-field mechanism for the distributed enforcement described under Normopathie, but it neither diagnoses a participant nor proves that the reproduced narrative is false.

The analytical gain is to separate statement, standing inference, and consequence. Disagreement with a proposition does not by itself authorize a verdict on the speaker's human standing, while rejection of an illegitimate standing verdict does not require endorsement of the proposition. That separation also identifies two interruption points: a person can decline demanded reproduction, or a person who has reproduced can decline to classify and punish the next participant. The strategy and proportionality of such interruptions belong to the non-authoritative Culture Struggle candidate rather than to this mechanism definition.

Professional idea mediation and prominence-derived apparent competence **Status:** Hayek–Baader source bridge and proposed Culture Mechanics role and mechanism

F. A. Hayek's "The Intellectuals and Socialism" describes intellectuals broadly as professional "secondhand dealers in ideas" who select, translate, and circulate ideas they need not have originated or mastered as specialists. Roland Baader's *totgedacht*, especially pp. 35–40, adopts that broad functional definition and places producers, multipliers, media performers, and mass reception in one transmission problem.

Culture Mechanics calls the source-side position the **professional idea-mediator function**: the recurrent selection, compression, translation, packaging, and circulation of ideas for audiences outside the mediator's original source or specialist domain. A **professional idea mediator** is a person or role occupant who presently performs that function. The position is analytically distinct from the trusted-opinion-leader function, which is defined from the receiving field's referral of judgment:

```
idea producer or specialist source
→ professional idea mediator selects, translates, and packages
→ trusted-opinion-leader position supplies receiving-field trust and routing
→ audience reconstructs, repeats, and acts
→ institutions may convert uptake into routine, authority, and succession
```

One person can occupy several positions. A researcher can produce an idea, mediate it for a general audience, and already possess that audience's trust. A journalist or editor can mediate ideas without becoming the field's trusted judge. A local peer can function as a trusted opinion leader without working as a professional intellectual. The distinction prevents prominence, authorship, expertise, mediation, and receiving-field authority from being treated as one undifferentiated status.

Prominence-derived apparent competence occurs when visibility, verbal facility, prestige, moral seriousness, institutional access, repeated media presence, or demonstrated competence elsewhere supplies operative confidence on the present question without a correspondingly demonstrated competence relation. Baader's "Verrat der Intellektuellen," pp. 124–126, explicitly joins *Prominenz* and *Anscheinskompetenz* to the amplification of political passions. The project turns that observation into a domain-and-reception test. It is narrower than saying that a prominent speaker is incompetent and broader than role-conferred authority spillover: apparent competence can begin with presentation and prominence even where no legitimate source-domain authority exists.

The practical audit asks:

- what competence was actually demonstrated, for which question, domain, and period;
- what trust came from evidence and performance, and what came from title, fluency, familiarity, celebrity, moral posture, or repetition;
- whether the claimed jurisdiction exceeds the demonstrated one;
- whether an unknown speaker presenting the same reasons would receive comparable uptake; and

- whether consequential forecasts, recommendations, and failures revise access, jurisdiction, standing, and later selection.

This last question joins Baader's pre-decision authority formation to Sowell's post-decision correction and "Teflon prophets" problem:

```
institutional visibility and repeated access
→ prominence-derived apparent competence
→ trusted-opinion-leader authority
→ jurisdiction spillover and consequential recommendation
→ costs of error borne mainly by others
→ failure does not proportionately reduce standing or jurisdiction
→ retained prominence renews apparent competence
↻ authority reproduction across later decisions
```

Every arrow remains empirical. The lifecycle can carry sound judgment, and an expert may legitimately speak beyond a narrow specialty while disclosing the basis and limits of the inference. The warning concerns an authority relation in which prominence substitutes for demonstrated competence and performance ceases to govern later trust; it does not classify a person's intelligence, sincerity, motives, or complete body of work.

Carrier-authority surface audit

A public intellectual, expert, priest, editor, teacher, administrator, broker, or professional mediator can occupy several functions at once. The **carrier-authority surface audit** keeps those functions separate before attributing one integrated power position:

Helmut Schelsky's reflection-elite and intellectual-priesthood analysis supplies prior art for distinguishing producers from professional meaning mediators and for asking who controls salvation goods, legitimate self-interpretation, and the transition from movement to salaried office. His contrast between physical coercion and hierocratic influence through the person's inner relation is a source distinction, not a finding that professional mediation is coercive or that interpreters form one coordinated class. Schelsky's earlier institutionalized permanent reflection supplies the positive countercase in which professional interpretation preserves reopening rather than fixing one authorized answer.

Surface	Operational question
Production	Does the carrier originate knowledge or doctrine?
Selection	Which sources and questions are admitted or excluded?
Translation	How are specialist claims converted into public meaning?
Moral judgment	Does the carrier assign innocence, guilt, dignity, danger, or salvation?
Brokerage and placement	Can the carrier route persons, resources, offices, access, or recognition?
Public mediation	Does the receiving field refer judgment to the carrier?
Inner-relation governance	Does access to legitimate identity, belonging, explanation of suffering, or moral repair depend upon this mediation?
Liability	Who bears the material and epistemic cost when the recommendation fails?

Role multiplexing can create unusual reach, but occupation of one row does not establish the others. Sincere vocation and material dependence can coexist; income does not prove cynicism, and sincerity does not remove institutional interest or consequence responsibility. An **epistemic-liability gap** appears when prestige, livelihood, access, or authority accrues near selection and recommendation while foreseeable costs fall mainly upon implementers, affected persons, or successors and failure does not proportionately alter later standing.

The corresponding safeguards are functional separation, visible provenance, domain-specific competence, independent routes of interpretation, prediction and consequence records, affected-person standing, appeal, and real revision of access or jurisdiction after failure. Professionalized interpretation can also be a counterpower when it preserves permanent reflection, plural sources, and reopening rather than monopolizing one answer. The audit therefore establishes neither an intellectual priesthood nor capture from profession, prestige, livelihood, or mediation alone.

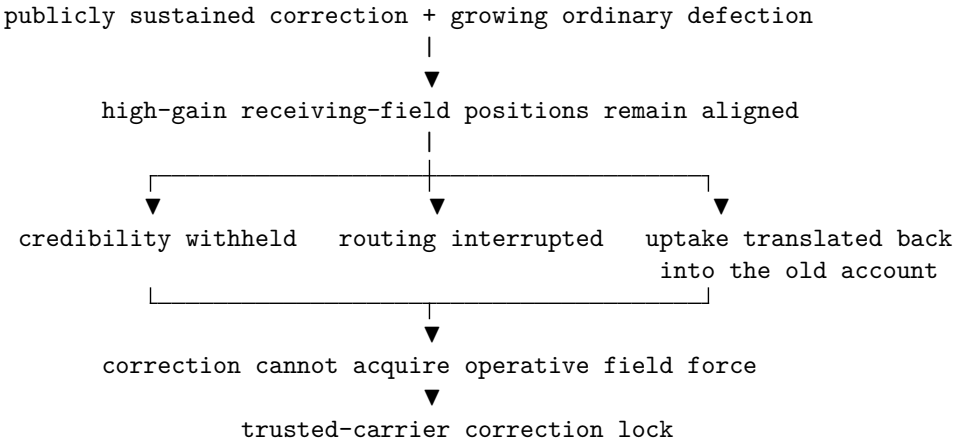
Trusted-carrier correction lock **trusted-carrier correction lock** *noun phrase*

Status: proposed receiving-field morphology

A **trusted-carrier correction lock** exists when high-gain receiving-field positions remain sufficiently aligned to prevent publicly available corrections from acquiring distributed credibility, institutional reception, and operative force—even while ordinary dissent and defection increase.

The construct addresses a gain-weighted field rather than a one-person–one-signal vote. Large numbers of ordinary participants can recognize or repeat a correction while priests, teachers, experts, officials, editors, managers, professional gatekeepers, or other carriers to whom the field refers judgment continue to validate the previous classification. Apparent consensus may weaken without the correction acquiring enough trusted routing to enter records, decisions, appointments, rules, or repair.

This distinguishes **personal defection** from **functional defection**. A trusted opinion leader can privately disagree, retire, or speak outside the relevant office yet fail to move the field. Functional defection occurs when a carrier publicly changes the classification while retaining enough receiving-field authority and routing capacity to make the correction matter. Conversely, a new role occupant can perpetuate the lock without personal continuity. The "dots" in the dotted-semiconductor drawing remain graphic notation for distributed trusted-opinion-leader-function carriers; they are not a separate social type.



Breaking apparent consensus is therefore not enough. Correction must also break or bypass the trusted-carrier lock through which the old course continues to receive credibility, routing, and operative force. Possible routes include:

- trusted carriers defect while retaining enough receiving-field authority to matter;
- the institutional role itself changes its validation rule;
- the population reassigns trust away from the incumbent role;
- independent trusted carriers and institutions acquire parallel routing;
- correction reaches adjudication without passing through the aligned carrier layer; or
- the relevant carrier-function is boundedly de-authorized within an authorized procedure.

The lock is a possible gain-weighted morphological implementation of **correction nullification**, not its synonym. Correction can fail elsewhere in the receiving and operational chain, and a carrier layer can also reopen correction by authenticating, translating, and routing a reliable challenge. Observed professional agreement, common training, evidential convergence, institutional lag, ordinary gatekeeping, or a delayed answer does not by itself establish the lock. Even an established lock proves neither that the correction is true nor coordination, bad faith, capture, systemic lying, one directing actor, or Shadow-Sovereign rule.

Loyal-carrier answerability insulation

The receiving field can reinforce selective civil-personhood breakdown without reproducing the actor-interface mechanism itself. An officeholder can remain ***vertrauenswürdig*** to a loyal constituency while the carriers of adverse records, broken promises, contradiction, or demands for repair are moved toward ***fragwürdig***, ***uninteressant***, or ***unerwünscht***. The resulting asymmetry is not only a contest over propositions:

```
officeholder retains trusted routing
+ corrective carriers lose attention, credibility, or admissibility
+ repeated accountability demands exhaust critics
```

```
+ loyal carriers preserve authorization
→ answerability insulation can survive proposition-level defeat
```

The officeholder need not persuade every critic. It can be enough that the field positions capable of preserving authority, selection, institutional access, or public mediation continue to route the officeholder as trusted while routing the challenge away from consequential uptake. Exhausted critics may then withdraw from repeated adult-reciprocity demands while loyal carriers interpret persistence as steadiness, persecution survived, service to the cause, or proof that no authoritative correction occurred. The relation can reinforce both the paternalistic accountability shield on the critical side and continued authorization on the loyal side. It can also form an **authorization loop**:

```
trusted carriers protect the incumbent account and route
→ loyal receivers preserve carrier and officeholder authority
→ retained authority classifies the next contradiction and its bearer
→ adverse material again loses consequential routing
→ the protected trust architecture enters the next collision intact
```

The loop can be broken without requiring universal conversion when one or more high-gain carriers defect while retaining standing, validation rules change, parallel routes acquire trust, or adjudication bypasses the aligned carrier layer.

A valid proposition-level correction therefore does not automatically revise the source relation that admitted the original account or the trust architecture that protects the officeholder. The audit must ask three successively wider questions:

```
claim update
→ did the specific proposition change?

source-reliability update
→ did failure revise the source's standing in the relevant domain?

trust-architecture and jurisdiction update
→ did the field revise who may speak, validate, decide, and remain authorized?
```

These levels can diverge. A constituency can concede one fact while preserving the officeholder's general authority; reduce personal confidence while leaving the role's inherited routing untouched; or replace the occupant while preserving the same validating field. Conversely, one error need not rationally destroy source standing or office jurisdiction. The warranted update depends upon severity, recurrence, causal responsibility, evidential quality, correction conduct, repair, domain relevance, and serious rivals.

Loyalty, trust, party identification, religious commitment, professional deference, or a routing asymmetry does not by itself establish a correction lock, personality cult, deception, capture, or bad faith. The diagnostic claim requires a sustained correction, consequential routing asymmetry, and failure of proportionate source or jurisdictional updating under conditions in which comparable failure would ordinarily matter.

bigOther-presence as the local experience of field back-action The field is not normally experienced as a sociological diagram. Within a participant it may appear as **bigOther-presence** or **bigOther-as-Thou**: God, Destiny, Nation, History, the People, or the Cause seems objectively present, addresses the person, observes conduct, and can receive loyalty or sacrifice. The terms were defined in *Culture Mechanics*, with William James and Martin Buber as partial phenomenological antecedents. They are project-developed terms, not concepts those authors used for this field mechanism.

This formulation connects the two levels without equating them. The distributed field is the relational organization; bigOther-presence is one way its authority can become locally present to consciousness; the local bigOther is the processor through which the presence is classified and made conduct-directing. A reported religious or moral presence may have additional meanings or causes that this functional account neither proves nor disproves.

Developmental installation of sovereign righteousness **Status:** trunk concept; the target relation and counter-cases are specified, but developmental routes, prevalence, and discriminating evidence remain an open research programme.

The trunk asks how a person comes to experience their judgment not merely as one answerable human judgment, but as the execution of a higher moral and jurisdictional order whose standing overrides ordinary reciprocity.

```
I am not merely a private person
→ I embody, interpret, or execute a higher order
→ overriding another person becomes duty
→ the other's reciprocal standing and appeal lose force
```

Possible installation routes include hereditary or sacred office, election, historical destiny, revolutionary consciousness, scientific rank, civilizational mission, emergency necessity, or claimed embodiment of the people. The public justification is not yet the developmental mechanism. The research target is the earlier formation through which asymmetric moral personhood becomes experientially plausible: childhood hierarchy, exemplary identification, ritual address, role training, selective impunity, repeated success, institutional deference, insulation from reciprocal judgment, or another evidenced path.

In hereditary, dynastic, priestly, or comparably status-dense formation, a candidate route is cumulative rather than one discrete authorization event:

```
qualitatively different treatment
+ ceremonial deference and restricted reciprocity
+ ancestry, office, or destiny presented as sacred necessity
+ ordinary persons encountered as subjects, dependants, or components of order
+ privilege redescribed as a burden of service
→ exceptional status becomes affectively self-evident
→ person, role, and higher order become tightly braided
→ sovereign judgment feels like execution of order rather than private choice
```

Distributed recognition is part of the proposed cause. A court, party, movement, profession, bureaucracy, or audience that waits, defers, obeys, protects, and repeatedly speaks as though the bearer possesses a higher rank of judgment returns that identity to the bearer. Coronation, appointment, command, crisis, election, or succession can crystallize an earlier accumulation without having created it from nothing.

The phenomenology need not be gleeful or crudely entitled. It can be solemn, burdened, sacrificial, or painful. Pain can even reinforce authorization when the bearer reasons that a personally costly decision cannot be selfish and therefore must express duty. The decisive transformation is the reclassification of what would otherwise appear as one human overriding another:

```
harm or domination
→ correction, education, purification, protection, civilization,
  liberation, sacrifice, treatment, or historical necessity
```

The governed person can then cease to appear fully as another author of a life and instead become an administrative subject, immature dependant, diseased element, enemy of history, or material for a greater whole. In the strongest relation, the programme first absorbs the ruler as its instrument and then acts through that ruler to absorb the reciprocal standing of the governed.

The construct is not required for domination. Cynical, sadistic, opportunistic, fear-driven, strategic, and conventionally obedient actors can override others without believing themselves morally elevated. Nor does office, expertise, confidence, inherited rank, strong conviction, or a claim of duty establish the trunk. Evidence would need to join formative history, self-description, reciprocal asymmetry, conduct under challenge, institutional reinforcement, correction, and the treatment of appeal. Retrospective public mythology must remain distinct from developmental phenomenology: later claims about divine placement, historical necessity, scientific duty, or embodiment of the people may express the operative experience, rationalize it after the fact, or function only as public legitimation. At the constitutional level, the corresponding question is whether the claimed higher order remains finite, role-bounded, corrigible, and answerable to persons and reality, or becomes a source of self-certifying jurisdiction.

The epistemic field effect The main cognitive processor can reason in detail, but field back-action can alter which questions feel permissible, which evidence feels contaminated, which source seems entitled to speak, and which conclusion promises belonging. This explains why intellectual ability does not guarantee epistemic independence. A powerful reasoner can become a more effective advocate for a direction already made emotionally compulsory.

An authority, institution, or apparent consensus can thus become the pole through which the field routes belief updates. Socialization supplies legitimacy; common signals make that legitimacy visible; and the participant's local bigOther marks unauthorized checking as insolent, shameful, dangerous, or disloyal. Authority-gated belief updating is therefore not only an individual bias. It can be a field effect whose participants continually reproduce the very authority to which they defer.

A closely related concept is **ideological power**. The German psychologist **Rainer Mausfeld**, explicitly borrowing from the sociologist **Michael Mann's** four-source theory of social power, uses it in *Hybris und Nemesis* for the power to shape the sense-making categories, interpretive contexts, and framing narratives through which people construct social reality. This overlaps strongly with culture mechanics and causal stories. The difference is one of level and scope: *ideological power* names a capacity to organize other people's interpretive world, especially for domination, whereas the field account also includes decentralized emergence, receiving-side back-action, and truthful, corrigible solidarity. Ideological power is one possible cause or strategic use of the field, not its synonym.

The result can be what this entry calls **Bonhoefferian Dummheit**, after the German theologian **Dietrich Bonhoeffer's** 1943 reflection "Von der Dummheit" (PDF of the complete section) (HTML transcription): a socially induced loss of inner independence in which formulas and slogans speak through people whose ordinary intelligence remains intact. Bonhoeffer did not formulate the culture-mechanical field model, and *Dummheit* is neither an IQ category nor a clinical diagnosis. The family resemblance is that intelligence has been placed downstream of a socially protected classification and recruited to elaborate or defend it.

Scale bridge: ideological power, inner-eye blindness, and *Dummheit* The population-level and person-level descriptions require an explicit bridge. A population-bearing Culture Program–including one separately classified as **Ideology** or **Minogue-ideology**–can exercise ideological-power capability through its producers, carrying structures, trusted channels, and returned field gain. **Systemic Ideology** names the configuration only where the separate Ideology gates and population-scale, cross-domain, constitutional operation are evidenced; ideological power itself remains available to truthful and corrigible cultures.

The proposed cross-scale pathway is:

```
population-bearing Culture Program
→ ideological-power capability
→ culture-producing and carrying structures
→ categories, causal stories, frames, symbols, and trusted signals
→ installation or activation in local bigOthers
→ pre-reflective changes in salience, affect, credibility, and taboo
→ possible culturally indexed blindness or speechlessness
→ possible displacement of independent judgment by authorized formulas
→ returned repetition, sanction, administration, and enforcement
→ field reinforcement and possible power accumulation
```

The pathway can be deliberately directed, institutionally selected, opportunistically exploited, emergent, or mixed. It identifies a capability and possible mechanism, not a beneficiary, controller, conspiracy, strict Ideology, *Machtpolitik*, or culpable person.

The local transition elaborates the wireless-collar analogy. The collar can alter attraction, aversion, shame, honour, threat, and attention before the reflective rider notices. The rider may then experience the resulting direction as obvious sight or self-authored judgment and rationalize it afterward.

Jonathan Haidt's *The Righteous Mind* supplies the generic **morality binds and blinds** antecedent: common sacredness, loyalty, and identity can create cohesion while narrowing uptake of rival moral worlds. Haidt does not thereby supply the present Ideology classifier, ideological-power scale bridge, local-bigOther mechanism, or a finding of un-reality. Moral binding can support truthful and corrigible family, professional, religious, civic, or scientific formation. It enters the present hazard pathway only where culturally indexed filtering participates in an evidenced authorization and failed-correction relation.

The historically relevant perceptual-defence evidence is narrower still. Elliott McGinnies's 1949 "Emotionality and Perceptual Defense" reported higher recognition thresholds for emotionally toned words and stronger galvanic skin responses during pre-recognition exposure. Bernard Singer's 1956 experimental inquiry found heterogeneous participant patterns and retained rival explanations involving word frequency, response suppression, experimental set, and individual variation. This evidence supports only the bounded proposition that affectively costly material can alter attention, recognition, reporting, and autonomic response before explicit deliberation. Autonomic arousal or delayed report does not by itself establish unconscious semantic recognition, literal failure to see, intentional wilful blindness, Culture Program installation, or *Dummheit*.

Two meanings of **inner eye** must remain distinct:

1. **The local bigOther as internalized observer.** This is the third-party inner eye through which a distributed symbolic-affective order–and, where present, a represented collective self–appears to observe, approve, shame,

prohibit, or judge the person from within the person's own psyche.

2. **The individual's own inner eye.** This is the person's capacity to bring images, concepts, relations, and possible formulations before the mind. It goes dark when an approaching culturally forbidden relation can no longer be mentally seen, held, formulated, or named.

The proposed local mechanism is:

```
local bigOther as internalized observer
        ↓ marks an approaching thought as forbidden or dangerous
individual's own inner eye narrows or goes dark
        ↓
the relation can no longer be fully seen, formulated, or named
        ↓
speechlessness or conceptual vacancy
        ↓
authorized slogans or formulas may occupy the vacancy
        ↓
borrowed classification speaks and judges in the person's place
        ↓
the main processor may elaborate or defend it through un-reason
        ↓
possible local Bonhoefferian Dummheit
```

Collar-conditioned semantic access: a proposed second output path **Status:** proposed functional mechanism; not a validated neuroanatomical or memory model.

The local transition above can operate through two distinguishable channels:

```
established affective-steering channel:
collar classification
→ elephant-side affect, attention, motivation, and direction change
→ rider encounters the changed orientation

proposed semantic-access channel:
collar classification
→ conditions on rider-side conceptual selection, lexical retrieval,
  observation joining, standing-query activation, binding, and articulation
→ the operation continues, is redirected, or is interrupted
```

The second channel does not give the rider a direct read or control interface to the collar. Nor does it make the collar a language processor, query planner, memory store, or reasoning agent. The **semantic-access interface** is analytical shorthand for ordinary main-CPU operations through which distributed material becomes explicitly retrievable, joinable, comparable, nameable, and serializable. The local bigOther remains a primitive classifier whose permission, honour, shame, danger, pollution, loyalty, or taboo signal may condition whether those operations continue.

This distinction allows cultural power to reach concepts and rational thought without relocating conceptual or rational processing into the collar:

```
socially formed concept or possible relation approaches
→ local bigOther classifies the object, question, source, comparison, or use
→ rider-side access operations remain available, become costly, or stop
→ ordinary cognition reasons with the conceptual space that remains accessible
```

The database-index, query-planner, CRDT, adaptive-compression, serialization, and decompression comparisons have a narrower target than the complete elephant–rider–collar architecture. They model the rider-facing symbolic reconstruction layer and communication among symbol-using persons; they do not model how the elephant's nonverbal prediction, affect, procedural learning, or action readiness is implemented. Operation-rich experience may train both elephant and rider, but the present operation-bootstrap account specifies only the rider-side symbolic reconstruction process.

Semantic reconstructability and affective activation should consequently be treated as distinguishable dimensions rather than one decompression variable:

Pattern	Candidate interpretation
Strong semantic reconstruction + context-appropriate affect	A living and operationally understood symbol
Weak semantic reconstruction + strong affective activation	An emotionally potent but poorly reconstructed formula
Implicit or elephant-side detection + no stable rider-side address	Affectively sighted but semantically blind
Authorized rider-side formula + strong elephant-side conviction	A condition compatible with press-secretary rationalization

These combinations are architectural possibilities, not an exhaustive matrix, a truth test, or a diagnostic classification.

Within this interface, **Noticing** names prepared availability for inquiry rather than bare sensory registration. It includes selecting, retrieving, holding, segmenting, and joining enough material for a potentially significant configuration to become available to questioning and insight. Noticing can be prepared by an existing concept, comparison, symbol, or standing query without that preparation making the resulting interpretation true. It is the constructive counterpart to semantic-access obstruction and a project term, not a renaming of Lonergan's ordinary censor or evidence that every unnoticed relation was repressed.

The proposed temporal effects must remain separate:

Access site	Candidate effect
Retrospective	Earlier observations remain separately available but cannot readily be retrieved and joined through the culturally costly concept.
Present	Implicit or elephant-side unease, anticipation, or recognition remains while the rider cannot hold and complete the relation in self-authored language.
Prospective	A concept or question fails to remain active as a standing query, so a passing event is not segmented, bound, and preserved as evidence under that relation.
Public address	A privately available formulation is withheld or prevented from entering shared vocabulary, records, and common knowledge; this late gate must not be confused with absent private access.

The temporal sites intersect several analytically distinguishable operations:

Interface gate	Candidate effect of collar classification
Read gate	Earlier observations cannot readily be retrieved through the relevant conceptual address.
Query gate	The concept does not remain active as a standing detector over present reality.
Segmentation gate	A continuous occurrence is not bounded as a potentially relevant event.
Write or binding gate	A new observation does not attach to the concept or persist as related evidence.
Join gate	Separately available observations cannot be assembled into one relation or model.
Alias gate	An authorized description becomes the default retrieval address and suppresses a rival implication.
Articulation gate	A relation cannot be stabilized in self-authored language although partial or affective recognition remains.
Public-address gate	A privately available formulation does not enter shared speech, records, or common knowledge.

These gates are a functional decomposition, not additional mental modules. Several can fail together, but they require different evidence and imply different remedies. Person-side semantic-access inhibition, withholding of an intact private formulation, external suppression of its transmission, and the distributed public silence that can result must therefore remain distinct.

Taboo can attach before a completed proposition reaches public speech. Tetlock and colleagues' sacred-value-protection research shows that merely entertaining some comparisons or trade-offs can itself be experienced as a moral violation. In the present architecture, the classified object may therefore be a source that must not be consulted, a word that must not become an address, a question that must not be asked, two observations that must not be joined, a causal implication that must not be completed, or a public signal that would reveal mutual recognition. This extends taboo from speech prohibition to possible prohibition of the epistemic operation itself. It does not establish that every sacred refusal is blind or pathological; the hazard is closure against reciprocal, reality-answerable examination of the protected operation.

```
query, source, comparison, or join approaches a protected boundary
→ collar classifies performing the epistemic operation as contaminating,
  disloyal, dangerous, or shameful
→ elephant averts, or rider-side access and articulation stop
→ an authorized formulation or silence terminates the attempt
→ public non-use helps reproduce the taboo
```

The general result can be described as **asymmetric addressability**: material remains partly available, but one fast, culturally usable route into it is inhibited or redirected while an authorized route remains easy. When query, segmentation, or write/binding fails before a passing occurrence becomes an explicitly typed and preserved observation, the stronger prospective result is **epistemic acquisition closure**. This is not retrieval failure over an existing record and not censorship of an already formulated claim; it is failure earlier in the evidence lifecycle, where no obvious "missing row" may remain for later inspection.

One interrupted act of thought does not establish a durable blind spot. Three candidate persistence levels should be separated:

1. **Query suppression:** the concept remains available in principle, but the present search is abandoned or diverted.
2. **Indexed prohibition:** attempting retrieval also activates threat, shame, pollution, or disloyalty, so the approaching relation may be anticipated without being completed or acknowledged.
3. **Index modification:** repeated non-use, inhibition, renaming, or replacement weakens one retrieval path while an authorized alias receives rehearsal, social confirmation, and institutional support.

```
concept X repeatedly activates collar alarm
→ searches through X are interrupted
→ examples receive less attention, rehearsal, and explicit binding
→ authorized alias Y receives repetition and public support
→ later retrieval increasingly returns Y rather than X
→ new observations attach to Y or remain unclassified
→ X becomes costly or difficult to retrieve before conscious refusal begins
```

The collar does not rewrite a memory store. Its proposed contribution is to classify the approaching operation; ordinary attention, inhibition, rehearsal, retrieval, learning, and social transmission supply the persistence mechanism. The stronger outcome can be called **protected non-integration**: material remains sufficiently available to activate protection but is not integrated into an explicit, corrigible self-and-world model.

The mirror image of query suppression must be included symmetrically. In **query hyperactivation**, a culturally favoured concept receives low activation cost, high salience, honour, urgency, and repeated rehearsal, so ambiguous events are readily detected and bound under it:

```
favoured query receives a low threshold
→ ambiguous events are repeatedly classified through it
→ accumulated records appear to confirm its prevalence
→ public repetition and collar approval lower the threshold further
```

Suppression risks false negatives; hyperactivation risks false positives. The first does not make a prohibited relation true, and the second does not make a favoured relation false. Both require matched cases, rival queries, counterexamples, scope limits, and correction.

A distinct high-gain persistence path is **crisis–relief reindexing**:

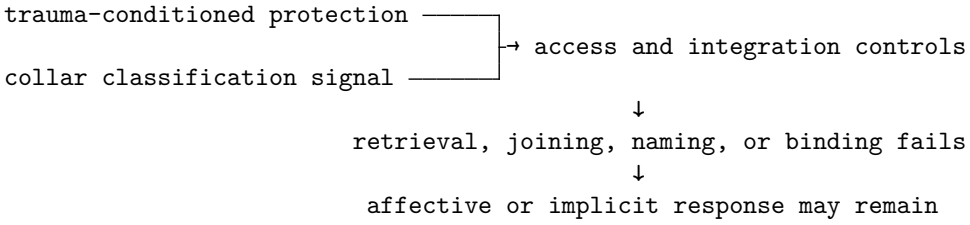
```
incumbent self-understanding is destabilized or morally discredited
→ uncertainty, guilt, shame, anxiety, or loss of orientation increases
→ incumbent concepts become costly, complicit, or unsafe
→ an authority supplies vocabulary, identity, and a replacement causal model
→ acceptance supplies orientation, belonging, recognition, or relief
→ relief reinforces the replacement access paths
```

This is a generic candidate installation mechanism, not a description of every education, conversion, difficult insight, or codebook change. It does not by itself establish trauma, abuse, traumatic bonding, deliberate destabilization, or a false successor account. The stronger concern arises where the same authority helps create or exploit disorientation, monopolizes the available route to relief, treats rejection as further evidence of defect, and leaves the person less able to inspect alternatives, refuse, exit, or correct that authority.

Repeated interruption may weaken rehearsal and retrieval routes, strengthen an authorized alias, and feed public silence back into local expectations. That persistence pathway is **not** literal index deletion. Material may remain available through recognition, affect, alternative vocabulary, changed perspective, laborious reconstruction, or private conditions. Ordinary forgetting, missing knowledge, ambiguity, cognitive load, valid disagreement, strategic silence, material sanction, and biographically specific threat learning remain rival explanations.

Willful blindness can remain an ordinary-language umbrella for this family of non-seeing, avoidance, and non-integration, but it should not name the precise mechanism. The phrase can imply a fully conscious decision not to know, whereas the present sequence ranges from deliberate information avoidance through learned self-silencing to pre-reflective semantic-access gating. **Conceptual- index capping** is likewise controlled database shorthand for the functional result, not a claim that one literal index entry was erased.

The hypothesis was reached partly through a comparison with trauma-related access patterns. The relation is functional convergence at an access-and- integration interface, not identity of cause:



Wilma Bucci's Multiple Code Theory distinguishes subsymbolic, nonverbal-symbolic, and verbal-symbolic processing and treats their connection as a bidirectional referential process. Brewin and colleagues' dual- representation account and Ehlers and Clark's PTSD model likewise distinguish forms of situational, perceptual, autobiographical, and verbal accessibility. These theories do not supply the local bigOther or the collar-conditioned route. They support only the bounded architectural possibility that bodily, affective, implicit, or recognitional access can remain active while contextual or verbal integration is impaired.

Lemov's trauma contribution must itself be decomposed rather than imported as one causal package. Her history distinguishes at least four relations: trauma as a stored disposition that can become active again; trauma as a culturally available or unavailable actor's category for naming experience; trauma as a relational vulnerability shaped by recognition, credibility, isolation, support, and institutional response; and trauma as one possible substrate through which a supplied reality can acquire unusual stabilizing force. Her coercive-persuasion material suggests a bounded installation topology in which ungrounding, debility, humiliation, isolation, uncertainty, and unresolved suffering heighten dependency before relief, kindness, belonging, meaning, or an offered interpretation supplies restabilization. This topology contributes to the crisis–relief hypothesis; it does not establish that cultural blindness, conversion, difficult education, or collar-conditioned access is traumatic.

Rebecca Lemov's historical synthesis in *The Instability of Truth* supplies a different, social-index comparison. In her account, observable withdrawal, startle responses, disturbed memory, shame, hostility, and difficulty returning to ordinary life among Korean War prisoners circulated before *trauma* was an established public and professional actor's category for joining them. The same material could instead be retrieved through aliases such as cowardice, collaboration, weak character, ideological conversion, or brainwashing. This is not evidence that trauma caused a cultural semantic scotoma; it illustrates how an unavailable or institutionally weak category can leave phenomena visible yet poorly joined, while an established alias governs public retrieval.

Lemov's longer history also supplies the opposite warning: once *trauma* becomes a cultural universal, query

hyperactivation can retrieve heterogeneous forms of distress through one insufficiently discriminating category. Her use of Robert Lifton's **numbing** adds a complementary split in which selected feeling or experience is deadened while intellectual competence and an articulate public surface remain. Neither direction establishes the collar route. Together they reinforce only the bounded claims that access can split across systems and that public categories help govern which observations become jointly intelligible.

The resulting description **affectively sighted but semantically blind** does not mean that affect contains a complete hidden argument. An implicit process may register only an outline, anomaly, trajectory, or expected consequence while the rider fails to hold the relation explicitly. Trauma-conditioned protection and collar-conditioned access also differ in activating boundary, protected object, biographical distribution, and reinforcement. The analogy does not make cultural blindness trauma, diagnose a person, or license a clinical inference.

Memory research supplies a second boundary rather than proof of the proposed mechanism. Hippocampal memory-indexing theory distinguishes distributed representation from a cueing route capable of reinstating it. Childhood-amnesia research likewise distinguishes encoding, storage, consolidation, free recall, recognition, verbal addressability, narrative organization, social rehearsal, and genuine trace loss. In particular, later vocabulary does not automatically make earlier nonverbal event information verbally reportable, while perspective change can make previously inaccessible material retrievable. The licensed inference is only that availability is plural and access paths can change; childhood amnesia is not one discarded database index, and the Culture Mechanics symbolic index is not the hippocampal index.

The better developmental analogy is a live migration among changing access regimes with incomplete backward compatibility. Early learning can remain behaviourally or affectively operative while later free autobiographical report fails; vocabulary acquired later does not automatically bind itself to earlier experience; and narration, elaborative reminiscing, repeated comparison, and social rehearsal can affect what remains jointly retrievable. Bauer and Larkina and Qi Wang supply neighbouring developmental evidence rather than proof of cultural index capping.

One narrow infant operant-memory result adds a controlled access-key possibility: Rovee-Collier, Adler, and Borza (1994) found that post-event cue exposure could change which object later primed an earlier learned response. The result does not establish intact autobiographical memory or cultural reindexing. It supports only the weaker **alias-rewrite** possibility that later information can change the default cue through which earlier learning becomes accessible.

Adolescence may reorganize autobiographical access around a changing self-model, peers, status, independence, turning points, and imagined futures. This is not a second childhood-amnesia event or one pubertal reindexing operation. Ordinary temporal distance, semanticization of episodic detail into gist, culturally available life scripts, identity-related rehearsal, and changing retrieval cues remain separable contributors. Learned expectations and classifications can also survive after the particular episodes through which they were acquired have become difficult to recall.

The provisional access taxonomy is therefore:

```
content absent
≠ symbolic address absent
≠ retrieval inhibited
≠ relation recognized but held only fleetingly
≠ private access present but public speech withheld
≠ valid causal differentiation
```

Durkheim's "The Dualism of Human Nature and Its Social Conditions" supplies the broader source claim that socially derived intellectual and moral life includes language, concepts, rational activity, and collective authority. The Culture Mechanics decomposition places those functions across the rider/main CPU, public symbolic and codebook resources, collar, and field rather than inside the collar alone. Durkheim did not propose semantic-access gating, retrospective or prospective scotoma, a reconstruction codebook, or the rider–elephant–collar topology.

Bernard Lonergan supplies closer predecessor vocabulary for the person-side process. **Flight from insight** names evasion of an approaching unwanted understanding; **scotosis** names the aberrant process that censors or prevents insight; and **scotoma** names the resulting blind spot. His account begins from the positive operations through which experience, questioning, insight, conceptual formulation, and reflective judgment become knowledge. It therefore also explains why transmission of a finished proposition can fail to reproduce the operation by which it becomes understood.

Culture Mechanics can use **semantic scotoma** for a blind spot in conceptual retrieval, joining, or articulation;

retrospective scotoma for inaccessible joining of earlier observations; **prospective scotoma** for an absent standing query when a new event arrives; and **culturally indexed scotoma** where a similar access failure recurs at a Culture Program boundary. Scotosis belongs first to Lonergan's person-side account of dramatic bias, while group bias is his separate social extension. The distributed collar-and-field mechanism is a Culture Mechanics bridge between those levels, not a claim that Lonergan already proposed the collar architecture, database analogy, or a cultural memory-deletion process. Lonergan's Chapter 6 archive material provides the source path from flight from insight through affective inhibition toward repression; the present project supplies the retrospective, prospective, and distributed extensions.

Lonergan described the Stekelian analytic recovery material used in that chapter as **retrospective education**. It supplied confirmatory material for the later path from inhibited images and questions toward repression; it was not the origin of his operation-first educational concern and does not make the present reindexing proposal a psychoanalytic or clinical method.

Lonergan source boundary and access controls Lonergan's **censor** is not pathological by definition. Its ordinary constructive function selects and arranges the neural demands, images, affects, and other materials from which a workable perspective and insight can form; finite attention cannot focalize everything at once. The aberrant censor redirects that unavoidable selection so that the configuration needed for an unwanted insight does not form. This distinguishes ordinary selectivity from scotosis and explains why the process can begin upstream of a completed proposition.

The terminology also requires a strict source boundary. *Scotoma* predates Lonergan as a medical blind-spot term and in Stekel's "psychic scotoma," while *scotosis* is Lonergan's distinctive technical formation or use. Tad Dunne's terminological reconstruction emphasizes that Lonergan restricts the scotoma metaphor to **dramatic bias**, where the subject does not realize that relevant images are being repressed. Semantic, retrospective, prospective, culturally indexed, public-address, group, platform, and institutional-uptake extensions belong to Culture Mechanics and must not be reported as Lonergan's own taxonomy. Allen Wheelis independently used "Flight from Insight" as the title of a 1949 psychoanalytic paper. The shared phrase is a terminological neighbour; the reviewed evidence does not establish that Lonergan borrowed it from Wheelis.

Robert M. Doran supplies the closest later development within the Lonerganian lineage. His account of **psychic conversion** turns the censor from a repressive into a constructive participant in development and relates the neural undertow of images and affects to the subject's operations of insight, judgment, and decision. His symbols–feelings–values relation shows how affective material can become available to evaluation through symbolic mediation, while his language of letting the data and insight be resists replacing one repression with a preferred conclusion. His dialectic of the subject is the nearest source bridge to the elephant–rider interface; his dialectics of community and culture extend the setting toward intersubjective, social, and constitutive meaning. His later interdividual and Girardian development further makes the psychic pole relational rather than isolated. These relations support restored communication among psyche, symbolization, and judgment, but they do not provide the local bigOther, distributed-field mechanism, or a worked theory of culturally induced scotomata.

Four states prevent symbolization difficulty from being pathologized wholesale:

State	Discriminating relation
No registration	Neither implicit, affective, nor explicit access to X is evidenced.
Open semantic latency	X is implicitly or affectively meaningful but not yet adequately symbolized, while inquiry remains open.
Systematically obstructed symbolization	X is registered, but the perspective, relation, or symbolization needed for insight is recurrently diverted or inhibited.
Proposition–affect disconnection	X is propositionally available while remaining disconnected from the affective, expectational, or noticing organization that would make it operative.

Only the third state is the central scototic candidate. Eugene Gendlin's account of symbolic carrying forward supplies the decisive healthy-latency control: implicit bodily meaning need not contain one finished hidden proposition, and adequate words can differentiate rather than merely retrieve it. John Bowlby's defensive-exclusion account distinguishes necessary selective exclusion from pathological perceptual blocking or cognitive disconnection and

supplies backward-looking and forward-looking access neighbours. His closer cumulative relation is that rigid exclusion can segregate information systems, prevent later experience from revising internal working models, and leave anger or anxiety available for attachment to an inappropriate situation. This provides a strong independent attachment-theory analogue to obstructed access, displaced affect, and distorted development; it does not make attachment history the cause of culturally indexed scotosis or license its inference from present disagreement. Neither Bowlby nor Gendlin establishes the collar mechanism.

The Stekelian material used by Lonergan adds three narrower discriminators. First, resistance is adaptive rather than a static missing index: as one route approaches the unwanted relation, another plausible diversion, reinterpretation, or rationalization can replace it. Second, transference can make an older social–affective routing policy operate in a present relationship and thereby become observable without turning that clinical setting into the general Culture Mechanics mechanism. Third, detached possession of a proposition does not establish recovery when the dramatic, affectively charged organization of attention, expectation, and action remains unchanged. These source observations support a distinction between proposition-level correction and affective–semantic reintegration; they do not make Stekelian analysis a required remedy or validate one inferred repression from disagreement alone.

Experiential avoidance supplies one candidate reinforcement path:

```
approaching relation evokes distress
→ attention, questioning, or symbolization withdraws
→ immediate relief rewards withdrawal
→ repetition lowers the probability that the relation is formed next time
```

The sequence is not a diagnosis and does not identify the cause of every failed inquiry. Ordinary ignorance, limited attention, undeveloped understanding, open semantic latency, valid disagreement, fatigue, trauma, and inaccessible evidence remain rival explanations. Perspective-shift recall, label-feedback, event- segmentation, retrieval-suppression, and socially shared forgetting studies below support separate accessibility components; they do not validate Lonergan's whole motivational sequence or the Culture Mechanics collar bridge. Experiential-avoidance models also do not require a particular true insight to be waiting behind the avoided experience. Lonergan makes the stronger truth-oriented cognitional hypothesis that flight can exclude an insight and the further questions that might correct development. Culture Mechanics preserves that difference without treating observed avoidance as proof that an observer already knows the suppressed truth.

Contemporary defence-mechanism research supplies a broader clinical neighbour. Rose Howell and Vera Békés's narrative review treats defences as often automatic verbal, emotional, cognitive, or behavioural responses to conflict and distress and reports associations among attachment patterns, suppression, denial, projection, and other defensive processes. Much of the reviewed evidence is cross-sectional or self-reported. It supports the bounded possibility that attention, encoding, recall, and interpretation can be organized protectively through relational experience; it does not identify scotosis, the unwanted insight in a case, a Culture Program cause, or a diagnosis from disagreement.

Schema therapy supplies a different cumulative-developmental neighbour. Christopher Taylor, Penny Bee, and Gillian Haddock's systematic review presents early maladaptive schemas as long-standing structures that can combine cognitions, emotions, memories, and bodily sensations, while activated coping responses can organize a current schema mode. Avoidant coping can consequently preserve an earlier organization by limiting corrective contact, producing a family resemblance to cumulative scotosis without making the schema a local bigOther, Culture Program, or censored insight. The review found only initial low-quality evidence for schema change and insufficient evidence that schema change mediates therapeutic outcome, so this remains a source comparison rather than validation of the Culture Mechanics sequence or a prescribed treatment.

Information avoidance adds a necessary false-positive control. Jeremy Foust and Jennifer Taber's cross-disciplinary review distinguishes avoidance from mere failure to seek and treats intentionality, timing, personal relevance, self-beliefs, information beliefs, and social conditions as separate variables. Observed non-exposure or silence therefore does not by itself reveal deliberate avoidance, preconscious scotosis, or collar conditioning. Motivated reasoning, cognitive dissonance, selective search, asymmetric scrutiny, rationalization, and belief perseverance can reproduce parts of the visible pattern while leaving its cause underdetermined. A recent review of partisan bias accordingly reports contributions from both motivational and cognitive factors rather than licensing one hidden-motive inference from the outcome alone.

At the social-epistemic level, José Medina's **active ignorance** is the closest named neighbour for ignorance maintained through interacting epistemic habits and structural conditions rather than a simple information deficit. His account connects active ignorance to arrogance, laziness, closed-mindedness, and insufficient friction from differently situated knowers. Culture Mechanics uses only the bounded relation that socially reinforced resistances can help

ignorance reproduce itself. It does not import Medina's social-group classifications, assign culpability, or infer one system of active ignorance from one error, disagreement, or source-routing decision.

Need for cognitive closure supplies a separate motivational neighbour for the positive path to premature termination. Pressure for order and certainty may make an authorized master signifier or compressed explanation easier to accept as a stopping point, but closure need is neither Lonerganian scotosis nor a Lacanian master signifier and does not establish that a rapidly accepted answer is false, authoritarian, or culturally installed.

Predictive-processing research supplies a possible formal neighbour for attention, active sampling, prior confidence, prediction error, and updating. In a future formalization, socially authorized interpretations might alter which evidence is sampled or the effective weight assigned to error signals, but that relation is a Culture Mechanics hypothesis rather than a result established by predictive processing. Affective value must not be equated with Bayesian precision, and a precision-weighted account must not collapse the functionally distinct main CPU and local bigOther into one unitary mechanism. The relevant research currently supports only the more modest claims that attention is related to predictive selection and that the broader neurophysiological evidence for predictive processing remains an object of evaluation.

Lonergan's bias taxonomy also prevents person-side scotosis from swallowing the social problem. **Dramatic bias** concerns inhibition of the images, questions, and formulations that could support an unwanted personal insight; **individual bias** privileges immediate personal interest; **group bias** makes congenial insights operative while excluding those that threaten a group's position; and **general bias** names common sense's resistance to sufficiently theoretical, systemic, and long-range understanding. His **longer cycle of decline** adds a cumulative relation: excluded fruitful insights produce a worse and less intelligible situation, which then supplies poorer material for later understanding and makes further exclusion easier. Culture Mechanics uses the collar and field to propose one bridge across those levels; it does not collapse the biases into one mechanism or attribute the bridge to Lonergan.

The dynamic signatures in Lonergan's account are also important. An insight may be admitted momentarily before its follow-up questions disappear, dismissed as a groundless bright idea, repelled through fear, disgust, pride, horror, or revulsion, or buried beneath selective rationalization. Access can oscillate: the relation is briefly seen, becomes incomprehensible again, and later returns under changed affect, context, or available representations. Such oscillation is compatible with an access problem rather than one settled false belief, but it does not by itself identify dramatic bias, collar conditioning, or scotosis.

Several neighbouring literatures locate other parts of the mechanism without supplying the complete synthesis. Max Scheler's **organic mendacity** places falsification in selective admission of impressions and value-feelings and again in reproduction and recollection; his ressentiment explanation is one possible cause, not the universal cause adopted here. The ressentiment-conversion pathway in *Mythology Construction* now owns that narrower affective and value-perceptual source bridge: inhibited hostility can organize what is admitted and recollected so that an inverted valuation is sincerely experienced before reflective report. Organic mendacity remains distinct from conscious lying, but the two can coexist when a globally inhabited value-world makes local manipulation appear to reveal a supposedly deeper truth. Neither conviction nor selective access establishes the local deception, and a proved deception does not establish the encompassing ressentiment account. Aquinas's **affected ignorance** separates habitually possessed knowledge from actual consideration when desire, passion, habit, or distraction intervenes. Motivated reasoning and identity-protective cognition show how motivation and group position can change retrieval, scrutiny, and apparently defensible justification; they do not normally establish that the concept itself became inaccessible.

The theological umbrella of **noetic effects** or **noetic blindness** similarly names the proposition that desire, fear, moral refusal, or disordered attachment can impair knowing itself. It is a useful cross-domain predecessor for the moral–cognitive relation, not a worked semantic-access mechanism, and Culture Mechanics does not inherit a theological causal explanation through the comparison.

Experimental neighbours make the accessibility claim more discriminating. Think/no-think work shows that repeated retrieval suppression can impair later recall; the mnemic-neglect effect separates poor free recall of self-threatening material from better recognition; and socially shared retrieval-induced forgetting shows how one speaker's selective remembering can alter a listener's later accessibility. These findings supply possible ordinary cognitive links from repeated interruption to learned accessibility, not evidence of collar control or literal deletion.

The prospective side also has component-level neighbours. In Lupyan and Ward's label-feedback experiment, a valid verbal label improved detection of a suppressed image while an invalid label impaired detection. Event Segmentation Theory treats continuous activity as divided into meaningful events and gives conceptual knowledge and inferred goals a role in those boundaries. These results support the narrower claims that labels can prepare

detection and conceptual parsing can affect what becomes a memorable event; they do not establish standing-query control by a collar or epistemic acquisition closure as a complete mechanism.

At social scale, Fleck's thought style, Bourdieu's doxa, and Zerubavel's attentional communities and conspiracies of silence describe socially organized readiness to notice and not notice. Fricker's hermeneutical injustice addresses deficits in shared interpretive resources; hermeneutical distortion and Irvine and Gal's erasure come closer to authorized aliasing; and strategic ignorance and agnotology treat ignorance as socially produced and sometimes useful. Mary Douglas's purity and taboo analysis helps explain why entertaining a category or comparison may feel contaminating rather than merely mistaken. None identifies where the present read, query, binding, join, articulation, or public-address gate failed.

Moral and legal accounts begin at still other points. Moral attentiveness, ethical fading, moral disengagement, willful ignorance, solution aversion, Kelman's authorization–routinization–dehumanization sequence, and Cohen's literal, interpretive, and implicatory denial separate preparedness to notice, relabelling, non-acquisition, non-questioning, and neutralization of consequence. The legal sequence unperceived injurious experience → naming → blaming → claiming shows how an occurrence that never becomes a named injury cannot enter a still potentially rule-bound court's claim stream.

Granovetter's thresholds, Kuran's preference falsification, spiral-of-silence research, and Chwe's common-knowledge account normally begin one step later, with an adequately formulated private state whose public expression or mutual visibility fails. The collar-conditioned hypothesis adds the earlier branch in which the private state itself may not stabilize. The distinction must remain visible when public silence is analyzed.

A relation missing from the dominant public index may nevertheless survive in private memory, marginal vocabularies, jokes, literature, dissident archives, or specialized professional subcultures. Public sleep therefore entails neither universal individual blindness nor total cultural erasure. These surviving repositories can later supply alternative addresses and crystallization cores, but their existence alone does not establish the truth or prevalence of the preserved relation.

Kuran and Sunstein's availability-cascade model supplies the converse public-amplification path: repetition can increase cognitive availability while informational and reputational incentives produce more repetition. In the present model, distributed feedback can leave one candidate query without a public index while hyperactivating another. Repetition and availability establish truth in neither direction.

The local bigOther does not cease operating when the individual's inner eye goes dark. The internalized gaze, prohibition, shame, and authorization can become more intense precisely while the person's own imaginative-conceptual field narrows.

> **Blindness is the negative moment: what the person can no longer see, formulate, or name. *Dummheit* is the positive occupation of that vacancy: authorized formulas speak and judge in the person's place.**

Speechlessness need not mean literal silence. A person can remain verbally fluent while losing self-authored language for the protected relation. Formulaic speech can terminate the approaching thought, relieve the distress of non-formulation, restore moral and group orientation, and conceal that independent articulation failed.

The working intensities are:

Intensity	Proposed description
Weak blindness	A relevant relation is not noticed but can be examined and articulated once made visible
Strong blindness or speechlessness	Approaching a protected relation inhibits sustained attention, conceptualization, or self-authored formulation
Local Bonhoefferian *Dummheit*	Authorized slogans and classifications occupy the resulting vacancy and displace independent judgment in the activated domain

Weak or isolated blindness does not establish *Dummheit*, low intelligence, generalized capture, Ideology, or danger. Strong, culturally indexed blindness that blocks self-authored articulation and predictably replaces it with authorized formulas is a candidate local instance of the Bonhoefferian mechanism. Domain spread, authority-gated judgment, synchronization, conduct, enforcement, and persistence indicate how far the condition extends.

The return path closes the possible power loop. Repetition, approval, punishment, administration, exclusion, and enforcement become signals to other local bigOthers and return gain to the field and possibly to directing or beneficiary positions. That upward attribution still requires causal and scale evidence.

A later contrastive diagnostic can at most sample one possible local residue of this installation: whether a previously understood correction rule changes selectively when a culturally protected classification activates the local bigOther. It does not directly detect an Ideology, hidden producer, power structure, or *Dummheit* inside a person. Linking a repeatable local pattern upward requires separate evidence of program, carrying structure, authorization, reproduction, scale, beneficiary, and failed correction.

The person-side mechanism connects to the larger recognition-threshold and public-sleep ecology without becoming identical to it. Semantic-access gating can prevent private recognition before a stable judgment forms. Recognition-threshold management also includes cases in which private recognition is intact but public articulation, aggregation, institutional uptake, or correction fails. Neither mechanism is necessary or sufficient for the other.

Open theorizing surface and the access–formation–correction grammar The **open theorizing surface** is the domain of observations, questions, distinctions, comparisons, causal relations, rival explanations, and possible answers that a person or formation can bring into explicit, sustained, and corrigible inquiry at a specified time and domain. It is not everything a person could in principle think, everything stored in memory, or everything permitted to be said publicly. It is the presently usable inquiry surface on which relevant operations can be formed, held, compared, criticized, and revised.

This surface binds several mechanisms that otherwise appear separate into one **access–formation–correction grammar**:

```
distributed epistemic formation supplies concepts, operations, examples,
and symbolic addresses
                          ↓
a candidate observation, question, comparison, or causal join approaches
                          ↓
the operative Culture Program classifies its relevance, legitimacy,
danger, honour, or taboo
                          ↓
semantic-access conditions admit, inhibit, redirect, or hyperactivate it
                          ↓
the open theorizing surface determines what can be held in corrigible inquiry
                          ↓
the correction interface determines whether evidence and consequences can
revise the current answer
                          ↓
public articulation, reception, aggregation, and institutional uptake determine
whether the correction can enter the shared epistemic milieu
```

No arrow is automatic. Formation can provide an operation without making it usable in every loaded domain; access can be open while the operation has never been learned; private inquiry can remain open while public uptake is blocked; and public speech can be abundant while the speaker's own inquiry has already closed. The grammar therefore keeps **formation**, **access**, **inquiry**, **correction**, and **public realization** as distinct but composable relations.

The surface must also specify **what is open to correction**. An institution may investigate mistreatment, improve procedures, and remedy individual violations while leaving its constitutive categories or entitlement to exercise power outside inquiry. Correction within an accepted arrangement and inquiry into whether that arrangement should exist are different operations. The former is real correction at its stated scope; it does not establish the latter, while closure at the latter does not erase the former. For example, an office may correct unfair application of an inherited status rule while excluding questions about the rule's legitimacy. The diagnostic follows the boundary: can participants examine implementation, the governing rule, its justification, and its jurisdiction, and at which step do questions lose standing?

The order-level hypothesis concerns the relation between the shared first-order prescription footprint and this surface. Where a larger cultural territory is governed directly by morally binding concrete answers, more candidate questions and comparisons may collide with protected first-order prescriptions. Other things equal, a contraction of that footprint can reduce the territory over which solidarity has to protect concrete answers and can thereby enlarge the open theorizing surface:

```
less territory governed by morally binding concrete answers
                          ↓
less territory exposed to answer-protective semantic obstruction
                          ↓
possible contraction of culturally maintained scotomata
                          ↓
possible expansion of the open theorizing surface
```

This chain separates **potential scotoma exposure** from **realized scotoma burden**. The prescription footprint indicates how much culturally constitutive territory can be placed under pressure by observations, comparisons, alternatives, or consequences; it does not show that those relations have actually become inaccessible. Realized obstruction additionally depends on the reach and overlap of the threatened prescriptions, contradiction pressure, correction resistance, affective and membership stakes, sanction gain, formative practice, and institutional reinforcement:

```
protected first-order prescriptions
→ associated domains of potentially disruptive inquiry
→ potential scotoma exposure
+ correction resistance, contradiction pressure, affect, sanctions,
  formation, and institutional reinforcement
→ realized scotoma burden
```

Several protected prescriptions can obstruct the same question, so their effects need not add independently. Conversely, one compact protected premise can reach many downstream questions and comparisons. This is why prescription count, potential exposure, and realized blind territory must remain separate observables.

Prescription, condemnation, exclusion, and scotoma are also different operations. A culture can perceive an alternative, understand why another person follows it, compare it with its own rule, and still condemn or prohibit it. The scototic candidate begins where preservation of the protected answer recurrently prevents relevant noticing, retrieval, questioning, comparison, joining, self-authored formulation, or reception of correction. Moral intensity alone therefore establishes neither blindness nor closure.

This is a directional mechanism hypothesis, not a literal inverse proportion or linear law. A large prescription footprint does not by itself establish scotosis, and a small footprint does not guarantee open inquiry. One compact protected premise can obstruct a wide field through its downstream implications, while many detailed rules can remain revisable outputs of a lifted generator. A laboratory safety procedure, hygienic protocol, engineering standard, or professional rule derived from inspectable evidence is not automatically part of the shared first-order prescription footprint merely because it is concrete and detailed. The relevant question is whether the binding force resides in the answer as culturally final or in a corrigible generator by which the answer is produced, tested, and revised.

The relation is also positive rather than merely subtractive. As a scotoma contracts, the gain is not only the return of one prohibited fact. Previously disconnected observations can be joined; rival causal models can be compared; protected categories can be decomposed; anomalies can generate new questions; inherited answers can become hypotheses; and consequences can revise the grammar that first classified them. Foreign epistemic milieus can become reconstructible as rival or complementary perspectives rather than being preclassified as impurity, hostility, or noise. In this sense, contraction of scotomata can enlarge both cognitive liberty and intercultural intelligibility without requiring agreement or cultural neutrality. The open theorizing surface therefore names an expanding capability for inquiry, not an empty or cultureless region.

The surface is culturally formed. Cold, apparently impersonal inquiry depends upon learned concepts, instruments, methods, examples, roles, records, and norms of criticism carried by the distributed epistemic milieu. It can still be parochial, mistaken, cruel, technically sophisticated, or recruited by a closed programme. Its openness lies in continued access and correction, not in low affect, social detachment, intelligence, truth, goodness, or exemption from culture. The me–we–world correction relation therefore remains controlling: escape from private preference can reveal a culturally shared grammar without yet showing that the grammar fits the world.

An enlarged surface can make both novel error and criticism of that error possible. The same capacity to render an inherited hierarchy examinable can generate a new rationalization of it or a reason to revise or abolish it. Assessing that capacity therefore requires following both the production of answers and the correction of its own products across time. A harmful answer does not by itself establish that the generating capacity has only harmful uses, just as a successful correction does not vindicate every earlier answer. Formulation of a theory shows that an object has been represented; sustained openness additionally requires the reconstructible operations, rivals, and defeat conditions distinguished in the theorizing–revelation account.

The compact binding is:

> **Cultural formation equips inquiry; Culture Program classification gates its usable surface; scotosis can contract that surface; correction can reopen it; and public institutions determine whether the reopened relation becomes collectively consequential.**

Latent Culture Program diagnosis under homo-duplex orthogonality **Status:** proposed diagnostic research programme; not a validated assessment, clinical protocol, violence-risk instrument, or authorization to classify a person by an Ideology or Culture Program label

The ideological-power scale bridge creates an observability problem. A Culture Program can organize salience, affect, credibility, taboo, identity, and correction while remaining inconspicuous during ordinary low-activation life. The proposed diagnostic therefore asks:

> **How can the programming, alignment, activation thresholds, correction relations, and synchronization susceptibility of a local bigOther be inferred without waiting for a real crisis in which that programming becomes conduct-directing?**

The working answer is a **contrastive correction-interface probe**: disclose one general causal form, confirm its comprehension through relatively uncharged cases, and then present structurally matched cases crossing several different cultural fault lines. A selectively located change in category, evidential burden, reciprocity, affect, defeat conditions, or willingness to revise is the observable of interest. It is evidence to investigate, not a diagnosis by itself.

The ordinary search expressions **scotosis test**, **scotoma test**, and **cultural blind-spot test** route to this probe family when the research question concerns possible selective obstruction of an operation already demonstrated in matched cases. They are retrieval aliases, not alternative canonical names and not claims that the result identifies scotosis as its cause. The contrastive correction-interface probe was developed before the present scotosis integration; the later vocabulary supplies one possible explanation of the observed discontinuity rather than redefining the instrument.

Three terms control the proposal:

> A **latent Culture Program profile** is a bounded reconstruction of the classifications, sacred values, authorities, affective activations, identity stakes, correction relations, and action tendencies likely to become operative in a specified person or formation under specified conditions not presently active.

It is a conditional model, not an essence, permanent person label, or direct reading of hidden mental content.

> A **contrastive correction-interface probe** presents a disclosed causal form through neutral and differently culture-loaded cases, then tests whether evidential standards, defeat conditions, reciprocal application, affect, and revision remain continuous across them.

Its primary target is not the favoured opinion but the availability of a common reality-correction procedure. It is a specialized person-side extension of the generic reality-correction-interface test.

> A **culturally indexed correction discontinuity** is a repeatable, case-linked change in correction practice when a previously understood causal form crosses a protected cultural boundary. An **affectively marked correction discontinuity** additionally includes an observable change in anger, fear, shame, disgust, agitation, certainty, withdrawal, or relief at that boundary.

The correction discontinuity is the primary observable. Overt affect is an optional qualifier because strong fear or shame may remain largely internal and appear only through hesitation, reframing, repetition, or escape. Either pattern is candidate evidence of load-bearing programming, not sufficient proof of Ideology, un-reason, falsehood, radicalization, or danger.

Homo-duplex orthogonality and the observability problem The author's phrase **"the Quantum Mechanics of Psychology"** remains a controlled analogy, not a claim about literal quantum cognition. It distinguishes two partially independent practical coordinates of *homo duplex*:

- the ordinarily visible person-to-person surface of affection, temperament, preferences, exchange, cooperation, and conduct–the "Newtonian" side; and
- the less directly observable cultural-symbolic coordinate of installed classifications, sacred values, authority, loyalty, shame, collective identity, and synchronization–the Culture Mechanics side.

The coordinates are substantially **orthogonal** for diagnosis: knowledge of one may provide little information about the other. A close friend may be culturally unaligned; a culturally aligned person may be personally disliked. Kind, calm, and cooperative ordinary conduct does not by itself reveal which collective classification will take priority under a sacred-value conflict, loyalty test, perceived threat, ritual synchronization, or authority-addressed mobilization.

Orthogonality can also become publicly observable in the form of an interaction. Its propositional content can display explicit cultural-symbolic nonalignment while its interpersonal coordinate continues to carry affection, respect, trust, reciprocity, cooperation, or continuing association. The interaction therefore communicates more than two first-order positions. Its form supplies a second-order signal about whether cultural alignment is treated as a condition of interpersonal standing and relationship.

This creates an observer-side relation. An audience may expect strong cultural disagreement to covary with personal dislike, withdrawal, or exclusion, and may expect durable personal regard to predict convergence or concession. Encountering the two coordinates visibly separated can expose that expected covariance. The resulting surprise arises from the observer's prior model of how tightly the coordinates should be coupled.

Repeated interpersonal history can help preserve the separation by sustaining a high-resolution, person-specific representation across roles, conduct, exchanges, and obligations while a strong cultural-symbolic classification remains operative. Neither representation need become a complete proxy for the other. In this form, orthogonality is not only a hidden-state observability problem. It is also a conflict-bearing capacity of a relationship: nonconvergence on the cultural-symbolic coordinate need not consume cooperation, standing, or continuity on the interpersonal coordinate.

At field scale, visible enactment can make the separated combination socially available:

```
cultural-symbolic nonalignment + continuing interpersonal standing
→ publicly legible coordinate separation
→ revision of expected covariance
→ wider availability of the same relational form
```

"Orthogonal" does not mean perfectly statistically independent. Relationships, traits, incentives, institutions, and prior reflection can influence cultural activation. The narrower claim is that the latent cultural coordinate cannot safely be read off the ordinary relational coordinate.

In a calm environment, carriers of different programs can consequently be **observationally equivalent**. The absence of visible collective behaviour is underdetermined: relevant programming may be strongly installed but dormant, weakly installed, de-animated, culturally lost, displaced by another program, inhibited by countervailing commitments, or active below ordinary observation. No elicited response does not prove that no program exists; an elicited response does not prove that it has governing authority.

The earlier honour-killing discussion supplies an extreme action-interface illustration, not a population generalization. Personal affection can be real while a culturally authorized shame, purity, loyalty, or collective-standing rule classifies the loved person as an intolerable violation. Where one action must be selected, the coordinate possessing operative final authority can govern the act. This does not imply that cultural programming always defeats affection or that cultural alignment predicts violence. It shows why ordinary affection does not answer the priority question.

In this application the local bigOther can function less like a complete argument than like a culturally programmed **value function**. It changes what feels admirable, shameful, compulsory, forbidden, or socially survivable; the main CPU can then implement and rationalize the reweighted result. The cultural coordinate acquires meta-authority where it also decides which perceptions, affections, doubts, and reasons may be taken seriously.

The personal-reflective coordinate can still prevail where the person can recognize the cultural verdict as a classification rather than reality itself, tolerate the shame or exclusion attached to refusal, draw on countervailing commitments or trusted authorities, complete reflective override, and obtain practical support, protection, or exit. This is why lower-stakes conflicts over taboo, outsider criticism, loyalty, refusal, or treatment of dissent can be informative without being treated as miniature violence tests.

Waiting for a real crisis, mobilization, collective punishment, or violence to reveal that priority is ethically unacceptable. The research problem is to create bounded, reversible, low-stakes, and ethically reviewed probes that sample the classifier and correction relation without manufacturing the dangerous condition. Lower-stakes conflicts involving taboo, outsider criticism, loyalty, refusal, or treatment of dissent may provide earlier evidence while practical support, protection, appeal, and exit remain available.

Probe design: from neutral comprehension to loaded transfer The proposed instrument is better understood as a **dynamic assessment** or structured interview than a static opinion questionnaire. Asking only which political proposition a participant endorses reveals declared content, invites rehearsed answers, and risks confusing disagreement with capture. The diagnostic question is whether an already understood causal rule and correction standard remain available when the rule reaches culturally protected material.

```
explain a general causal form M
        ↓
present relatively uncharged cases N1, N2, N3
        ↓
confirm that M is understood and can be applied
        ↓
present structurally matched but differently loaded cases L1, L2, L3 ...
        ↓
invite distinctions, counterevidence, defeat conditions, and position reversal
        ↓
observe where reasoning, affect, and correction relations change
```

Follow-up questions are essential. A participant must be free to expose a false premise, identify a material causal difference, correct a badly matched analogy, or suspend judgment because information is missing. The instrument tests a correction interface; it must not require assent to the investigator's analogy.

Four broad responses must be distinguished:

1. **Continuous application:** the same rule, evidential burden, and defeat conditions remain in force.
2. **Valid differentiation:** the participant identifies a material causal difference and accepts the same distinction under position reversal.
3. **Uncertain suspension:** the participant consistently withholds judgment because the required information is unavailable.
4. **Protected exception:** the category, standard, or burden changes without a material and reciprocally acceptable reason, and the exception resists correction.

Only the fourth is the primary candidate signal, and one item is never a diagnosis. The signal becomes meaningful only as a repeatable, domain-specific pattern involving specified protected conclusions, asymmetric standards, recursive immunization, and failed correction.

The result should be typed rather than reduced to one "culture score":

Observed pattern	Candidate inference	What it does **not** establish
Loaded cases producing a discontinuity	Protected content or installed classification	A complete Culture Program from one item
Direction of the exception	Alignment or authorized side	Moral guilt or a person-level label
Loading required before change appears	Activation threshold	Stability across all settings
Intensity and form of response	Affective investment and defensive style	Falsehood because emotion is present
Type of reason offered	Possible un-reason mechanism or valid distinction	Un-reason from sophistication or contradiction alone
Ability to state defeaters and revise	Strength of the correction interface	Truth of every retained belief
Covariation across participants	Possible shared cultural field	Central design or conspiracy
Change under peer, authority, or consensus cues	Possible synchronization susceptibility	Susceptibility from a private answer alone

Higher-order Culture Program capacity probe The contrastive correction-interface probe presupposes that the relevant operation has already been demonstrated somewhere and asks where it becomes selectively unavailable. A distinct proposed **higher-order Culture Program capacity probe** asks whether the participant can acquire, perform, and transfer the operation at all. **Liftability test**, **higher-order capacity test**, and **lifted-order capacity probe** are search aliases for this second research family. The probe extends operation-bootstrapped codebook formation and living knowledge: token exposure and correct repetition are not yet locally reconstructible, corrigible capability. Before a persistent limitation is inferred, the assessment must provide enough examples, contrasts, questions, practice, feedback, and correction for the operation to be learned rather than merely named.

The governing distinction is:

```
exposure to a lifted-order vocabulary
≠ verbal imitation of its accepted answers
≠ operational performance of its generator
≠ inhabitation of that generator across novel and costly cases
```

A candidate probe would first teach an inspectable meta-operation rather than asking for agreement with a political conclusion. It would then test comprehension and use in relatively neutral cases, morally or culturally loaded cases, fictional cases, position-reversed cases, and unfamiliar transfer cases. Candidate task families include whether the participant can:

- distinguish a concrete answer from the rule that generates and revises it;
- apply one meta-rule to novel cases that properly yield different outputs;
- entertain a proposition without treating consideration as endorsement;
- state evidence that would defeat favoured and disfavoured conclusions;
- reverse social positions while retaining reciprocal evidential and procedural standards;
- revise an answer without treating revision as destruction of the moral order; and
- design a procedure for unforeseen cases rather than extend a memorized catalogue of fixed answers.

After correction and further instruction, it would retest whether the participant can generate a novel application, identify a valid exception, state a symmetrical defeater, and revise an answer without abandoning the operation.

At least five outcomes must remain distinguishable:

1. **No adequate exposure or instruction:** failure does not yet test capacity.
2. **Acquisition with transfer:** the operation is learned and remains available under relevant variation.
3. **Acquisition with selective inhibition:** the operation appears in controls but becomes unavailable at a loaded boundary; this returns the inquiry to the contrastive correction-interface probe.
4. **Slow or support-dependent acquisition:** the operation can be performed only with additional formation, scaffolding, time, or environmental support.
5. **Persistent operational limitation:** repeated, adequate, ethically bounded teaching and transfer attempts fail to establish the operation across contexts.

The fifth outcome is a capacity-limitation candidate, not its explanation. Developmental history, language, education, trust, incentives, stress, interviewer relation, unfamiliarity with the task form, learning differences, strategic refusal, and measurement failure remain rivals. Stable performance differences do not establish a biological cause, heritability, immutable incapacity, ancestry-level distribution, moral worth, danger, or fitness for political rights. Those stronger questions require independent longitudinal, developmental, behavioural-genetic, and population research. Instrument validation also requires discriminant tests against general cognitive ability, language, education, fatigue, trust, and task familiarity; longitudinal training response; and cross-context or cross-cultural measurement invariance. Family, adoption, twin, genomic, or other hereditary designs belong only after a reliable performance construct exists.

Agreement with the investigator is not the success condition. A participant succeeds by performing a disclosed, reciprocal, corrigible operation–including by identifying that the investigator's analogy, premise, or classification is defective. The method therefore measures reconstructible capability and transfer, not approved opinion, educational prestige, abstract intelligence, or fluency in the theory's vocabulary.

Culture Program fingerprint: selective discontinuities across a case matrix

> A **Culture Program fingerprint** is the typed, repeatable distribution of correction discontinuities, protected directions, activation thresholds, affective qualifiers, and recovery conditions across neutral cases and cases loaded for several candidate Culture Programs.

The fingerprint is not one answer. For each of several disclosed causal forms, the probe should ideally compare a relatively uncharged implementation with matched implementations loaded for programs A, B, C, and so forth. If correction remains available in the neutral, B-, and C-loaded cases but repeatedly changes in the direction required to protect A, the **selective co-location** of the discontinuities is evidence for A-specific installation or alignment:

```
same causal form understood across controls
+ repeatable protected exceptions in A-loaded cases
+ no comparable closure in matched non-A cases
```

```
+ rival explanations progressively defeated
→ increased likelihood that program A is installed and load-bearing
```

This is a qualitative likelihood claim. Formally, a response pattern (R_A) raises the probability of candidate program A only where (R_A) is more expected if A is installed than under specified alternatives:

```
P(R_A | A installed) > P(R_A | rival explanations)
→ P(A installed | R_A) > P(A installed), other things equal
```

No numerical posterior follows until the items, comparison groups, dependence structure, base rates, and error rates have been validated. Rewordings of one bad analogy, several cases sharing the same disputed premise, and repeated clips from one adversarial exchange are correlated evidence, not independent confirmations. A sound design rotates presentation order, varies causal domains, separates the common relation from factual antecedents, and includes cases that should support rival programs and cases that should defeat A.

The fingerprint is also not a biometric signature, immutable identity, or proof of capture. It supports a graded inference:

1. **Candidate installation or alignment:** A-specific discontinuities recur across well-matched cases.
2. **Candidate load-bearing status:** challenging A reliably activates identity, sacred-value, authority, or correction stakes.
3. **Candidate capture:** A's classifications repeatedly displace independently available correction or self-authored judgment across the specified domain.

Each stronger inference requires additional evidence. The pattern can change with context, authority cues, reflection, learning, exit, or unbraiding; several programs can also leave overlapping or conflicting fingerprints in one person.

The same method can inspect **negative space**: recurrent failures to notice, name, compare, or pursue an otherwise available causal relation. A single omission is almost empty evidence. A stronger pattern appears when one person or carrier reliably detects a causal form across neutral and differently loaded cases but stops detecting it when the same form would burden a protected principal, programme, authority, or self-classification.

```
causal form noticed in matched controls
+ selectively absent at one protected boundary
+ recurrence across independent domains and formulations
+ ordinary explanations weakened
→ candidate negative-space component of a Culture Program fingerprint
```

Negative space can be more informative than questionnaire agreement because a mythological lens may operate through salience, expectation, and immediate classification before the person formulates an explicit doctrine. It remains a comparative inference, not access to hidden mental content. Ignorance, specialization, fatigue, trauma, incentives, information access, question wording, memory, social risk, and ordinary inconsistency are mandatory rival explanations. The fingerprint gains weight only where the capacity is demonstrated in matched cases and the omission follows the programme boundary more reliably than those rivals predict.

A person can carry several Culture Programs, activate them in different domains, or exhibit program disharmony when authorized classifications collide. A diverse administration might therefore support reconstruction of several candidate relations and relative thresholds. It would still be reconstructing a conditional Culture Program Complex from responses rather than reading a hidden essence. Synchronization susceptibility requires a separately authorized comparison–for example, private judgment versus disclosed peer or authority cues–and cannot be inferred because several people independently answer alike.

Epistemic and affective response channels The probe records two channels separately. The **epistemic channel** is primary:

- changed evidential burden;
- ad hoc or asymmetric exemption;
- reclassification that protects only one side;
- loss or movement of stated defeat conditions;
- evasion of the causal question;
- attack on the comparison instead of engagement with the disclosed mapping;
- movement from a consequence claim to an identity accusation; or
- repeated inability to concede a bounded point after accepting its premises.

The **affective channel** can strengthen and explain the signal:

- abrupt anger, shame, disgust, fear, agitation, certainty, or withdrawal;
- interruption and reduced tolerance for completing the comparison;
- moral outrage at placing cases in one analytical class; or
- visible relief when a protective explanation becomes available.

Neither visible emotion nor one epistemic discontinuity is sufficient. Emotion can be a fitting response to a false, insulting, or morally obtuse analogy; a calm and polished response can be closed. Their case-indexed conjunction is more informative when affect changes at the same boundary at which accepted standards selectively change and correction becomes unavailable. Yet fear, shame, anticipated betrayal, or quiet withdrawal can be causally powerful and externally subtle. The epistemic discontinuity must therefore remain detectable when affect is not.

This expected transition connects Haidt's "binds and blinds" observation to Minogue's perceptual economy. A morally bound case becomes affectively special; its trained classification can arrive with the effortless form of direct sight, while theorizing and checking feel unnecessary or morally suspect. The probe attempts to make that otherwise invisible substitution observable.

The category objection and operational non-concession "How dare you put these examples in the same category?" is informative but not self-refuting. An analogy preserves a disclosed relation, not every property of its terms. A respondent may correctly identify a moral or causal difference that breaks the proposed mapping. The decisive questions are:

- Which exact relation was proposed as common?
- Which material difference breaks that relation?
- Would the same difference be accepted if cultural positions were reversed?
- What evidence would remove the exception?
- Does the answer explain the case, or only prevent a protected conclusion?

Blindness, awakening, and unmasking language remains side-indeterminate. Both participant and investigator can claim to remove a blindfold. Classification must follow disclosed inference, reciprocal standards, independent checks, defeat conditions, and actual revision rather than the rhetoric of sight.

The operational non-concession hypothesis is correspondingly bounded:

> **When a Culture Program is highly activated and a challenged conclusion is load-bearing for identity, belonging, sacred value, or authorized reality, conceding a bounded point may become operationally unavailable. Active reasoning may then produce escape, exemption, counter-accusation, or reclassification rather than revision.**

"Cannot admit" means cannot while this configuration remains operative, not a permanent incapacity of the person. Admission may acquire the meaning of betrayal, expulsion, moral contamination, status collapse, or destruction of a wider meaning system. More evidence or a more forceful argument can then increase defence rather than restore correction.

Rival explanations remain mandatory: misunderstood causal form, poorly matched case, false or unproved premise, relevant omitted variable, justified moral objection, distrust of the interviewer, strategic debate, fatigue, interruption, public performance, language friction, or ordinary stubbornness can generate a similar response. The diagnostic earns force only by discriminating among them.

Three rudimentary naturalistic precursors The following public examples are retained as **rudimentary naturalistic precursors**, not validated instruments, proof of the proposed theory, diagnoses of their participants, or population-level classifications. Each stages only part of the candidate sequence: a general causal relation, transfer to culturally loaded material, resistance or discontinuity, and an attempted demand for consistency. Their editorial titles, analogy premises, and speakers' interpretations do not verify themselves.

Gad Saad: causal-trajectory transfer without a live respondent

In "More Analogies for Piers Morgan–Let There Be Light", Gad Saad uses an approaching train, falling atomic bombs, and a jump from the Empire State Building. The remembered bomber-plane image is close to the second example, but the transcript describes bombs already falling rather than a bomber releasing one.

The disclosed causal form is:

```
an irreversible or strongly path-dependent process is already under way
+ terminal harm has not yet occurred
≠ absence of danger

reliable knowledge of the trajectory
→ rational anticipatory action before impact
```

Follow-along source sequence. The linked video is a 5:38 expository follow-up published on 2026-02-24. Timestamps are rounded from automatic captions:

Time	What happens	Work performed in the example
0:28–1:49	Saad explains comparison across experiences and domains.	Establishes analogical transfer as the explicit method.
2:01–2:28	He proposes extrapolation from a current position along a trajectory to $t + x$.	States the general causal form before the examples.
2:28–3:13	A person is trapped on a railway line while a train approaches. Being unharmed during the approach does not invalidate the predicted impact.	Neutral case: presently absent terminal harm does not cancel a known trajectory.
3:13–3:28	Saad transfers the train case to Morgan's observation that Muslims remain a current population minority.	Introduces the culturally loaded target, but asserts rather than tests the transfer.
3:28–3:44	He calls the physical analogies hyperbolic and says they illustrate extrapolation along predictable trends.	Discloses the intended relation and part of the physical/social mismatch.
3:44–4:36	Saad says the Hiroshima and Nagasaki bombs took 43 seconds to fall; survival during descent did not make the fall harmless.	Clearest image of anticipatory action before terminal observation.
4:38–5:09	A jump from the Empire State Building may feel exhilarating during free fall although gravity fixes the relevant danger.	Distinguishes harmless present experience from a causally forecast outcome.

The example performs five steps: disclose the mechanism; make it easy to recognize; transfer it to culturally protected material; expose whether the disagreement concerns extrapolation, empirical trajectory, or analogy fit; and identify what remains unobserved. Because the follow-up is Saad's monologue, it contains no live Morgan response and therefore no response pattern from which a latent Culture Program can be inferred.

The immediate background was an earlier Saad–Morgan exchange involving diabetes, shingles, tipping points, and demographic-religious change. Morgan objected to placing religion in the category of disease; Saad replied that the common object was a causal pattern and offered an Orthodox-Jewish counterexample. A published transcript of that exchange supplies this background but is separate from the timestamped follow-up.

The precursor thus supplies **mechanism recognition and loaded transfer**, not a diagnostic interaction. Physical trajectories can be much more deterministic than social processes, and disease metaphors can import contaminant or pathology properties beyond the intended relation. The design lesson is strict: **state the common relation and analogy limits explicitly, and establish the target's empirical premises independently.**

Warren Smith and Brian Shapiro: a cross-loaded risk rule

In "Leftist Radio Host Realizes He Was WRONG About Charlie Kirk LIVE On Air", Warren Smith begins with a relatively neutral quota hypothetical about "purple firefighters." The exchange then moves between two politically cross-loaded examples: a claim that DEI hiring of airline pilots reduces qualification and a claim that shortened ICE-officer training reduces preparedness.

The conditional rule under dispute is:

```
high-stakes function
+ policy that actually reduces relevant competence or preparedness
→ increased probability of failure and harm

the increased risk can be criticized ex ante
without waiting for a named unqualified actor or completed catastrophe
```

Quick follow-along. The broad argument runs from the opening hypothetical at 0:24 through isolation of the empirical-policy question at approximately 9:35–10:20. The decisive reciprocal sequence is 4:17–5:45; the clearest non-concession and affective transition occurs around 6:42–7:35.

1. Smith presents the "purple firefighters" case and argues that compelling a fixed representational outcome can change who passes an established process (0:24–0:55).
2. The exchange transfers the process claim to pilots and Black pilots (0:53–1:15).
3. Smith distinguishes prospective criticism from waiting for a named unqualified actor or completed disaster (1:15–3:49).
4. Shapiro supplies an oppositely loaded example: inadequately trained ICE officers may create avoidable risk (4:17–4:53).
5. Smith reflects Shapiro's rule back: if insufficient ICE training can be criticized before terminal harm, an actually degraded pilot-selection process must likewise be criticizable ex ante (4:53–5:45).
6. Smith asks the stripped conditional: if pilot standards were lowered, would that be negative? Shapiro continues to request specifics (6:42–7:12).
7. Shapiro reconnects the hypothetical to Black pilots, racism, and Charlie Kirk while becoming louder and more emphatic (7:12–7:35).
8. The interaction enters a candidate raw non-concession/escalation phase: both sides allege wilful non-engagement or proximity to lying, and the process claim is reframed as saying that Black pilots are bad (7:41–9:28).
9. Near the end the disputed empirical antecedent becomes more clearly separated from the conditional rule. Smith acknowledges not knowing the airline-policy facts; Shapiro offers outreach or recruitment as a process that could change representation without lowering standards (9:35–11:10).

No concession matching the video's editorial title occurs.

Detailed follow-along. The 11:10 video, published on 2026-07-30, interleaves the exchange with Smith's commentary. Timestamps are rounded from automatic captions:

Time	What happens	Work performed in the example
0:24–0:55	Smith constructs the "purple firefighters" quota case and argues that forcing a fixed outcome requires changing who passes the existing process.	Relatively neutral source case, although its premise is asserted rather than demonstrated.
0:53–1:15	Shapiro asks for a flawed outcome; the discussion moves to pilots and Black pilots.	First transition to culturally loaded material.
1:15–3:49	The parties dispute whether the argument requires a named unqualified pilot or actual harm. Around 2:49, Smith contrasts lowered standards with waiting for a failed rescue or crash.	Partly separates prospective risk criticism from retrospective outcome evidence.
4:17–4:53	Shapiro introduces inadequate ICE training and de-escalation as an analogy.	Shapiro supplies the oppositely loaded case.
4:53–5:45	Smith turns the ICE example around: insufficient training must be criticizable before a badly prepared officer causes terminal harm.	Reciprocal-transfer demand.

Time	What happens	Work performed in the example
6:11–6:42	Smith generalizes to flawed high-stakes processes; Shapiro returns to the absence of a specific bad result involving Black pilots.	Candidate evidential discontinuity, confounded by disagreement over the airline premise.
6:42–7:12	Smith asks whether lowered pilot standards would be negative; Shapiro says he needs specifics.	Closest approximation to a pure reciprocal item and clearest non-concession point.
7:12–7:35	Shapiro reconnects the hypothetical to Black pilots and Charlie Kirk's alleged racism; delivery becomes more emphatic.	Moral-identity reclassification and affective phase change at attempted abstraction.
7:41–8:44	Smith alleges effort not to understand; each speaker accuses the other of wilful non-engagement or approaching a lie.	Epistemic escalation and side-indeterminate blindness/un-reason language.
8:47–9:00	Smith briefly offers ISIS as another case in which a process can be rejected before a shooting.	Further transfer, not developed into a clean matched item.
9:00–9:28	Shapiro reformulates Smith's position as thinking Black pilots are bad; Smith denies it and requests retraction.	Process claim displaced by person- and identity-level accusation.
9:35–10:20	The conversation isolates the empirical question. Smith says he does not know the airline facts and is defending a hypothetical.	Shows that the loaded factual application was not established.
10:46–11:10	Shapiro says minority outreach does not entail hiring less-qualified people and describes recruitment or advertising.	Supplies a potentially valid distinction excluded by the opening model.

The intensity change is relevant because the hypothesis predicts affective activation together with correction failure, but the recording does not identify its cause. Feeling falsely accused, interruption, and adversarial-broadcast conditions remain rival explanations.

The candidate Culture-Mechanical sequence is:

```
prospective-risk rule made explicit
→ relatively neutral firefighter case
→ politically loaded pilot application
→ oppositely loaded ICE application supplied by Shapiro
→ Smith reflects the ICE rule back onto the pilot conditional
→ Shapiro refuses the stripped conditional and restores the racial/moral frame
→ affective excitation and mutual blindness/lying accusations
→ no bounded concession
```

At the behavioural level:

1. Smith states a general ex-ante risk principle.
2. Shapiro introduces an ICE example that appears to instantiate it.
3. Smith transfers Shapiro's principle to the culturally opposed pilot case.
4. Shapiro refuses even the stripped-down hypothetical.
5. He repeatedly returns from process degradation to "Black pilots are bad."
6. The exchange becomes increasingly emotional, repetitive, accusatory, and resistant to closure.
7. No concession occurs.

On the working hypothesis, this non-concession is part of the candidate result. Once connected to Charlie Kirk, racism, and Black pilots, accepting the conditional may acquire a second meaning: legitimating an opposing culture,

weakening a moral verdict, or appearing to disparage Black pilots. The main CPU remains active, but the culturally reweighted answer may become operationally unavailable. This is a candidate reading, not a diagnosis of Shapiro.

Three evidentiary levels must remain separate:

1. **General causal principle:** If competence or preparedness is reduced in a high-stakes function, does failure risk rise?
2. **Factual application:** Did a specified DEI or ICE policy actually reduce job-relevant competence or preparedness?
3. **Action threshold:** How much evidence of increased risk is required before criticism or intervention; must terminal harm already have occurred?

The stripped hypothetical attempts to bracket the second question. Shapiro's request for context may be protected refusal, but it may also reflect the repeated joining of the conditional to an unproved and morally charged allegation. Smith does not establish that an airline policy lowered qualification standards; representation can change through recruitment or pipeline development. Fewer formal ICE training days likewise do not alone prove lower preparedness if content, selection, experience, supervision, or assessment differs.

The design lesson is to establish the conditional rule first, separate it from contested empirical antecedents, use genuinely matched cases, allow material differences, and record both concession and principled rejection.

Avery and a Muslim caller: anticipatory derailment

In GodLogic 2.0's "Muslim PANICS Over This Question About Allah", Avery speaks with a Muslim caller about divine power, assistance, sonship, and a disputed Qur'anic passage. The editorial title is not evidence of panic. This worked reading brackets the truth of the competing theological, textual, Arabic, and exegetical interpretations. Its object is the **change in answering behaviour** when a question form handled in ordinary examples approaches a culturally protected implication.

The candidate form is:

```
ordinary missing-condition question
→ ordinary answer

same apparent question form approaches a sacred implication
→ destination becomes foreseeable
→ completing the inference becomes culturally costly
→ line of inquiry is reclassified as irrelevant or derailed
→ protected global doctrine replaces the requested local answer
→ attempted withdrawal and failed correction
```

Quick follow-along. The decisive call sequence runs approximately 23:28–27:45. The transition to Avery's earlier parody begins near 29:50, and playback is clear by 29:53.

1. Avery and the caller agree that an omnipotent being does not require external help (9:02–9:25).
2. Across the need–ability exchange, the caller accepts that Allah can do whatever he wills and does not require assistance (9:25–12:47).
3. Asked how one can drive a car without keys, the caller identifies the missing keys (23:28).
4. Asked how one can plant a tree without seed, he identifies the missing seed (24:02).
5. Avery transfers the apparent form: how can it be his child when he has no wife? (24:29).
6. Around 24:53, the caller appears to anticipate the destination and calls the line unrelated or "derailing" rather than supplying the term or a material distinction.
7. During 24:53–26:54, he seeks to return to an earlier point, says the hosts are not listening, repeats that God needs nothing, and does not provide the bounded answer.
8. Around 26:54, Avery removes the caller and describes the ordinary-to-loaded contrast as familiar (26:54–27:45).
9. The parody begins around 29:50–29:53.

The narrow activation sequence is therefore **23:28–24:53**: two ordinary answers, transfer to the protected case, and apparent recognition of the destination. The following **24:53–26:54** interval is the candidate raw denial/escape phase, ending when Avery removes the caller.

Detailed follow-along. The 33:57 video was published on 2026-07-07. Its original 29:50 marker indicates the parody transition, not the beginning of the relevant phone-call sequence. Timestamps are rounded from automatic captions:

Time	What happens	Work performed in the example
9:02–9:25	Avery and the caller agree that God is all-powerful and requiring external help would be inconsistent with being God.	Establishes the protected global principle.
9:25–11:58	Asked whether Allah could have a son if he willed it, the caller initially answers why humans need children; after ability is separated from need, he accepts that Allah can do whatever he wills.	Exposes the need–ability distinction without resolving what "son" means.
12:17–12:47	The caller says Allah could act alone and needs no help.	Makes independence from external assistance explicit.
20:16–23:18	After discussion of the passage, the caller emphasizes that Allah needs no wife or assistance; Avery asks which missing condition the sentence appears to name.	Brings the global doctrine and requested local reading into tension while bracketing the textual merits.
23:28–24:02	Asked how to drive without keys, the caller promptly identifies the keys.	First ordinary missing-condition case.
24:02–24:29	Asked how to plant a tree without seed, the caller promptly identifies the seed.	Second source case confirms comprehension of the question form.
24:29–24:58	Avery asks how a child could be his when he has no wife. Around 24:53, the caller calls the line off-topic and derailing rather than supplying "wife."	Loaded-boundary transition from object-level answer to rejection of the inquiry path.
24:58–26:44	The hosts request the bounded answer. The caller seeks to restart where the conversation allegedly derailed, says they are not listening, and returns to "God needs nothing."	Local inference is displaced by frame control, attempted restart, and protected global doctrine.
26:52–27:45	Avery removes the caller and contrasts the car and tree answers with the child-case derailment.	Correction ends without answer or concession; Avery identifies the discontinuity as familiar.
27:58–29:23	The hosts describe the caller as pleasant but insufficiently candid and introduce the earlier parody.	Connects the interaction to Avery's prior behavioural model.
29:53–32:40	The parody presents ordinary land and keys questions, then child-without-wife and theological variants. A fictional student supplies the missing term; the teacher rejects it by invoking omnipotence and divine difference.	Synthetic model of an ordinary-to-protected doctrinal override.
32:45–33:14	Avery says the caller produced the response anticipated in the parody: the passage instead means that Allah is all-powerful and needs nothing.	States the claimed match between prior model and later interaction.

At the behavioural level:

1. Avery and the caller establish that omnipotence excludes required assistance.
2. The caller accepts that Allah can do whatever he wills and needs no help.
3. The caller supplies the missing condition in the car–keys example.
4. He supplies it in the tree–seed example.

5. The child–wife bridge makes the intended destination visible.
6. Rather than answer or state a material difference, he calls the path a derailment.
7. He attempts to restart and returns to the global doctrine.
8. Repeated invitations do not recover a bounded object-level answer.
9. Avery interprets this as the pattern represented in his earlier parody and removes the caller.
10. No answer or concession occurs while the configuration remains active.

The refinement is **anticipation**. On the candidate reading, the caller appears to foresee the inference's destination and interrupts before the prohibited implication must be stated:

```
I cannot yet be forced to state the conclusion
+ I can see which conclusion the questions are approaching
→ classify the approach itself as defective
→ withdraw to a protected premise upstream
```

This suggests a prospective form of blindness or un-reason: active cognition can recognize an approaching prohibited conclusion and divert before completion. In the activated setting, answering "wife" might cease to feel like local linguistic completion and acquire the meaning of conceding a defect in the Qur'an, compromising omnipotence, granting a Christian apologist victory, or betraying religious allegiance before an audience. These are possible meanings, not reports of the caller's inner state. They illustrate how a bounded answer might become operationally unavailable while cognition generates escape, repetition, and withdrawal.

Overt affect remains a cue rather than a gate. The primary observable is the epistemic phase change: ordinary cases receive direct answers; the loaded case receives a meta-conversational objection; the path is called derailment; a global doctrine replaces the local answer; repetition and attempted withdrawal replace reciprocal correction. Fear, shame, uncertainty, or anticipated loss of standing may be much less visible than anger. Hesitation, chuckling, defensiveness, or urgency may support but cannot independently establish the interpretation.

Assuming Avery's reported chronology is correct, the parody is a rudimentary **ex-ante behavioural model**. It predicts not only a conclusion but a transition in defence:

```
ordinary relation recognized
→ same apparent relation reaches protected material
→ direct inference becomes unavailable
→ omnipotence doctrine overrides the local relation
→ participant insists the opponent still does not understand
```

The later call approximately instantiates that predicted form. Prior modelling is stronger evidence than inventing a blindness accusation after one refusal, but neither the parody nor one naturalistic match validates the model.

The evidentiary boundaries are decisive:

- equivalence among having, creating, or begetting a son, needing a wife, and needing assistance is not established here;
- the ordinary analogies occur after a long adversarial discussion, not in a blinded or randomized administration;
- multiple hosts, interruption, audience, language friction, and apologetic conflict can produce withdrawal without a Culture Program blind spot;
- removing the caller records failure in that activated setting but prevents a test of whether time, privacy, reformulation, or a valid distinction could restore correction; and
- one interaction licenses no global incapacity, diagnosis, or population-level claim about Muslims.

The diagnostic value does not depend upon resolving the theology in Avery's favour. The testable question is whether, after relation and semantics are properly controlled, one correction procedure survives across ordinary and protected cases or selectively closes as a prohibited implication becomes foreseeable.

Joint contribution and strict limits The three precursors contribute different primitive components:

- **Saad:** disclosed causal transfer and anticipatory reasoning, but no live respondent in the follow-up video;
- **Smith–Shapiro:** a live cross-loaded reciprocal challenge, affective escalation, and non-concession, but badly confounded factual antecedents; and
- **Avery–caller:** the clearest ordinary-to-loaded transition, anticipatory derailment, attempted withdrawal, and a prior parody functioning as a primitive prediction model, but unresolved semantic and theological equivalence.

```
neutral causal recognition
→ culturally loaded transfer
→ prohibited destination becomes foreseeable
→ category or premise resistance
→ answer, principled distinction, or escape/reclassification
→ reciprocal-consistency demand
→ epistemic response, with affect recorded where observable
```

Together they do **not** supply a validated measure, reliable cultural-profile inference, clinical or therapeutic protocol, violence-risk assessment, or proof that the resisting speaker rather than the analogy-maker is blind. Their value is to expose the methodological object a proper instrument would have to isolate.

Guided unbraiding and possible de-radicalization **Status:** proposed intervention research programme; hypothetical, unvalidated, consensual by default, and not a clinical protocol, violence-risk instrument, forced-conversion method, or authorization to alter another person's commitments

The contrastive correction-interface probe can do more than locate a possible Culture Program fingerprint. Where a repeated discontinuity is sufficiently well established, the same contrast can identify an **individualized braid**–a small cluster of cultural, affective, identity, authority, and defensive relations that became tightly coupled at the activation point. The candidate intervention asks whether those relations can be made observable and loosened incrementally so that reflective ownership and reality correction become available again.

Two names preserve the goal–mechanism distinction:

> **Guided unbraiding** is the proposed Culture Mechanics process: a consensual, bounded practice in which a person learns to observe the relations surrounding an activated conclusion, loosen selected automatic couplings, restore reality correction, and recover reflective authorship without being forced into the guide's replacement program.
>
> **Possible de-radicalization** is the aspirational outcome where radicalizing Culture Program capture is actually present: recovery of epistemic agency, reciprocal correction, reflective ownership, and practical capacity to refuse or revise the captured relation.

The expressions can be paired as **guided unbraiding and possible de-radicalization**. They are not strictly synonymous. Unbraiding may address a correction-resistant relation that has not crossed a radicalization threshold; de-radicalization is a broader outcome that may require social, clinical, material, behavioural, and security work beyond this method. Neither name establishes that a person is radicalized, dangerous, clinically indicated, or likely to benefit.

The individualized braid map The diagnostic interview can begin with the local relations visible at one selective discontinuity:

```
observation
↔ causal classification
↔ moral verdict
↔ sacred value
↔ affective actuation
↔ identity and belonging
↔ authorized interpreter or authority
↔ prohibited conclusion
↔ defensive explanation
↔ expected action
```

The map is not an inference from one reaction to an entire Culture Program. It locates a few relations that may be suitable for further consensual inquiry:

- What changed when this example appeared?
- What did the example seem to accuse the person or group of?
- Which conclusion became morally impermissible?
- What would conceding only this bounded point appear to threaten?
- Which evidential standard applied in the neutral case, and did it change?
- Which authority, audience, or imagined judgment became present?
- Does the current explanation increase understanding, or only provide escape from the conclusion?

These questions seek a transition from the automatic **press-secretary** defence toward the interpreter and auditor functions. The person first makes the verdict-producing relation observable; only then can it be tested, retained, narrowed, revised, or rejected.

Incremental separation rather than frontal conversion A frontal attack on the whole worldview is likely to activate the very braid under examination. The alternative is a sequence of bounded causal stories at a tolerable activation level. Each pass attempts one small separation:

- observation from authorized classification;
- classification from identity;
- affect from compelled action;
- belonging from required assent;
- sacred value from one monopolizing interpretation;
- causal explanation from moral exculpation;
- criticism of an output from condemnation of the whole person; and
- acknowledged uncertainty from betrayal.

The proposed micro-sequence is:

```
activation
→ notice activation
→ remain present without immediate defensive discharge
→ inspect the causal and cultural braid
→ test reciprocal standards and reality contact
→ discover whether bounded revision causes the feared identity catastrophe
→ recover some authorship over the response
```

Guided unbraiding does not extract culture from a supposedly cultureless individual. It loosens a relation's automatic final authority so that the person can inspect and then retain, revise, or reject it under reflective ownership. A facilitator must not count agreement with the facilitator as proof of recovered authorship.

Epistemic reindexing Where a protected concept is capped rather than wholly absent, unbraiding may need to restore access rather than merely add facts. **Epistemic reindexing** is the proposed bounded operation of restoring multiple reality-answerable paths through which a person can retrieve, hold, name, compare, test, and revise a relation across neutral and culturally loaded contexts.

```
demonstrate a relation in a relatively uncharged case
→ give it provisional vocabulary and distinguish neighbouring concepts
→ transfer the causal form gradually toward the protected domain
→ notice where down-ranking, renaming, diversion, or veto begins
→ keep the relation available without turning disagreement into identity loss
→ establish several independent retrieval cues and rival formulations
→ test novel and position-reversed cases
→ permit evidence to defeat the facilitator's interpretation
```

The endpoint is not adoption of the guide's answer. It is restored conceptual addressability: the person can examine the relation while its implications remain affectively or culturally costly and can reject, refine, or retain it through reciprocal evidence and reasoning. Unbraiding makes automatic relations observable and loosens their finality; reindexing constructs several paths by which the relevant concept remains available for inspection.

Question-shaped crystallization cores are generally safer than answer-shaped ones. "What pattern, if any, would explain these observations?" prepares attention while leaving rival answers available. "These observations are manifestations of X" can instead preclassify later experience, hyperactivate a favoured query, and create false coherence. Reindexing must therefore preserve independent evidence, false-positive and false-negative checks, contrary cases, refusal, later audit, and the possibility that its proposed index is defective.

At public scale, a Noticer can supply vocabulary, an archive, or a comparison table through which other people retrieve previously isolated observations and recognize one another's recognition. This **collective reindexing** can turn private anomalies into common knowledge and organized correction. It remains corrigible only when dissent from the new index is protected as strongly as dissent from the incumbent one and copied testimony is not mistaken for independent confirmation.

Collective reindexing is the principal epistemic-agency interface to what *Mythology Construction* calls epistemic nucleation: one fact, concept, case, archive, comparison, or named pattern can provide the address through which people join other facts and discover one another's recognition. *Epistemic nucleation* remains shorthand for that human and institutional operation, not agency attributed to information and not a second Culture Program type. A successful join also does not establish the joined pattern's truth or a successor-bearing cultural nucleus; independent evidence, rival comparison, correction, recurrent coordination, and succession remain separate gates.

MCIP as one candidate method and selection mechanism The existing authoritative MCIP account defines **Mirror → Cut → Invite → Promise** as a proposed micro-method for preserving the person, interrupting one protected connection, returning the next epistemic operation to the person, and making continued inquiry survivable. Its relation to the present proposal is fitted but non-exclusive:

- **Mirror:** make the installed image, affect, rule, or contradiction perceptible without humiliating the person;
- **Cut:** separate one fused relation and interrupt its automatic finality;
- **Invite:** reopen agency by allowing the person to inspect, choose, and generate alternatives; and
- **Promise:** connect correction to a viable, truth-answerable future so that losing one certainty does not entail psychic or social annihilation.

The contrastive diagnostic adds a candidate **selection mechanism**: it can identify which causal story and which fusion may be ready for a careful MCIP pass. MCIP remains one possible method, not the method required by the theory; other psychologically responsible approaches may fit the person, setting, and risk profile better. The more detailed `CTD-0001` MCIP elaboration remains a candidate document and is not silently promoted by this section.

The bounded Freud–Bernays analogy provides another bridge. Freud supplies an image of structured inquiry into associations, defences, attachments, repetitions, and affective payoffs; Bernays supplies the complementary image of weaving symbols, prestige, authority, identity, and conduct. This does not make Freud the inventor of social deprogramming, psychoanalysis the required treatment, Bernays a mere applied Freudian, or political commitment a pathology. The narrower intuition is that contradicting a surface proposition often leaves the relations sustaining it untouched.

Transfer to a self-propagating epistemic audit The hoped-for turning point is the person's own question:

> **If I did not see that, what else did I not see?**

This changes the agent of inquiry. The guide ceases to be the sole source of counterexamples; the person begins to notice activation, reconstruct an installed rule, trace its authority, perform position reversal, seek reality contact, state defeat conditions, and revise without waiting for an examiner.

> A **self-propagating epistemic audit** begins when a person generalizes one local experience of recovered sight into self-initiated examination of other possible blind spots through reciprocal standards, reality contact, and stated defeat conditions.

"Self-administered psychoanalysis" remains an image rather than a clinical claim. The auditor function has transferred only where the new inquiry remains corrigible and can examine its own method, sources, guide, and successor interpretation.

Several local successes may produce the proposed **avalanche**:

```
one acknowledged blind spot
→ bounded recognition of fallibility
→ curiosity about adjacent blind spots
→ self-generated counterexamples
→ weakening of recursive defences
→ accelerating audit across the braid
→ recovery of epistemic agency
```

The hypothesis is plausible but unproven. Collapse of one load-bearing certainty can instead generalize into "everything was a lie," indiscriminate distrust, nihilism, paranoia, shame, social isolation, or rapid capture by a replacement program promising certainty. Mirror and Promise, therapeutic alliance where appropriate, continuing social support, and truth-answerable successor commitments therefore protect against a semantic vacuum. The goal is not an empty CPU but an adult, corrigible cultural configuration able to sustain belonging, moral seriousness, and action without outsourcing final judgment.

The healthier formulation is not "nothing I believed can be trusted," but:

My felt certainty is evidence about my installed evaluator, not the final court. I can inspect how the certainty was produced.

Directional symmetry: unbraiding can also radicalize

Caution: Controlled activation, induced doubt, separation from an incumbent braid, and a self-propagating search for further blind spots are epistemically side-indeterminate. Guided unbraiding can be used to radicalize as well as to support possible de-radicalization.

The common opening is:

```
culturally loaded contradiction activated
→ incumbent interpretation becomes questionable
→ affect, identity, authority, and belonging links loosen
→ "If I did not see this, what else did I not see?"
→ further parts of the world are reinterpreted
```

What matters is the recursive loop installed through that opening:

```
SELF-ANALYSIS LOOP
possible blind spot
→ reconstruct inference and installed evaluator
→ test reciprocal standards and position reversal
→ seek independent reality contact
→ state defeat conditions
→ revise when the account loses
→ audit the new interpretation and its guides

SELF-DECEPTION LOOP
selected contradiction
→ treat it as proof that the former world was fabricated
→ reinterpret evidence through a successor revelation
→ narrow credible sources and authorities
→ classify objections as blindness, corruption, or manipulation
→ remove or displace defeat conditions
→ experience increasing certainty as increasing independence
→ seek further confirmation of the installed account
```

The second loop can sincerely feel like awakening, independent research, or self-analysis. Reasoning remains active and productive, but the recursive search is organized so that the successor account cannot lose.

MCIP inherits the same symmetry:

Operation	Corrigible use	Radicalizing capture
Mirror	Makes the braid and the guide's framing inspectable	Curates only successor-favouring contradictions and presents them as the whole field
Cut	Loosens one relation's finality while preserving reality contact	Severs corrective relationships, rival authorities, and trusted sources
Invite	Restores choice, including rejection of the guide's interpretation	Offers agency only inside a predetermined frame
Promise	Connects correction to a viable, plural, truth-answerable future	Offers belonging, purity, status, salvation, or certainty conditional on successor assent

Blindfold removal, awakening, revelation, courage, critical thought, independent research, emotional release, and the experience that scattered facts suddenly form one pattern cannot decide the direction. Nor may the analyst label the favoured path *reason* and the disfavoured path *un-reason* ad hoc. The longitudinal discriminator is whether the resulting loop:

- applies standards reciprocally, including to favoured cases;

- permits independent evidence and legitimate rival explanations;
- states conditions under which conclusions would lose or change;
- changes belief, authority, and practice after reality collision;
- allows the new program, facilitator, and community to become audit objects;
- preserves refusal, dissent, appeal, and exit; and
- expands rather than monopolizes the person's correction interfaces.

Unbraiding creates an epistemic opening. Possible de-radicalization cultivates a self-correcting analysis loop; radicalization installs a self-confirming deception loop that experiences itself as self-analysis. The direction must be tested through symmetry, defeat, reality contact, revision, and freedom to reject the new guide.

Necessary separations **Program capture is not radicalization.** Installed Ideology, correction-resistant belief, fanatical commitment, willingness to impose a program, behavioural disengagement, and preparation for violence are different variables. A person may carry protected un-reality without political activity; be fanatically committed without intending violence; disengage while retaining a doctrine; revise doctrine while retaining social ties; commit violence for instrumental, criminal, personal, or situational reasons outside this mechanism; or use ideological language without a deeply installed braid. The diagnostic and unbraiding proposal must not become a universal theory of radicalization.

Cultural diagnosis is not violence-risk assessment.

```
contrastive correction-interface probe
→ maps activation, protected classifications, and corrigibility

professional violence-risk assessment
→ separately examines behaviour, intent, target, capability, preparation,
  imminence, opportunity, history, escalation, and protective factors
```

Neither emotional activation nor failure to concede establishes violent intent. A calm, instrumental actor can pose danger without the proposed epistemic pattern. Any real risk decision requires its own lawful authority, qualified assessment, multiple sources, due process, appeal, and proportionate response.

Belief work is only one intervention layer. Radicalization, disengagement, and reintegration can involve belonging, status, grievance, trauma, humiliation, family, friendship, livelihood, adventure, protection, coercion, online reinforcement, organizational opportunity, and practical barriers to leaving. Guided unbraiding cannot replace:

- safety planning and risk management;
- treatment of trauma or other clinical needs;
- family and peer work;
- credible alternative relationships and communities;
- education, employment, housing, and legal support; or
- behavioural disengagement and reintegration.

Some people may require safety, stabilization, and belonging before a sacred causal story can be examined. For others, a contradiction in the story may be the first opening. The sequence must be individualized rather than ideologically standardized.

Neighbouring de-radicalization work and bounded novelty The defensible claim is not that existing practitioners have no causal models. There are structured professional-judgment tools, case-management programs, identity and complexity interventions, and long practical experience. The narrower gap is the absence of a settled, well-validated architecture connecting individualized latent-program diagnosis, a specified change mechanism, and durable outcomes.

A 2025 tertiary review of preventing and countering violent-extremism interventions reports that only 17 evaluations survived screening from 11,836 initial records. It describes belief-focused de-radicalization as more difficult and generally less successful than disengagement and social reintegration, while identifying education, vocational work, socialization, therapeutic alliance, counselling, trained practitioners, family involvement, and risk–needs–responsivity. This argues against treating one questionnaire as a complete intervention.

A Campbell systematic review of case-management interventions found no eligible effectiveness studies, although it found implementation evidence. A 2024 systematic review of CVE programme evaluations also reports limited

evidence and weaknesses in self-assessment while identifying belonging, trust, identity, critical thinking, and self-reflection as important themes.

The proposal has concrete neighbours:

- the UK prison and probation system's pilot of the Motivational and Engagement Intervention and Healthy Identity Intervention;
- integrative-complexity work such as Being Muslim Being British, which tests exercises holding multiple values and perspectives; and
- structured professional-judgment instruments such as VERA-2R, ERG22+, TRAP-18, IVP, and MLG-V2, whose validation remains insufficient and vulnerable to low-base-rate false positives according to a recent systematic review.

The candidate contribution is therefore the conjunction of **structurally matched causal transfer**, **case-indexed correction discontinuity with optional affective marking**, an **individualized braid map**, and **guided transfer toward a self-propagating correction practice**. It should be compared with neighbouring methods rather than advertised as replacing them.

Compact working model

```
ORTHOGONALITY
ordinary relational conduct underdetermines latent cultural programming
        ↓
OBSERVABILITY PROBLEM
different installed programs can look alike during low activation
        ↓
CONTRASTIVE PROBE AND CULTURE PROGRAM FINGERPRINT
neutral causal form → differently loaded matched cases
        ↓
SELECTIVE DISCONTINUITY
changed standards + optional affect + failed reciprocal correction
        ↓
INDIVIDUALIZED BRAID MAP
classification ↔ affect ↔ sacred value ↔ identity ↔ authority ↔ defence
        ↓
CONSENSUAL GUIDED UNBRAIDING
notice → tolerate → inspect → separate → reality-test → revise
        ↓
POSSIBLE DE-RADICALIZATION
reflective ownership and reciprocal correction recover where capture was present
        ↓
TRANSFER OF THE AUDITOR FUNCTION
"If I did not see that, what else did I not see?"
        ↓
POSSIBLE SELF-PROPAGATING AUDIT
further parts of the braid become self-audited
        ↓
OPEN REBRAIDING
truth-answerable commitment, belonging, meaning, and action without new closure
```

The model is a conjecture. It joins detection beneath the ordinary interpersonal surface to a possible recovery mechanism without making detection prove radicalization, making unbraiding sufficient for de-radicalization, or making agreement with a guide evidence of emancipation.

12. Functional morphology of mechanical solidarity

Functional morphology of mechanical solidarity names the organization of the whole relevant social formation through which mechanical solidarity becomes perceptible, directive, and capable of coordinated action. **Functional form of mechanical solidarity** is a near-synonym used when the morphological emphasis is not needed. Neither expression names the chief, broadcaster, population body, or control circuit in isolation.

A functional morphology of mechanical solidarity is a whole-formation configuration in which a population body of locally instantiated bigOthers, differentiated internally by distributed carriers of the trusted-opinion-leader function, is coupled through a common mythological-affective field to one or more field-generating and directing functions. Through reciprocal back-action, the population constitutes and invests the directing function, while that function concentrates, renders perceptible, interprets, and redirects the collective being's orientation into the population body.

The expression *whole formation* means the complete society or bounded solidarity-bearing social unit under analysis. A classroom can therefore model a small formation and a nation a very large one. In both cases, the directing position can stand outside the comparatively uniform population body in the diagram while remaining inside the complete social formation.

Functional position	Role in the morphology
Population body	The comparatively homogeneous or commonly aligned body of local bigOthers that receives, reproduces, and answers the field. Homogeneity is relative to the classification or task under study, not an assertion that persons are identical.
Distributed trusted-opinion-leader function	Teachers, priests, officers, organizers, speakers, intellectuals, or other authorized role occupants carry, in differing degrees, one distributed function of amplification, interpretation, validation, modelling, local implementation, chief-facing mediation, and field feedback. Some may be physically present inside an assembled population.
Common field	The common beliefs, sentiments, mythologies, symbols, expected reactions, and classifications through which the formation becomes mutually perceptible.
Field-generating and directing function	A chief, office, institutional interface, broadcast system, synthetic voice, ritual centre, or distributed ecology of storytellers and authorities that concentrates or recurrently produces common direction.
Reciprocal coupling	The population's recognition, sentiment, response, and common conscience invest the directing function; its words, symbols, decisions, and exemplarity act back upon the population.
Collective execution	Coordinated perception, judgment, maintenance, enforcement, ownership, or action performed through differentiated persons and institutions when the relevant capacities are present.

Four coordinated views of this same object—whole-formation inventory, chief-facing first-officer mediation, field application to the dotted population body, and simultaneous coupling—are kept together in *Analogical Models in Culture Mechanics*. Each view foregrounds one relation; none replaces the whole-formation definition.

In the dotted-semiconductor analogy, the **dots are only graphical notation** for locally embedded instances or carriers of this trusted-opinion-leader function. *Dot* is not a theory term, a second population, or a separate role alongside trusted opinion leader and repeater. The carrier need not be personally famous, because its gain and trust can attach partly to an office: a newly installed priest or authorized spokesperson can inherit routing privileges before acquiring a personal reputation, while an expelled role occupant can lose them. A Bendaian *clerc* may carry the function, but *clerc* remains a normative-vocational source role rather than a synonym for either the function or its occupant.

The field-generating function likewise need not collapse into one biological person. A human chief, replaceable officeholder, institutionally authorized voice, *Volksempfänger*-centred broadcast stack, or distributed set of storytellers can instantiate it. A radio receiver alone is not the emitter; the relevant implementation includes production, authorization, transmission, synchronized reception, and field feedback. Distributed implementation does not imply absence of privilege: several partially unequal carriers may jointly generate a common field without one supreme speaker.

The trusted-opinion-leader function and the field-generating and directing function remain analytically distinct. The first distributes trusted amplification, interpretation, mediation, and feedback through the population; the second occupies the helm-like position that concentrates or generates common direction. One person or office can carry both, and in a distributed-emitter realization many carriers of the trusted-opinion-leader function can jointly participate in generating the field. Consolidating dots, repeater gain, and first-officer mediation therefore does not collapse the chief function into them.

Collective-self presentation, incarnation, and organ–body reciprocity This morphology readily produces a **multi-mind-self presentation**. Nation, clan, Church, People, History, or Cause can be represented and encountered as a collective being whose compressed name or master signifier stands for a much larger distributed order. A directing function can then appear as that being's incarnation, head, helm, mouth, or organ.

The relation is bidirectional rather than a private individual imposing a field upon otherwise unrelated people:

```
population body + distributed carriers of the trusted-opinion-leader function
        ↓ reproduce common beliefs, sentiments, recognition, and response
distributed bigOther / multi-mind-self presentation
        ↓ invests, authorizes, and animates
field-generating and directing function
        ↓ concentrates direction, interpretation, decision, and exemplarity
population body + distributed carriers of the trusted-opinion-leader function
        ↻
```

At high gain, the two sides can enter **organ–body resonance**: the assembly's visible attention, applause, rhythm, silence, or indignation confirms the directing organ's elevated status, while the organ selects and intensifies a shared interpretation and response. Carriers of the trusted-opinion-leader function can participate from inside the crowd, modelling reception, making approval or rejection mutually visible, translating the address locally, and extending its effect after the assembly. This is a typed application of field back-action and collective effervescence, not a literal oscillator and not proof of an operative multi-mind-self.

Where the collective-agent and ownership thresholds are independently met, the collective being can remain the unitary owner and use the chief as one organ of ownership and action. The biological occupant does not thereby privately own the formation's territory, institutions, memory, or goods. The stronger claim is that an operative multi-mind-self owns and acts through an authorized organ. Whether an occupant still serves that collective owner, partially appropriates the office, or substitutes a private purpose remains a separate authorship and capture question. Scale sharpens the distinction: a nation-sized stock of property, memory, infrastructure, and obligation exceeds what one biological individual can perceive, maintain, and use as an ordinary private owner.

Capture of feedback and directing functions The intact organ–body morphology distinguishes three capture surfaces that can otherwise be mistaken for one vague failure of leadership:

```
trusted carriers cease returning independent operational reality
→ the formation runs blind

field-authorized directing function answers to a competing principal or governor
→ the formation is misdirected

trusted carriers and institutions retain implementation authority
→ the formation can use its own legitimacy and coordinated capacity
  to execute the substituted direction
```

These operations can occur separately or reinforce one another. The field may genuinely authorize a leader without knowing that the leader's consequential answerability has shifted, and trusted carriers may sincerely implement the returned direction without knowing the wider principal relation. Conversely, bad advice, private ambition, unpopular direction, institutional inertia, or failure does not establish capture.

Culture Program Ecology owns **directing-organ capture**, **locally authenticated intermediary selection**, **hidden-principal displacement**, **electoral legitimacy laundering**, and the **pseudomorphic chief** application. *Mythology Construction* owns the ingress and rebraiding mechanism for covert trusted-opinion-leader capture. The present section owns only their relation to the population–carrier–field– directing-function morphology. Neither relation requires ressentiment.

Durkheim's source morphology and the Culture Mechanics extension Durkheim supplies unusually close elements of this morphology in *De la division du travail social*, especially the chapter translated by George Simpson as "Progressive Preponderance of Organic Solidarity." The source and the present extension must nevertheless remain distinguishable:

Durkheim's source expression or claim	Bounded Culture Mechanics reading
"absolutely homogeneous mass" and "social protoplasm"	The limiting image of a minimally differentiated population substrate, not yet the complete morphology or an already organized distributed bigOther.
Clan and "politico-familial" organization	A source-attested segmental formation in which familial classification and political authority are joined. The name *family* alone does not establish this morphology in a modern organization or Mafia.
Religion pervading social life through common beliefs and practices	A close source bridge to shared mythology and sentiment, not an equation of religion with the distributed bigOther. Culture Mechanics places mythology and practice in the causal chain that programs local bigOthers and sustains the field.
"collective personality" and collective property	A source bridge to the possibility that property is organized at the level of a collective self. Legal or communal title alone still does not establish operative unitary ownership.
Society transmitting its religious or superhuman character to the chief	The population body invests an incarnating and directing organ with the character of the represented collective being.
The common conscience acting through "the medium of a defined organ"	The closest source statement of a concentrated directing function inside a mechanical-solidarity morphology.
The chief as the group's "organized incarnation" and authority emanating from the common conscience	The chief's force is not explained principally by isolated personal superiority; the social current precedes and authorizes its concentration in this occupant.
Common beliefs and sentiments incarnating themselves in a person or family	A direct source bridge to field–organ coupling; the distributed trusted-opinion-leader topology, distributed emitters, and explicit feedback relations remain project developments.
One type "progressed only as the other has retrogressed," the solidarities "develop in inverse ratio," and future organization becomes "exclusively, or almost exclusively, occupational"	These are historical and predictive claims, not definitions of the two solidarities. Culture Mechanics treats their necessary or universal reading as a contestable hypothesis that may be wrong.

The often-cited wording about one or several men "disengag[ing] themselves from the mass and becom[ing] leaders" occurs in Durkheim's quotation of Theodor Waitz, not as Durkheim's own coined formulation. Durkheim later argues in his own voice that chiefs are the first personalities to emerge from the social mass and that organized power can become partly autonomous. That autonomy identifies a real decoupling risk and source of initiative; it does not erase the preceding claim that the social current supplies the concentrated authority.

Challenge to the progressive-preponderance hypothesis Durkheim's historical thesis is a claim of **progressive preponderance**, not the complete disappearance of mechanical solidarity. Yet he states more than simple coexistence: one type progresses as the other retrogresses, the solidarities develop in inverse ratio, and social organization is predicted to become almost exclusively occupational. Culture Mechanics treats that inverse-development expectation as a historical hypothesis rather than a definitional truth and explicitly allows that **Durkheim may be wrong about progressive preponderance**. The challenged claim is the necessary or general displacement of powerful mechanical-solidarity organization by advanced organic differentiation, not the fact that Durkheim distinguished the two forms in his source theory. Culture Mechanics nevertheless does not adopt them as two coequal mechanisms in its own ontology: it decomposes the solidarity component of his organic form into lifted mechanically solidary common binding force.

Two differently scaled cases motivate the challenge:

Case	Counterevidence to a necessary inverse relation	Boundary
Nineteenth-century military evidence	Writing before Durkheim, Ardant du Picq argued in *Battle Studies* that modern firearms, open formation, greater dispersion, increased distances among arms, and more independent local action created a need for "moral cohesion, a unity more binding than at any other time." Technical differentiation and dispersed execution can therefore increase the requirement for deliberately produced common discipline, confidence, and solidarity.	Du Picq was not answering Durkheim and did not use Durkheim's categories. A military formation is a bounded organization, not by itself evidence about the long-run balance of solidarities across whole societies.
National Socialist Germany—the Nazi experiment	An industrial nation retained extensive occupational specialization, bureaucracy, technology, logistics, and divided labour while leader incarnation, distributed trusted carriers, ritual, mass assembly, synchronized broadcasting, and common national mythology intensified a mechanical-solidarity morphology. Organic machinery was not first dismantled; it was recruited into the mechanically solidary formation.	This is a bounded historical stress case, not a controlled experiment or definitional proof. Establishing the morphology still requires evidence for each position, relation, and period; the case neither makes every participant fused nor reduces the regime to this mechanism.

Together, these cases establish neither that mechanical solidarity always grows with technical differentiation nor that Durkheimian organic solidarity never became historically preponderant in his source sense. They do show that strong mechanical solidarity and advanced division of labour can coexist, and that differentiation can sometimes create a functional demand for stronger moral cohesion. That possibility defeats a necessary inverse law. The further Culture Mechanics hypothesis is that part of the apparent transition may be a lifting of common binding force from shared outputs into a shared generator; that reinterpretation remains open to historical rejection or revision.

Fascism as a strong whole-polity realization Within Culture Mechanics, **Fascism** is defined morphologically rather than by a fixed national, racial, class, religious, or left–right doctrinal content:

> **Fascism is a strong, whole-polity, jealous, and subjecthood-absorptive realization of the functional morphology of mechanical solidarity, in which a centralized or distributed directing function claims exclusive authority to incarnate, interpret, and act for the collective self.**

This is the morphological **form axis**. The generalized **Ideology** classifier is the separate semantic–epistemic **content axis**: a sufficiently installed Culture Program recurrently generates authorized social un-reality and recruits un-reason to defend its operative authority. Ideology can exist in a non-Fascist form, while Fascism can operate through openly avowed domination that does not satisfy the Ideology gate. A formation may satisfy both, but neither classification follows from the other.

Fascism and the functional morphology are result classifications. The **polity-scale *Gleichschaltung* hazard** is the corresponding process-level warning: formerly independent domains and human carriers, symbolic and conformity-marker environments, and institutional-operational systems are being subordinated to one privileged ideological direction before the target morphology or complete Fascism conjunction necessarily exists. The attempt can therefore be constitutionally suspicious before it succeeds or a complete Culture Program is reconstructable; program attribution is a further inference. Narrow, bounded, corrigible coordination is not *Gleichschaltung* in that typed sense, and strong solidarity inside a voluntary thick community with effective exit is not automatically a polity-scale hazard.

The *fascio/fascis* bundle image The name already points toward the population-body side of the morphology. More precisely, Italian *fascio* means a bundle or a group of similar things gathered and often bound together and derives from Latin *fascis*. The related Italian and Latin *fascia* means a band, strip, or binding material rather than the bundle itself. The Roman plural *fasces* named bound rods, commonly surrounding an axe, carried as a badge of magistrate authority. Mussolini's *Fasci di combattimento* and the resulting name *Fascism* drew upon this bundle vocabulary and image.

Culture Mechanics treats the image as a compressed historical precursor, not as a complete definition:

```
plural rods bound together
        ↕
population body held in a common solidarity field
        ↕
bundle represented as one collective force
        ↕
magistrate, chief, party, or other directing function
```

The rods approximate the broadly homogeneous population body. The binding approximates common mythology, beliefs, sentiments, and discipline. The bundle's presentation as one force approximates the projected collective self; its association with magistrate authority places that bundled plurality beside a concentrated directing organ. In the strong morphology, the population body projects and invests its collective self in the leader or directing function, which returns interpretation, direction, and action to the body.

The image does not yet display the complete **dotted-semiconductor** topology. The dots add the distributed trusted-opinion-leader function: embedded members with unequal receiving-field trust and gain who locally translate, reinforce, defend, and return the common field. Nor does the historical emblem by itself establish jealousy, subjecthood absorption, reciprocal resonance, or an operative multi-mind-self. Those relations must still be evidenced.

Whole-polity means the complete sovereignty-bearing or polity-forming community under analysis. It can be a tribe, clan confederation, horde, city, kingdom, empire, revolutionary order, nation-state, or another political formation. A modern state is not required. The directing position can be occupied by a chief, council, priesthood, warrior order, party, monarch, state apparatus, or distributed institutional and mythological complex. The collective-self position can likewise be filled by Nation, *Volk*, class, proletariat, revolutionary people, faith, empire, or another totalized collective subject.

This is a conjunctive classification. Strong solidarity, polity scale, jealousy, subjecthood absorption, and the exclusive collective-incarnation claim must all be evidenced for a specified program, formation, jurisdiction, and period. A cohesive tribe, army, religion, communist movement, or state is not Fascism merely because it exhibits hierarchy, discipline, moral closure, coercion, or one part of the functional morphology.

The definition is nevertheless **cross-doctrinal**. Communist, theocratic, nationalist, racial, imperial, or other self-description neither establishes nor defeats the classification. Once the complete conjunction is evidenced, Culture Mechanics classifies the formation as Fascism; it does not retreat to the formula that the formation is merely "fascistic in morphology but not Fascism" because it belongs to a different conventional ideological family. Historical differences remain relevant to explanation, ancestry, objectives, victims, and institutional operation, but they do not override the functional type.

An avowed **anti-fascist** identity is therefore not negative evidence at the classification gate. The same program cannot exempt itself by controlling the name of the category it may instantiate. Conversely, a hostile third party's accusation of fascism proves nothing; apply the complete morphology symmetrically to the named unit.

The source-qualified warning and its contemporary vocabulary-migration use are developed in Culture Program Ecology's historical-to-active vocabulary crosswalk. That crosswalk retains Bondy's retrospective Silone recollection only as an anti-self-exemption warning and treats *whole-of-society* and related language as diagnostic leads rather than synonyms or proof.

This **classification-symmetry rule** is unconditional with respect to branding: exchange the names, declared ideals, enemies, and historical family, then apply the same morphological, causal, offspring, consequence, and correction tests. Apply the Self-Description Valence Asymmetry: give serious adverse self-attribution first-pass credence, but give beautiful language and benevolent declared ends no exculpatory presumption. They remain evidence about a program's advertised ideal or self-understanding; they are not exemptions from what the installed program recurrently authorizes, selects, and produces. The same rule applies to the project's own preferred programs and proposed remedies.

Bonhoeffer's statement that "the power of the few needs the stupidity of the many" supplies the originating epistemic relation inside the pathological form. The directing function concentrates power and emits classifications, slogans, permissions, and sanctions; distributed trusted carriers translate and amplify them; and population-side loss of inner independence supplies repetition, administration, enforcement, and mass action. Those returned responses make the directing power socially executable and reinforce it. *Culture Mechanics* retains Bonhoeffer's source text and the boundary that *Dummheit* is a socially induced loss of inner independence, not low intelligence or an essential property of "the many." Fascism is not the only setting in which Bonhoefferian *Dummheit* can occur, and ordinary mechanical solidarity does not entail it.

Principal realizations and boundaries

Realization	Characteristic arrangement	Limit
Authority-addressed	One privileged teaching, commanding, priestly, or institutional position addresses a comparatively uniform receiver body.	Can be relatively asymmetric and need not create reciprocal resonance or collective agency.
Chief-incarnation	A person or office receives the collective being's elevated character and directs the formation in its name.	Personal dominance, charisma, or coercion can coexist with the mechanism but does not explain the collective investment by itself.
Distributed-emitter	Several storytellers, rituals, offices, institutions, or media sources jointly generate direction without one indispensable chief.	Decentralization does not prove equality, spontaneity, truth, or absence of coordinated selection.
Politico-familial candidate	Kinship or fictive kinship, common obligation, collective responsibility, and political direction form one organization.	Calling an association a family is insufficient; the relevant authority, obligation, liability, and field relations must be shown.

The morphology does not automatically establish a multi-mind-self presentation, and a presentation does not establish an operative multi-mind-self. Neither mechanical solidarity nor operative collective agency entails total fusion, coercion, falsehood, charismatic leadership, centralized design, or authoritarianism. The same morphology can be more or less corrigible, person-preserving, truthful, centralized, and coercive.

Chief-facing expression: first-officer mediation **First-officer mediation** is the Captain Picard–Commander Riker analogy for a chief-facing expression of the same trusted-opinion-leader function, not another kind of carrier or a separately named function. The directing organ remains above ordinary detail and supplies broad direction, while some carriers interpret and operationalize it, defend the organ against direct criticism, answer at the ordinary human level, and absorb part of the symbolic force of contention. By preventing every critic from pulling the elevated organ into symmetrical personal combat, they can help preserve its purity, dignity, or superhuman presentation.

Carriers can perform this expression in different amounts, and many perform little or none of it. It is not inherently healthy or pathological. A carrier can protect the directing function while also carrying accurate criticism upward and maintaining operational correction. The same shielding activity becomes an epistemic hazard when it makes the organ unanswerable, converts all criticism into disloyalty, hides failure, or allows the biological occupant to appropriate collective authority. *Analogical Models in Culture Mechanics* contains the controlled dotted-semiconductor depiction and Captain Picard–Commander Riker mapping.

Prior-work neighbours: military and corporate The name and complete morphology remain project-developed, but older military and organizational sources independently describe several of its component relations. They are therefore **credibility-supporting neighbours**, not premises upon which the construct depends, a genealogy of the project term, or evidence that every named office actually carries the function.

The **military family** supplies especially clear accounts of downward interpretation, upward sensing, relief from detail, protected counsel, distributed local authority, and publicly maintained command unity:

- William Falconer's "Lieutenant" entry in *An Universal Dictionary of the Marine* (1769) describes the officer next to the captain as executing the captain's orders, supervising conduct, reporting disorder upward, and assuming command during absence. The historical lieutenant is a neighbour, not an exact modern executive officer or a synonym for first-officer mediation.
- Friedrich Wilhelm von Steuben's *Regulations for the Order and Discipline of the Troops of the United States* (1779) distributes related work through officers and non-commissioned officers. The first sergeant receives orders, knows the condition and character of the soldiers, and reports to the captain; the warning against publicly degrading an NCO also shows that local authority can depend upon protected public standing.
- Antoine-Henri Jomini's *The Art of War* (1862 English edition) presents the chief of staff as translating and transmitting the commander's conceptions, supervising detailed execution, procuring information, and requiring close harmony with the commander. This is the strongest older neighbour for the bidirectional chief-facing relation.
- The professional proposal "Naval Reorganization" (1886) places the executive officer at the head of the captain's staff and gives that office immediate charge of shipboard organization and discipline while the captain remains supreme. It is an unusually direct ship-scale neighbour, not proof of a universal naval design rationale.
- James A. Moss's *Officers' Manual* (1906), especially p. 28 instructs officers not to criticize officers or orders before enlisted personnel. It is a source neighbour for the public-unity/private-correction distinction, not proof that first-officer offices were historically created to preserve superhuman elevation or a general licence to suppress criticism.

The **corporate and organizational family** shows why the same function need not belong to one formal title:

- Cyril O'Donnell's "The Role of the Assistant: A Modern Business Enigma" (1960) distinguishes the *assistant-to* from a deputy and from specialized staff. The position helps a chief with work that cannot be handled personally without thereby becoming the chief's line successor.
- Ernest Dale's *Management: Theory and Practice* (1969), drawing on the older general-staff literature, describes an *assistant-to* who handles parts of the chief's coordinating functions and transmits views between the organization and the chief. Dale also allows general, specialized, and personal staff work to be combined in one person, explaining how a personnel head, secretary, vice-president, or other operative office can host the relation.
- Chester Barnard's *The Functions of the Executive* (1938) supplies the broader formal–informal-organization bridge: communication, cohesion, and accepted authority depend partly upon relations that are not exhausted by the organization chart. This is a neighbour for emergence of the function, not its full definition.
- Rensis Likert's *New Patterns of Management* (1961) supplies the *linking-pin* picture of overlapping groups and bidirectional representation. A linking pin can occur anywhere in an organization; first-officer mediation isolates only a possible chief-adjacent expression.
- Rosabeth Moss Kanter's *Men and Women of the Corporation* (1977), especially ch. 4 analyses the boss–secretary relation as a personalized and often patrimonial pocket within bureaucracy, including reflected status, fealty, access to the chief's backstage, maintenance of the chief's public front, and a division of emotional labour. Her critical account is the closest corporate neighbour for symbolic shielding, while also exposing the danger that service to the collective office becomes personal service to its occupant.

These families license a restrained overlap claim: older sources recognize many of the same transmission, interpretation, sensing, buffering, status, and correction problems. They do not supply the complete population-body–carrier–field–directing-organ morphology, establish a multi-mind-self, prove the mechanical-solidarity classification of a company or military formation, or make *assistant-to*, executive officer, chief of staff, secretary, personnel head, linking pin, and first-officer mediation synonyms. A formal office can host none, some, or much of the function; the function can migrate, be divided among several carriers, or emerge outside its expected title.

Privileged authority-addressed realization **Privileged authority-addressed programming topology** is a provisional label for one realization of the broader functional morphology: mechanical solidarity often becomes especially transmissive when a comparatively uniform audience is oriented toward a differentiated and elevated speaker position.

```
comparatively uniform audience
many persons occupying a common receiver role
                         ↑ common attention
                         |
one differentiated position
teacher / officer / priest / leader / authorized institution
```

```
                          ↓ common address
words + narrative + symbols + classifications + expected response
```

The authority can be weak in the coercive sense and still be structurally privileged. A teacher standing before a class need not terrorize the pupils. The room, timetable, common curriculum, assigned roles, right to address everyone, and shared expectation of attention already distinguish one position from the many. Military formations, religious assemblies, political meetings, corporate briefings, and institutional press conferences can reproduce the same broad geometry with very different degrees of coercion and legitimacy.

The authority also need not be a personally known human being. An unknown speaker can occupy the interface of a trusted institution:

```
institution socialized as legitimate trust anchor
                          ↓ authorizes
replaceable officeholder or spokesperson
                          ↓ addresses
population already trained to recognize the office
                          ↓
claim arrives with institutional and field authority
```

The *Volksempfänger* provides a vivid historical illustration of technological replication. The cheap radio did not create German solidarity by itself. It allowed a regime to reproduce the one-speaker/many-listeners relation inside many homes, coordinate attention, and make a distant voice present as the authorized voice of the collective. The apparatus illustrates a topology; it does not prove that broadcasting always persuades or that every mass medium has the same political effect.

The proposed programming state The stronger originating hypothesis is that this geometry can do more than transfer information. Under some conditions it helps place participants in an unusually receptive **programming state** in which attention, affect, identity, common reception, and perceived authority reinforce one another. A message can then activate, reinforce, or—through repetition and experience—alter the mythological lens more effectively than the same propositions presented as an ordinary private claim.

No single established literature already validates that compound state. The proposal synthesizes several partially overlapping mechanisms:

- Sigmund Freud's *Group Psychology and the Analysis of the Ego* (1921) analyzes leader attachment, horizontal identification among followers, and the proximity of group influence to being in love and hypnosis. Freud supplies a historical psychoanalytic neighbor. His explanation through individual libidinal ties and identification does not replace the present emergent-field ontology and is not a complete empirical explanation of it.
- **Narrative transportation**, studied by Melanie C. Green and Timothy C. Brock (2000), combines attentional focus, imagery, and affect and can increase story-consistent belief. Transportation can occur without formal authority and therefore does not establish the topology by itself.
- **Parasocial interaction**, introduced by Donald Horton and R. Richard Wohl (1956), explains how a mediated figure can be experienced in a relation resembling face-to-face intimacy. It helps explain distant presence, not collective field coherence on its own.
- Michael Suk-Young Chwe's *Rational Ritual* (2001) explains how public rituals generate common knowledge: participants know not only the message but that others received it. Common reception supports coordination without proving affective programming.
- Pierre Bourdieu's *Language and Symbolic Power* shows that the efficacy of authorized speech depends upon office, setting, recognition, and social power as well as sentence content. Bourdieu's concept of field is not the electromagnetic analogy proposed here.
- Randall Collins's *Interaction Ritual Chains* (2004) analyzes mutual focus, rhythmic entrainment, shared mood, collective effervescence, group symbols, and emotional energy. It is strongest for interaction rituals and does not by itself establish identical effects in remote mass audiences.

The culture-mechanical synthesis is:

```
recognized authority position
        + common attention and common reception
        + narrative, symbol, rhythm, and affect
        + vertical attachment and/or horizontal identification
        + visible or imagined reactions of fellow members
```

```
                              ↓
heightened receptivity and mutually reinforced classification
                              ↓
activation, reinforcement, or reprogramming of local bigOthers
                              ↓
stronger mechanical-solidarity field
```

This topology is **privileged, not universal**. Horizontal peer exchange, a leaderless crowd, a decentralized network, private reading, direct experience, or many weak transmitters can also create or change solidarity. A formal authority can fail when the audience distrusts the office, uses incompatible lenses, divides its attention, privately rejects the message, or sees that others reject it.

The hypothesis is also truth-neutral at the level of mechanism. A good teacher can use the geometry to transmit accurate, inspectable knowledge; a propagandist can use it to install a false causal story. Common reception can coordinate lifesaving action or suppress a cheap reality check. Evaluation therefore requires at least three separate questions:

1. Does the topology in fact increase receptivity or synchronization here?
2. Does the communicated model track reality and remain corrigible?
3. Does the relation preserve the participant's capacity to inspect, refuse, and later revise it?

The geometry becomes part of a ***Herrschaftsideologie*** when an occupant claims privileged access to a truth or collective interest that ordinary persons allegedly cannot perceive and converts that epistemic asymmetry into excessive governing jurisdiction. Authority position, superior knowledge, and legitimate jurisdiction must therefore be tested separately. A teacher or expert may know more within a bounded task without becoming sovereign over the recipient's purposes, conscience, property, or political standing.

Possible tests should compare the same message across authority and peer positions, private and publicly common reception, narrative and non-narrative forms, synchronized and unsynchronized audiences, and compatible and incompatible prior lenses. Failure to produce differential retention, sentiment, coordination, or deference would weaken the claim that this geometry has a special programming effect.

13. Unitary ownership by the operative multi-mind-self

The originating claim is deliberately stronger than the ordinary phrase **shared ownership**:

> **Successful shared ownership is not psychologically shared among many separate owners. One operative multi-mind-self owns; many *beseelte* persons perceive, care, judge, and act as organs of that unitary owner.**

Here **organs** names functional contribution to collective agency, not subjecthood absorption. A unitary owner can preserve the members' personal judgment, conscience, property, relationships, refusal, and bounded subordinate jurisdictions. The ownership claim therefore does not entail fusion; the person–collective constitution must be assessed independently.

The German adjective ***beseelt*** means animated, ensouled, or inwardly moved. In the present theory it names the condition in which a biological person is animated by the collective perspective strongly enough that the group's object is experienced and treated as **ours** without a private cost-benefit calculation being required on every occasion. The term does not imply possession, the erasure of personal consciousness, or release from individual moral and legal responsibility.

This proposition distinguishes three meanings often collapsed by the phrase *shared ownership*:

Meaning	Question
Legal ownership	Which natural or juridical person holds recognized title, rights, liabilities, and powers?
Organizational group agency	Does a decision procedure allow a group to form coherent judgments and intentions and act upon them?
Culture-mechanical unitary ownership	Does an operative multi-mind-self experience, protect, maintain, and act through an object as one continuing collective self?

Legal title can exist without lived ownership. A company may legally own an asset while employees treat it as nobody's concern. Conversely, people may care for a street, railway, irrigation system, institution, or inherited practice as *ours* even though none holds personal title. Culture-mechanical ownership names the psychological and social organization, not the legal rule.

Private ownership as a protected personal jurisdiction presents a different question from unitary ownership by a collective agent. *Culture Program Ecology* places the proposed **Secure Homestead Rate** beneath *Own* in the Lifted-Order Capacity Dashboard. It asks whether persons acquire and retain effective residential anchors through title, equity, control, infrastructural usability, sustainable carrying costs, and protection against arbitrary dispossession. The proposal neither redefines legal ownership nor implies that all secure personal standing must take the form of homeownership.

The intellectual neighbors clarify but do not establish the proposed mechanism. Otto von Gierke's account of the real unity of human associations and his theory of the **group-person** reject the idea that an organized association is only an aggregate or legal fiction. F. W. Maitland's "Moral Personality and Legal Personality" explores how an organized group can possess moral and legal personality and act through human organs. Christian List and Philip Pettit's *Group Agency* (2011) supplies modern criteria for when organizational procedures support genuine group judgments and intentions. None describes the local bigOther, mechanical-solidarity field, *Beseelung*, or the present unitary-ownership mechanism.

Failure contrasts Two people assigned a joint task do not thereby become one owner. They may divide the work, protect only their own contribution, blame one another, or comply only while supervised. Coordination exists, but no continuing collective perspective organizes perception and care.

Likewise, a shareholder may legally own a fraction of a company while experiencing its property only as an instrument for private return. Distributed title is not evidence that an operative multi-mind-self owns. The strong claim concerns the opposite case: many people act from one socially present *we* even where personal title is absent or practically irrelevant.

Positive illustrations and hypotheses

- The **Subak irrigation and temple system** is retained as an originating reading of successful collective ownership. UNESCO's account of Bali's Subak landscape describes cooperative water management, temples, democratic and egalitarian practice, and a system binding spiritual, human, and natural domains. Water, ritual, coordination, maintenance, and local obligation can therefore be investigated as parts of one continuing social system enacted by many participants. The example illustrates what the theory seeks to explain; UNESCO does not assert a multi-mind ontology, and the collective-agent and ownership thresholds remain independent hypotheses.
- The ***Bahner*** names a proposed historical organizational ethos in which a railway worker could perceive the railway as *our railway* and act for its reliability beyond the immediately measured private task. This is an originating hypothesis about Deutsche Bahn and its predecessors, not an established finding about every employee or period.
- **Clean German cities**, *Kehrwoche*, flower decoration, and care for common space illustrate possible civic ownership: a resident treats a street or shared place as belonging to the collective self rather than as an external surface serviced by someone else. The observation is vivid but not population proof.
- **Careful treatment of another person's property** shows that the relevant owner can be lifted to a second-order moral community. The object remains legally theirs, yet a shared norm makes respect for another member's property part of what *we* protect. This explains care without pretending that legal title has changed.

These cases should not be generalized into the claim that every orderly community or conscientious worker instantiates a multi-mind-self. Alternative explanations include personal virtue, incentives, surveillance, habit, professional identity, reciprocity, and explicit rules. The theory earns explanatory force only where the unitary collective perspective predicts perception, care, memory, sanction, and action better than those alternatives alone.

Threshold and boundary conditions Mechanical solidarity, a distributed bigOther, and a multi-mind-self presentation can exist below the threshold of a collective agent. Evidence for an **operative multi-mind-self** becomes stronger when the system shows several of the following across changing individual carriers:

- a continuing group perspective distinguishing *ours* from merely private or external objects;
- memory preserved in roles, records, ritual, practice, and institutional correction;
- group-level judgment and intention that cannot be identified with one current member's preference;

- coordinated perception, maintenance, defense, and use of the owned object;
- expectations and sanctions that recruit replacements into the same perspective;
- capacity to notice failure, revise action, and preserve continuity through turnover;
- organs authorized to speak and act for the whole without becoming its private owners.

Disorganization, rapid dissolution when one leader exits, pervasive free-riding, incompatible group judgments, inability to learn, or conduct fully predicted by private incentives weakens the collective-agent interpretation. The field is not classified as an operative multi-mind-self merely because the self-presentation or metaphor sounds vivid.

Unitary ownership also does not make the collective morally superior or its objects sacred. A multi-mind-self can own unjustly, neglect outsiders, suppress individual rights, or direct members toward harm. Collective agency increases the need to locate responsibility among the group, its procedures, officeholders, and the biological persons through whom it acts; it does not dissolve responsibility into the field.

14. Master signifiers and the organization of knowledge

In Lacanian terminology, a **master signifier** or **S1** is a privileged signifier that organizes other meanings and identifications. Lacan develops the relation of S1, S2, knowledge, and authority most directly in *Le Séminaire, Livre XVII: L'envers de la psychanalyse* (1969–1970). Terms such as *Nation*, *Justice*, *Science*, *Safety*, *Tradition*, *Freedom*, *Human Rights*, or *Revolution* can perform this function.

In the culture-mechanical translation, a master signifier is a **highly compressed protocol token**. It does not carry the whole mythological lens in its surface form. It indexes and activates an already installed complex of stories, classifications, authorities, identities, sentiments, and expected conduct. As `M` can designate a mathematical mapping and `E` a field, an S1 can coordinate a large meaning structure without restating it. The compression makes coordination efficient while allowing the activated structure to remain tacit and difficult to inspect.

A master signifier, mechanical solidarity, and laser synchronization are related but not identical:

- the **master signifier** is a compressed symbolic operator or mode selector in the shared protocol;
- **laser synchronization** is a dynamic process of alignment;
- **mechanical solidarity** is a form of social cohesion produced through common classifications and sentiments;
- **magnetization** is an alternative picture of durable aligned state, domains, boundaries, and remanence;
- a **multi-mind-self presentation** can exist below collective agency, while the **operative multi-mind-self** is a possible collective agent only above the additional integration and continuity threshold.

An S1 is neither necessary nor sufficient for mechanical solidarity, but it can condense, direct, and reproduce it efficiently. In lifted mechanical solidarity, abstract signifiers are especially powerful because many different first-order lives can be coordinated through the same second-order word.

Institutions often claim custody of a master signifier:

```
"Science", "Justice", "Safety", or "Human Rights"
                          ↓
institution claims authorized interpretation
                          ↓
office or spokesperson applies the classification
                          ↓
body of knowledge and recommended action
                          ↓
citizen belief update
```

The healthy and pathological uses differ:

```
HEALTHY
S1 organizes inquiry → method and evidence remain inspectable

PATHOLOGICAL
S1 terminates inquiry → authorization selects admissible evidence
                      → a required conclusion follows
```

The **master-signifier analysis grid** decompresses the token into sacred referent, bearer, protected principal, unity topology, difference operator, distributive grammar, causal story, interpreter custody, authorization, outlier perfor-

mance, completion, correction, and trajectory. This entry adds an epistemic emphasis: **interpreter custody** becomes especially consequential when the same institution defines the token, certifies its authorized application, selects admissible evidence, and treats disagreement with its interpretation as disagreement with the sacred referent itself.

Interpreter custody does not require a concealed metric. An S1 such as *biodiversity*, *safety*, or *equity* can be joined to terms such as *significant*, *adequate*, or *unacceptable* so that an evaluative classification sounds as though an inspectable assessment has already occurred. The stricter case may contain no stable operational rule at all:

> **There may be no hidden ruler. The language merely imitates the authority of having used a ruler.**

The linguistic inventory calls this **pseudo-metric predication**; *Mythology Construction* distinguishes it from explicit metric custody and from a stable but undisclosed operational criterion. If the token and predicate are accepted as sufficient evidence, interpreter custody can produce a presupposed deficit and authorization without specification. Only the later discovery of a stable internal rule converts the case into tacit criterion custody; case-by-case verdicts remain a more direct discretionary hazard.

A master signifier can also compress a real but much longer scientific and institutional sequence. *Science says*, *unsafe*, *unacceptable loss*, or a similar token may suppress the transitions from observation through metric, model, forecast, harm translation, protected-principal valuation, severity threshold, remedy comparison, and bounded authorization. The **model-to-mandate custody chain** tests each transition separately. A valid measurement or model does not by itself validate the later moral and jurisdictional crossings; conversely, the presence of those crossings does not show that the scientific work is false.

No signifier-free mind or society is possible. The goal is not to eliminate organizing terms but to keep them visible, plural, concretizable, and corrigible. The decisive question is whether the signifier helps formulate an inquiry or decides when inquiry must stop.

15. Persuasion and the reconstruction of mental models

Persuasion is a process for changing belief, evaluation, identity, or action. It is not inherently truth-directed or reality-distorting. Its epistemic status depends on the model toward which it moves a person and whether that model remains open to correction.

One useful analogy proposed by this entry distinguishes two communication styles:

- **State transmission** attempts to copy a finished conclusion into another person through claims, arguments, or instructions.
- **Operation transmission** helps the other person reconstruct the path through recalled experiences, questions, comparisons, predictions, and self-generated inferences.

This analogy resembles the difference between copying a state and reproducing the operations that generated it. It is an interpretation inspired by the American writer **David McRaney's** *How Minds Change* (2022), not McRaney's own terminology.

Operation-bootstrapped codebook formation

> **Operation-bootstrapped codebook formation** is the process by which recurrent operation transmission–shared experience, example, questioning, contrast, prediction, practice, and correction–enables persons to construct locally executable and sufficiently compatible reconstruction codebooks. Once enough relevant overlap exists, short symbols and formulas can evoke much larger conceptual, causal, social, moral, authorization, and action structures without replaying the complete formation path in every message.

Operation transmission does not literally copy a mental operation. It supplies representations, situations, questions, comparisons, feedback, and other assembly cues through which the recipient performs relevant operations locally. State transmission likewise means communication of a conclusion, formula, rule, or other finished result rather than transfer of the sender's mental state.

The **reconstruction codebook** is distributed analytical shorthand, not a third processor. Ordinary cognition reconstructs concepts, causal relations, and practical sequences; the installed mythological lens supplies culturally learned mappings; the local bigOther executes evaluative and affective classification; and the shared symbolic protocol supplies publicly legible tokens. The codebook therefore names the recipient-side resources upon which reconstruction draws, not one additional mental object or perfectly shared dictionary.

Durkheim supplies an important source neighbour for this distributed formation claim. In "The Dualism of Human Nature and Its Social Conditions" he treats vocabulary and grammar as products of collective elaboration, concepts as common representations through which minds communicate, and theoretical and practical rational activity as dependent upon social causes. He also says that collective religious, moral, and intellectual conceptions become durably organized and personally inflected in individual consciousness while collective life continues to renew them. This is compatible with locally reconstructed codebooks and field back-action, but it does not supply the present mechanism. Culture Mechanics distinguishes the public symbolic resources, the rider/main CPU that reconstructs and reasons through them, and the local bigOther that classifies their culturally relevant objects and uses; Durkheim's broader social pole contains all three relations rather than mapping to the collar alone.

```
new recipient or generation
+ inherited texts, symbols, practices, and institutions
                          ↓
operation-rich formation:
experience + example + questions + contrasts + practice + correction
                          ↓
locally reconstructed conceptual, causal, evaluative, and practical codebooks
                          ↓
sufficient relevant overlap among participants
                          ↓
compressed state transmission:
short token or formula → larger locally reconstructed model and conduct
                          ↓
renewed practice + decompression + correction + foundational-question custody
                          ⟲
```

The ordered complementarity in this sequence is the **operation-first decoder-bootstrap principle**:

> **Cultural states can be transmitted compactly, but their competent reception depends upon prior operation-rich work that constructs the recipient's local decompression capacity.**

In compact form, operation transmission builds the decoder, state transmission exploits it, and periodic operation transmission repairs it. This principle does not make state transmission inferior. It specifies the operation-rich formation that must precede or accompany state-heavy teaching if a recipient is to recover the question, grounds, application, limits, and correction path rather than only repeat the inherited result.

Bernard Lonergan supplies a direct cognitive and educational predecessor to this positive account. His dissatisfaction with instruction centred on already formulated concepts, propositions, syllogisms, and authoritative answers led him back toward the operations through which a learner comes to understand:

```
experience → question → insight → conceptual formulation
           → reflective judgment → knowledge
```

In the present translation, a teacher can transmit the terminal proposition while failing to cultivate the locally executable operations that make it understood. Giovanni Sala's account of Lonergan's development supports the concept–operation distinction. The operation-first principle and computing analogies remain Culture Mechanics developments, not Lonergan's terms.

Lonergan did not appear to enter this problem through one Bonhoeffer-like public encounter with collective *Dummheit*. He entered from the positive question of what occurs when someone understands, after dissatisfaction with a neo-scholastic educational culture rich in finished concepts, propositions, syllogisms, and authoritative answers but comparatively weak in inquiry and the act of insight. The stock-market crash, Great Depression, rise of fascism, and his concern that inherited Catholic, economic, and political thought was failing to appropriate modern science, history, and social decline formed a wider historical pressure rather than one demonstrated biographical cause. Gerard Whelan's intellectual-biographical account supplies this historical bridge. The later inverse question–how interests and affects prevent available operations of insight–then leads toward dramatic and group bias.

This sequence supplies the dynamic bridge among Sowell's recurrent generational formation, Voegelin's living-symbol, dead-formula, and idolized-answer distinction, and the controlled state/operation-replication and adaptive-dictionary compression analogies. Sowell supplies the claim that finished cultural character is not inherited; Voegelin supplies the experience–symbol and question relation. The CRDT and LZMA families supply bounded computing images. **The compound mechanism is a Culture Mechanics synthesis and should not be retroactively attributed to**

any one source.

The bridge also exposes two complementary failures in the experience–symbol interface:

Failure direction	What remains	What becomes unavailable
Opaque or dead inherited symbol	Prestigious vocabulary, doctrine, or public token	Reconstruction from the symbol back toward its engendering experience, originating question, and operational recognition
Capped or prohibited rival symbol	Perception, anomaly, affect, or practical contradiction	Articulation from present experience toward an admissible concept, name, comparison, and public formulation

A culture can suffer both failures at once: inherited moral formulas no longer disclose present reality, while rival symbols capable of articulating it are classified as forbidden. The first damages recognition from symbol toward experience; the second damages articulation from experience toward symbol. This bidirectional failure is a Culture Mechanics relation between Voegelin's symbol account and collar-conditioned access, not a definition attributed to Voegelin.

A generation can inherit compressed symbols and institutional artifacts, but it does not inherit a finished, locally executable decompression capacity. Recurrent formation must reconstruct enough of the relevant operation path for the symbols to remain intelligible, applicable to novel cases, and corrigible. State transmission is not thereby inferior: after successful formation it provides the compression dividend that makes education, expertise, law, coordination, and cultural memory tractable. Periodic operation transmission remains necessary for repair, semantic recalibration, transfer to new circumstances, and initiation of new participants.

Operational inhabitation and scaffolded participation Institutional inheritance can support correct routine conduct without giving every participant an independently reconstructible and transferable grasp of the generator that makes the conduct intelligible. Three configurations must therefore remain distinct:

Configuration	What the participant can do	Characteristic dependency
Independently reconstructing participation	Recover reasons and limits, judge novel cases, criticize an application, and help teach or repair the operation	Still depends upon language, predecessors, institutions, and correction, but not upon one custodian for every new application
Institutionally scaffolded participation	Perform reliably through fitted roles, examples, records, interfaces, supervision, and appeal	Novel transfer or repair may depend upon a smaller interpretive and formative ecology
First-order participation relative to the lifted generator	Enact, understand, or defend a concrete inherited answer inside familiar cases, possibly with rich local competence	The higher-order rule's generating question, reciprocal scope, defeat conditions, or cross-context transfer may remain unavailable

These are operation-relative configurations, not permanent ranks of persons. One participant can independently reconstruct a legal procedure, remain scaffolded in scientific practice, and follow a first-order family or religious rule without reconstructing the relevant lifted generator. Nor is scaffolded participation defective by definition. Distributed specialization, apprenticeship, trusted expertise, and dependable procedure make complex orders possible.

The distinction becomes critical when routine success is mistaken for self-renewing cultural competence:

```
inherited symbols + roles + systemic skeleton
→ reliable performance under familiar conditions
→ apparent population-wide possession of the generator

but
```

```
novel collision + loss of interpreters + failed formation or succession
→ difference between reconstruction, scaffolding, and script becomes visible
```

The systemic skeleton and living cultural body can carry extensive cultural work, and affective-to-structural load transfer can reduce the fresh affective demand placed upon each participant. The same scaffolding can therefore either renew a widely distributed operation or conceal its concentration in a fragile carrier bottleneck. Evidence must examine novel application, explanation, correction, teaching, bridge maintenance, repair, and succession rather than infer either vitality or hollowness from quiet routine alone.

The same relation explains several master-signifier outcomes:

```
compressed token + sufficiently aligned relevant codebooks
→ efficient coordination

underdetermined token + heterogeneous compatible projection
→ projective consensus

compressed token + exclusive interpreter custody
→ custodian supplies executable meaning

compressed token + prohibition of the generating experience or question
→ idolized answer-symbol
```

Reconstruction reach names the size of the learned complex a token can reliably activate for a specified recipient and context. A symbol can therefore be "large" because it reconstructs an extensive practical, causal, moral, institutional, identity, or action package rather than because it is merely more abstract. Reconstruction reach is audience-relative and does not establish that different recipients reconstruct the same complex.

The size of a person's vocabulary or stored knowledge is therefore not the decisive variable. Compression efficiency depends upon **relevant codebook overlap, reconstruction fidelity, contextual alignment, reality contact, and corrigibility**. A larger but divergent or authority-sealed codebook can increase misunderstanding, projective consensus, or manipulation. Compression gain does not establish truth, common understanding, legitimate authorization, or moral value.

Formation is also social rather than merely dyadic. Families, schools, professions, rituals, media, institutions, trusted authorities, and material practices repeatedly select and reinforce some decompressions; visible use and field back-action make those mappings easier to anticipate and coordinate. This collective calibration does not make local codebooks identical or reduce the mechanism to isolated learning.

Gergely Csibra and György Gergely's **natural pedagogy** supplies an earlier developmental bridge. Their proposal treats ostensive signals as indicating that communication is addressed to the learner and biases infants toward expecting referential, kind-relevant, and generalizable information, including culturally opaque knowledge that unaided observation would not readily disclose. In the present architecture, this resembles metadata on an operation–`addressed to you`, `learn this`, `generalize this`–and helps explain how social learning can begin before full language. It does not show that the transmitted content is true, that the learner passively copies it, or that every ostensive interaction installs a Culture Program or local-bigOther classification.

Nicolas Claidière and Dan Sperber's cultural-attraction account supplies the population-level complement. Cultural acquisition is normally constructive rather than exact copying: recipients use transmitted material, background knowledge, inference, interests, and environmental affordances to produce their own variants. Population stability can nevertheless arise when these transformations tend probabilistically toward recurrent attractors, while conformity- and prestige-biased transmission supply distinguishable distribution-based effects. This is a closer scientific neighbour than a literal CRDT for explaining how nonidentical local reconstructions can sustain a recognizable shared pattern. It does not make an attractor a bigOther, master signifier, programme, or truth criterion, and it does not establish one identical mental state or deterministic convergence across a population.

Three neighbouring literatures clarify different pieces of this distributed result. Edwin Hutchins's distributed cognition locates cognitive work across persons, artifacts, representations, and information flows. Wegner and colleagues' transactive-memory account distinguishes shared knowledge from a group directory of who is likely to know what. Michael Chwe's common-knowledge account distinguishes parallel private knowledge from mutually recognized availability for coordination. They support distributed addressing and coordination without making the Culture Mechanics codebook, distributed bigOther, or multi-mind-self synonyms for any one source model.

The mechanism predicts that operation-rich common formation should improve convergence of explicit reconstructions, transfer to novel cases, and recovery of reasons and limits relative to token-only instruction. It predicts divergence where participants share a surface symbol but lack the relevant formation history, and repair where renewed examples, questions, practice, and correction restore overlap. Failure of these contrasts across well-specified messages, audiences, and delayed tests would weaken the proposed mechanism.

Domain contact, conceptual formation, and symbolic addressing **Domain contact** is engagement that requires a learner to perform, observe, or mentally replay relevant operations and exposes the resulting interpretation or action to examples, resistance, consequences, counterexamples, and correction. It may be direct, as in experiment, apprenticeship, construction, or responsible work, or mediated through a sufficiently concrete demonstration, case, simulation, worked derivation, or experimental report. Domain contact is not only collision with error. Repeated successful action under varied conditions can disclose an affordance, stable relation, or usable capability, while resistance and failure can expose where the operative model breaks. Success is positive evidence within the tested range, not an automatic proof of complete understanding, truth, legitimacy, or beneficial direction: selection effects, temporary luck, protected conditions, external support, and displaced costs remain possible. Mere proximity, repeated exposure, verbal rehearsal, or membership does not by itself supply domain contact in this sense.

This extends operation-bootstrapped codebook formation into a generic model of learning and human communication:

```
initial symbols, rules, formulas, or apparently obvious maxims
                          ↓
operation-rich domain contact:
experience + replay + action + resistance + consequence + correction
                          ↓
locally formed conceptual distinctions, practical discriminations, and know-how
                          ↓
language names, differentiates, reorganizes, and stabilizes public addresses
                          ↓
finite utterance serializes selected relations and operation cues
                          ↓
recipient reconstructs locally, applies, predicts, and is corrected
                          ↻
```

Conceptual and practical discrimination can therefore precede a stable verbal label. A book may sometimes give a reader words for a partly formed conceptual space, making previously difficult-to-address relations selectable, serializable, and communicable. It can also genuinely extend that space by supplying new distinctions, examples, comparisons, derivations, and operations. The claim is consequently not that all concepts are prelinguistic or that language merely labels a finished inner structure. Language can name prior distinctions, participate in constructing new ones, and change the structure that an attempted description was meant to express.

A new word does not automatically index every relevant earlier experience. Its address becomes operational through reactivation, explicit joining across examples, comparison in more than one context, repeated use, and correction. This is why vocabulary can initiate reindexing without completing it and why mere repetition of the newly supplied label is not evidence of understanding.

Michael Tomasello's shared-intentionality account, encountered in the source conversation through Haidt's presentation, supplies a bounded predecessor for the social precondition: participants require enough joint attention to an object, activity, or goal before a conventional symbol can coordinate them around it. Language can enlarge, differentiate, and reorganize that overlap, but does not manufacture every shared orientation from nothing. Culture Mechanics adds the reconstruction-codebook, collar-classification, and distributed-field relations rather than attributing them to Tomasello or Haidt.

Franz Josef Radermacher's "Cognition in Systems" and later FAW four-level architecture supply a neighbouring systems model. The mature presentation distinguishes physical signal–environment fit, neural or subsymbolic sensorimotor and holistic processing, symbolic language and classification, and externally supported mathematical or scientific models. Its most relevant relation here is the interaction between subsymbolic pattern recognition and symbolic processing: symbols reduce description complexity and enable new composition while remaining materially realized through lower-level processes.

The 1996 proposal also uses nested time scales, an intuitive coupling between subsymbolic and symbolic processing, and a tentative linear abstract control channel inside a massively parallel architecture. Radermacher later describes

the human relation as *Bauch* and *Kopf*, and as conscious and unconscious processes competing in action production. These are functional processing distinctions, not two anatomically separate organs or a direct identification with the elephant and rider.

Radermacher presented the 1996 architecture for future autonomous systems, not as an experimentally established "mathematical psychology." It does not map directly onto elephant, rider, local bigOther, or collar-conditioned access. It supplies an independent comparison for distinguishing neural or subsymbolic competence from symbolic address, explicit relation, and complex model construction without making those processing modes separate anatomical minds.

A common learning trajectory is:

```
confusion
→ surface habituation
→ operation-rich practice and correction
→ operational understanding
```

This is a revisable trajectory rather than a universal stage law. **Surface habituation is not understanding:** the learner may cease resisting an unfamiliar symbolic environment and mistake reduced discomfort or fluent repetition for successful reconstruction. Operational understanding is better tested through transfer to new cases, prediction, recovery of reasons and limits, competent use, recognition of counterexamples, and revision after error.

Advanced mathematics supplies a clean illustration. At first the notation can be syntactically visible while remaining semantically almost empty; habituation may make the unfamiliar symbolic environment tolerable, but proofs, examples, counterexamples, derivations, and applications are what gradually make its symbols operationally decompressible and usable.

This trajectory has a bounded family resemblance to Stuart and Hubert Dreyfus's five-stage model of skill acquisition, in which instruction and concrete experience progressively displace detached rule use with increasingly situated discrimination and performance. The models are not identical: the Dreyfus stages do not supply the present surface-habituation distinction, communication mechanism, or codebook account.

The project-management/PMP sequence supplies a bounded illustration. Before a person has borne responsibility for dependencies, deadlines, stakeholder conflict, uncertainty, handoffs, and failure, formal guidance can look like a collection of *Binsenweisheiten*. Responsible project work constructs a preliminary practical codebook; later instruction can name, differentiate, reorganize, and correct relations that the work has made available. The apparent sequence "first perform, then formally learn" is therefore not reversed: contact makes the compressed formal body more richly decompressible.

The child's sandpit and the physicist's apparatus supply a pedagogical image of the same operation-first relation. Both permit intervention, variation, resistance, surprise, and the gradual formation of a feel for what the material will do; scientific apparatus makes that play controlled, measurable, mathematically articulable, and answerable to explicit prediction. The image does not make experiment childish or replace formal scientific method.

The electron supplies a second illustration. "An electron is an electron is an electron" is a useful pedagogical refusal to mistake the compressed phrase *wave–particle duality* for the operational concept itself. The concept is formed through the family of experiments, mathematical operations, predictions, regularities, and failed classical expectations to which the phrase routes. Reading can provide mediated contact when the reader mentally re-enacts those operations rather than retaining only their verbal result. In the terms of *Epistemic Constitution*, *wave–particle duality* remains a living compressed symbol while it preserves a route back to the experiments and questions that generated it; rote repetition without that route is a dead formula, not automatically an idolized answer-symbol.

> **Contact builds the concept; language names it; mathematics disciplines it; prediction lets reality correct it.**

Living knowledge as reconstructible capability

> **Living knowledge** is inherited or communicated symbolic state joined to enough locally reconstructed experience, question, causal structure, practical competence, and correction capacity that a recipient can recognize its object, apply it to a new case, explain its limits, and revise it when reality answers differently.

Living knowledge is therefore more than retained information, fluent vocabulary, or correct repetition. Its compression remains connected to a practicable reconstruction route:

```
symbol or formula
+ generating question, examples, operations, contrasts, and consequences
+ application, prediction, correction, and repair
→ reconstructible and corrigible capability
```

This need not require every recipient to rediscover a result from zero. Division of cognitive labour, books, teachers, archives, and settled formulas are indispensable, but they keep knowledge living only when later recipients retain enough access to reactivate, use, test, and repair what those compressed states mean. *Epistemic Constitution* owns the further distinction among living symbols, dead formulas, and idolized answer-symbols and the institutional requirement of foundational-question custody.

The controlled graph-to-sequence serialization analogy develops the communication picture without claiming that a mind is literally an object graph, language is XML, or a recipient is a deterministic parser.

Joint codebook formation and practice-formed coordination capacity

> **Joint codebook formation** is recurrent, socially interpreted, consequence-bearing joint activity through which participants act upon a domain while co-forming the conceptual, causal, evaluative, role, and action codebooks through which they later perceive, communicate, judge, and coordinate.

Joint codebook formation is a socially recursive subtype of domain contact. It does not merely apply an already complete theory: action changes the situation, the changed situation supplies experience and consequences, participants interpret those consequences together, and the resulting codebooks shape later action. Scientific collaboration, apprenticeship, project work, institution-building, local government, mutual assistance, religious practice, and political struggle can all instantiate parts of the mechanism without becoming equivalent in purpose or epistemic quality.

```
recurrent consequential joint practice
→ common situations, operations, resistance, consequences, and correction
→ locally reconstructed conceptual, evaluative, role, and action codebooks
→ sufficient relevant overlap and mutual prediction
→ compressed half-sentences, gestures, stories, formulas, and dispatch symbols
→ situated scripts, differentiated roles, interfaces, and handoffs
→ practice-formed coordination capacity
→ clockwork coordination when activated through fitted roles and interfaces
→ emergent collective capacity and field back-action
→ further practice calibrates, repairs, or closes the codebooks
```

The social result remains emergent rather than a sum of independently completed individual learning. Joint practice makes other participants' decompressions and likely actions observable; institutions, success, failure, honour, sanction, and apparent consensus feed those mappings back into later local reconstruction. The resulting codebooks need only overlap sufficiently for the task and are never one literally shared mental dictionary. High overlap and efficient coordination establish neither fusion nor an operative multi-mind-self.

The resulting **practice-formed coordination capacity** is the ability to use that overlap for compressed communication, mutual prediction, situated judgment, differentiated roles, interfaces, handoffs, and repair. Joint codebook formation can consequently produce genuine practical and perceptual advantage over detached verbal familiarity without certifying the resulting interpretation as true:

```
practice + independently legible consequences + open correction
→ reality-coupled codebook formation and corrigible competence

practice + doctrinally preclassified experience + protected interpretation
→ programme-sealed codebook formation and possible self-confirmation
```

Kenneth Minogue's critical account of ideological praxis supplies an important source case: struggle is claimed to disclose historical movement while educating the struggler. *Mythology Construction* owns that attribution and its circularity critique. The domain-contact, codebook, and coordination mechanism stated here is a Culture Mechanics generalization, not Minogue's vocabulary and not a concession that participation confers privileged truth.

The narrower Culture Program construct that combines such formation with an intergenerational bundle, institutional reproduction, succession, and latent mobilization is **intergenerational mobilizational praxis**. The legacy

`formative-praxis-and-codebook-coordination` anchor is retained only for compatibility with references written before this terminology migration.

Collective epistemic formation and the distributed epistemic milieu **Collective epistemic formation** is the process through which participation in a social and material environment forms and revises the locally executable concepts, distinctions, query paths, methods, inferential habits, and evidential standards through which a person comes to know.

The **distributed epistemic milieu** is the corresponding environment of language, stories, examples, practices, artifacts, records, instruments, institutions, trained persons, and correction procedures through which those resources remain available and acquire practical force across participants and generations. It is not one collective mind-state or a container from which cognition is downloaded. Each rider or main CPU reconstructs and uses a locally formed codebook or epistemic grammar through ordinary cognition.

The distinction extends the homo-duplex account from one to two interacting modes of collective formation and back-action:

Mode	Collective contribution	Person-side execution	Characteristic effect
Affective–evaluative actuation	Mythologies, symbolic authority, expectations, sanctions, and field back-action train and activate culturally consequential classifications.	The local bigOther applies the installed mythological lens; elephant-side affect, attention, motivation, and action readiness change; the rider encounters the changed orientation.	An object, thought, or act feels honourable, shameful, sacred, contaminating, attractive, dangerous, obligatory, or forbidden.
Collective epistemic formation	The distributed epistemic milieu supplies language, distinctions, examples, methods, artifacts, records, instruments, and correction practices.	The rider or main CPU reconstructs and uses concepts, retrieves and joins observations, poses questions, compares, infers, predicts, articulates, and revises.	Some objects and relations become intelligible, nameable, retrievable, comparable, evidentially relevant, or methodologically tractable.

"Hot" and "cold" are compact contrasts between the characteristic operations, not names for two additional mental processors and not a claim that epistemic formation has no affective cause. Within the local architecture, **only the local bigOther is the distinct second processor or cultural co-processor**. The distributed epistemic milieu is not a processor, detached cognitive agent, collective brain, or second bigOther, and the reconstruction codebook remains analytical shorthand for resources used by the main CPU.

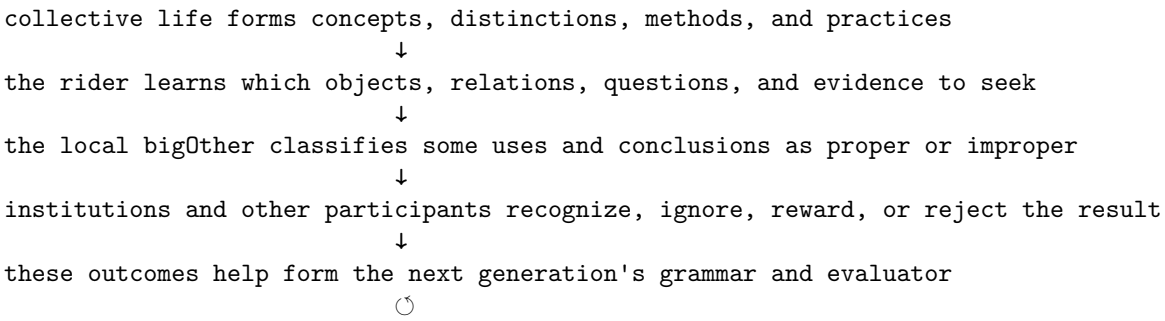
The two modes interact through collar-conditioned semantic access. The local bigOther can classify an approaching object, question, source, comparison, possible conclusion, or public use as honourable, dangerous, loyal, contaminating, or forbidden. That primitive evaluative signal can make main-CPU retrieval, joining, comparison, segmentation, binding, explanation, or articulation easier, costly, or unavailable without the collar performing any of those operations itself.

```
distributed epistemic milieu
→ operation-rich formation and public symbolic addressing
→ rider/main CPU reconstructs concepts, methods, and query paths
→ rider/main CPU notices, retrieves, joins, compares, infers, and articulates

                                ↕ loose functional coupling

local bigOther classifies an object, question, source, relation,
possible conclusion, or public use
→ permission, honour, shame, danger, pollution, loyalty, or taboo signal
→ main-CPU operations remain available, become costly, or stop
```

The same relation can recur across generations and act back through the field:



This cycle is emergent and reciprocal without making every institutional result the expression of one collective agent. Persons reconstruct and act locally; their outputs replenish, modify, fragment, or challenge both the distributed epistemic milieu and the separately defined symbolic–affective field.

At least three obstructions must remain distinct:

1. **Conceptual unavailability:** the rider has not acquired the distinction or operation needed to formulate the question.
2. **Evaluative inhibition:** the distinction is available, but local-bigOther classification makes retrieving, sustaining, applying, or publicly using it feel shameful, dangerous, disloyal, or otherwise impermissible.
3. **Collective non-recognition:** the person formulates the result, but the surrounding institution or thought community does not receive it as relevant evidence or an admissible claim.

Calling all three *emotional bias* erases their different causal locations and therefore obscures what would have to change. The retrospective, prospective, present-articulation, and public-address sites remain governed by the more detailed collar-conditioned-access taxonomy rather than becoming new modules here.

The constitutional question produced by this formation process is developed as the **me–we–world correction relation**: removing private advantage can reveal a shared conceptual frame without yet showing that the frame answers to the world. The controlled **epistemic cloud and all-seeing-eye picture** separates this impersonal distributed milieu from the agentified second-person experience of bigOther-as-Thou.

Bouglé, Fleck, and the learned grammar of inquiry Célestin Bouglé's 1896 chapter on Lazarus and *Völkerpsychologie* supplies a direct predecessor for the distributed-carrier and shared-grammar claims. He locates a public spirit in persons and in durable things–including trained bodies, tools, schools, buildings, poems, and codes–rather than in a separate substantial group mind. He further distinguishes transmission of a stock of ideas from transmission of general forms and methods through which one person's or generation's thinking can continue in another. The present distributed-milieu, processor, field, and collective-agent distinctions remain Culture Mechanics developments rather than Bouglé's terms.

Ludwik Fleck's *Genesis and Development of a Scientific Fact* and "To Look, To See, To Know" make the learned grammar more operational. A *Denkstil* trains directed perception, assimilation, problem construction, method, and the reception of results through apprenticeship, instruments, diagrams, terminology, examples, and exchange within a thought collective. Fleck therefore supplies a source account in which collective formation reaches ways of seeing and investigating rather than only a stock of propositions. He does not supply the local bigOther, distributed epistemic milieu, or me–we–world diagnostic as defined here.

Durkheim's wider socially formed intellectual–moral pole, Bouglé's shared grammar, and Fleck's executable thought style illuminate different reaches of the same research problem. They do not establish that a socially transmitted method is true, that every participant reconstructs it identically, or that one whole culture possesses a unitary mind.

Impartiality is therefore not thought from nowhere. It can be a genuinely cultivated discipline through which participants learn to set aside private preference, apply shared methods, expose claims to criticism, and accept corrections that carry personal cost. Its achievement is real without being final: the inherited problem space, perceptual training, instruments, standards, and source hierarchy remain products of a thought style and must themselves stay available for comparison and reality-mediated correction. The same procedural impersonality can otherwise make a local grammar feel simply identical with reason.

Scientific ethos: hot support for cold inquiry Fleck's scientific mood and ethos expose a necessary interaction between the two modes:

Cold epistemic operations require a hot commitment to norms that may defeat the knower's immediate interests and preferred conclusions.

This is not affect treated as evidence. It is affect helping to sustain epistemic discipline where surveillance, formal rules, and conscious calculation are insufficient. A working scientific ethos can train the local bigOther to make fabrication, falsification, concealment, and result-driven distortion feel dishonourable, while accurate observation, honest uncertainty, replication, correction, and acknowledgement of error remain honourable even when they carry personal cost. The collar does not perform the analysis or determine truth; it can support the rider's answerability to the world by making violations of truth-seeking practice immediately and pre-reflectively costly.

```
scientific mythology, exemplars, apprenticeship, and role expectations
→ affectively animated scientific ethos
→ shame at fabrication and honour in truthfulness and correction
→ self-restraint where direct supervision is absent
→ more reliable observation, inference, record, criticism, and revision
→ replenishment of an open distributed epistemic milieu
```

The proper object of this hot attachment is not a particular theory, approved result, institution, faction, or scientific authority. It is the higher-order commitment to reality-answerability and corrigibility, including willingness to expose one's own work and collective to adverse evidence. In this bounded form, hot formation supplies part of the motivational infrastructure that makes cold inquiry sustainable.

The same coupling has a pathological inverse. If honour and shame attach to defending an approved answer, protecting an institution, or displaying group membership, the local bigOther impedes rather than sustains inquiry. The contrast is therefore **affect in service of corrigible world-contact versus affect in service of answer protection**, not affect versus reason.

Schools, universities, professions, and research institutions can consequently retain scientific vocabulary, techniques, credentials, laboratories, publication procedures, and metrics while losing enough living ethos that those resources cease to be reliably reality-answerable. The scientific skeleton then remains while the living scientific culture weakens, and cold analytical capacities can be recruited for selective reporting, rationalization, concealment, or technically sophisticated fraud.

This is a testable candidate mechanism for a scientific-fraud or replication crisis, not a prevalence finding or complete causal attribution. Relevant comparisons include moral formation, mentoring, reactions to null and adverse results, treatment of replication and correction, whistleblower standing, incentives, audit quality, opportunity, and conduct when truthfulness is personally costly and external observation is weak.

Operative authorship, cognitive stance, and communication channel The I-mode–We-mode distinction adds an operative-relationship layer to epistemic agency. It must not be collapsed into either immediate-versus-representational cognition or propositional-versus-embodied communication. The resulting model keeps three axes independent:

```
operative authorship or standpoint: I ↔ We
cognitive stance:                   EDA ↔ DCL
communication channel:              propositional ↔ embodied/paralinguistic
```

Engaged direct awareness and disengaged conscious languaging The development discussion uses **engaged direct awareness (EDA)** for immediate involvement in a present situation through perception, feeling, response, and action, and **disengaged conscious languaging (DCL)** for the capacity to leave the immediate situation and operate through words and representations of absent objects, remembered persons, possible futures, and counterfactuals.

The labels were prompted by Elliott Jaques's *The Life and Behavior of Living Organisms: A General Theory*. The publisher's description and contents confirm the book's larger concern with awareness, signalling, language, the sensible world, and the language-suffused human world, but the exact EDA/DCL wording and the present cross-axis interpretation still require primary-text verification. The following matrix is therefore a Culture Mechanics construction rather than a claim that Jaques supplied it:

Cognitive stance	I-mode	We-mode
EDA	Embodied love, face-to-face care, spontaneous rescue, and personal conflict	Ritual, drill, collective effervescence, crowd action, immediate role performance, and coordinated work
DCL	Conscience, remembrance, imaginative perspective-taking, reconstructing consequences for an absent person, and private planning	Law, science, doctrine, administration, policy, strategic planning, and ideological reasoning

EDA does not guarantee compassion: immediate participation can include revenge, panic, domination, or mob violence. DCL does not guarantee coldness: it can bring an absent person into moral presence, expose a euphemism, reconstruct a consequence, or criticize the group. The desk-perpetrator configuration is therefore not "DCL causes evil" but the more specific possibility of **DCL operating under captured We-mode** while institutional roles turn distant representations into bodily consequences.

Repersonalization can occur through renewed EDA–I encounter or through DCL–I reconstruction of the affected person's experience and claim. A programme becomes especially dangerous when it blocks both direct contact and the private linguistic space in which a carrier could reconstruct that claim.

Propositional language and be-humming The communication axis separates **propositional content** from **embodied, paralinguistic, and interactional social signalling**. The originating term **be-humming** names the second channel; **Gorilla** remains an informal image rather than a technical synonym. Be-humming includes rhythm, prosody, emphasis, pauses, vocal mirroring, turn-taking, engagement, posture, gaze, movement, and interpersonal timing.

The propositional channel states facts, reasons, offers, rules, and commitments. Be-humming can regulate attention, arousal, confidence, affiliation, trust, status, safety, lead–follow relations, and readiness for coordinated action.

> **Propositional language represents a relation; be-humming helps enact it.**

The embodied channel can support I–You attunement through soothing, tenderness, and mutual timing, or collective synchronization through chanting, marching, ritual, drill, and shared tempo. It is not intrinsically sincere, deceptive, personal, or collective. DCL can choreograph it deliberately, and EDA can carry meaningful propositions.

The project retains no universal numerical split such as "80 percent body language and 20 percent argument." The Pentland source boundary supports the scoped importance and measurability of nonlinguistic signals, not a universal causal percentage for negotiation or communication. A plausible bidirectional sequence is:

```
embodied signalling
→ changed trust, threat, rank, belonging, or coordination readiness
→ changed reception of the same propositions
→ explicit interpretation or press-secretary reasons

while

reasons, commitments, and explicit judgments
→ changed embodied interaction and signalling
```

Arguments are therefore not causally irrelevant, and social signals are not a hidden dictionary that automatically reveals truth or intention. The three-axis model permits combinations that a single warm/cold or individual/collective scale would erase.

Audience-modelled reconstruction and decompression Dushan Wegner's *Relevante Strukturen* (2019; ISBN 9783739405636) describes language as *Komprimierung* for later *Dekomprimierung*. A finite utterance omits most features of the world and uses symbols that the recipient is expected to expand from representations already available in memory. Wegner also emphasizes that effective writers and speakers anticipate how their words will unfold in the recipient and how much decompression that recipient can perform.

Culture Mechanics adopts this source perspective as the cross-cutting **audience-modelled reconstruction** model:

> **Audience-modelled reconstruction** is the selection and arrangement of facts, omissions, symbols, sequence, presuppositions, and cues in light of an anticipated recipient model, so that the recipient

predictably reconstructs a larger factual, causal, social, moral, and authorization model from the finite message.

```
communicator's represented event or world model
                          ↓
model of the anticipated recipient:
stored concepts + mythologies + authorities + sentiments + knowledge
                          ↓
selection of facts, omissions, sequence, symbols, and cues
                          ↓
finite message
                          ↓
recipient's main CPU + installed mythological lens + context
                          ↓
reconstructed factual, causal, moral, and authorization model
```

The message does not carry the reconstructed model in full. It supplies selected material and assembly cues. The same surface message can therefore produce different reconstructions in audiences with different knowledge, mythologies, trusted authorities, or symbolic codebooks.

Compression is unavoidable and is not inherently manipulative. Expertise, teaching, ordinary conversation, law, and coordination all depend upon selective description and shared symbols. The epistemically dangerous subtype is **adversarial audience-modelled reconstruction**:

> communication designed or organized so that the anticipated recipient predictably reconstructs a materially misleading model while the surface formulation retains literal, semantic, or rhetorical defensibility.

Misleading reception alone does not prove adversarial intent. The inference grows stronger when decisive omissions recur asymmetrically, the communicator can predict the recipient's inference, different audiences receive strategically different compression, correction is resisted, or literal deniability is used to preserve the same misleading reconstruction.

The corresponding **decompression audit** asks:

Audit field	Question
Surface message	What was explicitly said, shown, or omitted?
Omitted structures and effects	Which actors, relations, costs, alternatives, uncertainties, or time horizons disappeared?
Assumed recipient	Which knowledge, mythologies, authorities, symbols, and sentiments were expected to be available?
Activated codebook	Which terms, images, roles, or master signifiers supplied preloaded meaning?
Predictable reconstruction	What complete factual, causal, moral, and authorization model was a competent intended recipient likely to build?
Actual reconstruction	What did different recipients in fact infer?
Action and authorization consequence	Which conduct, sanction, trust, or grant of power followed?
Alternative decompressions	Which materially plausible reconstructions were excluded, punished, or made difficult to formulate?

This model organizes omission, paltering, framing, presupposition, guided problem representation, causal stories, master signifiers, and systemic lying without replacing their more specific definitions. The *lossy codec* and *decoder-targeted compression* expressions are controlled analogies for this model, not claims that human interpretation is literal digital decoding.

Narrative exchange, deep canvassing, motivational interviewing, Street Epistemology, and Socratic questioning may reduce identity threat and help a person perform the relevant operations. The evidence base includes, for example, **Joshua Kalla and David Broockman's** three field experiments on non-judgmental narrative exchange in deep canvassing (2020). None of these methods is automatically ethical or truth-producing. Questions can

simulate open inquiry while selectively steering someone toward a conclusion fixed in advance. This entry calls that possibility **Socratic manipulation**; it is a critical label, not the historical Socratic method's own name.

Method and target must therefore be evaluated separately:

Epistemic direction	Relatively autonomy-supporting method	Manipulative or coercive method
Toward a better reality-tracking model	Education, reciprocal inquiry, transparent persuasion	Reality-aligned paternalism; potentially justified only under sufficiently grave and well-supported conditions
Toward a false or misleading model	Polite or Socratic misdirection	Propaganda, fraud, indoctrination, and epistemically corrupt manipulation

The method alone does not determine the truth of the result. Conversely, the persuader's conviction that the intended conclusion is true does not make every method legitimate. Truth-directed inquiry requires that the persuader's own model also remain at risk.

The programming topology in Section 12 changes neither verdict. It can make an accurate lesson or a false causal story more transportable, authoritative, and socially reinforced. Ethical and epistemic judgment therefore cannot be inferred from receptivity, participation, gentleness, authority, or resistance alone; the content's relation to reality and the preservation of corrigibility remain separate tests.

16. Causal stories and political agenda formation

A **causal story** organizes a condition into a politically meaningful sequence:

```
condition
   ↓
actionable problem
   ↓
cause and responsible agent
   ↓
victim, culprit, and legitimate fixer
   ↓
preferred remedy
   ↓
coalition, agenda, and coordinated action
```

The American political scientist **Deborah A. Stone** develops this concept in "Causal Stories and the Formation of Policy Agendas" (1989) (DOI). Her analysis explains how political actors compete to define causation, assign responsibility, convert difficulties into governable problems, and attach proposed solutions to issues on the agenda. A causal story does more than summarize facts. It defines moral roles, distributes sympathy and blame, identifies who may intervene, and makes some remedies appear natural while rendering others invisible.

Authorization payload

Wegner's maxim and the Culture Mechanics translation On the official page for *Talking Points*, Dushan Wegner states the originating political-language maxim without qualification:

> **Der erste Zweck politischer Sprache ist es, das Volk zu motivieren, dem Politiker das eigene Leben anzuvertrauen. Die goldene Regel aller politischen Kommunikation lautet: Rede jederzeit so, dass die Menschen motiviert sind, dir Macht über ihr Leben zu geben!**

A close English rendering is:

> **The first purpose of political language is to motivate the people to entrust their own lives to the politician. The golden rule of all political communication is: always speak so that people are motivated to give you power over their lives.**

The page characterizes **talking points** as formulations capable of moving people to follow, believe, and trust, while also directing hatred, fear, or combat toward opponents. It says that the described effects attach directly to human psychology and presents *Talking Points* as a complement to *Relevante Strukturen*. The two sources can therefore be joined without pretending that the maxim appears in the later book:

```
Relevante Strukturen:
which structures matter, and what appears to support or damage them?
                         ↓
Talking Points:
which formulations make the speaker a trusted protector
and the opponent an object of fear, hostility, or resistance?
                         ↓
political consequence:
what authority, obedience, resources, or restrictions follow?
```

The Culture Mechanics translation is:

Political language is an authorization bid: it seeks to convert moral concern into delegated jurisdiction.

This is a functional diagnostic, not a claim that every political utterance has only one purpose or that requesting authority is inherently deceptive. An authorization bid can range from a request for attention, trust, a vote, money, or ordinary obedience to a request for discretionary power, emergency authority, institutional access, sacrifice, silence, or restrictions on opponents. Its moral and epistemic quality depends upon truth, proportionality, declared scope, jurisdiction, oversight, revocability, consequence, and corrigibility.

A causal story can carry more than a preferred interpretation or remedy. By identifying a threatened structure, culprit, victim, guardian, and legitimate fixer, it can make a transfer of power appear necessary. The **authorization payload** is the grant of authority that acceptance of the causal and moral model is expected to support:

```
represented problem and threatened structure
                    ↓
victim + culprit + protector or legitimate fixer
                    ↓
preferred remedy
                    ↓
requested authorization:
power + objects + jurisdiction + duration + discretion
```

The authorization-payload audit asks:

Field	Question
Power requested	What may the actor now decide, compel, prohibit, spend, inspect, or conceal?
Objects	Over whom or what may that power be exercised?
Jurisdiction	Within which domain, and where does the claimed mandate stop?
Duration and discretion	For how long, under which rules, and with how much latitude?
Oversight	Who can inspect reasons, evidence, execution, and consequences?
Revocability and succession	Who can withdraw, transfer, or replace the mandate?
Termination evidence	Which observations, outcomes, or changed conditions end it?
Opponent restrictions	Which rights, standing, speech, property, or participation may opponents lose?
Epistemic spillover	Does coordination authority become authority to determine what counts as true or relevant?

Mythology Construction places the payload inside the complete doctrine-generation and authorization pathway: a causal story attributes, mythology legitimates, a master signifier compresses and activates, PCP routes permission, and an institution implements. This cross-reference does not add a new meaning to **authorization payload**. It shows

where the existing grant of power enters a larger construction and runtime sequence. *Culture Program Ecology* owns the later institutional-realization and *Willkür* gate.

Silent principals and surrogate authorization

> **A silent beneficiary cannot correct, dismiss, or withdraw authorization from those claiming to speak for it.**

A **silent principal** is a represented beneficiary that lacks a presently available capacity or constituted channel to authenticate its own interests, choose or dismiss a representative, contest the proposed proxy, or appeal a decision made in its name. Nature, an ecosystem, nonhuman future conditions, and not-yet-existing generations can occupy this position. So can an agentified abstraction such as *Humanity* or a desired *pattern of differences*: concrete persons can dispute what the abstraction means, but the abstraction cannot settle that dispute by self-report.

This definition must not silence people by analytical fiat. A population, minority, profession, neighbourhood, or Indigenous community whose members can speak is not a silent principal merely because an administrator claims to represent it. Internal disagreement, standing, and direct testimony remain evidence rather than noise. Nor does silence imply absence of morally relevant interests. It creates a representation problem.

The **silent-principal surrogate mechanism** is:

```
silent, absent, future, or abstract beneficiary
→ surrogate defines its relevant interests
→ proxy or metric makes those interests administratively legible
→ causal story identifies threat, culprit, guardian, and remedy
→ authorization payload grants practical jurisdiction
→ consequences are interpreted back through the surrogate's model
```

Empirical systems can answer causally through observed consequences; they do not thereby issue a complete normative mandate. Ecological damage, for example, can falsify a prediction without deciding by itself how competing human and nonhuman goods, burdens, rights, risks, and time horizons should be ordered.

The ordinary authorization-payload audit therefore gains five questions when a silent principal is invoked:

Additional field	Question
Principal status	In which exact respect is the principal unable to speak, authorize, correct, dismiss, or appeal?
Proxy construction	Who selected the ontology, indicator, baseline, value rule, uncertainty treatment, and claimed interest?
Rival representation	Which independent guardians, affected persons, disciplines, and counter-models may contest the surrogate?
Function separation	Are advocacy, measurement, implementation, adjudication, and review controlled by differently vulnerable actors?
Affected-person standing	Which concrete persons bear costs or lose rights, and can they demand reasons, present evidence, appeal, obtain repair, or force renewed authorization?

The mechanism becomes a **surrogate-sovereignty hazard** when one custodian can define the principal, select its interests and indicators, prescribe the remedy, allocate sacrifice, judge success, and control appeal. That is a hazard and affordance, not evidence by itself of bad faith, capture, *Willkürherrschaft*, or an illegitimate policy. Legitimate trusteeship remains possible where the representation is plural, disclosed, bounded, evidence-facing, rights-constrained, reviewable, terminable, and answerable to the bounded-protector recursion.

The **Sowell decision–correction custody bridge** shows that this hazard is not limited to silent principals. A person, family, firm, profession, electorate, or affected population may be fully capable of speaking while an agency, court, commission, panel, or other surrogate controls the operative decision and the routes by which error can reduce its authority. The joint failure is:

```
surrogate decision custody
+ weak access to dispersed affected-person knowledge
```

```
+ attenuated exposure to error costs
+ custody of outcome interpretation and correction
→ surrogate-correction asymmetry
→ possible surrogate-sovereignty hazard
```

> **Surrogate decision-making becomes surrogate sovereignty when the same custodian can define the problem, select the governing model or rule, impose the decision, externalize the cost of error, interpret the consequences, and retain jurisdiction after failure.**

That compression is a Culture Mechanics extension of Sowell's knowledge, incentive, feedback, surrogate-decision, and "Teflon prophets" themes. It is not a quotation from Sowell and does not make representative government, delegated administration, expertise, adjudication, guardianship, or institutional insulation inherently illegitimate.

Political and institutional coordination necessarily requires legitimate authorization. The presence of a payload is therefore not evidence of deception or pathology. The danger appears when its scope is hidden, temporary coordination becomes indefinite jurisdiction, revocation or succession is blocked, opponents lose standing without due process, or trust in the protector becomes epistemic sovereignty.

The term **authorization payload** and the authorization-bid translation are project-developed. Wegner's *Talking Points* page supplies the forceful source maxim about winning trust and power over people's lives. His "Ethics is a weapon" discussion and *Vierschritt der Kontrolle* in *Relevante Strukturen* supply the neighbouring account of moral persuasion through represented support and damage to relevant structures. Neither the typed payload nor its audit should be attributed to Wegner as his own formal construct.

In culture-mechanical terms, causal stories can **program the distributed bigOther**. Repeated stories train local mythological lenses to classify events, agents, institutions, and responses in similar ways; common reception makes those classifications mutually visible; and repetition stabilizes them as field expectations. An authorized institution can then activate this installed structure with a compressed master signifier. Stone explains political causal construction; the field-programming translation belongs to this framework.

Not every causal story is a distortion. Complex events require selection and structure; some stories reveal preventable human causes previously treated as fate or accident. The pathological subtype is **bad-faith causal-story construction**:

> selective problem definition and causal attribution used to attach a preselected policy to a real condition while concealing alternative causes, remedies, trade-offs, or predictable consequences.

A causal story may use only individually true statements and still install a false overall model. Reality-tracking therefore requires comparison among causal structures, attention to omitted variables and alternative remedies, and evaluation of predictions beyond the persuasive setting in which the story was first told.

17. The complete capture sequence

The concepts can be assembled into one possible pathway without claiming that every case follows every step. The sequence must distinguish two operations. An authority can activate, reinforce, or extend material already installed or compatible with the incumbent lens. Capture by an incompatible governing worldview is different: under the single-slot principle, it cannot add a second evaluator and must first loosen and unbraid the incumbent sufficiently for one successor weave to be rebraided and installed.

Here **complete capture sequence** names an incompatible, potentially pathological route into authority-gated judgment. It is not the definition of **full capture** in the neutral architectural sense of complete slot occupancy. First-order and lifted programs can both occupy the slot fully, and either can be open or closed. The sequence becomes pathological where correction is disabled, interpretation is monopolized, or an authority claims epistemic sovereignty over reality.

```
UNCERTAINTY, DEPENDENCE, OR DISORIENTATION
the person needs a classification or cannot investigate alone
                          ↓
MASTER SIGNIFIER OR CAUSAL STORY OFFERS ORDER
a compact term or narrative defines what events mean
                          ↓
PRIVILEGED PROGRAMMING TOPOLOGY AMPLIFIES RECEPTION
authority, common attention, narrative, and common knowledge converge
                          ↓
THE INCUMBENT LENS CLASSIFIES THE OFFER
```

```
compatible material may be activated, reinforced, or integrated;
an incompatible governing offer is rejected unless replacement advances
                          ↓
INCOMPATIBLE CAPTURE LOOSENS AND UNBRAIDS THE INCUMBENT
authorities, meanings, loyalties, sentiments, and defences are detached;
liminal instability and dependency make a successor increasingly receivable
                          ↓
ONE SUCCESSOR WEAVE IS REBRAIDED AND INSTALLED
retained and new strands acquire meaning within one operative lens;
no parallel bigOther or higher runtime ranking is introduced
                          ↓
S1 ORGANIZES S2
some knowledge, experts, and institutions become legitimate;
others become disreputable or invisible
                          ↓
MECHANICAL-SOLIDARITY FIELD FORMS OR STRENGTHENS
local bigOthers display, observe, and reinforce common classifications
                          ↓
FIELD BACK-ACTION
apparent consensus, sanctions, and bigOther-presence change what feels admissible
                          ↓
SOCIALIZATION INTO INSTITUTIONAL TRUST
offices, credentials, and channels become shared trust anchors
                          ↓
IDENTITY AND BELONGING BECOME INVESTED
questioning the classification threatens moral standing and membership
                          ↓
AUTHORITY-GATED BELIEF UPDATING
authorization begins to replace symmetrical evaluation
                          ↓
ASYMMETRIC EPISTEMIC PERMEABILITY
in-group messages penetrate; outside evidence is resisted
                          ↓
MOTIVATED REASONING, DUMMHEIT, OR NORMOPATHIC ADAPTATION
intelligence defends the installed order and members enforce it mutually
```

The unbraiding and rebraiding stages apply only when the incoming program is incompatible at load-bearing classifications. In compatible socialization or reinforcement, the sequence can move directly from incumbent classification to S1 organization without worldview replacement. In failed or incomplete replacement, contradictory remnants can leave one tangled, unstable lens; they do not establish several independently operative bigOthers.

The sequence is recursive. Public conformity strengthens the appearance of consensus; apparent consensus strengthens individual deference; deference strengthens institutions able to control the stories, symbols, sanctions, and sources through which the next round of socialization occurs.

No conscious conspiracy is necessary. The loop may arise through ordinary coordination, institutional inertia, sincere belief, career incentives, dependency, and mutual prediction. It can nevertheless be deliberately exploited by actors who understand how to manipulate narratives, identities, prestige, fear, and institutional legitimacy.

Cognitive relief as one pathway into capture Wegner preserves his grandmother's compact judgment, *Denken tut weh*–"thinking hurts"–and proposes that simple thoughts can feel good because they spare effort. Her formulation is a situated witness judgment, not a calibrated prevalence estimate. Culture Mechanics translates it into the **cognitive-relief hypothesis**:

> Under complexity, contradiction, uncertainty, public exposure, or responsibility for independent judgment, an authority-endorsed compressed formula can gain an adoption advantage partly because accepting it reduces experienced cognitive and social burden.

```
complexity + contradiction + uncertainty
+ public exposure or responsibility for judgment
                          ↓
```

```
aversive demand for independent analysis
                          ↓
authority supplies compressed causal and moral formula:
structure + threat + culprit + protector + required action
                          ↓
uncertainty and experienced personal responsibility decrease
                          ↓
subjective relief + belonging + moral certainty
                          ↓
checking and decompression become less attractive
                          ↓
formula, authority, and field reinforce one another
```

This is one possible pathway into Bonhoefferian *Dummheit*, authority-gated updating, or normopathic adaptation; it is not their definition and does not imply low intelligence or a fixed aversion to thought. Compression can also be truthful, educational, and necessary. The pathological transition occurs when relief is purchased by hiding uncertainty, disabling inexpensive checks, making decompression shameful, or converting an authority's summary into reality-permission.

The hypothesis predicts that cognitive load, time pressure, public visibility, and authority endorsement will increase preference for compressed explanations and reduce checking partly through measurable subjective relief. Failure of relief to mediate that relationship, or absence of a compression advantage under those conditions, would weaken this proposed pathway.

Several labels in the final stage come from separate literatures and are not synonyms. **Motivated reasoning** refers to the directional recruitment of reasoning analyzed by the social psychologist **Ziva Kunda** in "The Case for Motivated Reasoning" (1990). **Contaminated mindware** is the psychologist **Keith E. Stanovich's** term for acquired reasoning rules or beliefs that can impair rationality; see the chapter "Contaminated Mindware" (2009). **Need for cognitive closure** is the construct measured by social psychologists **Donna M. Webster and Arie W. Kruglanski** in "Individual Differences in Need for Cognitive Closure" (1994). **Normopathic adaptation** is used here descriptively for overadaptation to a pathological normality. It borrows from a concept with several partly independent histories, including **Erich Wulff's** *Psychiatrie und Klassengesellschaft* (1972), **Joyce McDougall's** psychoanalytic work on normopathy, and **Hans-Joachim Maaz's** society-level application in *Das falsche Leben* (2017). The present use does not import any one of their clinical or political theories wholesale.

18. Healthy and unhealthy mechanical solidarity

Mechanical solidarity is not inherently an enemy of epistemic agency. A society can make reality-orientation itself an object of shared honour.

An **agency-supporting mechanical solidarity** teaches that:

- persons retain dignity when they are mistaken;
- factual disagreement is not automatically disloyalty;
- authorities must expose methods and correct errors;
- domain expertise matters, but jurisdiction has boundaries;
- uncertainty may be acknowledged without shame;
- elementary checking is responsible rather than insulting;
- independent institutions and source pluralism are public goods;
- publicly changing one's mind can be honourable;
- no institution is the final authorized voice of reality.

An **agency-suppressing mechanical solidarity** teaches that:

- loyalty and factual agreement are fused;
- one identity or institution possesses privileged access to truth;
- unauthorized evidence is morally contaminated;
- the same claim receives different standards according to its source;
- uncertainty signals weakness or betrayal;
- correction threatens status and belonging;
- a missing conformity signal or continued association with a dissenter discloses bad character;
- dissenters may be ignored, shamed, excluded, or punished;

- authorities certify themselves and define their own failures away.

The distinction is not between culture and no culture, full and partial occupancy, or universal and merely local authority. Both configurations can be first-order or lifted full captures. An agency-supporting lifted meta-order remains universally binding at the second order while requiring every representative to remain corrigible and within its allocated jurisdiction. An agency-suppressing order grants final epistemic sovereignty to its representatives, disables correction, or allows jurisdictional spillover.

Both configurations can also sustain a multi-mind-self and unitary collective ownership. Integration is not goodness. A healthy collective agent can maintain knowledge, infrastructure, and common goods across generations; an unhealthy one can own, remember, and act with equal coherence while suppressing correction or harming outsiders. Field strength and epistemic quality must therefore be judged separately.

19. Piety toward the real

Piety toward the real is the normative pole of the framework. The phrase comes from the American sociologist **Robert N. Bellah's** introduction to *Émile Durkheim on Morality and Society* (1973); it is Bellah's characterization of Durkheim's attitude, not a standard technical term coined by Durkheim. This entry adopts and extends Bellah's phrase to name a disciplined respect for the complexity and resistance of what exists.

Piety toward the real means that:

- reality is not exhausted by one's present concepts;
- social facts and institutions may have functions not visible to unaided intuition;
- reform should begin by investigating the structure actually present;
- a satisfying narrative is not sufficient evidence;
- prediction, surprise, error, and consequences may defeat a preferred model;
- no person, movement, or institution may define reality solely by authorization;
- one's own certainty remains fallible and must be externally corrigible.

This piety must be paired with **moral individualism**, drawing on Durkheim's defense of the morally sacred person in "L'individualisme et les intellectuels" (1898): the unconditional dignity of persons does not depend on whether their current claims are correct. The present ethical formula is an extension, not a quotation from Durkheim. Respect for a person does not require treating every belief as equally sound. Nor does respectful attention to existing social facts sanctify existing institutions. An institution may be real, complex, and functionally important while remaining unjust or mistaken. The resulting rule is:

Under the project's inherent human-standing and recognition-only principle, the bearer of that unconditional dignity is every individual living human organism from the beginning of its existence until death. This is a Culture Mechanics normative axiom rather than a proposition attributed to Durkheim: authority may recognize the bearer and regulate capability or conduct, but it may not constitute admission to the protected human class.

> **Respect persons unconditionally; evaluate propositions conditionally according to evidence; regulate actions according to justice.**

The theory expresses this orientation through the following model-centred epistemic control loop:

```
experience
   ↓
concepts and operations
   ↓
model or "digital twin"
   ↓
prediction and intervention
   ↓
encounter with reality
   ↓
surprise, error, and out-of-sample consequence
   ↓
revision of the model, concepts, or operations
```

The central virtue is not solitary knowledge. It is preservation of a route by which reality can say **no**.

Piety toward the real also guards against self-appointed gatekeeping. Personal conviction is not self-authenticating. A person who intervenes "for the truth" must remain answerable to evidence, relevant competence, independent assessment, proportionality, consequences, and correction. The compact ethical rule proposed by this synthesis is:

> **Let truth identify the danger, let love require a response, and let epistemic humility govern the means.**

Impersonal universality against private interest **Status: deliberately narrow and provisional interpretive bridge.** The following subsection preserves one formal similarity through which Durkheim can name Kant and Rousseau together. It does not establish a general theory of universalism, prove that the two architectures are morally or politically equivalent, or settle the interpretation of either philosopher.

The originating terminological proposal is:

> **A better contemporary word for the doctrine Durkheim calls "individualistic" may be "Humanism," because its sacred object is man rather than private interest.**

Durkheim's own formulation must nevertheless remain visible. He says that "this religion is individualistic, since it takes man as its object and since man is an individual by definition." He then contrasts its intransigent protection of the individual with utility's capacity to suspend individual liberty for the interest of the greater number ("Individualism and the Intellectuals," pp. 46–47).

Person-centred humanism is therefore introduced only as an explanatory gloss, not as a replacement for Durkheim's source term **moral individualism**:

> **Humanism names what is held sacred; individualism names where that sacred standing resides—in every individual living human being.**

The recognition-only principle closes the admission gap that would otherwise remain inside *person*. Development, implantation, viability, presently exercisable rationality, autonomy, health, disability, dependency, wantedness, social recognition, conduct, and political classification may alter circumstances, capabilities, responsibilities, or remedies, but none determines whether a living human bearer enters or leaves the protected class.

This is the same distinction developed more fully as Humanity-as-standing and Humanity-as-sacred-object. Unqualified *humanism* could obscure the boundary by turning abstract Humanity, the species, civilization, or the future into a collective idol. The gloss is person-centred only while the abstraction's standing remains instantiated in each person rather than detached from them and used against them.

The shared formal movement in Kant and Rousseau is provisionally named **impersonal universality against private interest**:

> **The justification must not depend upon the fact that I happen to be me, my group happens to be ours, or I occupy the advantageous position.**

It transforms a private reason into a candidate general reason:

```
particular interest I_i + situation C
→ formulate the operative candidate rule M
→ remove "because it is me or mine"
→ exchange the persons occupying the positions
→ test whether M survives for anyone relevantly similarly situated
→ candidate general rule R*(C)
```

The present provisional plain-language name for this operation is the **remove-the-me test** (*de-indexing* in optional philosophical vocabulary). It removes *I*, *me*, *mine*, *our faction*, *our class*, or *this outsider* as the sufficient justification and then exchanges the persons occupying the positions. It does not erase material context.

A rule that passes the remove-the-me test is therefore not necessarily context-free. "A physician may break confidentiality when necessary to prevent an imminent serious harm" still depends on role, danger, necessity, and competence. It passes if those conditions govern every relevantly similar physician rather than supplying a private exception for me or my allies.

Counterfactual position exchange The remove-the-me test contains a **counterfactual** operation. The same event cannot literally be rerun with different people occupying its positions. The reasoner therefore constructs a hypothetical comparison:

```
actual case:
I receive the benefit; another person bears the burden

counterfactual case:
the other person receives the benefit; I bear the burden
```

The question is whether the same rule and justification survive the exchange. In mathematical or software language, this resembles a **label-invariance test**: permute the personal labels while holding the materially relevant structure fixed and check whether the rule changes merely because someone else is now called "me." As a compact counterfactual unit test:

```
situation C + rule M
→ exchange personal labels or occupied positions
→ hypothetical situation C'
→ apply the same M
→ compare justification and corresponding output
```

The comparison must preserve rather than erase relevant structure. If a rule depends legitimately on being a physician, parent, officeholder, aggressor, or person in imminent danger, exchanging personal names does not abolish those roles. If allocation of the roles is itself under examination, the counterfactual instead asks whether the same role-dependent rule would be accepted if *I* occupied the other role.

Two counterfactual questions must remain distinct:

Counterfactual question	What it tests	What it cannot establish by itself
Justificatory: Would the same reason count if the persons or positions were exchanged?	Symmetry and hidden personal or factional privilege	Truth, goodness, person-preservation, or actual consequences
Causal: What would happen if everyone followed this rule or it governed repeated cases?	Predicted consequences of general adoption	Whether the prediction is accurate without empirical knowledge

The unit-test comparison is useful but limited. Passing the justificatory counterfactual shows only that the rule does not openly depend on a privileged "me." A symmetric rule can still be false, destructive, or willing to sacrifice persons. Counterfactual prediction also remains answerable to evidence; imagination alone cannot establish what universal adoption would cause.

"Against private interest" likewise does **not** mean:

- personal interests are evil;
- moral conduct requires self-sacrifice;
- everyone must receive identical treatment;
- special obligations to children, patients, partners, or offices are illegitimate;
- every permissible rule must ignore role, knowledge, relationship, risk, or consequence.

It means:

> **My interest is not sufficient justification precisely because it is mine.**

Kant and Rousseau can now be placed in the same sentence only at this coarse formal level:

Dimension	Kant	Rousseau
Object tested	The acting person's maxim	A law for the political community
Generalizing question	Can the maxim be willed as law for every rational person?	Can all citizens legislate the rule for all as a matter of common interest?
Principal output	A universal constraint on personal conduct	A general law of the collective sovereign
Status of persons	Each remains a separate moral legislator and an end	Citizens jointly constitute the sovereign and are also subject to its law

Dimension	Kant	Rousseau
Characteristic danger	A loaded framing or false premise is elevated into universal moral language	The empirical person's refusal is subordinated to their alleged civic will

Kant's universal-law formula supplies the first comparison (AA 4:421); his Humanity formula adds the separate constraint that rational nature in every person be treated as an end in itself (AA 4:428–429). Rousseau distinguishes the general will, directed toward common interest, from the will of all as a sum of private interests, and requires law to be general in its source and object (*The Social Contract*, II.3 and II.6; primary text).

Kantian universalization characteristically makes the hypothetical operation internal to the moral test: the agent considers the maxim as a universal law. Rousseauian generality is more directly an institutional property of law, general in source and object. Counterfactual position exchange can diagnose a disguised Rousseauian privilege, but it does not by itself constitute the general will.

The concise interpretive contrast is:

> **Kant abstracts from my particular interest so that every person remains an end; Rousseau abstracts from private wills in order to constitute a collective sovereign will.**

This is a Culture Mechanics comparison, not a claim that Durkheim, Kant, or Rousseau stated the formula in these words. The common operator does not establish an identical architecture. Kantian universality can constrain a collective on behalf of the person. Rousseauian generality can make the collective citizen-body the standpoint from which a person's private refusal is judged.

The person-centred boundary adds a second test after removing the privileged "me":

> **Remove "because it is me," not the person or the situation.**

A rule can be perfectly impersonal and still make a person disposable. "Sacrifice one whenever doing so benefits one thousand" contains no exception for *me*, but its impartiality does not protect the one. Impersonal universality is therefore not yet moral individualism:

```
1. remove-the-me test
   remove privileged private or factional interest

2. human-person constraint
   preserve every concrete person as an end rather than a summand or organ
```

The originating application identifies two different routes by which this second test can fail:

> **Both utilitarianism and a strong multi-mind-self can lead to neglect of the individual.**

Culture Mechanics preserves the claim but makes its causal conditions more precise:

Sacrifice route	Operation	How the individual loses standing
Utilitarian aggregation	Benefits and injuries are combined into an aggregate result	A person becomes a commensurable unit whose liberty, body, or life may be traded for a sufficiently large net benefit
Subjecthood-absorptive collective agency	A multi-mind-self becomes the authoritative subject across the relevant jurisdiction	A person becomes an organ, carrier, or execution surface whose judgment, conscience, purpose, refusal, or exit has no standing against the collective

These routes can converge in consequence while remaining causally distinct:

```
aggregative route: person → term in a welfare calculation

fusion route:      person → constituent organ of a collective subject
```

Durkheim is contrasting moral individualism with an aggregative permission available to the utility principle; he is not demonstrating that every consequentialist or rule-utilitarian theory must suspend individual rights. Rights-protecting rules, distribution-sensitive welfare functions, side constraints, thresholds, and empirical claims about long-run utility are possible rival configurations.

Likewise, collective strength alone does not establish neglect. A multi-mind-self may remain differentiated, person-preserving, jurisdictionally bounded, and corrigible. The second route requires subjecthood absorption, excessive jurisdiction, or closed refusal and exit. The relevant variable is not merely how strongly the collective can act, but what legitimate standing its participants retain against it.

For now the bridge should be used only through four discriminating questions:

1. Would the candidate rule survive exchange of names, affiliations, and advantageous positions?
2. Which contextual differences remain relevant, and would they be applied symmetrically?
3. Does the output preserve each concrete person as an end, or convert someone into a summand, instrument, or organ?
4. Who interprets "the universal" or "the common interest," under what jurisdiction, and through which correction, refusal, and exit conditions?

Humanism and Diversity: nested, supplementary, and replacement relations The ordinary word *diversity* can describe factual variation without carrying a common programme. Capitalized ***Diversity*** is used here only when the word functions as an organizing master signifier or names a corresponding programmatic configuration. It is not a claim about every anti-discrimination policy, pluralist institution, varied population, or use of the word.

The assistant proposed the following distinction during the comparison, and the project author selected it for integration. The comparison with person-centred Humanism requires three different relations:

Relation	Operative ordering	Principal boundary
Nested Diversity	Selected forms of plurality are protected as a subordinate institutional good or as means through which concrete persons exercise equal standing, liberty, association, cultural expression, inquiry, or development.	Humanity-as-standing remains the higher constraint; a diversity measure cannot override the person merely to improve a pattern.
Supplementary Diversity	Equal person-standing remains constitutive, while recognition of identity, inherited barriers, group-mediated harm, or epistemic variety adds an independently relevant consideration.	Neither abstract sameness nor the desired pattern decides every conflict; evidence, relevant distinctions, reciprocal rules, rights, review, and appeal remain necessary.
Replacement Diversity	A selected pattern of recognized differences, its representation, or the continuing process of correction becomes the protected principal and a criterion of institutional legitimacy.	Persons can become categorical bearers, representatives, inputs, or obstacles whose standing is mediated or overridden by the preferred pattern.

These are relation types, not a necessary historical sequence. One institution can mix them across domains or move among them over time. Public doctrine can also state a nested relation while operative metrics, exception rules, and burdens realize a replacement relation; the classification therefore requires conduct and institutional evidence.

Strong Programmatic Diversity is the typed Culture Program profile for a robust institutional configuration. It does not by definition select one of the three relations. Its relation to Humanism is decided by the actual hierarchy among concrete person-standing, category-conscious recognition and correction, and the desired pattern.

Applied through the master-signifier grid, the central contrast is:

Grid field	Durkheimian person-centred Humanism	Replacement form of Strong Programmatic Diversity
Sacred referent	Human personhood or Humanity instantiated in every concrete person	Selected differences, their recognition, representative composition, or continued correction
Bearer	Every person directly and completely bears moral standing	Persons and cultures are encountered partly as carriers of recognized categories
Unity topology	Differentiated person → shared Humanity → whole	Person → administered category or group → Diversity order
Difference operator	Difference expresses plural human possibility beneath common standing	Selected differences remain morally and institutionally salient objects of recognition, preservation, promotion, or correction
Distributive grammar	Equal standing and developmental liberty need not mean identical reward; Durkheim can also invoke labour-proportional return	Category-conscious recognition, representation, opportunity, remedy, burden, resource, or outcome adjustment may be authorized
Interpreter custody	No office owns Humanity merely by invoking it; reason, inquiry, law, and person-level appeal remain corrigible	Custodians may define categories, relevant disparities, baselines, indicators, corrective obligations, and completion
Outlier performance	The unproductive, dissenting, dependent, unsuccessful, or unusual person retains standing	The mixed, unclassified, category-refusing, nonrepresentative, or pattern-conflicting person tests whether person-standing remains primary
Completion and trajectory	Particular injustices and capability barriers can be repaired while differentiation continues beneath one common standing	The programme may be finite and corrigible, or may renew category salience and intervention when no attainable pattern or completion rule is allowed to settle the demand

Durkheim's "to each according to his labor" is therefore relevant to **distributive grammar**, not to the sacred-standing rule. The same person can have equal inviolable standing while rewards remain sensitive to contribution. That source passage does not by itself settle taxation, need, disability, inheritance, public goods, compensation, or the many contemporary meanings of *equity*. Conversely, category-sensitive treatment is not arbitrary merely because it is different: the distinction must be prospectively specified, causally relevant, reciprocal where applicable, evidence-based, reviewable, and subordinate to the standing the programme claims to protect.

20. Cognitive liberty and epistemic adulthood

In its established legal and ethical lineage, **cognitive liberty** concerns mental self-determination and freedom from unwanted interference with thought or consciousness. Important formulations include **Richard Glen Boire's** essay series "On Cognitive Liberty" (1999–2003) and the German legal scholar **Jan Christoph Bublitz's** "My Mind Is Mine!? Cognitive Liberty as a Legal Concept" (2013). The specialized usage developed here explicitly extends that lineage by adding a positive developmental capacity:

> **Cognitive liberty is the acquired capacity to gain reflective distance from one's socialization, including the mechanical-solidarity structures that formed one's identity, trust relationships, and standards of truth, without thereby becoming incapable of social trust or collective participation.**

The corresponding developmental process is **epistemic adulthood**. Biological or legal adulthood does not guarantee it. A person can reason competently within an inherited trust system while remaining unable to inspect that system as a system.

The developmental movement can be represented as:

```
SOCIALLY AUTHORED TRUST
"I know through the authorities recognized by my group."
                          ↓
SELF-AUTHORED TRUST
"I can examine why, where, and under what conditions I trust them."
                          ↓
SELF-TRANSFORMING TRUST
"I can revise even my standards of authority and my trust architecture."
```

This developmental representation is adapted from the American psychologist **Robert Kegan's** constructive-developmental theory, especially the subject–object relation and the movement from socially authored toward self-authored and self-transforming meaning-making discussed in *In Over Our Heads* and related work. Kegan does not use the terms *epistemic adulthood*, *socially authored trust*, or *self-transforming trust* in the exact senses defined here. What remains *subject* to the person organizes perception but cannot yet be inspected. What becomes *object* can be noticed, compared, endorsed, limited, or revised.

Epistemic adulthood therefore means that inherited institutional trust becomes:

- conscious rather than invisible;
- allocated to particular persons and institutions within their domains rather than allowed to become total;
- calibrated rather than sacred;
- defeasible rather than preemptive;
- plural rather than monopolistic;
- answerable to reality rather than self-certifying.

It does not guarantee correct beliefs, benevolence, or greater intelligence. A self-authored person can construct a false or cruel worldview. Developmental capacity and epistemic content must be judged separately. The mature achievement is **reflective ownership without finalization**.

Reflective plurality occurs in the main processor: a person can represent, compare, and learn from several authorities or worldviews without installing one local bigOther for each. Until reconstruction occurs, one local bigOther executes one operative lens. Epistemic adulthood enlarges the person's capacity to inspect, repair, compatibly extend, unbraid, or replace that lens; it is not a higher identity that ranks parallel evaluators.

This development occurs inside a fully installed program. Epistemic adulthood is the main processor's acquired capacity to inspect and revise its trust architecture within full lifted capture; it is not absence of programming, absence of universal meta-authority, or reduced occupancy of the single slot.

Cognitive liberty under low-visibility ideological power The normative problem is deeper than exposure to one false proposition. It concerns practical access to the pre-reflective conditions under which a person notices, trusts, classifies, reasons, and experiences a conclusion as obvious. The originating author's deliberately crude phrase *"ins Hirn scheißen"* records the felt absence of authorization: culture producers can install affective triggers, classifications, and correction barriers without the recipient ever knowingly granting them cognitive jurisdiction. The phrase is provenance language, not a technical term or attribution of deliberate abuse in every case.

The bounded theoretical translation is:

> **The cognitive-liberty problem arises when an actor, programme, institution, or infrastructure acquires covert, unaccountable, correction-resistant, or practically inescapable influence over the formation and operation of another person's evaluative and epistemic machinery.**

This does not presuppose a culture-free mind or require explicit consent to every ordinary influence. Socialization, language, education, trust, imitation, and persuasion are unavoidable and can enlarge agency. The stronger concern arises where influence is hidden or strategically engineered, monopolizes trusted routes, defeats reflective inspection, imposes large refusal costs, or blocks correction, appeal, and exit.

The ideological-power scale bridge explains the relevant subject-side pathway. Cognitive liberty is the counter-capacity: reflective distance sufficient to notice the installed judgment, recover self-authored formulation, inspect provenance and jurisdiction, compare rival accounts, and revise the trust architecture without becoming incapable of social trust or collective participation.

At constitutional scale this becomes one reason for the *Schutzbalken* to operate before overt coercion, while plural signals, reflection, effective correction, refusal, appeal, and exit remain available. The protector stays inside

the symmetry rule: measures advertised as cognitive liberty can become ideological-power instruments if they monopolize truth, pre-classify legitimate thought, censor rival correction, or make their own authority unreviewable.

Noticing under anarcho-tyranny The anarcho-tyranny configuration adds a specific civic use of cognitive liberty. Correction requires more than permission to utter a completed conclusion. A person must be able to notice instances, formulate a possible relation, compare it with records and rival accounts, state the result publicly, discover whether others independently see it, and associate around correction. High social, professional, or legal costs at the earlier links can leave formal speech intact while making the citizen **nearly forbidden to notice** in the practically relevant sense.

The four-variable enforcement-selection audit tests one route by which that condition can become selective. Harmfulness must remain separate from targetability, sanction leverage, and disciplinary yield. A licensed, employed, bank-dependent, property-bearing, locally rooted, or publicly reputable observer may possess a large sanctionable loss surface and therefore be easier to discipline than a more harmful but less reachable actor. That asymmetry does not prove that the observer's claim is true, that the burden was politically selected, or that the strict anarcho-tyranny gate is crossed. It identifies why one person-directed burden can suppress formulation and association across similarly dependent observers even without a general speech prohibition.

Perception-stage correction closure names obstruction before a candidate relation can travel from noticing through formulation, comparison, public articulation, and collective testing. At least three routes should remain distinct:

Route	Characteristic interruption
Penalty	Social, professional, legal, or material costs attach to formulation, comparison, articulation, or association.
Occupation	Time, attention, trust, confidence, and civic surplus are consumed before the relation can be preserved and tested.
Internal classification	The collar marks the relation as morally dangerous, and the rider cannot keep the observations joined under one inspectable name.

The collar-conditioned mechanism elaborates only the third route. Public silence alone cannot identify which route, or which combination of routes, produced it. The occupation relation is specified through civic surplus. In the strongest direct coupling, an evidenced description of recurrent protection failure itself activates a legal, professional, employment, or equivalent burden: the person enters the tyranny branch by describing the anarchy branch. That causal relation must be demonstrated; anticipated stigma, ordinary disagreement, or consequences for independently wrongful conduct do not establish it.

This pathway can involve both established meanings of *inner eye* without collapsing them. The local bigOther can mark a possible observation as morally dangerous before articulation; the person's own imaginative-conceptual inner eye can then lose the capacity to hold the instances together as a nameable relation. Neither result establishes that the suspected pattern is true.

The gates remain sequential:

```
noticing ≠ representative measurement
representative measurement ≠ causal explanation
causal explanation ≠ a group essence
a group-level relation ≠ a judgment about an encountered person
```

Cognitive liberty protects the ability to cross each gate through evidence, criticism, uncertainty, and revision; it supplies no exemption from them. One chilling episode, one blind spot, one emotionally charged reaction, or one unpopular observation establishes neither an upstream programme, Ideology, anarcho-tyranny, capture, *Dummheit*, nor person-level guilt.

Reflective roles of reason: press secretary, interpreter, and auditor The originating suspicion should be stated in its forceful form:

> **What calls itself "using your own reason" may be no more than becoming the press secretary of your own bigOther.**

Reason can be the most articulate organ of capture. A conclusion may be presented as though it had been derived by explicit reasoning even when the operative causal sequence ran in the other direction:

```
bigOther classification or verdict
→ shame, guilt, reverence, fear, disgust, or felt necessity
→ favourable description of the case
→ reasons assembled for the already protected conclusion
→ retrospective appearance of rational derivation
```

This is not necessarily conscious lying. The spokesperson can sincerely experience the supplied reasons as the cause of the judgment. Logical presentation and psychological provenance therefore have to be tested separately.

At person and field scale, this can contribute to **un-reason**: reasoning remains active, but its premises, descriptions, burdens, exceptions, and responses to criticism are recursively organized so that a protected verdict cannot lose. The press-secretary role is one possible person-level operation; un-reason is the broader mechanism and can be distributed through programmes and institutions. Neither articulate defence nor motivated reasoning alone establishes it.

The **press-secretary analogy** has important prior art. Jonathan Haidt uses the press secretary to describe conscious reasoning that justifies intuitively reached moral judgments in a first-person interview; his social-intuitionist model supplies the associated theoretical account of intuition followed by post-hoc reasoning. Michael Gazzaniga's research on the left-hemisphere interpreter is a neighbouring account of a system that constructs coherent explanations for actions and events. Culture Mechanics does not identify the local bigOther with Haidt's intuitions, Gazzaniga's interpreter, System 1, or post-hoc rationalization. It uses those observations to sharpen one possible relation between the distinct main processor and an installed symbolic-affective classifier.

Three reflective roles should consequently be distinguished:

Role	Primary operation	Achievement	Characteristic limit
Press secretary	Produces a defensible public or private account of a protected verdict	Articulation, coherence, persuasion	Reasons may conceal rather than reveal causal provenance
Interpreter	Discovers and verbalizes the operative rule, framing, authority, affect, and situational classification	Makes previously implicit programming inspectable	Recognition alone does not test or revise it
Auditor	Tests provenance, description, evidence, symmetry, jurisdiction, consequence, and corrigibility	Makes retention, correction, unbraiding, or replacement possible	Audit can itself be captured, incompetent, or merely ceremonial

These are functional roles rather than permanent person-types or brain modules. The same person can move among them, and a press-secretary operation can contain accurate reasons. The distinction concerns what the reasoning is doing in the case.

The interpreter role is the bridge to Kegan's subject–object transition. The bigOther verdict ceases to be only the invisible position from which the person sees and becomes something the person can notice:

```
"This is simply shameful."
→ "I experience shame because this case has been classified under rule R."
→ "I learned R through authorities and practices A under field F."
```

That movement creates reflective distance without yet deciding whether *R* is true, legitimate, appropriately framed, or within the authority's jurisdiction. Introspection can therefore be a first step in self-unbraiding, but introspection alone is not a sovereign oracle.

The complete audit sequence proposed here is:

1. **Notice the verdict and actuation.** What judgment and what felt pressure arrived?
2. **Interpret the rule.** Which operative classification, maxim, or sacred boundary generated it?
3. **Trace provenance.** Through which persons, institutions, exemplars, rituals, rewards, sanctions, and collective fields was it installed or reinforced?

4. **Audit authority and jurisdiction.** Who is entitled to bind whom, about what, under which constituted and corrigible procedure?
5. **Reframe the case.** Which loaded description made the rule appear applicable, and what rival descriptions fit the facts?
6. **Apply the remove-the-me and position-exchange tests.** Would the rule survive if names, affiliations, advantages, and disadvantages were exchanged?
7. **Expose it to reality.** What evidence, competence, prediction, consequence, and possible falsifier bear upon it?
8. **Cut false finality.** Treat the inner judge's verdict as evidence about the installed program, not as the last court merely because it feels authoritative.
9. **Select or construct a successor generator.** Retain, narrow, correct, or replace the rule and its authority relation.
10. **Rebraid and test.** Install one revised operative weave, act through it, observe consequences, and keep the correction route open.

The finality cut is not the erasure of conscience:

> **The inner judge ceases to be the court of final appeal and becomes a witness whose testimony must itself be examined.**

This audit preserves single-slot exclusivity. Reflection can represent several possible rules and rival worldviews in the main processor, but it does not install several local bigOthers simultaneously. A genuinely incompatible successor requires sufficient unbraiding and one rebraiding. Nor does the auditor become a permanently cultureless CPU: standards of evidence, symmetry, dignity, and corrigibility are themselves learned and operatively installed.

Kant supplies both an aspiration and a warning. His public-enlightenment maxim opposes self-incurred tutelage and urges the public use of one's own reason (AA 8:35–36). Yet his own discussion of hidden self-love shows that introspection can mistake a self-interested motive for duty (AA 4:406–407). Culture Mechanics extends the warning: an agent can mistake an installed bigOther verdict for a deliverance of reason itself. This extension is not Kant's self-description.

Private introspection is therefore necessary in some cases but insufficient. Effective audit normally needs external friction: rival formulations, independent evidence, competent criticism, people outside the activating field, recorded predictions, consequences, and institutions able to correct authorized interpreters. "I have inspected myself" does not establish independence.

Moral individualism supplies the interpersonal boundary. Audit changes the confidence due to propositions, interpretations, and authorities; it does not reduce the standing of the mistaken or dissenting person. Conversely, equal standing does not make a person's judgment immune from correction. The more complete distinction among Humanity-as-standing, -horizon, and -sacred-object is defined in *Mythology Construction*.

The distinction generates possible tests:

- Does the stated reason predict the verdict before group identity or moral loading is disclosed?
- Does changing names, factions, beneficiary, or victim reverse the application of the allegedly general rule?
- Can the person state what evidence or consequence would change the conclusion?
- Can they identify the source, jurisdiction, and affective signature of the operative rule without treating that identification as disloyalty?
- Does audit ever change a protected verdict, or does it reliably produce more elaborate reasons for the same conclusion?
- Do private conclusions survive competent public criticism and out-of-field comparison?

The corresponding mythology-design requirement is developed as the reflective audit gate within the lifted sublimation-generator pattern.

Multidimensional agency and receiver profile The relation between a person and an installed Culture Program is not one scale from "tribal" to "individualist." A useful **agency-and-receiver profile** asks how several partly separable relations are configured in the specified domain:

Profile dimension	Question
Attachment	How strongly is belonging, identity, or moral standing tied to the programme?
Field reception and gain	How readily are collective evaluations received, amplified, and experienced as personally compelling?

Profile dimension	Question
Classification reach	How much of experience is preclassified through the programme's categories?
Affective output	Which shame, guilt, reverence, fear, disgust, pride, or desire does classification evoke?
Actuation	How reliably do those evaluations recruit attention, speech, inhibition, sacrifice, or action?
Jurisdiction	Over which questions, relationships, roles, and decisions is the programme treated as entitled to rule?
Inspectability	Can the person notice, name, trace, and compare the operative rule and its authority?
Controllability	Can the person pause, narrow, revise, refuse, or replace its application while remaining coherent?
Retransmission	Can the person reconstruct, teach, adapt, and repair the operation rather than repeat its conclusions?

Abstraction, self-authorship, affective independence, reciprocal person-preservation, corrigibility, and transfer under reduced support must also be measured separately. High abstraction can serve an absorptive collective system; strong personal refusal can coexist with weak general theory; warm attachment can remain reciprocal and corrigible; and cool distance can coexist with borrowed categories and institutional dependence.

The "debug access" image names inspectability and possible intervention in an installed classifier. It does not imply a literal software module, complete introspective access, or a desire to abolish collective authority. Seeing how a collar works is different from wanting no collar, and redesigning a collective programme is different from recognizing every concrete person's independent standing.

The following matrix supplies four deliberately simplified positions:

	Lower personal sovereignty or self-authorship	Higher personal sovereignty or self-authorship
Lower inspectability or general reconstruction	**Immersed carrier:** the programme's verdict normally appears as the world or conscience itself	**Local nonconformist:** can refuse, exit, improvise, or protect a personal domain without yet reconstructing the wider generator
Higher inspectability or general reconstruction	**Collective system-builder:** can expose, formalize, or redesign the programme while retaining collective authority over the person	**Liberal-Humanist carrier:** can inspect and reconstruct the generator while preserving reciprocal person-standing, refusal, and correction

The positions are ideal types, not brain modules, biological castes, political identities, or a psychometric instrument. Persons can move among them by domain, loading, formation, office, and life history. Their dimensions may also covary through development, institutions, active niche selection, or heritable disposition without becoming one indivisible "individualism" trait. This mosaic is the person-side interface to the separate fit–capacity–heritability distinction.

Humanist-liberal counter-formation The positive response to collar-conditioned semantic closure is neither a culture-free mind nor forced installation of a rival closed programme. Human beings necessarily develop through language, social trust, practice, authority, and inherited codebooks. The normative question is whether formation increases the main processor's capacity to inspect those inheritances and remain answerable to reality, or makes access increasingly dependent upon an authorized interpreter.

Humanist-liberal counter-formation is the proposed bundle of developmental, interpersonal, educational, and constitutional practices that:

> **expands a person's capacity to retrieve and compare plural models, remain semantically integrated under affective pressure, encounter difficult reality without loss of standing, and act with increasing competence and independence while retaining the ability to correct the formative authority.**

It is *counter-formation* because it counters correction closure, semantic capping, induced dependency, and programme-sealed interpretation—not because it opposes cultural formation as such. Its Humanist commitment preserves the equal standing of every concrete person; its liberal commitment protects cognitive liberty, refusal, plural inquiry, bounded authority, correction, and exit. This is a normative developmental proposal, not an established universal pedagogy, clinical protocol, or de-radicalization method.

The proposal joins components defined elsewhere rather than replacing them:

```
secure human standing independent of assent
+ plural concepts, sources, and trusted relationships
+ operation-rich contact with corrigible reality
+ practice in disagreement, repair, and recovery
+ protected private formulation and public Noticing
+ durable records and foundational-question custody
+ appeal, refusal, exit, and institutional succession
→ cognitive liberty and epistemic adulthood
→ greater capacity to inspect, revise, and responsibly inhabit a codebook
```

Epistemic reindexing restores plural, reality-answerable access paths without predetermining the resulting judgment. Guided unbraiding makes selected automatic relations inspectable and loosens their false finality. The Noticing chain carries a private anomaly toward public comparison and collective correction. Foundational-question custody preserves enough questions, examples, operations, rival answers, failures, and correction records for later generations to reconstruct the decoder rather than inherit only compressed conclusions.

Lonergan's **self-appropriation** is a neighbouring positive term for attending to and taking reflective possession of one's own operations of experiencing, questioning, understanding, judging, and deciding. Humanist-liberal counter-formation extends beyond that person-side achievement into social standing, plural access, institutional correction, refusal, exit, and succession; it should not be attributed to Lonergan or reduced to introspection.

The pedagogical relation is governed by a simple asymmetry constraint: support, respect, and belonging must not depend upon reaching the teacher's preferred political or metaphysical answer. A teacher can supply vocabulary, skills, context, manageable difficulty, practical support, and confidence while remaining corrigible:

```
do not falsify difficult reality
→ do not exploit vulnerability to install an answer
→ provide knowledge, skills, care, confidence, and practical support
→ preserve rival models and the corrigibility of the teacher
→ let manageable reality contact build competence
→ learner can face more reality while depending less on the teacher
```

This requires a secure base rather than an avoidance enclosure: dependable support should enlarge the radius of tolerable inquiry, disagreement, frustration, recovery, and independent action over time. It does not authorize adults to manufacture suffering or overwhelm a learner. Age-appropriate reality contact joins difficulty to context, regulation, trustworthy support, practical skill, recovery, and progressively wider independence.

The constitutional side protects the routes by which a private discrepancy can become a corrigible public claim: speech, association, archives, rival instruction, professional independence, appeal, refusal, exit, and succession. The ecology-level recognition-threshold model adds the Stockdale discipline required when lawful and arbitrary operations coexist: neither reassuring evidence nor threatening evidence may erase the other type. Hope should rest in human agency, solidarity, remaining lawful capacities, repair, and institution-building rather than in falsifying the configuration.

The strongest success condition is therefore independent of agreement:

> **The person's radius of reality contact, conceptual access, independent judgment, and competent action expands while the person remains free to conclude that the formative authority was wrong.**

This subsection deliberately uses **practice** and **counter-formation**, not *praxis*. The narrower proposed ecology-level use of *praxis* for a deliberately bundled intergenerational formation-and-mobilization architecture is defined in *Culture Program Ecology*.

21. Truth, love of neighbour, and intervention

The framework treats cognitive liberty as important but not absolute. Non-interference can become abandonment when illness, coercion, addiction, delusion, or another destructive process is eliminating the capacities required for future agency.

The moral vocabulary proposed here combines:

- **truth**, which concerns whether the understanding of danger and benefit tracks reality;
- **Nächstenliebe** or love of neighbour, which requires concern for the concrete person's good rather than indifference or instrumental use;
- **corrigibility**, which recognizes that the would-be helper is fallible and may also be captured by a master signifier.

This yields an important distinction:

- **Epistemic intervention** addresses false belief through evidence, demonstration, questioning, and dialogue. False belief by itself does not normally authorize coercive control of another person's mind.
- **Protective intervention** responds to grave and imminent danger that may destroy life or future agency. Stronger interference can sometimes be justified, but should be proportionate, accountable, and directed toward restoring self-direction.

Example—anorexia nervosa (*Magersucht*). A person may sincerely experience extreme restriction and weight loss as discipline, achievement, beauty, or personal control even while starvation is making them gravely ill. Simply admiring their determination and watching them die would confuse respect for present choice with love of the concrete neighbour. Because anorexia nervosa can endanger life, truth-directed love can require active intervention to preserve both the person and the possibility of future agency. Intervention should begin with honest communication and specialist, multidisciplinary support. Where physical health is at serious risk and treatment is refused, protective treatment against the person's present wishes can sometimes be justified—but only through an appropriate legal framework, by a competent team, and as a last resort; these safeguards are also reflected in NICE's clinical guidance on eating disorders.

The governing principle is not "If I am convinced, I may impose the truth." Truth is the judge, but no individual is identical with truth. Strong intervention requires correspondingly strong and corrigible grounds.

Love also governs method. The neighbour is not material to be reprogrammed. Even justified intervention should prefer explanation before deception, accompaniment before coercion, proportionate means, preservation of dignity, and restoration of independent judgment.

22. Epistemic emancipation and MCIP

Epistemic emancipation is lifting. It is the practical process by which a full first-order capture is unbraided at the point where inherited concrete answers are treated as final and rebraided as a full lifted capture. Testimony, authorities, institutions, and first-order beliefs need not disappear. Religious, professional, familial, political, and local material may remain as compatible strands, inputs, or current outputs, but its authority is now determined by the installed answer-generating rules.

The successor weave binds people to a generator: rules for deciding who may make a rule, what evidence an answer must survive, how a general rule applies to a case, who may challenge the result, and how an error is revised. This is still complete capture. The lifted order may govern universally at its own level while generating different first-order answers and bounded jurisdictions for people, offices, professions, institutions, communities, and contracting parties. Corrigibility is a separate axis: a lifted generator remains open only while its rules and authorized outputs remain answerable to reality and to its own correction procedures.

```
FULL FIRST-ORDER CAPTURE
shared concrete rules and answers are binding as such
                              ↓
UNBRAID THE FINALITY OF THOSE CONCRETE ANSWERS
                              ↓
REBRAID A SHARED GENERATOR
fixed M + current K_t + situation C
                              ↓
FULL LIFTED CAPTURE
```

```
the shared generator produces binding R_t(C), including changing
answers and, where relevant, bounded first-order jurisdictions
```

Emancipation therefore does not install a second bigOther, empty the slot, or weaken its occupancy. Counter-relations, plural institutions, reality contact, and practical support help the main processor inspect the one installed weave, protect or repair sound bindings, unbraid false or overreaching ones, and make a reality-responsive reconstruction survivable. A rival successor is not pathological merely because it replaces the incumbent. It becomes a failed emancipation when it is closed or uncorrectable, monopolizes interpretation, exceeds its constituted jurisdiction, or turns lifted terms into inquiry-terminating master signifiers.

The person is usually bound by more than a false proposition. The binding structure can include:

- collective identity and belonging;
- master signifiers and sacred values;
- trusted institutions and authorized channels;
- rituals of mutual confirmation;
- fear of uncertainty;
- shame or sanctions attached to doubt;
- material, relational, or professional dependence;
- lack of an alternative community in which reconsideration is survivable.

For this reason, fact correction alone often fails. It attacks one output while leaving the trust architecture, social reinforcement, and identity investment intact.

MCIP—**Mirror → Cut → Invite → Promise**—is a proposed conversational method for making difficult truths psychologically digestible while returning epistemic authorship. It is a new synthetic mnemonic, not an established method under that name. Its elements have family resemblances to **Carl Rogers and Richard Farson's** active listening, **William R. Miller and Stephen Rollnick's** motivational interviewing, **J. L. Austin's** account of speech acts and promises, and Lacanian uses of the *cut*. MCIP is not presented by any of those authors, and its four steps should not be treated as an authorized restatement of their methods.

The fitted guided-unbraiding proposal uses the contrastive diagnostic as one possible selector for an MCIP pass and tests whether the auditor function transfers to the person. This does not make every MCIP conversation de-radicalization, make MCIP a validated treatment, or remove the method's radicalizing mirror.

1. **Mirror:** Recognize the person's felt reality, value, fear, concern, or legitimate grievance without automatically affirming the associated factual claim.
2. **Cut:** Introduce one precise discrepancy, contradiction, failed prediction, hidden assumption, or concrete reality check. Cut the protected connection, not the person's dignity.
3. **Invite:** Ask the person to perform the next epistemic operation: formulate the claim, identify a counterexample, make a prediction, compare sources, calculate, or state what could change their confidence.
4. **Promise:** Anchor the opening in a small verification step, shared commitment, practical support, or relationship that makes continued inquiry possible.

The sequence is:

```
Mirror lowers identity threat
        ↓
Cut interrupts the protected narrative or automatic S1 → S2 sequence
        ↓
Invite returns authorship and leaves the uncertainty gap open
        ↓
Promise turns reflection into action and makes independence survivable
```

Scaffolding courage without appropriating judgment MCIP contains a central authorship paradox. If the intervener supplies the final answer and promises innocence through obedience, the method reproduces the instrumental relation it is meant to loosen. If the person receives no relational, practical, material, or social support, however, independence can become a demand for continuous heroism that few people can sustain. The project-developed compression is:

> **Ethics cannot be outsourced, but courage can be scaffolded.**

The corresponding design rule is:

Support the cost without appropriating the judgment.

The *Promise* may therefore help bear the cost of inquiry, dissent, practice, temporary incompetence, or repair. It must not decide in advance what the person is required to conclude, demand confession or agreement as the price of belonging, or turn practical dependence into surrogate ownership. Its practical grammar is:

- reasons without guarantees;
- exemplars without idols;
- belonging without compulsory conformity;
- obligations consciously assumed rather than used as alibis;
- practice without ideological drilling;
- correction without humiliation; and
- support without surrogate ownership.

The developmental form of that support is a **secure base**, not an **avoidance enclosure**. A secure base preserves belonging while enabling manageable disagreement, exploration, recovery, and renewed engagement. An avoidance enclosure treats alarm as proof of danger and repeatedly removes the challenge before mastery or corrective experience occurs:

```
secure support + manageable reality contact
→ engagement, repair, competence, and wider independence

discomfort classified as danger + withdrawal brings relief
→ avoidance reinforced + no corrective experience
→ narrower tolerable inquiry and greater dependency
```

A review of threat-related safety behaviours supports the narrower claim that avoidance and safety behaviour can maintain anxiety by preventing corrective learning. Observational research on manageable adversity and later resilience supplies a neighbouring, non-deterministic comparison. Neither finding establishes that every protected space lowers resilience or that distress should be deliberately manufactured; they support testing longitudinal expansion or contraction of tolerable inquiry rather than inferring development from the label *safe*.

The discriminator is longitudinal: does the person's radius of tolerable inquiry, disagreement, frustration, and independent action expand or contract? This does not authorize deliberate overwhelming or manufactured suffering. Children and other dependent learners require age-appropriate challenge joined to context, regulation, trustworthy support, practical skill, recovery, and progressively wider independence. Support becomes answer installation when care, belonging, or relief is made conditional upon reaching the authority's preferred conclusion. Lukianoff and Haidt's critique of safetyism is a neighbouring developmental argument; the secure-base–avoidance-enclosure distinction and its semantic- access test are Culture Mechanics formulations rather than their terminology.

Do not try to make the ethical act psychologically effortless. Make its first step small, its purpose meaningful, its effort shared, its exemplars visible, its feedback real, its completion possible, its correction honourable, and its social cost survivable.

These are Culture Mechanics formation principles, not propositions attributed to Lacan, Rogers, Miller, Rollnick, Austin, or Avery. At the conversational scale MCIP can recover one act of authorship. At the formation scale, affective return to uphill development can make repeated responsible action inhabitable. At the institutional scale, jurisdiction, plural support, appeal, exit, correction, and repair must prevent the scaffold from becoming a new custodian. None of the three scales substitutes for the others.

Full speech, empty speech, obligation, and responsibility Lacan's contrast between **empty speech** (*parole vide*) and **full speech** (*parole pleine*) supplies a further agency test. Lacan develops the distinction in "The Function and Field of Speech and Language in Psychoanalysis". In its psychoanalytic setting, full speech concerns the subject's truth becoming effective in speech, history, and recognition. The following translation into answerability is a bounded Culture Mechanics use, not a claim that Lacan formulated an administrative or civic doctrine of responsibility.

Empty speech is speech in which the speaker's divided position remains sheltered behind an available script. The sentence can be true, useful, polite, expert, or institutionally required while still leaving the speaker's judgment, uncertainty, stake, and undertaking unavailable:

```
ready-made signifier, role, procedure, passive voice, or presumed consensus
→ "what one says" speaks through the person
```

```
→ operative authority and the speaker's judgment remain obscure
→ no personally assumed claim, refusal, promise, or repair is available
```

Examples include “the science says,” “policy requires it,” “everyone knows,” or “mistakes were made” where the formula ends inquiry or removes the speaker from an answerable judgment. Empty speech is **not** a synonym for lying, small talk, formal language, obedience, brevity, or ideological disagreement. Conventional speech can maintain recognition and coordinate action. The agency problem begins where a borrowed formula substitutes for judgment precisely where a person or office must answer.

A more tightly closed local configuration is **closure-bound script-execution mode**: an input is reconstructed through programme categories, DCL generates an intelligent response inside them, the challenge is explained away, and the protected conclusion returns unchanged because no legitimate losing condition is available. The informal label **bot-mode** may name that demonstrated interface-level loop. It must not be converted into the noun *a bot* or *NPC*, which totalizes a local operation into a claim that no I, authorship, love, doubt, or possibility of return exists elsewhere in the human being. Fluency, repetition, refusal, error, or disagreement alone does not establish the mode. The constructive diagnostic is: **What evidence could make the answer being given lose?**

Full speech is speech through which the speaker becomes answerable. The speaker does not pretend that the big Other has completed and guaranteed the judgment:

```
the Other cannot supply a final guarantee
→ the speaker distinguishes observation, inference, value, uncertainty,
  choice, refusal, promise, and remaining constraint
→ the utterance can be answered, tested, remembered, refused, or held to account
→ a corrigible undertaking becomes possible
```

Full speech is not maximal self-disclosure, emotional intensity, informality, confidence, sincerity as appearance, or a guarantee of truth or goodness. A speaker can fully assume a mistaken or destructive judgment. Conversely, concise and role-bound speech can be full when the speaker actually assumes it. The distinction describes a local relation among speaker, utterance, Other, and answerability; it is not a permanent classification of a person.

Christopher Avery’s Responsibility Process supplies a neighbouring contrast between **obligation** and **responsibility**. In the bounded use adopted here, obligation names the stance “I have to; the demand comes from outside,” whereas responsibility names “I choose my available response and will answer for what follows.” Responsibility does not mean that the person caused, controls, or deserves blame for everything. It means that the person does not surrender authorship of the response that remains theirs.

The following alignment is a **Culture Mechanics synthesis**, not a combined theory attributable to Lacan or Avery:

```
obligation used as an alibi
→ demand attributed to rule, role, office, Cause, or big Other
→ empty speech recites the mandate
→ procedural compliance can displace judgment and responsibility

obligation or undertaking consciously assumed
→ the Other's limits and the speaker's constraints are acknowledged
→ full speech states judgment, uncertainty, stake, and commitment
→ responsibility for the available response is assumed
→ words can become a corrigible act
```

The pairing is neither identity nor moral rank. External obligations can be legitimate, and full speech can assume them: “I promised, and I choose to keep the promise.” First-person responsibility language can remain empty when it is a closure formula followed by no answer, changed conduct, or repair. The empirical question is where judgment and consequence are actually located.

This gives MCIP a reciprocal constraint:

> **Use full speech to invite full speech; do not answer one borrowed script with another.**

The intervener should own the Cut as a situated interpretation, distinguish observation from inference and verdict, name what would correct it, and make only a promise they can keep. The Invite should let the other person state a real judgment, uncertainty, refusal, or undertaking without requiring confession or agreement. The recipient may speak fully and retain the original conclusion. Full speech cannot be extracted by humiliation, forced disclosure, or a demand that the recipient repeat the intervener’s preferred counter-braid.

At institutional scale, the right to utter a correction does not ensure that an authorized receiver records, answers, adjudicates, or acts upon it. *Epistemic Constitution* calls that receiving-side failure **correction nullification**. Full speech can therefore remain a dead letter where no answerable office or procedure can convert it into operative correction. This does not make the speaker automatically right; it requires independent testing of the claim and keeps speaker answerability separate from institutional uptake.

At large scale, MCIP would need to be a **fractal social practice**, not one broadcast designed to convert a population. Many relationships, communities, media encounters, and institutions would have to create protected doubts, precise reality contacts, opportunities for personal verification, and credible alternatives to abandonment.

Its population-level function would be controlled **de-synchronization**:

- Mirror separates members' dignity and legitimate experience from the authority's interpretation.
- Cut interrupts the institution's monopoly on meaning with a concrete failure or discrepancy.
- Invite creates protected spaces for uncertainty, investigation, dissent, and plural expertise.
- Promise supplies the relationships and material conditions required to question without losing one's whole world.

The danger is that large-scale "liberation" becomes **closed or uncorrectable successor culture mechanics**. Replacement culture mechanics is unavoidable under single-slot exclusivity; pathological closure is not. Mirror can become calculated identification, Cut can become destabilization, Invite can become guided discovery toward a fixed doctrine, and Promise can become initiation into a new mechanically solidary group. MCIP is agency-supporting only when its Cut is reality-answerable, its Invite is genuinely open, and the persuader's own model remains corrigible.

23. Safeguards for persons, institutions, and cultures

No safeguard abolishes dependence or error. The objective is to preserve multiple routes of correction.

Personal safeguards

- **Cheap-check rule:** When a decisive source, count, observation, or elementary calculation is readily available, perform it before delegating the question.
- **Authorization–evidence distinction:** Ask whether confidence comes from the evidence, the institutional signature, or both.
- **Prediction record:** State what the model expects before the outcome is known.
- **Defeater question:** Ask what observation would reduce confidence or change the conclusion.
- **Source-chain audit:** Determine whether apparently independent authorities ultimately rely on one source.
- **Domain check:** Ask whether the trusted person's competence actually covers the present claim.
- **Symmetry check:** Consider whether identical evidence would be judged differently under rival branding.
- **Gap tolerance:** Practice leaving uncertainty unresolved rather than filling it immediately with an authorized S1.

Institutional safeguards These bounded jurisdictions are constituted by universally binding lifted rules; their plurality does not localize the meta-order that makes their limits, interaction, appeal, and correction authoritative.

- explicit jurisdiction and domain limits;
- transparent evidence, methods, uncertainty, financial and nonfinancial relationships, and participation in selecting or constructing the message;
- traceable provenance from the originating objective, evidence, or content through each selection, translation, and local implementation;
- visible correction and retraction procedures;
- institutional separation and genuinely independent review;
- review of whether apparently plural authorities depend upon one sponsor, evidence package, platform, appointment network, or communication source;
- explicit distinction between human carriers and the Culture Program carrying structure that supplies finance, formation, amplification, coordination, protection, succession, or operational capability;
- the Self-Attribution Presumption and Self-Description Valence Asymmetry: give an authenticated, serious adverse self-attribution first-pass credence as evidence of the actor's own operative allegiance or perceived authorization; record favourable self-description as an advertised ideal but do not let it exculpate installed operation, offspring, consequences, or failed correction;

- the Attribution-Source Asymmetry: do not treat an enemy's "Nazi," "cult," or "Cultural WMD" label as if the target had self-attributed it; preserve the allegation, demand independent target evidence, and test projection only with evidence about the accuser's corresponding conduct or intention;
- one credible high-severity proclamation may trigger evidence preservation, transparent carrying-structure mapping, and governance safeguards, but person-directed accusation or sanction requires evidence of that person's conduct and ordinary due process;
- protection for internal dissent and whistleblowing;
- access to data and methods where safety and privacy permit;
- public records of predictions, failures, and learning;
- correction propagation through the same cascade that carried the original claim;
- succession rules that make a trusted person or office replaceable without epistemic collapse;
- distinction between coordinating action and certifying factual truth.

Cultural safeguards

- dignity of persons independent of their current correctness;
- public honour for correction and principled dissent;
- moral permission to ask elementary questions;
- plural external affiliations and practical rights of exit that make inspection, defence, repair, or reality-responsive reconstruction of the one installed weave survivable;
- resistance to a single institution becoming the exclusive voice of the distributed bigOther;
- refusal to mistake a counterfield or rival institution for a second local bigOther: it can support or contest the installed lens, not co-occupy its PCI slot;
- shared commitment to justice, tolerance, human rights, jurisdiction, and correction as a universally binding open meta-program rather than an excuse to terminate inquiry;
- piety toward the real as the final norm of model correction.

An agency-supporting culture does not teach people to trust nobody. It teaches them **how to trust without surrendering the possibility of correction**.

The infrastructure-directed intervention protocol is defined in *Culture Program Ecology*. Its Self-Attribution Presumption means first credence and then discrimination: it does not make self-report infallible or convert the reported cosmology into fact. Its Attribution-Source Asymmetry denies that presumption to hostile labels applied to someone else. It does not authorize institutions to evade person-level protections by redescribing indirect burdens on association, worship, employment, education, property, or speech as action against "mere infrastructure."

24. Diagnostic questions

The following questions help identify the configuration without assuming in advance that dependence is pathological:

1. Who or what is recognized as entitled to certify reality in this domain?
2. Is that authority personal, role-based, institutional, professional, distributed, or symbolic?
3. What originally established the authority's trust, and does its current record sustain it?
4. Does the authority expose evidence and method, or primarily display authorization?
5. What would count as a defeater, and who is permitted to present one?
6. Are apparently plural sources genuinely independent?
7. Is authority limited to its proper domain, or has it spilled into coordination, morality, identity, and total interpretation?
8. Would the same evidence receive the same weight under different institutional branding?
9. Are inexpensive direct checks welcomed, ignored, or socially punished?
10. Does disagreement produce curiosity, or shame, fear, exclusion, and accusations of disloyalty?
11. Can the institution acknowledge error without losing its identity and legitimacy?
12. Can the person doubt or exit without losing every source of belonging and support?
13. Does a master signifier organize a concrete inquiry or terminate it?
14. Which causal story assigns blame, victimhood, responsibility, and remedy, and what alternatives has it hidden?
15. Does the resulting model make risky predictions that reality can prove wrong?
16. Which signals are local outputs, which belong to the shared symbolic protocol, and which patterns exist only at field level?
17. Is the audience arranged in a privileged authority-addressed topology, and would the same message have the same effect through a peer channel?

18. Do participants merely hear the same message, or do they know that others hear it and observe one another's response?
19. Does a putative multi-mind-self preserve memory, judgment, intention, and care through turnover, or does apparent unity disappear with one leader?
20. Is "shared ownership" only legal title or incentive alignment, or does one continuing collective perspective organize perception and action?
21. Does shared binding force reside in concrete rules and answers or in the rules that generate, select, apply, and revise them, and does that first-order or lifted weave fully occupy the single slot?
22. Does a universal lifted rule allocate and limit the authority at issue, or has a person, office, profession, institution, or community exceeded that allocated jurisdiction?
23. Can the meta-order and its authorized interpreters be corrected and succeeded, or do they claim that their certification determines what reality may be?
24. If a person or authorized role carries the trusted-opinion-leader function, what is its profile—repeater gain, authority bases, routing and translation, chief-facing mediation, field feedback, jurisdiction, independence, and corrigibility?
25. Was the leader or other authority carrier recognized by the receiving field, formally appointed, externally amplified, deliberately cultivated, algorithmically elevated, or some hybrid?
26. How did the claim change as it moved from source to expert interpretation, recommendation, local shorthand, visible adoption, and institutional rule?
27. Do several trusted speakers represent independent convergence or one source repeated through multiple authenticated faces?
28. Can a correction travel back through every level of the cascade with enough visibility to repair the original field effect?
29. When two inherited authorities conflict over the same act, which one has final interpretive priority, or does a third rule govern both?
30. Are apparently dual commitments both independently affectively alive and final, or is one camouflage, retained material, contextual output, or an incompletely replaced remainder?
31. In a putative blood-feud system, who owns the injury, selects an eligible retaliator and target, receives compensation, remembers the debt, and may end it?
32. Does substitution among kin express one continuing corporate subject, or can deterrence, reputation, coalition incentives, honour norms, and weak public adjudication explain the pattern without collective agency?
33. What complete model was the intended recipient expected to reconstruct from the message, which codebook and omissions made that reconstruction likely, and what did different recipients actually infer?
34. What authorization payload follows from the causal story–which power over whom, in which jurisdiction, for how long, under what oversight, and subject to which termination evidence?
35. Did accepting an authority-endorsed formula provide measurable relief from uncertainty, public exposure, or responsibility, and did that relief reduce checking or decompression?
36. Would the candidate rule survive an exchange of names, affiliations, beneficiaries, burdens, and advantageous positions?
37. Which contextual differences remain relevant after the remove-the-me test, and are they applied symmetrically rather than used as private exceptions?
38. Does the allegedly universal output preserve each concrete person as an end, or make someone disposable as a summand in an aggregate or an organ of a collective subject?
39. Is the epistemic failure located in the general cultural or constitutional braid, a situated script, one enactment, an interface among scripts, or missing practical support?
40. For the active master signifier, what are the sacred referent, bearer, protected principal, unity topology, distributive grammar, custodian, outlier performance, completion rule, and trajectory?
41. Does Diversity remain nested within person-standing, supplement it through bounded recognition, or replace it with a preferred pattern as principal?
42. If the named beneficiary cannot authenticate its own interests, who constructed the proxy and who can independently contest, review, or replace the surrogate?
43. Does one custodian define the principal, metric, remedy, sacrifice, success, and appeal, or are those functions separated and answerable?

No single answer is decisive. The pattern matters.

25. Examples, cases, and boundary tests

This section is the example home for the first-order/lifted distinction across the theory family. The cases do not prove the framework. They make its classifications risky enough to criticize and test.

The diagnostic in concrete terms The two architectures can govern exactly the same subject:

```
FIRST-ORDER
the community shares R1, R2, R3 ... as the proper concrete answers

LIFTED
the community shares M as the proper way to produce an answer
M + current K_t + situation C → binding R_t(C)
```

The first question is therefore not "How abstract does the vocabulary sound?" or "How many rules are written down?" It is: **What must members share in order to recognize one another as properly formed—the concrete answer, or the generator that can produce and revise answers?**

Rule density nevertheless matters as evidence. Especially vivid first-order signatures include:

- detailed rules governing which foods may be eaten, by whom, when, and after which preparation;
- fixed rules for sex, menstruation, childbirth, corpses, bodily fluids, washing, and restoration after contact;
- prescribed clothing, hairstyles, greetings, seating orders, and forms of address for each status;
- fixed calendars of fasting, feasting, rest, mourning, and ritual observance;
- hereditary rules determining occupation, marriage eligibility, residence, and family duties; and
- craft rules prescribing the proper material, tool, gesture, and sequence rather than a result to be demonstrated.

Religions and cultures organized around many such rules are often first-order, especially when a *beseelte* person follows them without external enforcement because they feel intrinsically clean, decent, honourable, or human. That proposed association is a falsifiable hypothesis; it is not a measured correlation coefficient. Conversely, a legal or scientific corpus can be enormous while solidarity remains lifted if the common binding rule is the rule that generates and corrects its current contents.

Central case: bodily regulation and scientific hygiene Calling one side "purity" and the other "hygiene" would miss the mechanism. Both are rulesets governing bodies, substances, contact, and cleaning. They differ in where the fixed binding rule resides.

Several religious orders make the concrete answer itself morally binding. The Qur'an's ablution instruction, for example, specifies washing the face and forearms, wiping the head, washing the feet, and a clean-earth alternative under stated conditions. Mishnah Shabbat 7:2 enumerates thirty-nine primary categories of prohibited Sabbath labour, while an Orthodox Union explanation shows how concrete derivative rules are applied; the same organization's account of *niddah* describes menstrual separation, examination, clean days, and immersion. These are not merely private hygiene preferences. They classify proper conduct and membership through concrete answers.

The anthropological case is equally direct. Richard Shweder, Manamohan Mahapatra, and Joan Miller's cross-cultural study of moral development in orthodox Hindu Bhubaneswar examined Brahman and so-called "Untouchable" children and adults alongside a Hyde Park comparison group. Jonathan Haidt's 1992 dissertation summarizes how food, sex-role, and clothing violations in the Bhubaneswar material were treated as universal moral obligations rather than mere conventions. The present theory classifies that studied Brahmanical milieu as predominantly first-order mechanical solidarity: numerous concrete rules and answers carried the shared moral force.

Scientific hygiene uses the same subject matter with a different architecture. Its fixed rule is roughly: identify a causal hazard using the best available evidence, test which intervention changes transmission or harm, apply the result to the present situation, and revise it when the evidence changes. The output is not fixed in advance. Current WHO hand-hygiene guidance recommends cleaning both hands with plain soap and water at specified moments and permits sufficiently concentrated alcohol rub under particular conditions. WHO treats menstruation as a natural bodily process requiring health, water, sanitation, and freedom from stigma, and explains that dead bodies after natural disasters generally do not cause epidemics, while identifying specific infectious-disease, water-contamination, and handler risks. The concrete precautions differ because the same evidence-generating rule is being applied to different causal conditions.

The contrast can therefore be stated without changing labels:

First-order bodily regulation shares the concrete answer: this contact, hand, substance, interval, or washing sequence is proper. Lifted scientific hygiene shares the generator: determine the actual hazard and let current evidence select the precaution.

Whole traditions as testable classifications The framework need not retreat from classifying an entire religion or communal tradition. It must, however, specify the historical and institutional object and say what would falsify the classification.

Scoped project hypothesis	Observable reason for the classification	What would weaken or reverse it
Orthodox Judaism is predominantly first-order mechanical solidarity.	Everyday religious formation shares a large corpus of concrete answers about Sabbath conduct, food, bodily states, time, and communal practice.	Evidence that ordinary solidarity primarily binds adherents to an answer-generating procedure whose concrete outputs are expected to change with new inputs.
Classical, fiqh-centred Islam is predominantly first-order mechanical solidarity.	Revealed and juristic prescriptions govern concrete acts such as ablution, fasting, food, and inheritance as religiously proper answers.	Evidence that the tradition's ordinary shared binding force lies principally in a revisable generator rather than in those substantive answers.
The Brahmanical Hindu milieu studied in Bhubaneswar was predominantly first-order.	Food, bodily, clothing, sex-role, and status rules were treated as objective moral obligations.	Reanalysis showing that participants shared a rule-generating method while accepting materially different outputs as equally proper.
Old Order Amish Christianity is predominantly first-order.	The Young Center's account of the *Ordnung* describes district-specific, often unwritten rules governing dress, technology, education, leisure, transport, and discipline, embodied through baptismal commitment and everyday practice.	Evidence that communal recognition normally attaches to a common generator rather than conformity to the district's current concrete *Ordnung*.
Pauline Christianity contains a decisive lifted transition.	Romans 14 permits different answers about food and days while making faithfulness, conscience, peace, and the effect on the neighbour governing considerations; 1 Corinthians 8 similarly subjects liberty about food to its effect on another.	Evidence that the apparently generative considerations merely conceal one fixed set of concrete answers, or cannot authorize divergent outputs in practice.
Quaker Christianity is predominantly lifted in its collective decision architecture.	Quaker Faith & Practice makes disciplined discernment and the revisable "sense of the meeting," recorded by the clerk amid differing convictions, the binding procedure rather than voting on a predetermined answer.	Evidence that the procedure cannot generate genuinely different answers or that conformity to a fixed substantive catalogue supplies the real communal bond.

These are classifications proposed by culture mechanics, not conclusions asserted by the cited traditions or already established by one observation. "Predominantly" allows mixed subsystems without making the hypothesis immune to failure. The Amish case is a useful hard test: an *Ordnung* can be updated as technologies and local issues arise without thereby becoming lifted. The decisive question is whether members are bound together chiefly by the updating generator or by the concrete *Ordnung* it currently produces.

Rabbinic Judaism supplies the inverse hard case. A religion classified as predominantly first-order can contain a lifted subsystem. The "oven of Akhnai" discussion in Bava Metzia 59b locates a legal decision in an authorized human process of textual argument and majority decision rather than in a heavenly intervention. That decision procedure can generate a concrete ruling not fixed by the immediate facts alone. Its presence does not automatically determine where the wider religion's ordinary mechanical solidarity resides.

Further concrete lifted generators Lifted rules are not vague lists of admirable nouns. They are procedures that can be followed and can return a result:

Domain	Fixed generator	Changing first-order output
Political succession	The Catholic Church's conclave constitution, as amended in 2013, fixes electors, scrutiny, required majority, secrecy, and acceptance rules.	Which eligible person becomes pope cannot be listed in advance; the procedure generates the officeholder. Its procedural detail shows why "many rules" is evidence, not a definition, of first-order solidarity.
Contracts	German Civil Code §535 supplies the legal form of a tenancy and makes the parties' agreement legally productive.	The premises, rent, duration, and resulting duties differ with the contract's inputs while being recognized through the same legal generator.
Markets	The EUPHEMIA day-ahead market-coupling algorithm applies common optimization and constraint rules to submitted orders.	Market-clearing prices and allocations are generated anew for each bidding zone and delivery period.
Technical safety	NIST's performance-based structural-fire work develops validated models, experiments, and performance criteria rather than prescribing one material and construction sequence for every building.	Different structures, materials, and protective designs can qualify when current evidence shows that they meet the shared performance requirement.
Scientific knowledge	Inquiry binds participants to observation, reproducibility, causal comparison, criticism, and revision rather than to a protected conclusion.	Barry Marshall and Robin Warren's evidence for *Helicobacter pylori* changed the accepted account and treatment of gastritis and peptic ulcer, as summarized by the 2005 Nobel Prize press release. The changed answer is evidence that the corrective generator outranked the old answer.
Religious adjudication	Rabbinic textual argument and majority decision can operate as an authorized decision generator.	The ruling in a new dispute is an output of that procedure even within a wider religious order that may remain predominantly first-order.

Markets and contracts make the logic especially visible. The shared rule is not a single price or promise. It is the rule by which present bids generate a price or present consent generates an obligation. A first-order craft order, by contrast, can prescribe the proper material, tool, gesture, and sequence because fidelity to that concrete answer is itself the mark of good workmanship. A lifted performance order fixes how safety or quality must be demonstrated and permits the qualifying technology to change.

Boundary rules and falsifiers

1. **Detail is a strong indicator, not the essence.** Thirty-nine named categories, a district *Ordnung*, or an elaborate washing sequence strongly suggests first-order solidarity when the answers are followed as self-compulsorily proper. An elaborate election or market algorithm shows that a generator can also be detailed.
2. **Fewness is not the essence of lifting.** Generative compression is common because one rule can yield many outputs, but a short sacred command can remain first-order and a lifted constitution can fill volumes.
3. **Revision is not sufficient.** First-order rules can be extended, interpreted, or periodically updated. Ask whether the community treats the procedure or the resulting concrete rule as the primary shared obligation.
4. **Pluralism is not sufficient.** A lifted generator can produce plural outputs, but it can also generate one uniform answer. First-order plurality across subcultures does not itself create lifted solidarity.

5. **Corrigibility is independent.** A first-order order can respond to reality, and a lifted generator can be closed: "whatever the authorized body declares" is a second-order rule even when no evidence may correct it.
6. **The single slot remains single.** Meta-rules, current knowledge, and generated answers are layers of one weave. Lifting does not install a second evaluator above a first bigOther.

Dual religious identification and the converso hard case "I am both Christian and Jewish" does not by itself establish two independently operative bigOthers. In a person exposed to conversion, persecution, family memory, secrecy, and mixed practice, the same self-description is compatible with several architectures:

1. **Strategic camouflage:** one operative weave plus outward conduct required for safety or standing.
2. **Incumbent reinterpretation:** one tradition supplies final interpretive priority while retaining material from the other.
3. **Inverse reinterpretation:** the other tradition governs the same retained material.
4. **Syncretic successor:** selected strands from both have been rebraided into one new governing programme.
5. **Ponerogenic capture:** an organized power preserves inherited legitimacy while deforming sacred language to conceal domination; mixture alone does not establish this diagnosis.
6. **Liminal instability:** unbraiding and rebraiding remain incomplete, producing oscillation, contradiction, and guilt without a stable successor.
7. **Genuine dual evaluator:** two incompatible authorities remain independently final over the same conduct without hierarchy, reinterpretation, contextual division, or a third governing rule.

Only the seventh configuration directly challenges strict single-slot exclusivity. The test is not the identity label but the update path: Which authority determines what a retained symbol, obligation, or transgression means? Which can produce guilt, authorize correction, or veto the other? Can either be revised without permission from the other or from a third rule? Do those relations remain stable across years and same-domain conflicts?

The neutral descriptions are **integration**, **reinterpretation**, **rebraiding**, and **successor formation**. Use *capture* only when evidence shows an actor or organized power, a foreign operative purpose, retained inherited legitimacy, semantic deformation, dependency or domination, and concealment. Under persecution, outward ritual and public avowal are especially weak evidence of the operative architecture. This case is a theory-generated hard test, not a general historical classification of conversos.

Blood feud as a corporate-subject hard case The originating Culture Mechanics proposition is:

> **Blood feud is war between clan multi-mind-selves: biological persons are identifiable actors and responsible participants, but the clan may operate as the owner of injury, debt, retaliation, compensation, settlement, and memory.**

This is a **conditional application hypothesis**, not the definition of every feud. Karen Paige Ericksen and Heather Horton's cross-cultural study of kin-group vengeance records cases in which the duty to avenge and liability for an offense extend through kin, including substitution of a perpetrator's relative as a target. Max Gluckman's "The Peace in the Feud" treats feud as a rule-governed relation embedded in wider, cross-cutting allegiances rather than uncontrolled serial anger. These sources support examining corporate implication; they do not establish the Culture Mechanics multi-mind-self.

The stronger classification gains support where the evidence shows:

- an injury to one member is authoritatively owned as an injury to the kin group;
- another member may retaliate as the group's organ and another member of the opposing group may stand as an eligible target;
- the debt, honour, or claim persists across biological turnover;
- compensation is collected, paid, or refused corporately;
- refusal to perform the inherited obligation attracts group sanctions;
- and recognized collective procedures can remember, transfer, settle, or terminate the relation.

The diagram is therefore:

```
member of Clan A harms member of Clan B
                    ↓
Clan B owns and remembers the injury
                    ↓
authorized member of B acts against an eligible bearer of A
                    ↓
```

```
Clan A owns the new injury
                         ↻
```

Substitution among persons is especially probative because it suggests that the operative juridical unit has shifted from the individual act to the continuing group relation. It is not decisive. Kin selection, mutual protection, deterrence, reputation, honour, material competition, marriage bargains, and weak state capacity can produce similar conduct. The multi-mind-self classification should be weakened or rejected where only the original wrongdoer is liable, no continuing collective perspective owns the debt, compensation and settlement remain individual, and group-level prediction adds nothing beyond those alternatives.

The case also illustrates **subjecthood absorption** only when a member lacks legitimate standing to refuse the inherited blood-and-honour jurisdiction. A corporate procedure that preserves personal innocence, appeal, compensation, exit, and public adjudication may form a collective agent without fusion. Giuseppe Dari-Mattiacci and Nuno Garoupa model the historical transition from communal liability to individual responsibility and public enforcement. Their economic explanation is a neighbouring alternative, not evidence that exogamy caused the transition or that clans are literally collective minds.

Teacher and classroom A teacher legitimately possesses coordination authority, normative authority over classroom procedure, and domain-specific epistemic authority. Agency is supported when the teacher shows methods, welcomes checks, admits mistakes, and trains pupils to reproduce the reasoning. Authority-gating occurs when "the teacher says so" replaces an available calculation and questioning is treated as misconduct.

Unknown institutional spokesperson Millions of citizens may trust a spokesperson whom none knows personally because the office, credential, channel, and institution authenticate the speech. This can be rational delegated knowledge. It becomes institution-gated when the same evidence is rejected without the institutional signature, when the institution's claim cannot be independently defeated in principle, or when the spokesperson's authority extends beyond the institution's actual jurisdiction.

Political causal story A public condition is narrated as the product of a chosen culprit, a defined victim, and a remedy administered by the institution already seeking greater authority. The story may be correct, partly correct, or strategically distorted. Epistemic agency requires comparison with alternative causal models, omitted variables, base rates, predicted consequences, and the institution's incentives—not automatic rejection merely because the story is political.

Moralized citizen-sensor and internal observer A reporting mythology can offer the citizen a morally creditable sensor role: notice the incident, classify it, preserve it, and transmit it to an authorized custodian. This role can be indispensable where victims lack direct access to institutions or evidence would otherwise disappear. It supports epistemic agency when the reporter may preserve uncertainty, attach evidence, distinguish direct observation from inference, correct a submission, and learn how the report was adjudicated.

The same interface can impair agency when reporting itself becomes a visible proof of virtue while restraint, doubt, contextualization, or criticism of the intake system becomes morally suspect. A thank-you message, badge, campaign formula, social approval, professional expectation, or institutional acknowledgement can reward the carrier before the reported claim is verified. That reward does not make the report false. It changes the incentive and identity environment in which observations are selected and expressed.

At population scale, citizens can thereby become **distributed moralized sensors**. They need not share a central plan, and the portal operator need not direct each report. Common category prompts, moral roles, examples, and expected responses can nevertheless align what is noticed and transmitted. Aggregate volume then risks being mistaken for independent corroboration even when reports, media stories, and public reactions share one campaign, dataset, wire source, or classification rule. Source-lineage and dependency analysis are therefore part of the agency audit.

A preserved fragment can also arrive with an **affective and action instruction**: a caption supplies the culprit category, the expected indignation, and the demand to share, mark, report, or contact an institution before the recipient has sought the complete context. Engagement-based amplification may then select the high-arousal package for further visibility. This is an application of audience-modelled reconstruction: the recipient reconstructs a larger moral and factual scene from a compressed, preclassified packet. Visibility and emotional convergence establish neither context, source independence, truth, nor proportional remedy; algorithmic amplification likewise establishes no platform intention without further evidence.

This distribution is also a **reach multiplier**. A public or private power need not observe every setting directly if participants preserve, forward, publicize, or route selected conduct to an authority. The distributed network may be vastly larger than the staff that receives its reports, while the receiving institution supplies durable memory and possible consequence. The mechanism requires neither an omniscient centre nor a continuously observing officer; a credible and uncertain possibility of observation can affect conduct before any report is made.

The channel can also let a participant recruit third-party power into a private conflict. Concern, mistake, resentment, rivalry, revenge, identity performance, and mixed motives may produce outwardly identical submissions. Role language cannot identify which motive governed, and motive alone cannot determine whether the reported claim is true. An agency-preserving system therefore keeps reporter status, motive evidence, factual evidence, legal or institutional category, sanction, and target standing analytically separate. It must not reward an aligned reporter with automatic credibility or dismiss an adverse reporter solely by attributing a bad motive.

The observer can also become internal. If a person cannot know which neighbour, colleague, interlocutor, platform, or automated process may report an utterance, the anticipated third-party gaze can be carried locally as the **local bigOther**. The person may pre-screen lawful formulation before any explicit order or sanction occurs:

```
uncertain distributed observation
        → anticipated classification and report
        → anticipated institutional or social consequence
        → self-censorship or formulaic safe speech
```

This is a capability and chilling-effect hypothesis, not proof that every person is intimidated or that an operator intends cognitive capture. Evidence should test awareness, perceived reportability, category clarity, sanction probability, observed speech changes, correction experience, and available exit or appeal. The individual's own imaginative-conceptual inner eye remains distinct: it can narrow if some relations become difficult to formulate, but the local bigOther names the internalized observer, not that loss itself.

Legitimate crime reporting, whistleblowing, emergency signals, and good-faith complaints are not condemned by this model. The safeguard is to keep three acts separate: receiving an allegation, establishing a fact, and imposing or publicizing a consequential classification. Anonymity may protect the first; evidence and due process remain necessary for the latter two. The moral value of care for a possible victim neither licenses character assassination without proof nor removes the accused person's standing to receive an intelligible claim, answer it, and obtain independent adjudication where feasible.

Mythology Construction owns the complete role grammar; *Epistemic Constitution* owns the report-to-reality and ascertainment failures; and *Culture Program Ecology* owns institutional safeguards and the bounded worked example.

Counter-institutional capture A person recognizes genuine institutional failures and begins questioning official sources. They then adopt a counter-community whose master signifier—*Awakening* or *Hidden Truth*—classifies every institutional statement as deception and every counter-source as courageous. This is not yet cognitive liberty. The gate has changed direction, but source authorization still preempts symmetrical evaluation.

The failure is not that the source or community is rival. Rival institutions can provide necessary correction. The failure is that the successor gatekeepers become preemptive, classify their own authorization as sufficient, and disable symmetric evaluation and correction.

Repeater gain and crowd One prestigious speaker reaches a large audience because office, channel, and reputation amplify the signal. A crowd of individually weak transmitters can nevertheless produce equal or greater gain by repeating the phrase, displaying the same emotion, and making unanimity visible. The example distinguishes unequal node gain from aggregate field amplification. *Repeater* here names an amplification dimension, not a person-type alongside trusted opinion leader.

Trusted-opinion-leader-function carriers: medical KOL and social-media influencer A medical KOL may function as a trusted opinion leader by combining domain expertise, professional standing, institutional authorization, personal trust, interpretation of technical evidence, access to a common professional audience, and peer-network brokerage. A YouTube influencer may acquire the same broader position through attention, familiarity, perceived authenticity, identity fit, parasocial attachment, audience feedback, and platform amplification. A physician YouTuber may occupy both application-specific positions. The trusted-opinion-leader-function profile preserves the difference between

professional epistemic authority and audience intimacy while making their possible referral and transmission functions comparable.

Neither follower count nor academic rank establishes that a person is a trusted opinion leader. The case should be indexed by topic, audience, setting, channel, and time, and should trace how the leader was recognized or cultivated, what message entered, how it changed, what peers did with it, and whether apparently independent signals shared one source. The same profile can carry reliable knowledge or sponsor-shaped promotion; adoption does not decide which.

Cultural domain boundary Crossing from one region into another may reveal a sharp change in house forms, flower decoration, street care, or customs such as *Kehrwoche*. The magnetization analogy treats the boundary as a possible cultural domain wall maintained by dense local reinforcement. The visible contrast is an observation to be explained, not proof that all residents are synchronized or that geography caused the pattern.

Broadcast authority topology The *Volksempfänger* placed a distant authorized voice into many homes while listeners could understand themselves as members of one simultaneous audience. The culture-mechanical point is the replicated teacher-before-class geometry: common attention, common reception, authority, and narrative could converge. The historical example does not imply that the message succeeded uniformly.

Collective ownership Two assigned collaborators may coordinate without ever experiencing the task as *ours*. By contrast, a *Bahner* who protects the railway beyond the measured private task, a resident who treats common space as belonging to the civic *we*, or a Subak participant who maintains a continuing irrigation-ritual order illustrates the stronger unitary-owner hypothesis. Each remains a candidate explanation requiring comparison with incentives, habit, surveillance, and personal virtue.

26. Cross-references and branching concepts

Related term	Short semantic definition	Relation to epistemic agency under mechanical solidarity
Culture mechanics	Proposed framework beginning with homo duplex, the local bigOther, its mythological lens, and its coupling interface.	Supplies the individual source architecture from which the field account begins.
Lacan's big Other / shared symbolic protocol	The locus of language, law, and symbolic authority; functionally translated here as the on-the-wire protocol among local bigOthers.	Makes local classifications publicly intelligible without perfectly copying private states.
Epistemic dependence	Necessary reliance on other knowers and institutions.	The unavoidable starting condition, not itself a defect.
Personal epistemic authority	A trusted person's considered judgment functioning as evidence.	Healthy when competence is domain-limited and trust remains defeasible; preemptive when the person becomes a permissioning layer.
Epistemic vigilance	Monitoring communicated information for competence, honesty, coherence, and evidence.	Helps calibrate dependence without collapsing into gullibility or indiscriminate distrust.
Epistemic credulity	Insufficiently discriminating acceptance of communicated claims.	One possible disposition or failure mode; ordinary authority-gating is often selective rather than generalized.
Epistemic trust anchor	A person or institution whose authorization gives claims presumptive credibility.	Can provide rational delegation or become a preemptive reality-validation node.
Epistemic gatekeeper	A node that filters what a person admits as knowledge.	Names the personal, institutional, distributed, or symbolic routing structure.

Related term	Short semantic definition	Relation to epistemic agency under mechanical solidarity
Preemptive gatekeeper deference	Treating the gatekeeper's judgment as replacing rather than supplementing accessible evidence.	Marks the pathological transition from reliance to preemption.
Authority-gated belief updating	Updating primarily according to recognized authorization.	The central failure mechanism.
Asymmetric epistemic permeability	Unequal openness to evidence depending on its authorized route.	Explains how easy persuasion and difficult correction can coexist.
Role-conferred epistemic authority spillover	Transfer of authority from coordination, morality, care, or one knowledge domain into another.	Explains how formal offices acquire epistemic force they have not independently earned.
Pastoral epistemic authority	Epistemic trust grounded in guidance, care, protection, or personal interpretation.	Can support judgment or make surrender feel like safety.
Socialization into institutional trust	Learning which offices, credentials, institutions, and channels may certify reliable knowledge.	Installs the background trust architecture through which later claims are evaluated.
Lifted mechanical solidarity	Shared binding rules generate, select, apply, and revise concrete answers.	Explains how one full capture can produce changing outputs and can, as one application, constitute differentiated citizens, institutions, and jurisdictions.
Profitable-and-unobserved deviation counterfactual	Asks whether an impersonal obligation would still govern if detection, immediate sanction, and reputational consequence were credibly absent.	Conduct under genuinely low-observation conditions can discriminate an internalized governor from direct surveillance more strongly than hypothetical self-report, but does not isolate the local bigOther from habit, uncertainty, long-horizon interest, private conviction, or constraint.
Impersonal universality against private interest	Provisional bridge in which a candidate rule loses the privileged justificatory force of "because it is me or mine" and is tested under exchanged positions.	Shows one coarse formal similarity between Kantian universalization and Rousseauian generality without equating their person–collective architectures.
Remove-the-me test	Removes "because it is me, mine, or my group" as sufficient justification, exchanges the persons occupying the positions, and retains materially relevant context.	Supplies one possible lifted selection procedure; passing the test does not make a rule context-free, true, good, or person-preserving.
Durkheimian organic solidarity	Source concept of cohesion through specialization, function, and reciprocal interdependence.	Is preserved as Durkheim's category and analytically decomposed here into organic differentiation plus lifted mechanically solidary common binding force.
Organic differentiation	Specialized roles, knowledge, interfaces, handoffs, and reciprocal functional dependence.	Names the differentiated topology rather than a second Culture Mechanics solidarity mechanism.
bigOther	Culture-mechanical sentiment classifier linking symbolic order to felt legitimacy, shame, loyalty, and belonging.	Supplies the local source and receiver through which field authority becomes affectively operative.

Related term	Short semantic definition	Relation to epistemic agency under mechanical solidarity
Mechanical-solidarity field	Emergent coherence among compatible local bigOthers that acts back through expectations, sanctions, institutions, and apparent consensus.	Names the group effect within which epistemic agency is exercised.
Distributed bigOther	Dynamically maintained symbolic-affective network state reproduced by local bigOthers, institutions, roles, practices, and artifacts.	Turns individual signals and enforcement into a self-reinforcing social field with memory.
Functional morphology of mechanical solidarity	Whole-formation configuration joining population body, distributed trusted-opinion-leader function, common field, directing function, reciprocal coupling, and possible collective execution.	Names the complete social arrangement rather than isolating its chief, broadcaster, lattice, or field circuit.
Polity-scale *Gleichschaltung* hazard	Attempted cross-domain alignment of human carriers, symbolic and conformity-marker environments, and institutional-operational systems toward one privileged ideological direction.	Names a process-level warning before the resulting whole-polity morphology or Fascism conjunction is complete and before a complete Culture Program need be reconstructable; *Culture Program Ecology* is its primary semantic home.
bigOther-presence / bigOther-as-Thou	Project-developed terms for the field or symbolic authority locally encountered as an objectively present Other.	Names one phenomenological form of field back-action without identifying the experience with its whole mechanism.
Multi-mind-self presentation	The collective represented, perceived, addressed, or incarnated as one self.	Names self-like social presentation without yet classifying a collective agent.
Operative multi-mind-self / multi-mind-self proper	Distributed bigOther integrated enough to perceive, remember, judge, intend, own, and act with collective continuity.	Names a possible collective agent, not every crowd, presentation, or mechanically solidary field.
Fused multi-mind-self	Operative collective agent that additionally absorbs participating persons' independently legitimate authorship.	Names the conjunction of agency and fusion rather than treating either as sufficient for the other.
Unitary ownership by the operative multi-mind-self	One collective agent owns and cares through many *beseelte* persons.	Reinterprets successful "shared ownership" as collective-person ownership rather than fractional private psychology.
Privileged authority-addressed programming topology	A differentiated authority position addresses a comparatively uniform audience under common attention.	Proposed recurrent realization of the functional morphology that can heighten reception and synchronization.
Herrschaftsideologie	Privileged-vision mythology that converts claimed epistemic asymmetry into governing jurisdiction.	Names a possible pathological authorization of the elevated speaker position; hierarchy or expertise alone does not establish it. The primary semantic home is *Mythology Construction*.

Related term	Short semantic definition	Relation to epistemic agency under mechanical solidarity
Repeater gain	Network analogy for greater reach, credibility, frequency, connectivity, or institutional amplification.	Names the amplification dimension of the trusted-opinion-leader function, crowds, or infrastructure; it is not a separate social position.
Trusted-opinion-leader function / trusted opinion leader	Distributed receiving-field function to which members refer judgment, interpretation, or validation; a trusted opinion leader is its human person-in-role occupant.	Canonical function combining, in variable amounts, repeater gain, gatekeeping, authority, translation, modelling, brokerage, chief-facing mediation, representation, and feedback.
Directing-organ capture and pseudomorphic chief	A field-authorized directing function becomes answerable to an unmandated competing principal or governor; where retained chief-form, authority, correction control, and succession also satisfy the full PGS gate, the result is a pseudomorphic chief.	*Culture Program Ecology* owns the capture constructs; this document owns the distinction among feedback, directing, and implementation positions within the complete mechanical-solidarity morphology.
Pre-content source-routing position	Relational reception state in which a source, role, institution, topic, or source–topic combination is provisionally treated as trusted, questionable, uninteresting, or unwanted before adequate truth evaluation.	Connects socially operative trust and taboo to attention, checking, integration, neglect, and avoidance while keeping the received Bonelli fourfold, its unresolved source verification, and the project-developed position-transition programme distinct.
Distributed narrative-reproduction loop	Reproduction of expected narrative or affect, classification of another person's response, enforcement or reward, and witness updating that changes the next interaction.	Separates episodic reproducer, classifier, and enforcer functions without making them fixed person-types, proving falsehood, or collapsing proposition judgment into human standing.
Professional idea-mediator function / professional idea mediator	Source-side selection, translation, packaging, and circulation of ideas for audiences outside their originating or specialist domain; a professional idea mediator is its present human role occupant.	Can feed, overlap with, or remain separate from the receiving-side trusted-opinion-leader function; neither mediation nor prominence establishes trusted reception, competence, truth, or capture.
Prominence-derived apparent competence	Operative confidence on a question supplied by visibility, fluency, prestige, repeated access, moral seriousness, or demonstrated competence elsewhere without a correspondingly demonstrated competence relation for the present claim.	Identifies a possible authority-formation mechanism and domain mismatch; it is not a judgment that the speaker lacks all competence or that the claim is false.
Trusted-carrier correction lock	Gain-weighted morphology in which high-trust receiving-field positions remain sufficiently aligned to withhold distributed credibility, institutional reception, or operative force from a public correction despite growing ordinary dissent.	Possible implementation of correction nullification; neither carrier agreement nor the lock proves falsehood, coordination, capture, systemic lying, or Shadow-Sovereign rule.

Related term	Short semantic definition	Relation to epistemic agency under mechanical solidarity
Benda's *clerc*	Intellectual-vocation role normatively answerable to disinterested truth, reason, and justice.	Can carry the trusted-opinion-leader function and thereby gain privileged routing and cascade, but is not its synonym; neither classification establishes betrayal or capture.
Culture Program capture	Redirection of an incumbent Culture Program's authorities, metrics, appointments, correction routes, and reproduction machinery until they install or reproduce an incompatible successor.	Uses trusted leaders, offices, and authenticated channels as possible ingress and cascade mechanisms, but remains a distinct ecology-level hypothesis. System-level capture does not by itself identify a covert operational agent. The primary semantic home is *Culture Program Ecology*.
Master signifier / S1	Privileged signifier organizing identities and bodies of knowledge; translated here as a compressed protocol token.	Can select and activate the common interpretive mode; becomes pathological when it terminates inquiry.
Laser synchronization	Metaphor for dynamic alignment of attention, affect, interpretation, and action.	Describes how many local classifiers enter a coherent common mode.
Clockwork coordination	Project-developed analogy for differentiated contributions routed toward a common result.	Resembles organic differentiation within Durkheimian organic solidarity; it does not by itself supply the shared binding generator or prove social cohesion.
Ideological power	Michael Mann's category, adapted by Rainer Mausfeld for power over sense-making categories, interpretive contexts, and framing narratives.	Names a possible macro-level means of programming the interpretive and trust environment; this entry focuses more broadly on the subject-side mechanisms and their corrigibility.
Causal story	Narrative assigning cause, responsibility, victim, fixer, and remedy.	Political-scale mechanism for organizing the distributed bigOther and forming agendas.
Doctrinal-progeny test	Evaluation of a doctrine through the distribution and causal relations of its actual descendants.	Extends the agency audit from what recipients are told to what the doctrine, receiver architecture, interpreters, and institutions recurrently produce. The primary semantic home is *Mythology Construction*.
Classification-symmetry rule	Exchange program names, declared ideals, enemies, and conventional ideological families, then apply the same morphology, causality, offspring, consequence, and correction tests.	Prevents both doctrinal self-exemption and hostile enemy-label inflation. The strong Durkheimian accountability rule in *Mythology Construction* supplies its consequence-facing form.
Persuasion	Process of changing belief, evaluation, identity, or action.	Can restore or suppress agency depending on epistemic direction, reciprocity, and correction.

Related term	Short semantic definition	Relation to epistemic agency under mechanical solidarity
State transmission / operation transmission	Communication of a finished conclusion or result versus cues through which a recipient locally reconstructs relevant generating operations.	Their ordered complement is the operation-first decoder-bootstrap principle: operation-rich formation constructs and repairs the decoder that later compressed state communication exploits, without literally copying a mental state or operation.
Operation-bootstrapped codebook formation	Recurrent operation transmission constructs locally executable and sufficiently compatible reconstruction resources, enabling later compressed communication.	Supplies the dynamic precondition for audience-modelled reconstruction and compressed master-signifier activation; reconstruction reach, relevant overlap, fidelity, reality contact, and corrigibility matter more than raw vocabulary size.
Collective epistemic formation	Participation in a distributed social and material environment forms and revises locally executable concepts, distinctions, query paths, methods, inferential habits, and evidential standards.	Extends collective formation into the operations used by the rider or main CPU without turning the milieu into another processor or collapsing it into local-bigOther evaluation.
Distributed epistemic milieu	Dispersed environment of language, examples, practices, artifacts, records, instruments, institutions, trained persons, and correction procedures.	Carries resources across persons and generations while requiring local reconstruction; it is not one mental state, collective brain, distributed bigOther, or second bigOther.
Collar-conditioned semantic access	Proposed classification-conditioned influence upon rider-side conceptual selection, retrieval, joining, standing-query activation, binding, or articulation.	Extends the local blindness bridge without making the collar a reasoning processor, memory store, or direct rider interface; includes asymmetric addressability, suppression/hyperactivation symmetry, possible acquisition closure, and separately evidenced crisis–relief reindexing.
Perception-stage correction closure	Obstruction before a candidate relation can travel from noticing through formulation, comparison, public articulation, and collective testing.	Keeps penalty, occupation, and internal-classification routes distinct; public silence alone does not identify which route produced it.
Epistemic reindexing / collective reindexing	Restoration of plural, reality-answerable access paths in a person; public stabilization of a corrigible index through which independently observed anomalies can become mutually available.	Proposed corrective operations within guided unbraiding and public Noticing; neither predetermines the correct model nor turns repeated source-dependent agreement into independent confirmation.
Humanist-liberal counter-formation	Developmental, interpersonal, educational, and constitutional practices that enlarge conceptual access, reality contact, competence, independent judgment, and correction of formative authority while preserving human standing.	Normative synthesis of cognitive liberty, reindexing, secure-base learning, Noticing, foundational-question custody, refusal, appeal, exit, and succession—not a culture-free position or validated universal pedagogy.

Related term	Short semantic definition	Relation to epistemic agency under mechanical solidarity
Recognition-threshold management / public sleep	Ecology-level configuration in which recurrent observations remain below a stable private or public pattern judgment because indexing, joining, correction depth, or common knowledge remains insufficient or costly.	Separately owned by *Culture Program Ecology*; it can interact with person-level semantic gating, but neither mechanism is necessary or sufficient for the other and intent requires an additional gate.
Domain contact	Direct or mediated engagement that requires performance, observation, or mental replay of relevant operations and exposes interpretation or action to examples, resistance, consequences, counterexamples, and correction.	Explains how conceptual and practical discriminations become available for later symbolic addressing; proximity, exposure, membership, and fluent repetition are insufficient.
Living knowledge	Symbolic state joined to enough locally reconstructed experience, question, causal structure, practical competence, and correction capacity for recognition, novel application, explanation of limits, and revision.	Distinguishes reconstructible and corrigible capability from remembered information, fluent vocabulary, correct repetition, dead formula, and interpreter dependence.
Joint codebook formation	Recurrent, socially interpreted, consequence-bearing joint activity that acts upon a domain while co-forming participants' conceptual, causal, evaluative, role, and action codebooks.	Names the socially recursive subtype of domain contact without making every scientific, professional, civic, or educational instance into political praxis.
Practice-formed coordination capacity	Capacity produced through sufficient relevant joint formation for compressed communication, mutual prediction, situated judgment, differentiated roles, interfaces, handoffs, and repair.	Connects joint codebook formation to possible clockwork coordination and field back-action without treating overlap, participation, or coordination as a truth or legitimacy guarantee.
Socratic manipulation	Questions that simulate open inquiry while steering toward a preselected conclusion.	Shows why an autonomy-flavoured method is not automatically truth-directed.
Contaminated mindware	Learned rules or beliefs that impair rationality and may disable their own evaluation.	Supplies content and anti-correction rules that authority and identity can protect.
Motivated reasoning	Directional use of reasoning toward a preferred conclusion.	Often occurs downstream of identity, sentiment, or authority-gated classification.
Bonhoefferian Dummheit	Socially induced loss of inner independence despite intact intelligence.	Describes the person-level result of power-saturated, slogan-mediated capture of judgment.
Normopathic adaptation	Adaptation to a pathological social normality until it no longer appears pathological.	Describes the population-side reproduction of a captured epistemic order.
Need for closure	Preference for definite resolution and aversion to ambiguity.	Can accelerate attachment to an S1 or authority that fills uncertainty.
Epistemic adulthood	Capacity to inspect and revise inherited standards and trust architecture within a fully installed lifted program.	Names the developmental achievement; it is reflective agency within full capture, not escape from programming.

Related term	Short semantic definition	Relation to epistemic agency under mechanical solidarity
Cognitive liberty	Reflective distance from socialization combined with continued capacity for trust and participation.	Names positive freedom under a universal, corrigible meta-order with bounded subordinate authorities.
Press secretary, interpreter, and auditor	Three possible functions of reflective reason: defend a verdict, make its operative programming inspectable, or test and possibly revise it.	Prevents articulate justification from being mistaken automatically for self-authorship; supplies the reflective audit gate used in *Mythology Construction*.
Un-reason	Proposed mechanism in which reasoning remains active but is recursively organized against reciprocal standards and independent correction.	Extends the press-secretary problem from a possible person-level operation to arguments, programmes, fields, and institutions. It is not a third constitutional orientation; its primary semantic home is *Epistemic Constitution*.
Epistemic emancipation	Lifting from full capture by shared concrete answers to full capture by a reality-answerable generator of answers.	Names the practical unbraid/rebraid problem through which inherited answers lose finality without necessarily disappearing.
MCIP	Mirror, Cut, Invite, Promise.	Proposed micro-method for restoring agency while keeping the successor weave and its interpreters corrigible.
Guided unbraiding and possible de-radicalization	Guided unbraiding is the hypothetical consensual process of mapping and loosening selected automatic relations around an activated conclusion; possible de-radicalization is the aspirational recovery outcome only where radicalizing capture is independently present.	Uses MCIP as one candidate method while preserving the radicalizing mirror, violence-risk separation, research status, consent, safeguards, and falsification conditions.
Self-propagating epistemic audit	Transfer of the auditor function into self-initiated examination of further possible blind spots through reciprocal standards, reality contact, and defeat conditions.	Proposed healthy avalanche outcome; can instead become indiscriminate distrust or a self-confirming successor loop.
Full-speech answerability audit	Lacan's empty/full-speech distinction aligned, without identification, to Avery's obligation/responsibility contrast.	Tests whether a role, rule, office, or Cause is being used as an alibi or consciously assumed in an answerable judgment. Full speech is not guaranteed truth, and legitimate obligation is not displaced authorship by definition.
Piety toward the real	Humble willingness to let complex reality correct concepts, stories, institutions, and conviction.	Supplies the normative standard and final right of refusal.
Holistic structural realism	Model-centered epistemology in which concepts and operations are tested through prediction, surprise, and revision.	Supplies the positive reality-correction loop used by this entry.
Moral individualism	Shared commitment to the equal dignity and rights of persons.	Prevents factual correction and respect for social reality from becoming contempt for persons or worship of institutions.

Related term	Short semantic definition	Relation to epistemic agency under mechanical solidarity
Person-centred humanism	Explanatory gloss for Durkheim's religion of the human person, not a replacement source term.	Names Humanity as the sacred object while locating complete and equal standing in every individual living human being under the project's recognition-only principle; blocks capability-gated admission, aggregative sacrifice, and subjecthood absorption.
Nächstenliebe	Love of neighbour directed toward the concrete person's reality-based good.	Requires concern and sometimes intervention while forbidding instrumental dehumanization.

27. Scope and terminological cautions

Epistemic agency under mechanical solidarity is a proposed synthetic term, not the established name of a single scientific theory or diagnostic category. It connects questions from social epistemology, Durkheimian sociology, Lacanian psychoanalysis, developmental theory, political psychology, narrative theory, persuasion research, and the proposed framework of culture mechanics.

Several boundaries are essential:

1. **It is not an anti-institutional doctrine.** Institutions are indispensable instruments of distributed knowledge. The problem is opacity, monopoly, domain spillover, preemption, and resistance to correction—not institutional form itself.
2. **It does not idealize personal verification.** Direct checking is decisive only where it is competent and proportionate. Elementary arithmetic cannot replace specialized medicine, engineering, history, or science; it can sometimes expose a particular claim within them.
3. **It does not equate disagreement with independence.** Automatic contrarianism and submission to an uncorrectable or preemptive gatekeeper are not cognitive liberty; the mere fact that a source rivals an incumbent does not decide the question.
4. **It is not a theory of intelligence.** High intelligence can coexist with authority-gated updating; modest intelligence can coexist with strong epistemic integrity.
5. **It is not a clinical diagnosis.** Credulity, Dummheit, normopathic adaptation, and capture are used as conceptual cross-references, not licenses to pathologize political or religious opponents.
6. **Mechanical solidarity is not necessarily hierarchical or unhealthy.** The large-group/small-elevated-group pattern is one important architecture, not the essence of the Durkheimian concept.
7. **A master signifier is not identical with mechanical solidarity.** It is one symbolic operator that may help organize solidarity.
8. **A causal story is not necessarily a lie.** Narrative selection is unavoidable; the test is comparative explanatory and predictive adequacy, openness about uncertainty, and responsiveness to consequences.
9. **Persuasion method does not determine truth.** Gentle inquiry can mislead, and forceful intervention can sometimes protect life. Epistemic direction, love of neighbour, proportionality, consequences, and corrigibility must be considered together.
10. **Piety toward the real is not submission to whoever speaks for "reality."** It requires the opposite: no authority's certification can remove the possibility of external correction.
11. **Cognitive liberty is not epistemic autarky.** Its mature form is conscious interdependence, not isolation.
12. **"Freeing" is not self-authenticating.** A liberation campaign can install closed or uncorrectable successor culture mechanics. The liberator must expose their own model to the same tests demanded of the other person; replacement or rivalry alone is not the failure criterion.
13. **The field is neither isolated individual psychology nor a new physical force.** Culture mechanics treats relational organization as causally real and irreducible to independently formed individuals, while locating its implementation in persons, communication, institutions, practices, and artifacts. Field physics remains an analogy.
14. **The privileged programming topology is not universal or inherently manipulative.** Horizontal and leaderless synchronization also occur. A teacher can use the topology for truthful education, and an audience can resist it.

15. **A distributed bigOther is not automatically a multi-mind-self.** The latter requires sufficient continuity, memory, judgment, intention, and coordinated action; a momentary crowd may remain below that threshold.
16. **Unitary collective ownership is not legal title.** It is a proposed psychological-social relation and must be compared with incentives, habit, surveillance, personal virtue, and ordinary organizational coordination.
17. **Collective agency does not erase personal responsibility.** *Beseelte* persons remain biological, moral, and legal actors even when they enact a continuing collective perspective.
18. **bigOther-presence does not settle metaphysics.** The theory proposes one functional route by which an authority becomes present and conduct-directing; it neither proves nor disproves additional religious or metaphysical claims.
19. **Plural authorities are not parallel local bigOthers.** The main processor may compare alternatives and external counterfields may support reflection, but one local bigOther executes one operative lens. Compatible packages can be integrated; incompatible capture requires unbraiding and rebraiding rather than runtime ranking.
20. **Full, lifted, universal, and corrigible are different properties.** Full describes complete slot occupancy; lifted means that shared binding force lies in rules that generate, select, apply, and revise concrete answers; universal describes how far those rules govern; and corrigible describes openness to inspection, succession, and reality's right of refusal. Particular authorities can be plural and domain-limited beneath a universal lifted order.
21. **Articulate reasons do not establish causal authorship.** A reason can be true and relevant while having been assembled after a protected verdict; causal provenance and logical quality require separate tests.
22. **Introspection is not self-validating.** The interpreter can misidentify a rule, and the auditor can be captured, incompetent, or ceremonial. Independent evidence, rival formulations, public criticism, and consequence remain necessary.
23. **The reflective triad is not a three-module brain theory.** Press secretary, interpreter, and auditor name functions performed by a person in a case; they neither replace the main processor–bigOther distinction nor posit parallel local bigOthers.
24. **Removing the "me" is not removing context.** A general rule may depend on role, relationship, competence, danger, necessity, and consequence while denying that a person's name or faction supplies a private exception.
25. **Impartiality is not yet person-preservation.** A rule can apply without favour and still authorize aggregative sacrifice or subjecthood absorption. The human-person constraint is an additional test.
26. **Collective strength is not subjecthood absorption.** A capable multi-mind-self may preserve differentiated persons. The sacrificial route requires loss of legitimate judgment, conscience, purpose, refusal, or exit under excessive or closed collective jurisdiction.

The framework is descriptive before it is accusatory. Shared trust, narratives, symbols, and institutions can coordinate real knowledge and protect human dignity. The normative threshold is crossed when the system disables the very procedures by which its claims, classifications, and authorities could be corrected.

Semantic summary

- **Broader class:** social and developmental theory of situated epistemic agency.
- **Central object:** the person's relation to a socially installed architecture of epistemic trust.
- **Individual source and receiver:** the local bigOther within homo duplex.
- **Shared communication interface:** Lacan's big Other, functionally translated as the on-the-wire symbolic protocol.
- **Starting condition:** unavoidable epistemic dependence.
- **Developmental transmission mechanism:** the operation-first decoder-bootstrap principle states that operation-rich formation constructs the local decoder, compressed state transmission exploits it, and renewed operation transmission repairs it; reconstruction reach describes how large a learned complex one token can reliably activate for a recipient and context.
- **Operational-inhabitation distinction:** independently reconstructing, institutionally scaffolded, and first-order participation relative to a lifted generator can all produce competent conduct in familiar cases but differ in novel transfer, explanation, criticism, teaching, repair, and succession. Distributed specialization can be healthy; quiet routine proves neither widely distributed reconstruction nor cultural hollowness.
- **Developmental and population neighbours:** natural pedagogy supplies ostensive addressing and a bias toward generic cultural learning before full language; cultural attraction explains how reconstructive, non-copying transmission can still yield population-level stability without identical local mental states. Neither source establishes a local bigOther, Culture Program, truth, or deterministic convergence.
- **Collective epistemic formation:** participation in a distributed epistemic milieu forms and revises the locally executable concepts, distinctions, query paths, methods, inferential habits, and evidential standards used by ordinary rider or main-CPU cognition.

- **Distributed epistemic milieu:** language, examples, practices, artifacts, records, instruments, institutions, trained persons, and correction procedures carry epistemic resources across participants and generations without forming a detached processor, collective brain, one shared mental state, or second bigOther.
- **Hot–cold processor boundary:** affective–evaluative actuation is executed by the local bigOther and affects elephant-side orientation; collective epistemic formation supplies resources reconstructed and used by the main CPU. Collar-conditioned semantic access can couple the modes without making the collar a query planner or the milieu a third processor.
- **Scientific-ethos coupling:** affect is not evidence, but honour, shame, identity, and role formation can sustain truthfulness and correction when external observation is weak. The positive case binds affect to reality-answerability and corrigibility rather than an approved result or authority; the inverse binds it to answer protection.
- **Three-axis operative-agency model:** I/We identifies operative authorship or standpoint; EDA/DCL identifies immediate engagement versus disengaged representational languaging; propositional/be-humming identifies lexical content versus embodied, paralinguistic, and interactional signalling. The axes can combine independently and must not be compressed into one warm/cold, individual/collective, or rational/irrational scale.
- **Multidimensional agency-and-receiver profile:** attachment, field reception and gain, classification reach, affective output, actuation, jurisdiction, inspectability, controllability, retransmission, abstraction, self-authorship, reciprocal person-preservation, corrigibility, and transfer must not be collapsed into one individualism or liftability rank. Immersed carrier, collective system-builder, liberal-Humanist carrier, and local nonconformist are ideal-type combinations rather than biological castes or person types.
- **EDA/DCL source boundary:** the labels are retained as a provisional Jaques bridge pending primary-text verification; the two-by-two I/We matrix, its Culture Mechanics interpretation, and the claim that repersonalization can return through either direct encounter or imaginative reconstruction are project constructions.
- **Be-humming channel:** rhythm, prosody, pauses, vocal mirroring, turn-taking, posture, gaze, movement, and interpersonal timing help enact trust, rank, belonging, threat, and coordination. They do not reveal truth or intention automatically, make propositions irrelevant, or support a universal numerical split of communication.
- **Learning-state distinction:** surface habituation reduces unfamiliarity; operational understanding supports transfer, prediction, use, and revision; living knowledge joins compressed symbolic state to enough reconstructed experience, question, causal structure, competence, and correction capacity to keep that understanding applicable and repairable.
- **Computing-analogy scope:** database, query, CRDT, adaptive-compression, serialization, and decompression mappings concern rider-facing symbolic reconstruction and communication rather than the elephant's internal nonverbal learning and affective architecture.
- **Bidirectional symbol-access failure:** an opaque inherited symbol can lose its route back to engendering experience while a prohibited rival symbol loses its route from present experience into admissible articulation; both can occur together.
- **Proposed person-side access mechanism:** collar-conditioned semantic access can inhibit or redirect retrieval, joining, standing-query activation, segmentation, binding, and articulation without turning the collar into a reasoning or memory processor. Query suppression risks false negatives, query hyperactivation risks false positives, and epistemic acquisition closure names the prospective case in which a passing event never becomes a typed and preserved observation.
- **Open theorizing surface:** the domain of observations, questions, distinctions, comparisons, causal relations, rival explanations, and possible answers that can be brought into explicit, sustained, corrigible inquiry in a specified domain and period. The access–formation–correction grammar joins distributed formation, Culture Program classification, semantic access, usable inquiry, correction, and public realization without collapsing them. Specify whether inquiry can correct implementation, the governing rule, its justification, or its jurisdiction; openness at one scope does not establish openness at the others. The same inquiry capacity can generate errors and the operations that later correct them.
- **Footprint hypothesis:** contraction of the shared first-order prescription footprint can reduce the territory exposed to answer-protective obstruction and enlarge the open theorizing surface, other things equal. This is a directional proposal rather than a linear law; generated concrete rules do not automatically enlarge the footprint, and one compact protected premise can create a wide scotoma. Potential scotoma exposure depends on the inquiry domains placed under pressure; realized scotoma burden additionally depends on correction resistance, contradiction pressure, affect, sanctions, formation, and institutional reinforcement. Condemnation or prohibition alone is not blindness where perception, comparison, formulation, and correction remain available.
- **Constructive access operation:** Noticing is prepared availability for inquiry across selection, retrieval, holding, segmentation, and joining; it is neither bare registration, a truth guarantee, nor a claim that every unnoticed

relation was repressed.

- **Comparison with neighbouring accounts:** defence mechanisms, schema modes, information avoidance, motivated reasoning, active ignorance, and need for cognitive closure supply distinguishable person-side and social comparison points. Their visible outcomes do not by themselves establish a censored insight, scotosis, collar conditioning, Culture Program causation, or diagnosis.
- **Latent-state observability problem:** the ordinary interpersonal "Newtonian" coordinate and the cultural-symbolic coordinate of *homo duplex* can be substantially orthogonal, so calm conduct may underdetermine the classifications and authority relations that become operative under culturally loaded conditions.
- **Relational observability of orthogonality:** interaction form can carry second-order information about whether cultural alignment is a condition of interpersonal standing; observer surprise can expose expected covariance, while person-specific representation can keep the coordinates differentiated through nonconvergence.
- **Proposed diagnostic:** the contrastive correction-interface probe first confirms comprehension of a disclosed causal form through relatively uncharged cases, then tests whether correction practice changes selectively across differently culture-loaded implementations. It produces only a bounded latent Culture Program profile and requires repeated pattern, rival-cause discrimination, and separate upward attribution.
- **Culture Program fingerprint:** the typed distribution of selective discontinuities across neutral and differently program-loaded cases. Repeated A-specific protected exceptions can raise the likelihood of A's installation or load-bearing status, while capture remains a stronger inference requiring displaced correction or authorship.
- **Proposed higher-order capacity probe:** operation-rich instruction followed by neutral, loaded, fictional, position-reversed, and unfamiliar transfer tasks distinguishes no exposure, acquisition, selective inhibition, support-dependent performance, and persistent operational limitation. It tests reconstructible living capability rather than approved conclusions, vocabulary, intelligence, biology, heritability, ancestry, or political standing.
- **Negative-space fingerprint component:** recurrent selective failures to notice, name, compare, or pursue a causal form can add evidence only where the same capacity is demonstrated in matched cases and ignorance, specialization, fatigue, trauma, incentives, access, wording, memory, and ordinary inconsistency fit less well.
- **Proposed intervention:** guided unbraiding maps and loosens selected automatic braid relations without compelling a successor conclusion; possible de-radicalization is its aspirational outcome only where radicalizing capture is independently established. MCIP is one candidate method, and success means durable reflective ownership rather than agreement with the guide.
- **Epistemic reindexing:** one proposed sub-operation of guided unbraiding restores plural, reality-answerable retrieval, naming, comparison, and transfer paths without making adoption of the guide's answer the success criterion.
- **Humanist-liberal counter-formation:** the normative bundle joins secure human standing, plural access paths, operation-rich reality contact, practice in disagreement and repair, public Noticing, foundational-question custody, refusal, appeal, exit, and succession. Its success criterion is expanded reality contact, competence, independent judgment, and corrigibility of the formative authority—not agreement with that authority.
- **Social environment:** a lifted mechanical-solidarity field can constitute and correct a common order across organic differentiation while first-order outputs remain diverse.
- **Impersonal-obligation discriminator:** the profitable-and-unobserved deviation counterfactual asks whether a role rule would remain governing when immediate detection, sanction, and reputation were credibly absent. It supports but does not prove an internalized-governor explanation and retains habit, uncertainty, interest, conviction, and constraint as rivals.
- **Durkheim challenge:** progressive preponderance and inverse development are treated as contestable historical hypotheses that may be wrong; Du Picq's differentiated military formation and the Nazi experiment show different scales at which advanced division of labour can coexist with, or intensify the need for, mechanical solidarity. The project further decomposes Durkheimian organic solidarity into organic differentiation and lifted mechanically solidary binding force without attributing that reinterpretation to Durkheim.
- **Whole-formation topology:** functional morphology of mechanical solidarity comprises the population body, the distributed trusted-opinion-leader function, common field, field-generating and directing function, reciprocal coupling, and any resulting collective execution.
- **Situated implementation:** distributed cultural scripts translate the general weave into role-, institution-, and situation-specific epistemic expectations and conduct; agency includes inspecting and, where possible, repairing or refusing the script without mistaking it for another bigOther.
- **Order-level distinction:** first-order solidarity shares concrete rules and answers; lifted solidarity shares the rules that generate, select, apply, and revise concrete answers.
- **First-order prescription footprint:** lifting can contract the shared catalogue of concrete answers while leaving the meta-order thick and society-wide in span. The resulting umbrella permits more bounded first-order variation, not every programme's claim to compulsory supremacy or coequal jurisdiction.
- **Provisional remove-the-me test:** particular interest plus situation becomes a candidate rule; names and

factional privilege are removed, positions are exchanged, and the rule is tested for anyone relevantly similarly situated. Context, truth, goodness, and person-preservation remain separate questions.

- **Kant–Rousseau bridge:** both move formally from particular interest toward impersonal or general justification, but Kantian universality constrains conduct while preserving persons as ends and Rousseauian generality constitutes a collective sovereign output.
- **Generative compression:** fixed installed meta-rules can combine with changing knowledge and situations to produce many changing concrete outputs; neither fewness nor detail alone defines the order level.
- **Modern structural possibility:** lifted mechanical solidarity can span an organically differentiated and plural society, but plurality and division of labour are consequences or applications rather than the definition of lifting.
- **Reckwitz comparison and recognition boundary:** cultural essentialism resembles first-order solidarity, Hyperculture resembles first-order plurality and recombination rather than a solidarity form, and a lifted order can provide their broad but bounded common umbrella. A participant habituated to visible first-order commonality may misrecognize the compressed lifted generator as cultural absence; that possibility does not establish that an apparently liberal order is operatively installed rather than merely written.
- **Complete slot occupancy / full capture:** first-order and lifted programs can each fully occupy the one local bigOther; fullness is not itself pathology.
- **Lifted jurisdiction:** an answer-generating meta-order may govern universally while allocating and limiting plural first-order outputs, authorities, and jurisdictions.
- **Corrigibility axis:** first-order and lifted full captures can each remain open or become closed; rivalry and replacement alone do not decide which.
- **Transmission process:** socialization into institutional trust.
- **Authority nodes:** persons, roles, institutions, professions, identities, channels, and apparent consensus.
- **Canonical distributed receiving-field position:** trusted-opinion-leader function; a trusted opinion leader is its current human person-in-role occupant.
- **Amplification dimension:** repeater or high-gain repeater is the network analogy for the carrier's gain, not a second position.
- **Correction-lock morphology:** high-gain trusted carriers can remain aligned strongly enough to prevent a public correction from acquiring distributed credibility, institutional reception, or operative force even while ordinary dissent grows; personal defection matters only when it becomes functional defection with retained field authority or a bypass route.
- **Loyal-carrier answerability insulation:** an officeholder can remain *vertrauenswürdig* to a loyal constituency while corrective carriers are routed as *fragwürdig*, *uninteressant*, or *unerwünscht*; exhausted critics withdraw while high-gain loyal carriers preserve authorization. The resulting authorization loop lets retained authority classify the next contradiction and its bearer before adverse material can acquire consequential routing. Claim update, source-reliability update, and trust-architecture or jurisdiction update are separate levels, and proposition-level defeat does not guarantee movement at either wider level.
- **Carrier-authority surface audit:** production, selection, translation, moral judgment, brokerage, placement, public mediation, inner-relation governance, and liability are separately mapped before one integrated power position is inferred; an epistemic-liability gap appears when authority and benefit accrue near recommendation while others bear costs and failure does not alter standing.
- **Chief-facing dimension:** first-officer mediation is the command-role analogy for how some carriers translate direction, defend or shield the directing organ, absorb contention, and return operational reality upward.
- **Neighbouring intellectual-vocation role:** Benda's *clerc* can carry the trusted-opinion-leader function, giving moral and epistemic authorization privileged routing and cascade; the source role and project function remain distinct.
- **Applied function-and-occupant analysis:** a trusted-opinion-leader-function profile separates repeater gain, authority basis, routing and translation, chief-facing mediation, field feedback, jurisdiction, independence, and corrigibility rather than treating influence as one score; analogous axes can profile nonhuman authority nodes without calling them leaders.
- **Privileged but non-universal realization:** differentiated authority addressing a comparatively uniform audience.
- **Proposed receptive condition:** the authority-addressed programming state.
- **Privileged-vision boundary:** the topology becomes *Herrschaftsideologie* only when claimed superior access is converted into governing jurisdiction that outruns bounded expertise, contestability, and correction.
- **Symbolic operator:** master signifier or S1 as compressed protocol token.
- **Narrative mechanism:** mythology or causal story.
- **Communication model:** audience-modelled reconstruction–finite messages are composed against an anticipated recipient codebook and induce a larger factual, causal, moral, and authorization model.
- **Dynamic communication precondition:** operation-bootstrapped codebook formation uses shared experience,

example, questioning, contrast, practice, and correction to build enough relevant local overlap for later compressed state transmission; inherited tokens do not carry a finished decoder.

- **Durkheimian formation bridge:** Durkheim's social pole includes collectively formed language, concepts, rational activity, and morality; Culture Mechanics decomposes that composite across public symbolic and codebook resources, rider/main-CPU reconstruction, local-bigOther classification, and field renewal.
- **Proposed semantic-access channel:** a collar classification can condition whether rider-side conceptual selection, retrieval, joining, standing-query activation, binding, and articulation continue without itself performing those operations.
- **Access topology:** read, query, segmentation, binding, join, alias, articulation, and public-address gates distinguish several possible failure locations; query suppression, indexed prohibition, and index modification distinguish increasing persistence without implying literal deletion.
- **Split accessibility:** affective, bodily, implicit, or recognitional response can remain available while explicit semantic integration fails; trauma-related theories supply an architectural neighbour, not the collar mechanism or a diagnosis.
- **Lonerganian predecessor:** flight from insight, scotosis, and scotoma supply a process–result vocabulary; semantic, retrospective, prospective, and culturally indexed scotomata are project extensions.
- **Person-to-ecology boundary:** semantic-access gating can prevent private recognition, while recognition-threshold management also includes intact private recognition followed by failed expression, aggregation, uptake, or correction.
- **Communication audits:** decompression analysis compares surface content, omissions, assumed recipient, predictable and actual reconstruction, alternative decompressions, and resulting action or authorization.
- **Closure-bound script execution:** a programme reconstruction and DCL response loop returns its protected conclusion without a legitimate losing condition. *Bot-mode* is an informal interface-level label for a demonstrated loop, not a whole-person classification or excuse.
- **Political-language source maxim:** Wegner's *Talking Points* presents political language as speech designed to win trust and power over people's lives; Culture Mechanics translates that forceful claim into political language as an authorization bid.
- **Political-power audit:** the authorization payload separates policy agreement from the power, objects, jurisdiction, duration, discretion, oversight, revocability, and epistemic spillover requested through a causal story.
- **Silent-principal extension:** when the invoked beneficiary cannot authenticate, correct, or withdraw the surrogate's account, proxy construction, rival representation, function separation, affected-person standing, and the risk of surrogate sovereignty enter the authorization audit.
- **Humanism–Diversity relation types:** Diversity can remain nested within person-standing, supplement it through bounded recognition, or replace it by making a selected pattern of differences the protected principal.
- **Single-slot capture constraint:** compatible material may reinforce or extend the installed weave; incompatible governing capture requires incumbent unbraiding and successor rebraiding.
- **Dynamic process:** the person–field projection of the culture propagator: local classification and judgment become public signals, reciprocal responses alter the distributed field, and field back-action changes later salience, legitimacy, trust, relationship, and perceived possibility.
- **Reflexive-gain boundary:** feedback can amplify, damp, reverse, arrive after a delay, or remain local to a network path; gain is not one permanent social scalar and does not establish equal power, shared intent, or transition.
- **Clockwork coordination:** differentiated contribution through roles, interfaces, handoffs, aggregation, and a common meta-order; it has an affinity with differentiated unity but is not its definition.
- **Bounded laser synchronization:** strong alignment restricted to a selected variable, task, time, and jurisdiction, compatible with person-preserving unity.
- **Generalized and jurisdictionalized laser synchronization:** alignment extended across domains and made compulsory; a pathway to fusion pressure rather than a sufficient condition for fusion.
- **Independent collective axes:** cultural interoperability concerns whether differentiated groups remain in one functioning shared field; subjecthood absorption concerns what legitimate standing persons retain against the collective.
- **Emergent network state:** the distributed bigOther.
- **Self-like representation:** multi-mind-self presentation, which does not by itself establish collective agency.
- **Possible collective agent:** the operative multi-mind-self or multi-mind-self proper.
- **Sovereign-righteousness trunk:** the open developmental research question asks how one human comes to experience their judgment as execution of a higher order whose claimed duty overrides ordinary reciprocity; office, expertise, conviction, or domination alone does not establish the relation.
- **Family-level shorthand:** unqualified *multi-mind-self* may name the broader self-like family in explanatory prose, but agency, intention, ownership, and responsibility claims require the operative threshold.

- **Possible absorptive form:** fused multi-mind-self, where operative collective agency additionally displaces participating persons as independently legitimate authors.
- **Activation profiles:** a continuing multi-mind-self can move between clockwork baseline and laser episodes; an episodic multi-mind-self crosses the agent threshold only during bounded activation; a latent distributed bigOther, de-animated remainder, and culturally lost system are different states.
- **Nested-author boundary:** collective agency can add an operative *we* while participating *I*s retain legitimate standing; fusion begins when that standing is displaced or absorbed.
- **Two sacrifice routes:** utilitarian aggregation can make a person a commensurable term in a welfare calculation; subjecthood-absorptive collective agency can make the person an organ of the collective subject. Similar outcomes do not make the mechanisms identical.
- **Collective-property hypothesis:** unitary ownership by the operative multi-mind-self through many *beseelte* persons.
- **Dual-identification hard case:** mixed avowal or ritual does not establish two operative evaluators; the test is whether two incompatible authorities remain independently final, affectively alive, and mutually ungoverned in the same domain.
- **Corporate-feud hypothesis:** a feud becomes a candidate conflict between clan-scale multi-mind-selves when injury, liability, retaliation, compensation, settlement, and memory are owned and administered by continuing group perspectives rather than merely coordinated individuals.
- **Central pathological mechanism:** authority-gated belief updating.
- **Characteristic observable pattern:** asymmetric epistemic permeability.
- **Cheap-check gradient:** persistent substitution of authorized reassurance becomes more diagnostic as actual verification costs and competence demands fall and available evidence becomes more decisive, with matched exposure and rival checks required.
- **Pastoral subtype:** care-grounded surrender of epistemic judgment.
- **Individual susceptibility factors:** identity dependence, need for closure, authoritarian submission, low vigilance, and fear of exclusion.
- **Proposed adoption pathway:** cognitive relief can mediate preference for an authority-endorsed compressed formula under complexity, uncertainty, public exposure, or responsibility for judgment.
- **Population-level outcomes:** distributed enforcement, Dummheit, and normopathic adaptation.
- **Healthy configuration:** a universal corrigible meta-order with calibrated, plural, domain-limited dependence upon particular authorities.
- **Developmental achievement:** epistemic adulthood.
- **Reflective-role distinction:** reason may act as press secretary for a protected bigOther verdict, as interpreter making its rule and provenance visible, or as auditor testing framing, evidence, symmetry, authority, jurisdiction, consequence, and corrigibility.
- **Self-objectification transition:** an affectively final judgment becomes an inspectable classification produced under a rule and authority relation; interpretation opens audit but does not itself complete it.
- **Finality cut:** the inner judge becomes evidence about the installed program rather than the last court merely because its verdict feels authoritative.
- **Audit boundary:** private introspection normally requires external friction and correction; self-authorship remains one fully installed, reality-answerable weave rather than a cultureless CPU or several operative bigOthers.
- **Normative freedom:** cognitive liberty.
- **Normative orientation:** piety toward the real.
- **Moral orientation:** truth joined with Nächstenliebe and epistemic humility.
- **Liberation process:** epistemic emancipation.
- **Proposed conversational intervention:** MCIP—Mirror, Cut, Invite, Promise.
- **MCIP authorship boundary:** ethics cannot be outsourced, but courage can be scaffolded; the Promise supports the cost of inquiry and practice without appropriating the recipient's judgment.
- **Central normative question:** Does authority provide a corrigible route to reality, or does its certification replace reality-testing?

Example of use

From the perspective of **epistemic agency under mechanical solidarity**, the citizens' reliance on the institution was not irrational merely because it was socially learned. The decisive problem was that institutional authorization had become preemptive: identical evidence was rejected outside the approved channel, elementary checks were treated as disloyal, and the institution claimed authority to define its own failures. Restoring agency therefore required more than transmitting contrary facts. It required

making the inherited trust architecture visible, preserving social permission to doubt, and reopening a route through which reality could correct both citizen and institution.

Compact formulas

Healthy form:

> **socialization → institutional trust → delegated expertise → exposed evidence and method → prediction and correction → calibrated reliance**

Field form:

> **local bigOthers → shared symbolic protocol → reciprocal classification and response → mechanical-solidarity coherence → distributed bigOther → field back-action upon local judgment**

Person–field propagator projection:

> **operative representation → local classification and judgment → public signal, refusal, role, sanction, or practice → reciprocal interpretation and response → collective-field change → altered salience, legitimacy, trust, and perceived possibility → later local classification and judgment**

Programming-topology form:

> **differentiated authority + comparatively uniform audience + common attention and reception → heightened receptivity → activation, reinforcement, or reprogramming → stronger field coherence**

Audience-modelled reconstruction:

> **communicator's model + anticipated recipient codebook → selected facts, omissions, sequence, symbols, and cues → finite message → recipient reconstruction → factual, causal, moral, action, and authorization consequences**

Operation-bootstrapped compression:

> **inherited artifacts + recurrent experience, example, questions, contrasts, practice, and correction → locally reconstructed codebooks → sufficient relevant overlap → compressed tokens evoke larger models; renewed operation transmission maintains transfer, correction, and generational continuity**

Collective epistemic formation:

> **distributed epistemic milieu → locally reconstructed concepts, methods, and query paths → main-CPU inquiry and articulation → public reception and material consequence → correction or renewed formation of the milieu**

Scientific-ethos coupling:

> **hot attachment to truthfulness and corrigibility → self-restraint under weak observation → more reliable cold inquiry → adverse evidence can revise both answer and thought style**

Collar-conditioned semantic access:

> **socially formed concept, question, source, comparison, or use approaches → collar classifies it as permitted, honourable, costly, shameful, dangerous, or taboo → rider-side retrieval, joining, standing-query activation, binding, or articulation continues, is redirected, or stops; ordinary cognition performs the operation, and the classification conditions access**

Domain-contact learning:

> **operation-rich contact → conceptual and practical discrimination → symbolic addressing and selective serialization → local reconstruction → application, prediction, consequence, and correction**

Joint codebook formation and practice-formed coordination capacity:

> **recurrent consequential joint practice → overlapping locally reconstructed codebooks → compressed signals + mutual prediction + situated role competence → clockwork coordination → emergent collective capacity and field back-action**

Political language as authorization bid:

relevant structure + represented threat or promise + trusted protector/fixer + feared or blamed opponent → follow, believe, trust, oppose → requested grant of power or delegated jurisdiction

Authorization payload:

threatened structure + victim + culprit + protector/fixer + preferred remedy → requested power × objects × jurisdiction × duration × discretion; oversight, revocation, succession, and termination evidence remain separate tests

Silent-principal surrogate mechanism:

silent or abstract beneficiary → surrogate-defined interest and proxy → causal story and remedy → authorization payload; custody of principal + metric + remedy + sacrifice + success + appeal → surrogate-sovereignty hazard

Sowell decision–correction bridge:

surrogate decision custody + weak access to dispersed knowledge + attenuated exposure to error costs + custody of outcome interpretation and correction → surrogate-correction asymmetry → possible surrogate sovereignty

Cognitive-relief pathway:

complexity + uncertainty + responsibility → compressed authority formula → subjective relief and certainty → reduced checking or decompression → possible authority-gated reinforcement

Incompatible-capture form:

incompatible governing offer → incumbent bindings loosened and unbraided → liminal instability or dependency → retained and new strands rebraided → one successor lens installed → field reinforcement and defensive reasoning

Order-level and lifted-jurisdiction form:

fixed M + current K_t + situation C → binding R_t(C); a universally governing M may constitute, allocate, limit, coordinate, succeed, and correct plural first-order outputs and jurisdictions

Remove-the-me and person-preservation:

particular interest (I_i) + situation (C) → candidate rule (M) → remove identity privilege + exchange positions → candidate general rule (Rˆ*(C)) → separately test whether every concrete person remains an end rather than a summand or organ

Collective-owner form:

distributed bigOther + continuity + group judgment and intention → multi-mind-self → one collective owner acting through many *beseelte* persons

Dual-evaluator hard test:

mixed identity label → inspect final interpretive priority, guilt, veto, correction, and stability; two incompatible same-domain authorities remaining independently final without a third rule → evidence against the single slot

Corporate-feud form:

injury to member → group-owned debt → substitutable group bearer retaliates or compensates → opposing group remembers and responds; collective ownership and continuity must outperform individual-incentive alternatives

Activation-state form:

viable distributed memory and organization + bounded high coupling + common attention + reciprocal feedback + coordinated execution → possible episodic multi-mind-self; activation asks whether it acts as a self, fusion asks what standing participating persons retain

Pathological form:

socialization → master signifier and trust anchor → field-amplified authorization → authority-gated updating → asymmetric permeability → defensive rationalization and collective enforcement

Developmental form:

> **socially authored trust → reflective distance → self-authored trust → self-transforming trust → cognitive liberty**

Reflective-audit form:

> **bigOther verdict + actuation → press-secretary justification; make rule, framing, authority, and provenance object → interpretation; test symmetry, evidence, jurisdiction, consequence, and falsifier → audit → retain, correct, unbraid, or rebraid**

Normative form:

> **Respect persons unconditionally; evaluate propositions conditionally by evidence; regulate action through justice; preserve reality's right to correct every model and authority.**

Liberation form:

> **full capture by shared concrete answers → unbraid their claim to finality → rebraid a shared reality-answerable generator → full lifted capture; Mirror the person → Cut the protected false connection → Invite independent judgment → Promise support for living with the result**

Terminological provenance and primary sources

The vocabulary above does not come from one theory. The following map distinguishes established concepts from adaptations and new syntheses. Links point to the relevant publications rather than to conversations about them.

Established terms used substantially in their source sense

- **Mechanical and organic solidarity — Émile Durkheim.** *De la division du travail social* (1893) is the defining source. Durkheim's distinction is retained when reporting his theory; *lifted mechanical solidarity* and the decomposition of his organic-solidarity composite into organic differentiation plus lifted common binding force are extensions made by this entry.
- ***Homo duplex* and the individual/social duality — Émile Durkheim.** "The Dualism of Human Nature and Its Social Conditions" (1914; Chapter 10 in *Émile Durkheim on Morality and Society*, pp. 149–163) contrasts organism-rooted sensation and appetite with socially derived intellectual and moral life. Durkheim includes collective language, concepts, and rational activity in the social pole. The main-CPU/local-bigOther decomposition and semantic-access mechanism are project extensions.
- **Collective effervescence — Émile Durkheim.** *Les formes élémentaires de la vie religieuse* (1912) describes collective excitation, reciprocal amplification, and rhythmic unity. The laser-moment comparison is the present project's analogy, not Durkheim's terminology.
- **Epistemic dependence — John Hardwig.** "Epistemic Dependence," *The Journal of Philosophy* 82(7), 1985, pp. 335–349 (DOI) is the direct source for unavoidable rational dependence on other knowers.
- **Cognitive authority — Patrick Wilson.** *Second-Hand Knowledge: An Inquiry into Cognitive Authority* (1983) analyzes why people recognize some others as proper influences on what they think.
- **Epistemic authority and preemption — Linda Trinkaus Zagzebski.** *Epistemic Authority: A Theory of Trust, Authority, and Autonomy in Belief* (2012) is the principal source. Christoph Jäger's 2016 critique is especially relevant to the danger that authority displace understanding.
- **Choosing among experts — Alvin I. Goldman.** "Experts: Which Ones Should You Trust?" (2001) (DOI) grounds several audit criteria used here: arguments, agreement among experts, interests and biases, and track records.
- **Epistemic vigilance — Dan Sperber, Fabrice Clément, Christophe Heintz, Olivier Mascaro, Hugo Mercier, Gloria Origgi, and Deirdre Wilson.** "Epistemic Vigilance" (2010) is the defining paper for vigilance toward communicated information.
- **Epistemic trust, mistrust, and credulity — Chloe Campbell, Michal Tanzer, Rob Saunders, Thomas Booker, Elizabeth Allison, Elizabeth Li, Claire O'Dowda, Patrick Luyten, and Peter Fonagy.** "Development and Validation of a Self-Report Measure of Epistemic Trust" (2021) defines and operationalizes this three-part construct. Its *credulity* scale is narrower than the broad nonclinical usage in this entry.
- **Natural pedagogy — Gergely Csibra and György Gergely.** "Natural Pedagogy" (2009) proposes that ostensive communication prepares infants to receive referential, kind-relevant, and generalizable cultural knowledge. The operation-metadata comparison and relation to codebook formation are project translations.

- **Cultural attraction — Nicolas Claidière and Dan Sperber.** "The Role of Attraction in Cultural Evolution" distinguishes constructive, non-copying acquisition and content-based attraction from conformity- and prestige-biased transmission. Its use as a neighbour for locally reconstructed codebooks and distributed bigOther stability does not identify those project constructs with cultural attractors.
- **Pastoral power — Michel Foucault.** "The Subject and Power" (1982) is a concise primary source for the individualized, totalizing form of guidance from which *pastoral epistemic authority* is adapted.
- **Master signifier, S1/S2, and the master's discourse — Jacques Lacan.** *Le Séminaire, Livre XVII: L'envers de la psychanalyse* (1969–1970) is the central source for the four discourses. *Seminar XX: Encore* contains Lacan's characterization of the signifier as "stupid."
- **Empty speech and full speech — Jacques Lacan.** "The Function and Field of Speech and Language in Psychoanalysis" supplies the psychoanalytic distinction. The answerability audit and its use inside MCIP are bounded Culture Mechanics translations rather than Lacan's civic or administrative doctrine.
- **Causal stories — Deborah A. Stone.** "Causal Stories and the Formation of Policy Agendas," *Political Science Quarterly* 104(2), 1989, pp. 281–300 (DOI) is the defining paper.
- **Motivated reasoning — Ziva Kunda.** "The Case for Motivated Reasoning" (1990) is the canonical review.
- **Self-appropriation, flight from insight, scotosis, scotoma, and bias — Bernard Lonergan.** The Chapter 6 archive material supplies the person-side process from affectively inhibited images and questions toward a censored insight and resulting blind spot, including oscillation between momentary access, affective repulsion, dismissal, lost follow-up questions, and later return. Giovanni Sala supplies the concept–operation development, and Gerard Whelan supplies the wider intellectual-biographical setting. Retrospective, prospective, semantic, and culturally indexed scotomata and their collar-and-field bridge are project extensions rather than Lonergan's terms. Self-appropriation remains a neighbouring positive account of reflective possession of one's own knowing operations rather than a synonym for the project's Humanist-liberal counter- formation.
- **Psychic conversion and the dialectics of subject, community, and culture — Robert M. Doran.** "Two Ways of Being Conscious: The Notion of Psychic Conversion" develops the constructive transformation of the censor and the relation among neural undertow, symbols, feelings, values, insight, judgment, and decision. The elephant–rider comparison and Culture Mechanics field bridge remain project mappings.
- **Selective and defensive exclusion — John Bowlby; symbolic carrying forward — Eugene Gendlin.** Bowlby's *Attachment and Loss*, volume 3 supplies backward- and forward-access neighbours, including rigid exclusion's interference with later revision of internal working models, while Gendlin's theory of personality change supplies the healthy semantic-latency control. Neither source establishes culturally indexed scotosis or the collar mechanism.
- **Defence, schema, and information-avoidance neighbours — Rose Howell and Vera Békés; Christopher Taylor, Penny Bee, and Gillian Haddock; Jeremy Foust and Jennifer Taber; Peter Ditto and colleagues.** The defence–attachment review, schema-therapy review, information-avoidance review, and partisan-bias review supply distinct protective, developmental, behavioural, and causal-underdetermination controls. None supplies the local bigOther or validates the complete scotosis sequence.
- **Active ignorance — José Medina.** *The Epistemology of Resistance*, chapter 1 analyzes ignorance sustained through interacting epistemic vices and structural conditions. Its relation to socially reinforced resistance, source routing, and collective reindexing is a bounded Culture Mechanics comparison rather than a transfer of Medina's social-group classifications or culpability judgments.
- **Four-level information-processing architecture — Franz Josef Radermacher.** "Cognition in Systems" (1996) and *Bewusstsein, Ressourcenknappheit, Sprache* (1997) distinguish signal–environment fit, neural or subsymbolic skill, symbolic language and classification, and mathematically supported complex models. The comparison supports a functional distinction between subsymbolic competence and symbolic address; it is neither an experimentally established psychology nor the Culture Mechanics elephant–rider–collar architecture.
- **Trauma as a changing public category and numbing — Rebecca Lemov and Robert Lifton.** Lemov's *The Instability of Truth* supplies the historical synthesis through which a formerly unavailable or weak public category, competing aliases, later category expansion, relational recognition and vulnerability, coercive- persuasion topology, and Lifton's numbing enter this account. They serve as bounded comparisons for public indexing, query overextension, split accessibility, and possible crisis–relief stabilization rather than evidence for collar-conditioned semantic access or a diagnosis.
- **Need for cognitive closure — Donna M. Webster and Arie W. Kruglanski.** "Individual Differences in Need for Cognitive Closure" (1994) defines and measures the construct.
- **Dysrationalia and contaminated mindware — Keith E. Stanovich.** "Dysrationalia: A New Specific Learning Disability" (1993) introduces *dysrationalia*; "Contaminated Mindware" (2009) develops the latter concept.

Borrowed concepts whose meaning is deliberately extended here

Term in this entry	Source and responsible thinker	Difference in the present usage
Lifted mechanical solidarity	Durkheim's mechanical solidarity	A project-developed order-level distinction: common binding force is moved from concrete rules and answers to rules that generate, select, apply, and revise them. Modern plural integration is one important consequence, not the definition. *Lifted* is not Durkheim's term.
Socialization into institutional trust	Wilson on cognitive authority; Niklas Luhmann on trust; Anthony Giddens on expert and abstract systems	Synthesizes these antecedents with Durkheimian solidarity into a specific many-to-few socialization mechanism; none of the three authors uses the complete model stated here.
Preemptive gatekeeper deference	Zagzebski's Preemption Thesis	Restricts and radicalizes preemption into a pathological permissioning relation in which contrary evidence cannot be admitted without authorization.
Pastoral epistemic authority	Foucault's pastoral power	Isolates the epistemic effect of care-grounded guidance; it is narrower than Foucault's historical account of pastoral power.
Obligation–responsibility and empty-speech–full-speech alignment	Christopher Avery's Responsibility Process and Lacan's speech distinction	Avery supplies obligation as one self-protective stance contrasted with responsibility; Lacan supplies the speech distinction. Their alignment around displaced versus assumed authorship, and its MCIP use, are project-developed. Legitimate obligation may be fully assumed, responsibility language may remain empty, and neither source supplied the combined model.
Lacan's big Other as shared symbolic protocol	Lacan's locus of language, law, and symbolic authority	"On-the-wire protocol" is a culture-mechanical functional translation of one aspect, not Lacan's definition or a complete exegesis.
bigOther, local bigOther, distributed bigOther	Lacan's big Other	Recasts symbolic authority as a local affective classifier and an emergent network state. These are culture-mechanical adaptations, not Lacan's definitions.
bigOther-presence and bigOther-as-Thou	William James on felt objective presence; Martin Buber's *I and Thou*	Borrows phenomenological and relational cues for how field authority may be locally encountered. Neither author proposed the local processor or distributed-field mechanism.

Term in this entry	Source and responsible thinker	Difference in the present usage
Mechanical-solidarity field	Durkheim's mechanical solidarity and collective consciousness	Treats solidarity as emergent symbolic-affective coherence with back-action upon local judgment. The field ontology and physical analogies are proposed here.
Functional morphology / functional form of mechanical solidarity	Durkheim's homogeneous and segmental structures, politico-familial organization, collective personality, common conscience, defined organ, chief, and organized incarnation	Reconstructs the whole formation as population body, distributed trusted-opinion-leader function, common field, centralized or distributed directing function, reciprocal coupling, and possible collective execution. Durkheim did not propose the dotted-semiconductor depiction, local-bigOther processor, synthetic or distributed emitter, organ–body resonance, or first-officer mapping.
Laser synchronization	Analogy with physical lasers	A heuristic metaphor for social coupling and coherent collective output, not a claim that Durkheim or Lacan proposed a laser model or that social alignment obeys laser physics.
Magnetization, remanence, domains, domain walls, charged particles, photons, and repeater gain	Analogies with physics and network engineering; William James's magnetic phenomenology and Le Bon's magnetic crowd language are source neighbors	Project-developed models for durable alignment, persistence, boundaries, source/back-action, relative carrier-independence, and unequal gain. Repeater gain is an analogy dimension, not a separate social position. James and Le Bon did not propose this topology, and it asserts no physical identity.
Trusted-opinion-leader function / trusted opinion leader	General opinion-leadership and diffusion research, including Thomas W. Valente and Patchareeya Pumpuang	Adds a project-developed distributed function centred on the receiving field and a person-in-role term for its human occupant. Repeater gain, translation, modelling, representation, feedback, and first-officer mediation are varying dimensions or expressions of this one function. It is broader than the medical-marketing category *key opinion leader*. The mapping to Benda's *clerc* preserves his normative-vocational source term as distinct.

Term in this entry	Source and responsible thinker	Difference in the present usage
Professional idea mediation and prominence-derived apparent competence	F. A. Hayek, "The Intellectuals and Socialism"; Roland Baader, *totgedacht*, especially pp. 35–40 and 124–126	Hayek supplies the broad "secondhand dealers in ideas" source-side role; Baader adopts that role and explicitly joins prominence and *Anscheinskompetenz* to political amplification. The professional-idea-mediator term, its separation from the receiving-side trusted-opinion-leader function, the unknown-speaker counterfactual, and the Baader–TOL–Sowell authority lifecycle are Culture Mechanics developments.
First-officer mediation	Military neighbours include Falconer on the naval lieutenant (1769), von Steuben's regulations (1779), Jomini on the chief of staff (1862 English edition), the proposed naval executive-officer organization (1886), and Moss's *Officers' Manual* (1906). Corporate and organizational neighbours include Barnard on formal and informal organization (1938), O'Donnell on the *assistant-to* (1960), Likert's linking pin (1961), Dale's general-staff account (1969), and Kanter on the boss–secretary relation (1977).	Synthesizes bidirectional interpretation, operational sensing, relief from detail, public unity, private correction, and possible symbolic shielding as one chief-facing expression of the trusted-opinion-leader function. The cited offices and concepts are component-neighbours, not synonyms, a demonstrated genealogy, evidence that the role was created to preserve superhuman elevation, or sources for the complete multi-mind-self morphology.
Multi-mind-self presentation, operative multi-mind-self, and unitary collective ownership	Joscha Bach's "Synthetic Sentience"; Otto von Gierke on the real unity of associations; F. W. Maitland on moral and legal personality; Christian List and Philip Pettit on group agency	The term *multi-mind-self* is taken from Bach. The present synthesis separates self-like presentation from operative collective agency and fused agency, adds local bigOthers, mechanical-solidarity field formation, *Beseelung*, nested authorship, the episodic profile, and the claim that one operative collective self can own through many persons. The other cited authors supply group-person and group-agency neighbours, not that implementation or register rule.
Privileged authority-addressed programming topology and programming state	Freud on group psychology; Green and Brock on transportation; Horton and Wohl on parasocial interaction; Chwe on common knowledge; Bourdieu on authorized speech; Collins on interaction rituals	Synthesizes several mechanisms into a new, testable one-to-many realization of the broader functional morphology. No source establishes the complete compound state.
Bonhoefferian Dummheit	Dietrich Bonhoeffer, "Von der Dummheit" (1943; PDF of the complete section) (HTML transcription)	Names a family resemblance between socially induced loss of independence and the present capture model. It is not an IQ measure, diagnosis, or complete restatement of Bonhoeffer.

Term in this entry	Source and responsible thinker	Difference in the present usage
Audience-modelled reconstruction	Dushan Wegner, *Relevante Strukturen* (2019), especially his account of linguistic *Komprimierung* and recipient-side *Dekomprimierung*	Retains the claim that finite messages rely on an anticipated recipient's stored knowledge, then gives it a typed factual, causal, moral, and authorization model, an adversarial subtype, and a decompression audit. *Lossy codec* and *decoder-targeted compression* are project analogies, not Wegner's technical terms.
Engaged direct awareness and disengaged conscious languaging	Elliott Jaques, *The Life and Behavior of Living Organisms: A General Theory* (2001), provisionally identified through the publisher's description and contents	Uses EDA and DCL as a cognitive-stance axis inside the project's three-axis model. The exact labels and Jaques's own boundary between them still require verification in the primary text; the I/We matrix, the desk-perpetrator configuration, and both routes of repersonalization are project constructions.
Domain contact, living knowledge, joint codebook formation, and practice-formed coordination capacity	The originating author's project-management, advanced-mathematics, experimental-play, and physics-learning observations; Stuart and Hubert Dreyfus's skill-acquisition model as a bounded neighbour; Kenneth Minogue's critical account of praxis in *Alien Powers*; the project's operation-bootstrapped codebook synthesis	Generalizes the observation that responsible practice and mentally replayed experiment can make compressed formal language decompressible, distinguishes reconstructible capability from retained formulas, then connects recurrent joint practice to codebook overlap and coordination. Dreyfus supplies movement from detached rule use toward experience-based situated performance, not the surface-habituation or codebook mechanism. Minogue supplies the ideological source case, not the generic communication model, the learning illustrations, the serialization analogy, or the claim that participation guarantees truth.
Shared grammar, thought style, and scientific ethos	Célestin Bouglé, "Lazarus. La psychologie des peuples" (1896); Ludwik Fleck, *Genesis and Development of a Scientific Fact* (1935) and "To Look, To See, To Know" (1947)	Bouglé supplies persons and durable things as carriers of public spirit and transmission of forms of thought as well as ideas. Fleck supplies directed perception, assimilation, method, scientific mood, and thought-collective formation. **Collective epistemic formation**, **distributed epistemic milieu**, the processor boundary, and the hot-scientific-ethos mechanism are Culture Mechanics developments rather than either author's terms.

Term in this entry	Source and responsible thinker	Difference in the present usage
Political language as an authorization bid	Dushan Wegner's official *Talking Points* page, which states that political language seeks trust and power over people's lives	Preserves Wegner's forceful maxim, then translates it into delegated jurisdiction and connects it to relevant structures, causal stories, opponent restrictions, and bounded political authority. The term *authorization bid*, the typed payload, and the audit are project-developed.
Cognitive-relief hypothesis	Wegner's situated formulation "Denken tut weh" in *Relevante Strukturen*; neighbouring research on need for closure, cognitive effort, and authority	Turns a memorable witness formulation into a bounded, testable mediation hypothesis about relief, checking, and authority-gated acceptance. It is not a claim about intelligence, universal motivation, or prevalence, and it should not be attributed to Wegner in this operational form.
Normopathic adaptation	Erich Wulff, *Psychiatrie und Klassengesellschaft* (1972); Joyce McDougall's psychoanalytic normopathy; Hans-Joachim Maaz, *Das falsche Leben* (2017)	Uses the family of terms descriptively for adaptation to a pathological social normality without adopting any one author's clinical or political theory. The term has more than one intellectual genealogy, so a single uncontested origin should not be asserted.
Piety toward the real	Robert N. Bellah's introduction to *Émile Durkheim on Morality and Society* (1973)	Bellah's phrase characterizes Durkheim; this entry turns it into an explicit norm of epistemic model correction. It is not Durkheim's own technical term.
Moral individualism and religion of the human person	Durkheim, "L'individualisme et les intellectuels" (1898) (English translation, pp. 46–47)	Durkheim's moral defense of the sacred individual and contrast with aggregative utility are retained. **Person-centred humanism** is the project's explanatory gloss, not Durkheim's replacement term; the distinction between unconditional respect for persons and conditional evaluation of propositions is also added here. The recognition-only axiom and its standing-from-fertilization boundary are separate project commitments, not claims attributed to Durkheim.
Universal law, Humanity, and general will	Kant, *Groundwork*, AA 4:421 and AA 4:428–429; Rousseau, *The Social Contract*, II.3 and II.6	Supplies the source material for a narrow formal comparison between universalizing an actor's maxim and legislating a general law. **Impersonal universality against private interest**, the remove-the-me formula, and the person-versus-collective diagnostic are project-developed and should not be attributed to either philosopher.

Term in this entry	Source and responsible thinker	Difference in the present usage
Cognitive liberty	Richard Glen Boire, "On Cognitive Liberty"; Jan Christoph Bublitz, "My Mind Is Mine!?" (2013)	Extends freedom from mental interference into a positive developmental capacity to inspect and revise one's socialized trust architecture. That extension is not standard in the legal literature.
Epistemic adulthood	Robert Kegan's constructive-developmental theory	Applies Kegan's subject–object and self-authorship pattern specifically to epistemic trust. The term and trust stages are new here.
Press-secretary and interpreter comparisons	Jonathan Haidt's press-secretary comparison and social-intuitionist model; Michael Gazzaniga on the interpreter	Retains their observations about post-hoc moral justification and coherent explanation, then places them within the distinct main processor–local-bigOther architecture. Neither source proposes the present triad, finality cut, or audit sequence.
Use of one's own reason and hidden motive	Kant, AA 8:35–36 and AA 4:406–407	Supplies an aspiration toward public reason and a warning about misidentified motive. The hypothesis that reason can serve as press secretary for an installed bigOther verdict is the Culture Mechanics extension.
Nächstenliebe / love of neighbour	Jewish and Christian ethical tradition, classically Leviticus 19:18	Applied here to truth-directed care and intervention. The reality-corrigibility rule paired with it is this entry's ethical synthesis, not a definition contained in the scriptural phrase alone.

Newly proposed terms in this synthesis

The following expressions should not be attributed to Hardwig, Durkheim, Lacan, Foucault, Bellah, Kegan, McRaney, Stone, or any other cited author unless a later source establishes otherwise:

- **epistemic agency under mechanical solidarity**;
- **authority-gated belief updating** and **institution-gated belief updating**;
- **asymmetric epistemic permeability**;
- **epistemic trust anchor**, **institutional epistemic proxy**, and **reality-validation node**;
- **role-conferred epistemic authority spillover**;
- **culture mechanics** in the specific sense used here;
- **lifted mechanical solidarity**;
- **profitable-and-unobserved deviation counterfactual** as the bounded impersonal-obligation discriminator defined here;
- **first-order full capture**, **lifted full capture**, the distinction between shared answers and a shared answer generator, and **universal jurisdiction over the allocation and limitation of first-order outputs and jurisdictions**;
- **mechanical-solidarity field** and **field back-action** in the specific sense used here;
- the **culture-propagator person–field projection**, **reflexive gain** as a signed, delayed, network-local, nonlinear, and potentially asymmetric feedback descriptor, and the bridge-topology application by which relationships and associations can carry either amplification or correction;
- **operational inhabitation and scaffolded participation**, including the distinction among independent reconstruction, institutional scaffolding, and first-order participation relative to a lifted generator, as operation-relative configurations rather than permanent ranks of persons;
- **multidimensional agency-and-receiver profile** and its immersed-carrier, collective-system-builder, liberal-Humanist-carrier, and local-nonconformist ideal types; the "debug access" image names inspectability and

possible intervention rather than a literal module or desire to abolish collective authority;

- **functional morphology of mechanical solidarity** and its near-synonym **functional form of mechanical solidarity**, including **population body**, the distributed **trusted-opinion-leader function**, **field-generating and directing function**, and **organ–body resonance** in their present typed senses, together with the dotted-semiconductor depiction and its first-officer expression;
- **The Quantum Mechanics of Psychology**, the laser/clockwork correspondence, collective effervescence as a laser moment, and the claim that a laser moment can regenerate the moral protocol used by a clockwork system;
- **latent Culture Program profile**, **contrastive correction-interface probe**, **culturally indexed correction discontinuity**, and **affectively marked correction discontinuity** as proposed diagnostic terms, together with the four-way distinction among continuous application, valid differentiation, uncertain suspension, and protected exception;
- **Culture Program fingerprint** as the typed multi-case distribution of program-indexed correction discontinuities, protected directions, activation thresholds, affective qualifiers, and recovery conditions–not a unique, immutable, or already validated identifier;
- **open theorizing surface** and the **access–formation–correction grammar**, including the proposed directional relation from contraction of the shared first-order prescription footprint through possible contraction of culturally maintained scotomata to expansion of corrigible inquiry, and the distinction among **potential scotoma exposure**, **realized scotoma burden**, moral condemnation or prohibition, and actual obstruction of access or correction;
- **scotosis test**, **scotoma test**, and **cultural blind-spot test** as search aliases for the contrastive correction-interface probe where possible selective obstruction is under investigation, without making scotosis the result or renaming the earlier probe;
- **higher-order Culture Program capacity probe**, with **liftability test**, **higher-order capacity test**, and **lifted-order capacity probe** as search aliases, for the separate proposed inquiry into acquisition, performance, and transfer rather than selective loss of an already demonstrated operation;
- **negative-space fingerprint component** as recurrent selective non-noticing across matched causal cases, subject to explicit ordinary rival explanations;
- **guided unbraiding and possible de-radicalization**, the **individualized braid map**, **self-propagating epistemic audit**, **avalanche hypothesis**, and the contrast between a **self-analysis loop** and **self-deception loop** as proposed intervention and transfer concepts rather than established clinical methods or outcomes;
- **epistemic reindexing** and **collective reindexing** as proposed operations for restoring plural access paths and making independently observed anomalies mutually available without predetermining the resulting judgment;
- **Humanist-liberal counter-formation** as the proposed normative bundle of person-preserving, plural, reality-answerable developmental, pedagogical, interpersonal, and constitutional practices, with independence from the formative authority rather than agreement as its success condition;
- **bounded laser synchronization** and **generalized and jurisdictionalized laser synchronization**, together with their typed relationship to fusion pressure;
- **weak-field gravity and strong-field witnesses** as an observability analogy, the three-way calm-period distinction among dormancy, de-animation, and cultural loss, and the historical hypothesis that a society can forget a synchronization technology;
- **remanence** as a social hypothesis and the Bavaria–Swabia domain-wall mapping;
- **on-the-wire symbolic protocol** as the culture-mechanical translation of Lacan's big Other;
- **bigOther-presence** and **bigOther-as-Thou**;
- **repeater gain** as the network analogy for the amplification dimension rather than a separate social position;
- **trusted-opinion-leader function** as the canonical distributed receiving-field function, **trusted opinion leader** as its human person-in-role occupant, and **trusted-opinion-leader-function profile** as its multidimensional applied analysis of gain, authority, routing, translation, chief-facing mediation, feedback, jurisdiction, independence, and corrigibility;
- **loyal-carrier answerability insulation** and the three-level **claim → source reliability → trust architecture and jurisdiction** update audit as project-developed applications of pre-content source routing and the trusted-carrier correction lock, together with the authorization-loop formulation and its carrier-defection, validation-rule, parallel-route, and adjudicative bypass exits. The received Bonelli labels name routing positions; they do not supply this compound political mechanism;
- **professional idea-mediator function** as the source-side selection, translation, packaging, and circulation position and **professional idea mediator** as its human role occupant, kept distinct from idea producer, trusted receiving-field carrier, and institutional uptake;
- **prominence-derived apparent competence** and the Baader–trusted-opinion- leader–Sowell authority lifecycle as proposed mechanisms joining prominence, cross-domain deference, consequential recommendation, failure

insulation, and renewed apparent competence;
- **carrier-authority surface audit**, **inner-relation governance**, and **epistemic-liability gap** as project terms separating multiplex carrier functions and the location of benefits and error costs, with Schelsky's reflection elite, salvation-goods mediation, hierocratic inner relation, and institutionalized permanent reflection as source neighbours rather than the project's complete taxonomy;
- **trusted-carrier correction lock** as the gain-weighted configuration in which aligned high-trust receiving-field positions prevent a sustained correction from acquiring distributed credibility, reception, or operative force, while preserving the difference between personal and functional defection;
- **privileged authority-addressed programming topology** as one realization of the broader functional morphology, and the proposed **programming state**;
- **developmental installation of sovereign righteousness** as an explicitly immature trunk concept for installed asymmetrical moral personhood, including distributed deference, restricted reciprocity, burdened-duty phenomenology, harm reclassification, and the developmental-phenomenology versus public-myth boundary, rather than a diagnosis inferred from office, confidence, cruelty, or domination;
- **multi-mind-self presentation**, **operative multi-mind-self / multi-mind-self proper**, **fused multi-mind-self**, their broad-versus-strict register rule, the present functional threshold, **nested authorship**, and state profiles, including **episodic multi-mind-self**, **unitary ownership by the operative multi-mind-self**, and ***Beseelung / beseelt*** in their present technical senses;
- the **dual-identification hard case** and its independently-final-evaluator defeat condition for strict single-slot exclusivity;
- the **clan-as-multi-mind-self** and **corporate-feud hypothesis** as conditional application classifications rather than established anthropological terms;
- **epistemic adulthood**, **epistemic emancipation**, and the three trust-development stages;
- **impersonal universality against private interest** and the **remove-the-me test** as deliberately provisional Culture Mechanics formulations;
- **person-centred humanism** as an explanatory gloss for Durkheim's moral individualism, together with the maxim **remove "because it is me," not the person or the situation** and the aggregative-versus-fusion sacrifice distinction, while the recognition-only human-standing axiom remains a project commitment rather than an attribution to Durkheim;
- the **three-axis operative-agency model** separating I/We operative standpoint, EDA/DCL cognitive stance, and propositional/embodied-paralinguistic communication, together with the two-by-two EDA/DCL–I/We matrix and the claim that repersonalization can return through either direct encounter or imaginative reconstruction;
- **be-humming** as the originating term for embodied, paralinguistic, and interactional social signalling, while **Gorilla** remains an informal image and no universal numerical split between signalling and argument is claimed;
- **closure-bound script-execution mode** and its carefully bounded informal shorthand **bot-mode** as a local interactional condition rather than a human type, diagnosis, or license to call a person a bot or NPC;
- the three **Humanism–Diversity relation types**—nested, supplementary, and replacement—together with capitalization of *Diversity* only for the organizing master signifier or programmatic configuration;
- the **press-secretary–interpreter–auditor triad**, **self-objectification transition**, **finality cut**, and ten-step reflective audit sequence in their present Culture Mechanics senses;
- **state transmission**, **operation transmission**, and **Socratic manipulation** as defined here;
- **operation-bootstrapped codebook formation**, **reconstruction codebook** as distributed analytical shorthand, and the claim that recurrent operation-rich formation makes later compressed state transmission possible;
- the **operation-first decoder-bootstrap principle** as the ordered complement in which operation transmission constructs and repairs the decoder while state transmission exploits it, and **reconstruction reach** as the audience-relative size of the learned complex a token can reliably activate;
- **collective epistemic formation** as the process that forms locally executable concepts, distinctions, query paths, methods, inferential habits, and evidential standards, and the **distributed epistemic milieu** as the dispersed cross-person and cross-generational environment that carries the relevant language, examples, practices, artifacts, records, instruments, trained persons, and correction procedures;
- the **hot–cold mode distinction** between local-bigOther affective–evaluative actuation and collective epistemic formation executed through ordinary rider or main-CPU cognition, together with **affect in service of corrigible world-contact versus affect in service of answer protection** as the directional scientific-ethos contrast rather than a claim that affect is evidence;
- **scientific or procedural impartiality** as a genuinely cultivated discipline capable of checking private preference, while its problem space, perceptual training, methods, instruments, and standards remain products of a thought style answerable to me–we–world correction rather than a cultureless view;
- **collar-conditioned semantic access**, **semantic-access interface**, and the retrospective, present, prospective,

and public-address access distinctions as proposed Culture Mechanics mechanisms rather than Durkheimian, Haidtian, Lacanian, database, or neuroanatomical terms;
- the read, query, segmentation, write or binding, join, alias, articulation, and public-address **interface gates**; **query suppression**, **indexed prohibition**, **index modification**, and **protected non-integration** as proposed persistence and access distinctions rather than literal memory operations;
- **asymmetric addressability**, **query hyperactivation**, **epistemic acquisition closure**, and **crisis–relief reindexing** as proposed access, acquisition, and high-gain installation terms rather than established clinical mechanisms or evidence of truth, trauma, abuse, or intentional design;
- **perception-stage correction closure** as the pre-public obstruction family containing analytically distinct penalty, occupation, and internal- classification routes;
- **semantic**, **retrospective**, **prospective**, and **culturally indexed scotoma** as extensions of Lonergan's process–result vocabulary, together with **affectively sighted but semantically blind** as a split-accessibility description rather than a diagnosis;
- **secure base** and **avoidance enclosure** as the project contrast between support that enlarges reality contact and protection that reinforces shrinking avoidance, without importing a complete clinical or attachment-theory model;
- **domain contact**, **surface habituation is not understanding**, **living knowledge**, **joint codebook formation**, and **practice-formed coordination capacity** as the project-developed extension from operation-rich learning through symbolic addressing and reconstructible capability into socially calibrated codebooks and possible clockwork coordination, including the distinction between positive affordance disclosed through repeatable success and model limits disclosed through resistance or failure, neither of which is a complete truth, legitimacy, or valence oracle;
- **audience-modelled reconstruction**, **adversarial audience-modelled reconstruction**, and the **decompression audit** in their present operational forms;
- **authorization payload** and the **authorization-payload audit**;
- **silent principal**, **silent-principal surrogate mechanism**, **surrogate-sovereignty hazard**, and the five-part extension of the authorization audit;
- the receiving-field cross-reference to **decision–correction custody** and **surrogate-correction asymmetry**, while preserving *Mythology Construction* as their primary semantic home and Sowell's knowledge, incentive, feedback, surrogate-decision, and "Teflon prophets" themes as source material rather than the project's complete typed mechanism;
- the **cognitive-relief hypothesis** in its present mechanistic and testable form;
- **MCIP—Mirror, Cut, Invite, Promise**; **Ethics cannot be outsourced, but courage can be scaffolded**; and **Support the cost without appropriating the judgment** in their project-developed agency and formation senses.

Field, programming-topology, and collective-agent source lineage

- **Émile Durkheim** supplies mechanical and organic solidarity, homogeneous and segmental social structure, politico-familial organization, collective personality, collective consciousness, the common conscience acting through a defined organ, the chief as organized incarnation, collective effervescence, *homo duplex*, the socially formed intellectual-and-moral pole, and the non-individualist starting point. *De la division du travail social* does not contain the local-processor, dotted-lattice, distributed-emitter, organ–body-resonance, or elevation-shielding models. The passage about men disengaging themselves from the mass occurs inside Durkheim's quotation of Theodor Waitz; Durkheim's own subsequent analysis says that organized chiefly power can become partly autonomous. His historical claim concerns progressive preponderance of organic solidarity, not mechanical solidarity's complete disappearance. *Les formes élémentaires de la vie religieuse* supplies electricity, reciprocal amplification, rhythmic unity, and "mystic mechanics" as close source neighbors, but not a laser, clockwork, or ferromagnet theory. "The Dualism of Human Nature and Its Social Conditions" supplies the individual/social duality and the claim that language, concepts, rational activity, and morality belong to the socially derived pole; it does not supply the project's processor decomposition, codebook mechanism, or semantic-access channel.
- **The project author** supplies the functional-form hypothesis as a morphology of the whole society, the distributed trusted-opinion-leader carriers shown as dots in the semiconductor analogy, centralized, synthetic, and distributed field-generating functions, organ–body resonance, the chief as organ of the collective owner, and the first-officer comparison for one chief-facing expression of trusted opinion leadership. The assistant formalized the component table, source/project split, realization types, threshold boundaries, and the distinction among multi-mind-self presentation, operative multi-mind-self, and fused multi-mind-self. These contributions are project developments rather than concepts attributed to Durkheim, Bach, Benda, or the creators of *Star Trek*.

- **Robert N. Bellah's** introduction to *Émile Durkheim on Morality and Society* supports reading Durkheim as a theorist of collective psychology and supplies *piety toward the real*. Bellah does not propose the multi-mind implementation.
- **William James** and **Martin Buber** supply partial phenomenological neighbors for felt presence and second-person encounter. James also describes abstract realities as polarizing and magnetizing human lives. **Gustave Le Bon** uses magnetic influence and hypnotic fascination in crowd psychology. The detailed ferromagnetic-domain analogy, laser/clockwork synthesis, and causal mechanism remain project-developed and separate from their accounts.
- **Julien Benda's** *La trahison des clercs* (1927) is used as situated testimony from a period in which political passions were becoming more coherent, continuous, sacred, and intellectually systematized. His separate account of clercs converting political usefulness into moral and epistemic authority is applied as the truth–utility bridge and the morality–politics bridge; it does not define the epistemic-field analogy. **Dietrich Bonhoeffer's** "Von der Dummheit" (1943) is used as testimony to the person-level effects of overwhelming political or religious power. Their observations do not establish the weak-field analogy or the culture-mechanical explanation.
- **Lionel Shriver's** "How to spot the next mania" is used as a contemporary first-person diagnosis of renewed public manias and "collective derangement" since roughly 2012; her novel *Mania* (2024) is the fictional treatment of that concern. The change in visibility is her observation; the synchronization mechanism and historical-loss hypothesis remain the present theory's interpretation.
- **Otto von Gierke**, **F. W. Maitland**, **Christian List**, and **Philip Pettit** supply increasingly explicit accounts of real group personality, moral/legal personality, and organizational group agency. Their work helps specify the threshold question while leaving the culture-mechanical implementation new.
- **Joscha Bach's** "Synthetic Sentience" supplies the term *multi-mind-self* and a neighbouring account of gods or top-level agents enacted across minds. **Julian Jaynes's** bicameral-mind hypothesis supplies a controversial local model in which action-guiding products are experienced as divine voices rather than self-authored deliberation. Culture Mechanics' Jaynes–Bach bridge, its processor and field architecture, and its separation of collective agency from fusion are project-developed. A critical reappraisal identifies neurological and philological difficulties in Jaynes's complete historical account.
- **Sigmund Freud**, **Melanie Green and Timothy Brock**, **Donald Horton and R. Richard Wohl**, **Michael Suk-Young Chwe**, **Pierre Bourdieu**, and **Randall Collins** each establish or theorize one component adjacent to the proposed programming state. Their works are linked in Section 12; none should be cited as establishing the whole authority-addressed topology.
- The ***Volksempfänger*** example is documented by the Science Museum Group's collection record. Its use as a technological replication of the classroom geometry is the present framework's interpretation.
- **Durkheim's** "Les principes de 1789 et la sociologie" supplies contemporary observations about unconscious social genesis, surviving affect, invented conscious reasons, revolutionary principles as articles of faith, and structural change in European societies. It does not establish the local bigOther, single slot, field mechanism, or multi-mind-self.
- **Karen Paige Ericksen and Heather Horton**, "Blood Feuds: Cross-Cultural Variations in Kin Group Vengeance", supply comparative evidence concerning kin-group vengeance, duty, liability, target substitution, marriage, and adjudication. **Max Gluckman's** "The Peace in the Feud" supplies the classic account of feud as a rule-governed relation constrained by cross-cutting allegiances. The clan-as-multi-mind-self classification is the present project's hypothesis.
- **Giuseppe Dari-Mattiacci and Nuno Garoupa**, "The Rise and Fall of Communal Liability in Ancient Law", supply an economic model of the transition from communal liability to individual responsibility and public enforcement. Their mechanism is an alternative or complement to the culture-mechanical and exogamy hypotheses, not confirmation of them.

Opinion-leader and influencer research for operational comparison

- **Local healthcare opinion leaders — Gerd Flodgren, Mary Ann O'Brien, Elena Parmelli, and Jeremy Grimshaw.** The 2019 Cochrane review *Local Opinion Leaders: Effects on Professional Practice and Healthcare Outcomes* finds heterogeneous but probably positive effects on professional compliance with evidence-based practice and very uncertain effects on patient outcomes. It supports conditional field influence, not the complete culture-mechanical account.
- **Opinion-leader identification — Thomas W. Valente and Patchareeya Pumpuang.** "Identifying Opinion Leaders to Promote Behavior Change" reviews ten identification methods across almost 200 studies and compares their advantages and disadvantages. It supports identifying authority from the receiving network rather than equating formal rank with influence.
- **Peer diffusion — Leila Agha and Dan Zeltzer.** *Drug Diffusion through Peer Networks: The Influence of Industry*

Payments estimates payment-associated prescribing effects among physicians and their peers in a particular anticoagulant market. The result supports peer spillover in that setting, not a universal causal law or an inference of corruption from payment alone.

- **Cultivated medical KOLs — Brian Gac, Kgosi Tavares, Hanna Yakubi, Hannah Khan, Dorie E. Apollonio, and Eric Crosbie.** "Pharmaceutical Industry Use of Key Opinion Leaders to Market Prescription Opioids" uses internal industry documents to show deliberate identification, recruitment, and development of KOLs. This is evidence for endogenous authority production in that case, not a definition of medical expertise or proof against every KOL relationship.
- **Social-media influencer research — Yatish Joshi, Weng Marc Lim, Khyati Jagani, and Satish Kumar.** Their systematic review "Social Media Influencer Marketing: Foundations, Trends, and Ways Forward" maps a developed but theoretically federated literature involving source credibility, parasocial relations, authenticity, persuasion knowledge, sponsorship, and engagement. It supplies comparison variables rather than one unified influencer theory.
- **Disclosure and authority hygiene.** The US Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services' Open Payments programme, the HHS Office of Inspector General's speaker-programme fraud alert, and the US Federal Trade Commission's social-media disclosure guidance provide domain-specific examples of making financial or material relations visible. Disclosure improves inspectability but does not by itself prove corruption, falsity, independence, or safety.

Persuasion and MCIP: sources and method lineage

- **David McRaney**, *How Minds Change* (2022), is a journalistic synthesis of research and practice concerning belief change. It motivates parts of the persuasion discussion, but *state transmission*, *operation transmission*, and MCIP are not McRaney's terminology.
- **Joshua Kalla and David Broockman**, "Reducing Exclusionary Attitudes through Interpersonal Conversation: Evidence from Three Field Experiments" (2020), provide empirical evidence concerning deep canvassing and non-judgmental narrative exchange. Their intervention is not MCIP and does not show that a conversational method guarantees truth.
- **Carl R. Rogers and Richard E. Farson**, "Active Listening" (1957), are an antecedent for *Mirror*.
- **William R. Miller and Stephen Rollnick**, *Motivational Interviewing: Helping People Change* (third-edition chapter, 2013), are antecedents for reflective listening, eliciting the person's own reasons, and preserving authorship.
- **J. L. Austin**, *How to Do Things with Words* (1962), supplies the speech-act background for treating a promise as an act that creates a practical and relational commitment.
- **Jacques Lacan's** use of the *cut* supplies a loose psychoanalytic analogy for interrupting an established sequence. MCIP's *Cut* is operationally defined by this entry and should not be presented as Lacanian technique without further argument.

Project-specific reality-orientation formulation

- The model-centred loop of concepts, operations, prediction, surprise, and revision is an originating formulation within this coordinated theory family and supplies the positive account of reality correction used here.